

Yeshua: Jesus Without Christianity

Encountering the Galilean before the religion

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Who I Am

I was born on August 13, 1980, in Iași, into a religious, neo-Protestant environment, belonging to the Christian Evangelical denomination. From the very beginning, my childhood was saturated with the language of faith: memorized verses, sermons heard with close attention, church gatherings in which Scripture was treated as the absolute reference point for life. For me, the Bible was never merely a religious text. It was the universe in which I learned to think.

At the age of fourteen, I joined another neo-Protestant group in Brașov, one not officially affiliated yet holding a doctrine very close to that of the other evangelical denominations. For an adolescent, this environment had something magnetic about it: moral clarity, passion, the sense of taking part in something greater than yourself. In those years, faith was not, for me, a cultural identity but an existential calling. My passion for Scripture quickly became the center of my life.

I spent thousands of hours studying the Bible—not out of obligation, but out of fascination. I remember whole evenings spent reading, comparing passages, trying to understand meanings, connections, apparent contradictions. For me, the Bible was an intellectual and spiritual puzzle of almost infinite depth. At twenty-two, I graduated from the Bible school attached to the community I belonged to. At that moment I was convinced that my life would be devoted to religious ministry. It was the natural path for someone who had already lived through years of intense study and spiritual involvement. At twenty-three, I also completed my degree at the Faculty of Psychology of Spiru

Haret University in Braşov. At the time, I saw no contradiction between the two directions—theology and psychology. On the contrary, I saw them as two different ways of understanding the human being. Only later did I realize how deeply this training had shaped me.

My inclination toward psychology led me, almost inevitably, to read the biblical text not only theologically but also humanly. To look for inner dynamics, mechanisms, patterns of behavior, not only doctrines. And, if I am honest, it sometimes became hard for me to see things in purely religious terms once I had begun to see them psychologically.

Still, at twenty-seven, I made a decision that would radically change the direction of my life: I separated from that denomination. Not out of a lack of faith, but out of the conviction that the institutional form in which it was expressed had become too restrictive for the questions I had begun to ask myself. Initially, my intention was to start another church, an independent one. But I chose to wait another year before taking that step. Paradoxically, that period of waiting was the very moment when I began to drift further and further from the idea of religious organization itself.

I never stopped studying the Bible. But, gradually, my perspective changed. I began to read the text not only as a doctrinal authority but as an existential document—a collection of human experiences, spiritual intuitions, and historical tensions. Psychology helped me see in these texts not only “truths to be believed,” but also states of consciousness, defense mechanisms, forms of fear, attachments, needs for validation or control. Things that, once you see them, you can no longer unsee.

This process was not a quick one. It took me roughly ten years from the moment I left the community that had formed me before I could honestly say that I identify more with an existentialist-humanist perspective than with the traditional Christian identity. This change did not mean abandoning my interest in Yeshua. On the contrary.

As I moved away from the religious institution, the figure of Yeshua became even more fascinating to me. I began to look at him not through the filter of dogma, but through the lens of fundamental questions about the human condition: freedom, responsibility, authenticity, conscious-

ness. Ironically, it was precisely this perspective that provoked strong reactions from practicing Christians.

Many of them tell me that the way I interpret Yeshua's teachings is not Christian. Others, on the contrary, say that for the first time these teachings strike them as alive. This contrast of reactions was one of the main reasons I wrote this book. I currently host two podcasts on YouTube: one on existential philosophy, called "Existential Questions," and the other on the psychology of relationships, called "What Women Want."

Once again, I combine theology with psychology, exactly as I will do throughout this book. I am not writing from the position of an institutional theologian, nor from that of an adversary of Christianity. I write from the position of someone who lived the faith from the inside, with intensity, who spent thousands of hours in the biblical text, and who, for that very reason, feels the need to return to the fundamental question: What did Yeshua actually mean to say?

And, if I am honest, that question gave me no peace. It changed my direction. This book is the result of that question.

Foreword

This book is not written against Christianity. Nor is it written to replace it. I do not contest anyone's faith, I do not dismantle rituals, I do not attack communities, and I do not set out to wrench from people's hands something that gives them meaning, support, or hope. I deeply respect the human need to believe, to belong, and to anchor oneself in a tradition. What I am doing here is something simpler—and, perhaps for that very reason, more uncomfortable.

I try to draw close to Yeshua, the man from Galilee, before his message became a system, a doctrine, an institution, or an ideology. Not in order to “reclaim” him from Christianity, but in order to see him as he is. Throughout history, between Yeshua's voice and the Christianity that was built in his name, there have settled centuries of interpretations, translations, political decisions, councils, fears, needs for control, and cultural contexts. None of this is, in itself, malevolent.

But it inevitably changes who Yeshua actually was. This book does not begin from the question “what must we believe about Yeshua?”, but from one far more uncomfortable: how did he live, how did he see, and how did he relate to people, to truth, to error, and to God? I do not write from the stance of someone who “knows better.”

I write from the stance of someone who has read, compared, asked questions, and observed real tensions between Yeshua's living message and the religious form that resulted from it afterward. The non-Christian reader is not being “converted.” But he is invited to look beyond religious labels. If, along the way, some ideas prove uncomfortable, it is

not because they attack faith, but because they touch a rarely explored area: the difference between following a message and belonging to a system.

Yeshua did not demand adherence to a doctrine. He did not demand uniformity. He did not demand the defense of a religious identity. And I admit this confused me for a long time. Because that was exactly what I was doing. But Yeshua demanded lucidity, ownership, presence, and inner transformation. This book does not ask you to agree with it. It asks only to be read with honesty.

1. Who Is Yeshua

Yeshua or Jesus

At the heart of this book lies a distinction that, though it may seem merely formal, profoundly changes the way the message of Jesus is understood: the difference between Yeshua and Jesus. Yeshua is the Aramaic form of the name borne by the Jewish man from Galilee. It was a common name in the first century, derived from Yehoshua, and it means “God saves” or “God delivers.” This is how his family, his friends, his disciples, and ordinary people called him.

Yeshua belongs to a living context: a culture, a language, a concrete history. He is the man who lived, spoke, healed, provoked, and loved. Jesus, by contrast, is the Greco-Latin form of the same name (*Iesous* in Greek, *Iesus* in Latin), through which the figure of Yeshua entered the theological, imperial, and later dogmatic world.

“Jesus” is already a name laden with centuries of interpretation, doctrines, councils, and definitions concerning divine nature, sin, salvation, and religious authority. This book does not claim that one is “true” and the other “false.”

Isus or Iisus?

In the Romanian language, a question often arises: which form is correct — “Isus” or “Iisus”? Both are correct, but they come from different traditions. The form *Iisus* is specific to the Orthodox tradition and more faithfully reflects the transliteration from ancient Greek

(Iēsous), where the initial vowel is lengthened. For this reason, Orthodox writings and translations use “Iisus Hristos.”

The form *Isus* is common in modern Romanian, having been adopted in more recent translations of the Bible and in academic, theological, and secular usage. It is the form most widespread in current use, and it does not represent a “mistaken simplification” but rather a natural linguistic adaptation. This book uses the form *Yeshua*, not for confessional reasons, but for the sake of readability and clarity for a contemporary readership.

The choice does not imply a theological stance and does not deny the validity of the form “Jesus.” In essence, the form of the name is not what is at stake. What is at stake is whether we are speaking of a religious figure being defended or a living message, lived and embraced. This book seeks the Yeshua behind the name.

Why Yeshua Did Not Found a Religion

One of the most striking things, when you read Yeshua without the lenses of the institution, is that he does not seem interested in building a system. And, honestly, that is hard to accept if you come from within a system. He does not establish an organization with hierarchies, procedures, doctrinal manuals, and mechanisms of belonging. He does not demand adherence to a formula; he invites a transformation of one’s way of being. Instead of saying “believe in my system,” he says “follow me” (Mark 1:17).

But “follow me” is not an invitation to conformity; it is a call to a way of life that is recognized by its fruit, not by its slogan. Yeshua speaks obsessively about the Kingdom, but the Kingdom is not an institution. It is a lived reality. He says that the Kingdom “does not come in a way that can be observed” and that “the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21). If you take this seriously, almost all the religion we know disappears.

It is the perfect antibody against institutionalization: if the Kingdom is within, no one can possess, administer, or control it. Institutions live

by monopoly. Yeshua's Kingdom lives by freedom. Yeshua harshly criticizes religion as a system of purity and status. Not faith as a living relationship with God, but religion as a mechanism of separation and superiority.

When he says, "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites," his criticism is not aimed at prayer or at Scripture, but at a type of "holiness" that produces proud, closed, rigid people, and that uses the law in order to feel above others (Matthew 23). The problem is not morality, but moralism: the use of morality as a weapon of identity. And here it becomes uncomfortable, because moralism is far easier than transformation. Moreover, Yeshua constantly breaks the boundaries of belonging.

He speaks with Samaritans, he praises the faith of a Roman centurion, he allows himself to be touched by those considered "unclean," he eats with sinners (John 4:7–10; Matthew 8:10–11; Mark 2:16–17). Within a religious system, the "unclean" person is excluded in order to protect the purity of the group. In Yeshua's logic, that is precisely where the work lies: not to relativize the truth, but to demonstrate that God is not the property of those who are "clean."

If Yeshua had founded a religion, he would have created clear criteria of belonging: formulas, rituals, signs. Instead, he speaks of fruit: "by their fruit you will know them" (Matthew 7:16). Fruit cannot be falsified indefinitely, whereas belonging can. Religion needs external identifiers. The Kingdom needs internal transformation. This is where the historical tension arises: after Yeshua's death, the community must survive.

And this is where the compromise begins, perhaps inevitably. Any community, in order to survive, becomes an organization. An organization needs boundaries, rules, doctrine. And so a religion *about* Yeshua is born. But the religion *of* Yeshua remains something else: a way of being that cannot be fully captured by an institution. That is why, in every age, Yeshua remains uncomfortable even for those who "defend" him.

Did Yeshua Intend to Create Christianity?

In the words and deeds of Yeshua, there never appears any intention to found a new religion, an institution, or a separate doctrinal system. Yeshua does not use the term “Christian,” does not define dogmas, does not build hierarchical structures, and does not draw confessional boundaries. The very idea of “Christian” would probably have sounded strange even to his disciples. He speaks constantly about the Kingdom of God, not about a religion.

“The Kingdom of God is near.” (Mark 1:15) “The Kingdom of God is within you.” (Luke 17:21) Yeshua does not call people to adhere to a system, but to enter into a state of life. His call is existential, not institutional. He does not say “create an organization,” but: “Follow me.” (Matthew 4:19) This following is not a formal belonging, but a transformation of one’s way of being. Yeshua does not propose a new religion, but a new humanity.

Where Does Christianity Appear as a Religion?

Christianity, as a theological, doctrinal, and institutional system, appears historically after Yeshua. It is not born directly from his life and message, but above all from the interpretation, formulation, and systematization carried out afterward, especially by the Apostle Paul. In this process, the emphasis gradually shifts from the Kingdom to salvation, from living to doctrinally formulated belief, from a living example to a sacrifice centralized in a single event.

The Pauline formula “We preach Christ crucified” (1 Corinthians 1:23) becomes the nucleus of the new religious construction. This shift has an obvious advantage: the message becomes easier to transmit on a large scale, easier to preach, easier to organize. At the same time, however, it also becomes easier to separate from lived experience. The emphasis shifts from “follow me” to “believe about me,” from inner transformation to the acceptance of a doctrine.

Here Christianity appears as a religion of the creed, not merely as a path of becoming. Not as a life lived, but as a truth declared.

Why the Institution of the Church Nonetheless Appeared

After Yeshua's death, the community had to survive. Any community that endures through time inevitably becomes an institution. Rules, roles, buildings, and doctrine appear. This process is historical and, to a certain extent, inevitable. But to confuse this evolution with Yeshua's original intention is to project back onto him a logic that he constantly contested.

Yeshua explicitly warns against hierarchies of a religious type: "you are not to be called rabbi... for you have one Teacher" (Matthew 23:8). This warning is hard to reconcile with the idea that he would have intended a rigid clerical structure. So Yeshua did not want to have churches in the institutional sense. He wanted there to be a living community, built on recognition, not on power.

When he says, "on this rock I will build my Church," he is referring not to buildings, not to offices, not to a succession of authority, but to a consciousness that sees and to a community that lives by this seeing. The Church, in Yeshua's sense, is not a place where you go. It is a way of being together.

Yeshua and the Religious Institution

The relationship between Yeshua and the religious institution is one of the most tension-filled and revealing themes of the Gospels. Not because Yeshua was against faith, but because he constantly refused to allow faith to be reduced to a system that controls life. By contrast, Paul would lay the foundations of an organization without which the message would not have survived historically, but this organization would profoundly change the perspective.

The Christianity that came after them would gradually transform this organization into an institution of power, sometimes in direct opposition to Yeshua's original spirit. Yeshua is not anti-religious. He lives within Judaism, goes to the synagogue "as was his custom" (Luke 4:16), takes part in the feasts (John 7), and quotes the Scriptures with profound

naturalness. His criticism is not directed against faith, but against the moment when faith becomes a mechanism of control.

Yeshua's major conflict is not with sinners, but with the religious leaders: "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!" (Matthew 23:27). The reason is repeated: the institution had come to defend the rule more than life itself. "They tie up heavy burdens, hard to bear, and lay them on people's shoulders" (Matthew 23:4).

In Yeshua's view, the institution becomes dangerous when it absolutizes the rule, legitimizes itself through fear, excludes in the name of God, and protects its own authority more than the truth. Instead of demanding the reform of the institution, Yeshua relativizes it through a statement that moves the center of the relationship with God from the outside to the inside: "The hour is coming when you will worship neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem" (John 4:21).

This is not a geographical criticism, but a theological one. The relationship with God will no longer depend on a place, a temple, or a religious caste, but on a state of the human being: "The true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth" (John 4:23). Here the rupture occurs: the institution is no longer the center. Yeshua refuses to ground his authority on office or on institutional validation.

He forgives without ritual: "Son, your sins are forgiven" (Mark 2:5). He heals without permission, even on the Sabbath, provoking harsh reactions: "They watched him to see whether he would heal him on the Sabbath" (Mark 3:2). He speaks directly in the name of God, without asking anyone's approval. That is why the Gospels note people's astonishment: "He taught as one who had authority, not as the scribes" (Matthew 7:29). The institution functions through the delegation of authority; Yeshua functions through presence. This is the essential rupture.

With Paul, the problem is different. He does not know Yeshua historically and does not enter into direct conflict with the Jewish institution in the same way. His mission is to build stable communities in a hostile and fragmented world. For this, organization becomes inevitable. Paul introduces structures of leadership — "overseers" and

“elders” (1 Timothy 3) — communal rules, criteria of belonging, and internal discipline.

He warns against “strange teachings” (Galatians 1:6–9) and insists on order: “God is not a God of disorder but of peace” (1 Corinthians 14:33). For Paul, the institution is not the enemy of life, but the condition of the message’s survival. The emphasis begins to shift from Yeshua’s radical freedom to doctrinal unity and communal stability. This shift is pragmatic and, in a sense, necessary.

But it changes the perspective: faith begins to be administered. What in Yeshua was a direct encounter with God gradually becomes belonging to an organized community that guards the message. The Christianity that came after Paul would carry this logic further. With the alliance between the Church and political power, the religious institution becomes the supreme moral authority, the administrator of salvation, the arbiter of truth, and the guardian of social order.

The relationship with God begins to be mediated by hierarchies, obligatory rituals, fixed dogmas, and sanctions. What in Paul was organization for protection becomes institution for control. The fear of error replaces trust in discernment. The question becomes dangerous. Direct experience becomes suspect.

It was precisely this dynamic that Yeshua had criticized when he said: “You have taken away the key of knowledge; you yourselves did not enter, and you hindered those who were entering” (Luke 11:52). The difference in perspective becomes clear when we look at the relationship between life, authority, and institution. In Yeshua, the institution is always relative. Life is the measure of truth, not the framework that contains it. Authority springs from the coherence between word and life, not from position.

That is why Yeshua can say: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). He does not send people toward an institution in order to encounter God; he sends them back into their own awakened consciousness. In Paul, the institution becomes necessary for coherence and continuity. Authority also comes from fidelity to the message preached, and faith begins to be structured and protected from chaos.

In later Christianity, this displacement reaches the point of inversion: the institution becomes central, and life is called to conform to it. Truth no longer flows from life toward the institution, but is defined by the institution and transmitted to life. Yeshua did not come to build an institution. He came to free the relationship with God from dependence on institutions. Paul built structures so that the message would survive.

Later Christianity often transformed the structures into an end in themselves. Whenever the institution serves life, it remains legitimate. Whenever it begins to serve itself, the words of Yeshua resound once more: what truly matters has been forgotten.

Did Yeshua Want to Have Churches?

The question of whether Yeshua intended to create “churches” in the sense in which we know them today is one of the most important and most uncomfortable questions of Christianity. For if the answer is “no,” then a great part of what we today call religious life must be reread not as the fulfillment of Yeshua’s will, but as a later historical development.

In the Gospels, Yeshua does not speak about buildings, hierarchies, standardized rituals, or administrative structures. He does not sketch out an institutional plan, does not designate offices, does not create a formal organization. His message constantly revolves around the Kingdom of God — a living, dynamic, present reality, not a fixed institution.

That is why, when we come to the sentence “On this rock I will build my Church” (Matthew 16:18), it is essential to pause and ask: what did Yeshua mean by “church”? The word translated as “church” is *ekklesia*. In the context of the first century, *ekklesia* did not denote a sacred edifice, nor a religious institution. It meant, quite simply, an assembly, a calling together, a convened community.

It was a term used in civic life to describe a gathering of people called to take part in a common reality. Therefore, when Yeshua says “I will build my Church,” he is not speaking of walls, altars, or structures, but of a living community, formed of people who live out of a different

consciousness. The “building” is not architectural, but relational and existential.

This interpretation is confirmed by the fact that Yeshua never associates *ekklesia* with any particular sacred space. On the contrary, he constantly relativizes space: “The hour is coming when you will worship the Father neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem... the true worshipers will worship in spirit and in truth” (John 4:21–23). Such a statement is incompatible with the idea that Yeshua sought to build a religion centered on sacred locations.

The statement to Peter appears at a key moment: the disciples are asked who they believe Yeshua is. After various answers, Peter says: “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God” (Matthew 16:16). Yeshua’s reply is famous: “You are Peter, and on this rock I will build my Church” (Matthew 16:18). Institutional Christian tradition would interpret this “rock” as the person of Peter, from whom a line of authority, succession, and power would derive.

But the text, read carefully, allows a far deeper understanding, one more coherent with the rest of Yeshua’s message. Yeshua does not say: “on you, Peter, as an individual, I will build an institution.” He makes a play on words between Peter’s name (Petros — stone) and *petra* — rock, a term that indicates a foundation, not an office.

The “rock” is not the man Peter with his weaknesses — whom Yeshua will rebuke just a few verses later (“Get behind me, Satan!” — Matthew 16:23) — but the revelation that Peter has just spoken. Yeshua clarifies this immediately: “flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father” (Matthew 16:17). So the “rock” is not a personal quality of Peter, but the capacity to see.

It is the recognition of Yeshua beyond appearances, a seeing that does not come from reason, tradition, or status, but from an inner openness. On this “rock” — that is, on this awakened consciousness — Yeshua says he will “build” his community. The Church, in Yeshua’s sense, is formed of people who see, not of people who hold offices. Of people who recognize, not of people who administer.

This interpretation is confirmed by the fact that Yeshua does not grant Peter a role of domination. On the contrary, Peter will fail gravely, he will deny Yeshua (Matthew 26:69–75), and his restoration will not come through institutional reinstatement, but through a relational question: “Do you love me?” (John 21:15–17). Authority, in Yeshua, does not come from office, but from love.

What “I Will Build” Means

The “building” of which Yeshua speaks is not an act of rapid construction, but a living process. Yeshua does not say “I will establish,” “I will organize,” or “I will administer.” He says “I will build” — an organic, slow, relational verb. This building happens through transformed relationships, people who learn to live without fear, communities that do not operate on domination. That is why Yeshua adds: “the gates of hell will not prevail against it” (Matthew 16:18).

“Hell” (Hades) is not a place of fire, but the symbol of death, fear, and separation. A community built on seeing and relationship cannot be destroyed by fear, because it is not based on control.

How Yeshua Wants Us to Relate to Him

From his own words, Yeshua never presents himself as an inaccessible exception, severed from the human condition, but as a model of living that can be followed. He does not speak of himself as an unattainable ideal, but as an open path. His language is constantly one of imitation, of participation, and of becoming: not “look at me,” but “follow me.”

This perspective is clear in his gestures and teachings, when he says: “I have given you an example, that you also should do as I have done” (John 13:15). Here, Yeshua directly links truth to life, not to passive admiration. The same perspective appears even more clearly when he affirms: “Whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do” (John 14:12).

Faith, in his sense, is not intellectual assent, but entry into a state of consciousness from which the same deeds spring. Yeshua does not ask

to be venerated from a distance, but to be followed from within. To follow him does not mean to repeat external gestures, but to enter into the same quality of being: love without conditions, truth without a mask, full presence, and the abandonment of the ego as the center of life.

When Yeshua says: “Be perfect, as your heavenly Father is perfect” (Matthew 5:48), he is not proposing a rigid and impossible moral perfection, but is speaking of the fullness of love. This call would make no sense if it were fundamentally impossible. In his logic, perfection is not ethical performance, but the maturing of the heart. That is why he also affirms that “the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21).

Yeshua does not position himself as a substitute for the maturing of the human being, but as its living direction. He does not say, “You will never be able to be like me,” but constantly utters the simple and radical call: “Follow me.”

Would Today’s Christianity Recognize Yeshua?

The Gospels offer an uncomfortable precedent that cannot be avoided: Yeshua was not recognized by the religious elites of his time. Not because they were less devout or less concerned with God, but because they were deeply dependent on a system through which they administered the truth. It was precisely this dependence that made it impossible to recognize life when it appeared outside the framework.

The same risk exists today, in different forms, but with the same underlying structure. Yeshua had no recognized credentials. “How does this man know the Scriptures, when he has never been taught?” (John 7:15) expresses not curiosity, but suspicion. He relativized the form whenever it blocked life: “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27). He forgave without institutional permission: “Son, your sins are forgiven” (Mark 2:5–7).

He healed on the Sabbath, provoking the system at its sensitive point (Mark 3:1–6). He ate with the excluded, undermining the moral boundaries that defined belonging (Luke 5:29–32). All these were not

accidental deviations, but signs of a different axis. The verdict that Yeshua pronounces remains one of the harshest in the Gospels: “You have taken away the key of knowledge; you yourselves did not enter, and you hindered those who were entering” (Luke 11:52).

The problem was not a lack of religious zeal, but the transformation of religion into a system for controlling access to God. If Yeshua were to appear today in his real form, the reactions would be surprisingly familiar. There would be institutional suspicion: “Who authorized you?” — perhaps phrased more elegantly, but with the same meaning (Matthew 21:23).

Doctrinal anxiety would arise, because Yeshua would once again preach the Kingdom as a life lived, not as a system of correct ideas: “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord’...” (Matthew 7:21). There would also be a profound discomfort with his freedom. Yeshua puts love before the rule: “I desire mercy, not sacrifice” (Matthew 12:7). He puts freedom before belonging: “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32).

For a Christianity centered on control, demarcation, and doctrinal security, this freedom would sound dangerous. History repeats itself not out of malice, but out of blindness. Yeshua names this blindness as not moral, but perceptual: “Blind guides” (Matthew 23:16). It appears wherever authority is confused with office, truth with doctrine, fidelity with conformity. When the system becomes the goal, life becomes a threat.

Yeshua remains uncomfortable for any structure that defends itself, because he does not negotiate the truth in order to protect the form. As then, not everyone would be blind. Some “from within” would sense the truth without being able to control it. Nicodemus comes by night, with fear and sincerity (John 3). Joseph of Arimathea takes the risk when everything seems lost (John 19:38). They would be few, but decisive.

People who put life before role, conscience before position, truth before security. It is plausible that a part of today’s Christianity would not recognize the real Yeshua, not because he would be too little

religious, but because he would be too alive for a system that prefers control over transformation.

And the question would repeat itself, almost identically: “By what authority are you doing these things?” The answer would be, as then, not a theoretical justification, but life itself — a life that heals, liberates, and tells the truth without asking permission.

Today’s Churches Would Reject Yeshua

Looked at closely, many contemporary Christian churches operate according to the Pauline perspective rather than that of Yeshua. They rest on clearly delimited dogmas, on firm boundaries between “us” and “them,” on morality transformed into an identity marker, and on a well-established hierarchical authority. These elements offer coherence and predictability, but they come at a cost: the reduction of life to conformity.

“You hold to the tradition of men” (Mark 7:8) remains the warning that hovers over any system that sustains itself through rules. Within this framework, Yeshua would quickly appear as an uncomfortable presence. His refusal to judge quickly, his constant closeness to those labeled “sinners,” his criticism of religious hypocrites, and his silence before trap questions would be read as relativism or a lack of firmness.

“Why do you eat and drink with tax collectors and sinners?” (Luke 5:30) is the question that repeats itself, in other forms, in every age. Yeshua would be perceived as too soft on sin, subversive toward order, and lacking in “doctrinal clarity.” Most likely, he would be invited to a “clarifying” discussion. He would be asked to formulate his positions, to define his limits, to fall in line. If he refused — as he did then — he would become problematic.

Not excluded immediately, but neutralized through labeling: “he has good intentions, but he creates confusion.” “Whoever is not with us is against us” (cf. Mark 9:38–40) is the logic that reappears whenever freedom threatens the framework.

Why Yeshua Refuses Political Power

The refusal of political power is one of the most constant and most difficult-to-understand traits of Yeshua. It appears from the beginning of his public activity and remains unchanged until the end. Yeshua not only does not seek political power, but actively avoids it, even when it is offered to him indirectly or when it seems to be the “natural” solution for imposing his message. This refusal is neither naivety nor a lack of historical realism.

It is a position deeply coherent with the way Yeshua understands the nature of evil, of change, and of human freedom. The episode of the temptations in the wilderness sets the framework for this refusal from the very beginning. When he is offered “all the kingdoms of the world” and their glory (Matthew 4:8–10), the temptation is not an abstract one. It is the invitation to produce good through control, to impose justice from the outside, to accelerate change through force.

Yeshua refuses, not because power is evil in itself, but because political power operates on a logic incompatible with the Kingdom of God. The political changes behaviors through coercion; the Kingdom changes consciousnesses through truth. Throughout the Gospels, Yeshua systematically avoids any association with messianic political projects. After the multiplication of the loaves, the crowd wants to make him king, and he withdraws alone to the mountain (John 6:15).

The gesture is revealing: at the very moment when he would have had popular legitimacy, Yeshua refuses. For him, power obtained through the enthusiasm of the crowd is just as dangerous as power obtained through force. Both replace inner freedom with dependence on a leader. Yeshua knows that political power, even when it begins with good intentions, tends to perpetuate itself. It quickly creates mechanisms of exclusion, hierarchies, and justifications for “necessary” violence.

That is why, when he is asked about political authority — “Should we pay taxes to Caesar or not?” — he refuses the trap (Mark 12:13–17). He does not position himself as an anti-imperial revolutionary, nor as a

supporter of the existing order. His answer does not legitimize the system; it relativizes it. Caesar has a limited sphere. God does not compete with him for control of the world, because the Kingdom is not of the same category.

Before Pilate, Yeshua formulates this difference explicitly: “My Kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36). The statement does not mean that the Kingdom has no impact in the world, but that it does not function according to the logic of worldly power. If it had been “of this world,” Yeshua says, his servants would have fought. But it is precisely the absence of armed struggle that is the distinguishing sign of this Kingdom. The refusal of political power is therefore an act of profound lucidity.

Yeshua understands that change imposed from the outside produces conformity, not transformation. The political can create order, but it cannot create love. It can regulate behaviors, but it cannot heal fear. The Kingdom of God begins precisely where fear loses its authority. And fear cannot be eliminated through greater fear. By refusing political power, Yeshua refuses to become what he criticizes. He does not want to replace one domination with another. He does not want to be “a good Caesar.”

He wants to reveal another meaning of existence, in which truth is not imposed but recognized, and freedom is not negotiated but embraced.

Why Yeshua Is Always Dangerous to Religion

Institutional religion needs predictability, norms, hierarchies, and control of meaning. Yeshua, however, brings presence, freedom, confrontation with oneself, and personal responsibility. He moves the center from the system to the heart. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) disarms any mechanism that promises salvation through belonging. That is why Yeshua was not killed by “sinners,” but by the defenders of the truth.

Not by the world, but by religious leaders convinced that they were defending God. “It is better that one man die for the people” (John 11:50) shows how quickly truth becomes a danger when it cannot be controlled. The same pattern remains valid today. A Yeshua without a title, without institutional confirmation, without “verifiable” miracles, but with the same cutting lucidity and uncomfortable love, would be perceived as a spiritual threat, not as good news.

The chances that Yeshua would be immediately recognized as authentic are surprisingly small. Not because he would say something different, but because he would say the same thing — and that would expose how far we have moved away from him. The Apostle Paul might be cautious or suspicious, out of concern for the community. Today’s churches, in many contexts, would become defensive or rejecting.

The supreme truth of this exercise is simple and painful: Yeshua is not dangerous to sin, but to religion without a heart. Wherever religion chooses certainty over presence, control over love, Yeshua will always be... suspect. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) remains the promise that cannot be tamed by any system.

Why Christianity Moved the Resurrection from Consciousness to the Tomb

One of the most subtle changes that occurred in the history of Christianity is the shift of the emphasis of the resurrection from within the human being to events outside of history. In the Gospels, the resurrection often appears as a present reality, an awakening of consciousness, a passage from inner death to spiritual life. But in the later theological development, the emphasis was shifted almost exclusively onto the physical event of Christ’s resurrection and onto the resurrection of bodies at the end of the world.

So what could have been lived as a transformative experience in a person’s life became largely a doctrine about the future. In the Gospels, Yeshua speaks of eternal life not as a post-mortem reward, but as a reality that begins now. He says: “Truly, truly, I say to you, whoever

hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life and does not come into judgment, but has passed from death to life” (John 5:24).

We note the present tense: *has* eternal life and *has passed*. It is not only a future promise, but a present transformation. Death and life are not only biological states, but states of consciousness. This idea appears again a few verses later: “The hour is coming, and is now here, when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who hear will live” (John 5:25). If we read it literally, it seems absurd: how can the dead hear? But it is precisely here that the spiritual meaning is hidden.

The “dead” are those who live without consciousness, without love, without an inner life. The voice of Yeshua is the call to awakening. This perspective is confirmed by the way Yeshua speaks about the Kingdom of God. He says: “The Kingdom of God does not come in a way that can be observed... for behold, the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21).

If the Kingdom is within, then the resurrection too — which is the entry into this new life — must be, at least in part, an inner transformation. Over time, however, the message began to be understood more and more in external terms. Instead of the resurrection being seen as a spiritual experience accessible to every person, it became primarily a unique historical event and an eschatological promise.

In this shift of emphasis, the human being becomes a spectator rather than a participant. Christ has risen — and we wait. But the language of the New Testament suggests an active participation. Paul says: “We were buried with him through baptism into death, in order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life” (Romans 6:4). Christ’s resurrection now becomes the model of a personal transformation.

It is not merely a miracle to be contemplated, but a path to be followed. In the same spirit, Paul affirms: “If then you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above” (Colossians 3:1). Again, the verb is in the past tense: *if you have been raised*. This suggests that the resurrection can already be lived as a change in the way of seeing the

world, the way of loving, the way of being. The danger of externalizing the resurrection is that inner transformation becomes secondary.

A person may remain in the same consciousness dominated by fear, resentment, and separation, yet believe that the resurrection nonetheless concerns him — because it is a doctrine he accepts. In this case, the resurrection is no longer an awakening of consciousness, but merely a theological affirmation. But if we return to the spirit of the Gospels, the resurrection appears as a change of perspective on life. It is the passage from fear to trust, from judgment to compassion, from ego to love.

The Apostle John expresses this transformation in a simple sentence: “We know that we have passed from death to life, because we love the brothers” (1 John 3:14). Here the criterion of the resurrection is not an external event, but the appearance of love. In this sense, the resurrection can be understood as a passage from a fragmented consciousness to an integrated one. From separation to unity. From reaction to presence.

This is what spiritual traditions sometimes call transcendence: the surpassing of the previous level of consciousness. That is why the resurrection should not be thought of only as a single moment, but as a continuous process. Each time a false identity dies and a deeper understanding is born, a resurrection takes place. Each time fear gives way to love, a resurrection takes place. Each time a person renounces separation and discovers unity, a resurrection takes place.

Yeshua himself describes this process through the metaphor of the seed: “Unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit” (John 12:24). The death of the seed is not destruction, but transformation. This is precisely the logic of the resurrection. So the resurrection is not merely emerging from a tomb. It is emerging from a limited consciousness. It is the passage from a life lived in fear to a life lived in love.

It is the moment when death — in its inner form — loses its power. That is why Paul says of Christ: “Christ, being raised from the dead, will never die again; death no longer has dominion over him” (Romans 6:9). But this affirmation also becomes an invitation. For when a person passes through his own inner resurrection, death begins to lose that

same power over him as well. In this profound sense, Christ's resurrection is not merely an event to be celebrated. It is a map of the transformation of human consciousness. And the central question is no longer only whether Christ rose, but whether his resurrection produces a resurrection in us as well.

2. Why Yeshua Did Not Found a Religion

Did Yeshua Say of Himself That He Was the Messiah?

The question of whether Yeshua said of himself that he was the Messiah seems, at first glance, a simple one. Christianity answered it in the affirmative long ago. But when we read the Gospels carefully, without projecting back onto them the dogma that came later, we discover a reality far more nuanced. Yeshua does not present himself publicly as the Messiah in the sense expected by his contemporaries, he does not claim the title as a political or religious identity, and, surprisingly, he consistently avoids being named in this way.

This avoidance is not accidental. It says something essential about what Yeshua understands by “Messiah” — and about what he refuses to let the word mean. In the Jewish context of the first century, “Messiah” (Mashiach, “the anointed one”) was not an abstract spiritual figure. It was a historical and political expectation.

The Messiah was to be a liberator, a king from the line of David, a restorer of Israel’s sovereignty, someone who would put an end to Roman domination and reestablish justice through power (Isaiah 11:1–10; Jeremiah 23:5–6). This expectation was charged with tension, hope, and, above all, latent violence. To declare oneself Messiah in that context meant to strike a political spark. It was not a neutral theological statement but a subversive act.

Yeshua knew this very well. That is why the way he relates to the title is marked by caution, ambiguity, and reinterpretation. Yeshua does not walk through Galilee saying, “I am the Messiah.” On the contrary, when he is recognized as such, he reduces the claim rather than amplifying it. After Peter’s confession — “You are the Christ” — Yeshua orders his disciples “to tell no one about him” (Mark 8:29–30). This imposed silence is extremely important.

If Yeshua had wanted to be recognized as the Messiah in the classical sense, this would have been the perfect moment for proclamation. Instead, he chooses discretion. This strategy of silence appears again and again. The demons recognize him and cry out who he is, and he silences them (Mark 1:34). The crowds want to make him king, and he withdraws (John 6:15). Yeshua seems to defend himself against the title rather than to claim it. The reason is not a denial of identity but a refusal of the wrong meaning.

There is, however, one moment in which Yeshua answers directly. Before the high priest, at his trial, he is asked explicitly: “Are you the Christ, the Son of the Blessed One?” (Mark 14:61). This time, Yeshua answers: “I am” (Mark 14:62). But even here, the answer is immediately recontextualized. Yeshua does not stop at the title; he shifts it into another key: “and you will see the Son of Man seated at the right hand of Power and coming with the clouds of heaven.”

He does not confirm the expectation of a political Messiah; he dismantles it and moves it into an eschatological and symbolic register. This is the moment in which he is condemned. Not because he declared himself a political leader, but because he completely redefined the idea of authority.

Was Yeshua the New Moses?

Yeshua goes up the mountain and speaks (Matthew 5), just as Moses goes up Sinai. He interprets the Law, feeds the crowds in the wilderness, symbolically crosses the waters, gathers a people. All these echoes are too consistent to be accidental. But the real question is not whether

Yeshua is presented as a new Moses, but how he relates to this image. Yeshua never explicitly says, “I am the new Moses.”

And, more importantly, he does not behave like a lawgiver bringing a new Law in the classical sense. When he says, “You have heard that it was said..., but I say to you...” (Matthew 5), he does not position himself as Moses’s rival but as the one who fulfills the intention of the Law. He does not add rules; he shifts the center of gravity from the outside to the inside. If Moses brings the Law written on stone, Yeshua speaks of a Law lived in the heart (Jeremiah 31:33, implicitly taken up again).

The fundamental difference is this: Moses is the mediator of the Law, Yeshua is the mediator of the relationship. Moses leads the people out of slavery toward outward freedom. Yeshua speaks of a deeper liberation, from inner fear and attachment. If Moses forms a people through rules, Yeshua forms a community through presence and transformation. The Gospels deliberately suggest this parallel in order to show a transformed continuity, not a replacement.

Yeshua does not annul the road begun by Moses; he carries it into another dimension. That is why, in the episode of the Transfiguration, Moses appears alongside Elijah, and the voice says, “Listen to him” (Mark 9:7). Not because Moses has been surpassed, but because his role was pedagogical. The Law leads up to a point; beyond that point lies the relationship. Yeshua does not see himself as the new Moses in the sense of a national leader or a supreme lawgiver.

He refuses precisely that form of authority. But he sees himself as the fulfillment of the meaning of the Mosaic road: the passage from fear to trust, from bondage to freedom, from letter to life. If Moses says, “Thus you shall do,” Yeshua says, “Come and see.” So Yeshua does not substitute himself for Moses; he transcends him. He does not bring a new Sinai but a continuous presence. He does not found a new people through law, but opens access to a reality in which everyone can become free from within.

Yeshua heals not in order to prove his divinity, but because this is what life looks like when the Kingdom is present. Yeshua does not

proclaim himself the new Moses; he fulfills the road begun by Moses, moving it from the outside to the inside. In both cases, Yeshua refuses to be reduced to a role. He does not want to be proven. He wants to be followed.

The Law and the Old Testament in Yeshua

The way the Law and the Old Testament are understood marks one of the deepest ruptures between the message of Yeshua and the Christianity that would be built after him. Although Christianity claims to follow Yeshua, the dominant way the Scriptures, the Law, and the idea of obedience are read belongs largely to Paul and to later doctrinal developments.

The difference is not one of fine interpretation but of inner meaning: from life to system, from sight to authority, from transformation to conformity. For Yeshua, the Law is never an end in itself. He does not treat it as an untouchable sacred structure, but as a pedagogical instrument meant to serve life. The statement “I have not come to abolish the Law but to fulfill it” (Matthew 5:17) is often read as a validation of legalism, but the context shows exactly the opposite.

“Fulfillment” does not mean the literal reinforcement of the commandments, but bringing them to their meaning. Yeshua does not preserve the Law as letter; he passes through it in order to reveal its spirit. This approach becomes evident in the repeated formula: “You have heard that it was said... but I say to you” (Matthew 5). Yeshua does not cite the Law in order to impose it, but in order to surpass it from within. He shifts the center of gravity from the deed to the heart, from conformity to conscience.

The Law is no longer a barrier between man and God, but a mirror that shows where the heart is still fragmented. That is why Yeshua never asks whether someone has kept the Law, but whether he sees, whether he loves, whether he is alive. Yeshua’s relationship with the Old Testament is one of profound freedom. He quotes it, but he does not

absolutize it. He uses it, but he does not submit to it as to a final authority.

“The Scriptures testify about me” (John 5:39) does not mean that the texts are the goal, but that they point to a reality that must be lived. When Scripture is used against life, Yeshua confronts it without hesitation. Healing on the Sabbath is the supreme example: “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27). This statement undermines any religion centered on law. For Yeshua, the Old Testament is not a legal code but the history of a search.

Moses, the prophets, the psalms are not final authorities but witnesses of a road toward spiritual maturity. That is why he says that the true worshipers will no longer be bound to a place, a ritual, or a form (John 4:21–23). The Law is relativized by presence. Truth is no longer mediated by the text but recognized inwardly. With Paul, this meaning changes.

Paul does not know Yeshua historically but through revelation, and his main concern is not the lived life of the Teacher but the organization of a saved community in a hostile world. In this context, the Law again becomes a central concept, but in a transformed form. Paul affirms that the Law does not save (Romans 3:20), yet he does not dissolve it in spirit but moves it into a broader juridical logic.

For Paul, the Law has the role of revealing sin and of demonstrating man’s helplessness (Romans 7:7). It becomes part of a system in which the central problem is no longer the blindness of consciousness but universal guilt. Although Paul affirms that man is saved by faith and not by the works of the Law (Galatians 2:16), he preserves the juridical structure: the Law accuses, God judges, Christ satisfies justice, faith justifies.

In this paradigm, the Old Testament is interpreted as a doctrinal preamble. Adam becomes the figure of universal guilt (Romans 5:12), the Law becomes the instrument of condemnation, and the history of Israel is read typologically in order to support a theology of salvation through substitution. This reading will lie at the foundation of

institutional Christianity, which will transform Scripture into supreme authority and a criterion of belonging.

Christianity from Yeshua's time until today inherits this Pauline vision. The Bible becomes "the Word of God" in a normative sense, not a living testimony. The Law is formally replaced by grace, but the structure remains the same: correct rules, correct doctrine, correct interpretation. Obedience is no longer to life but to the text. Truth is no longer recognized but defended. Yeshua never demanded submission to Scripture. He asked for presence.

Paul demands fidelity to the message about Christ (Galatians 1:8–9). Yeshua relativized the Law in order to free man; Christianity relativized life in order to protect the reinterpreted Law. So what was, in Yeshua, a gate to freedom becomes, in time, a structure of spiritual control. The final difference is clear. For Yeshua, the Law is a finger pointing toward life, and it must be lowered once life has been recognized.

For Paul and for institutional Christianity, the Law — whether Mosaic or doctrinal — remains the framework in which salvation is decided. Yeshua came to free man from dependence on law. Christianity taught man to live from it, even when it calls it grace.

Is Yeshua a King?

The question of whether Yeshua is a king cannot be understood correctly without noticing the constant tension between the way people want to make him king and the way he refuses this form of kingship. The Gospels show clearly that the title of "king" accompanies Yeshua from birth to the cross, but the meaning of this title is radically overturned by him. What people call dominion, Yeshua dismantles; what Yeshua calls dominion, people do not recognize.

At the beginning of his life, the magi ask: "Where is the newborn King of the Jews?" (Matthew 2:2). The title is royal, but Herod's reaction immediately reveals the conflict between two kinds of power: one that defends itself through violence and one that comes without a guard, without an army, without a palace. Yeshua is not born in a center

of power but in a manger. His kingship begins in the absence of any outward sign of authority.

Throughout his ministry, the crowds repeatedly try to turn him into a political leader. After the multiplication of the loaves, “Yeshua, knowing that they intended to come and take him by force to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself alone” (John 6:15). This is a decisive moment: Yeshua explicitly refuses the form of kingship that people understand. He does not accept being king within the logic of hunger, of collective enthusiasm, or of national hope.

When he enters Jerusalem, the scene is again royal: “Behold, your King is coming to you, gentle and mounted on a donkey” (Matthew 21:5). But it is precisely this detail that changes the whole meaning. The king does not come on a warhorse but on a donkey. He does not come to conquer but to let himself be received. His kingship is marked by gentleness, not by force. The moment in which the meaning of his kingship is formulated most clearly is in the dialogue with Pilate.

Asked directly, “Are you the King of the Jews?”, Yeshua answers: “My kingdom is not of this world. If my kingdom were of this world, my servants would have fought” (John 18:36). Here Yeshua does not deny that he is a king; he completely redefines the nature of his kingdom. The criterion is simple: the absence of struggle for power. The absence of violence is the proof that his dominion does not belong to the same logic. The paradox reaches its peak at the cross.

Above his head is written: “Jesus of Nazareth, the King of the Jews” (John 19:19). The inscription is placed in mockery, but the Gospel lets it stand as truth. Yeshua is proclaimed king precisely at the moment when he appears completely stripped of power. His throne is the cross, his crown is of thorns, and his court is made up of soldiers who mock him. His kingship consists not in dominating but in remaining in the truth even while he is being crushed.

This inversion also explains the way Yeshua speaks about authority. “Whoever wants to be great among you must be your servant” (Matthew 20:26). In his Kingdom, leading does not mean being above but being beneath, holding up the lives of others. Power is not

exercised through control but through service. That is why Yeshua can say: “I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep” (John 10:11). The royal image is replaced by the image of the shepherd.

The king, in his logic, is the one who exposes himself for the safety of others, not the one who exposes others for his own safety. In light of this perspective, it becomes clear that Yeshua is a king, but not in the sense in which the world understands kingship. He does not lead through fear, he does not impose through force, he does not administer through control. His dominion is the dominion of truth over fear, of love over violence, and of freedom over coercion.

When Yeshua says, “For this I was born and for this I came into the world: to bear witness to the truth” (John 18:37), he binds kingship to truth, not to power. Truth is his scepter. Love is his law. Presence is his method. Yeshua is a king not because he sits on a throne, but because nothing in him can any longer be dominated by fear, guilt, or falsehood. He is a king because he is free and sets others free. He is a king because he does not demand submission but awakens life.

His kingship is not measured by how many follow him, but by how many are healed in his presence. It is not measured in territories but in liberated hearts. It is not imposed by decree but recognized through truth. Yeshua is a king. But he is the king of a kingdom that resembles nothing that people have ever called power.

Was Yeshua More “God” Than We Are?

The question is not whether Yeshua was special. The Gospels leave no room for doubt that he was. The real question is in what sense he was special: ontologically — of a different substance than we are — or revelationally — having lived fully what is possible for a human being. Yeshua never begins his preaching by affirming, “I am different from you in essence.” On the contrary, his discourse is one of inclusion, not of separation. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21).

“Truly I tell you, whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do; and he will do greater works than these” (John 14:12). These statements become hard to understand if Yeshua perceived himself as an ontological exception impossible to attain. In Yeshua’s language, “Son of God” is not a biological or metaphysical title but a relational one.

He speaks of God as Abba — Father — and, at the same time, explicitly invites others into the same relationship. “One is your Father, the one in heaven” (Matthew 23:9). “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called sons of God” (Matthew 5:9). “I am ascending to my Father and your Father” (John 20:17). If his intention had been to affirm the absolute exclusivity of his own sonship, these statements would create a tension difficult to explain.

For Yeshua, “the son” is the one who lives in unity with the Father, not the one who has a different origin. The virgin birth appears in the narrative of the Gospels, but Yeshua never appeals to it as an argument of authority. Not in his sermons, not in his confrontations, not in his moments of revelation. In biblical logic, “miraculous” births are signs of God’s initiative, not ontological hierarchies: Isaac, Samuel, Samson, John the Baptist.

They say, “God is beginning something,” not “this man is of another essence.” That is why Yeshua shifts the emphasis from his own biological origin to the spiritual birth of all: “What is born of the Spirit is spirit” (John 3:6). When he speaks of resurrection, Yeshua does not present it as an exclusive privilege but as a universal reality. “The hour is coming when all who are in their graves will hear his voice” (John 5:28). “God is not the God of the dead but of the living” (Mark 12:27).

His resurrection is shown as a beginning, not an exception: “Unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit” (John 12:24). The message is not “I can, you cannot,” but “what happens to me shows what is true about life.” Yeshua consistently avoids positioning himself above people through divine status. When he is called “good,” he answers: “Why do you call me good? No one is good except One: God” (Mark 10:18).

When he is tempted to affirm his power, he refuses. When he is challenged to save himself, he is silent. His identity is transparent, not domineering. “I and the Father are one” (John 10:30) — not as an isolated privilege, but as a state of unity that he desires for all: “That they may all be one, as you, Father, are in me and I in you” (John 17:21). In Paul, the emphasis shifts visibly. Yeshua becomes not only an existential model but an ontological mediator.

“He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation” (Colossians 1:15). “God has highly exalted him” (Philippians 2:9). Salvation takes the form of adherence to his person and his work: “If you confess with your mouth that Jesus is Lord...” (Romans 10:9). Where Yeshua says, “Follow me in the way of being,” Paul says, “Believe in what he has done for you.” Institutional Christianity carries this shift all the way to its fixation in dogma.

Yeshua is affirmed as the only Son of God in an ontological sense, fundamentally different from the rest of humanity by nature, not only by way of life. The virgin birth becomes the proof of an essential superiority, and the resurrection becomes the exclusive guarantee of salvation. Naturally, the imitation of Yeshua’s life and state of consciousness becomes secondary to his adoration as an object of worship.

The distance between Yeshua and man is no longer pedagogical, meant to inspire transformation, but structural, consolidating dependence and separation. And so, if we were to ask Yeshua directly whether he is “more God” than we are, the Gospels suggest that he would not answer with a metaphysical statement but with an invitation: “Be perfect, as your heavenly Father is perfect” (Matthew 5:48). “The Kingdom does not come in a way that strikes the eye” (Luke 17:20). Yeshua does not present himself as the maximum limit of humanity, but as its truth.

Not as the exception that excludes us, but as the mirror that shows us what we are called to become.

Then What Is the “Great Commission”?

Then, what really is the “Great Commission”? Read through the usual lens of religious history, it seems a mandate of expansion, a call to conversion and doctrinal uniformity. But in Yeshua’s logic, the meaning is far deeper and far more demanding inwardly. “Go and make disciples of all nations” (Matthew 28:19) does not mean “make members,” “win followers,” or “impose a system of belief,” but calls for the formation of people who learn to live from the same source from which he lived.

Discipleship, in Yeshua, is not the transmission of dogma but transformation through shared life. That is why he continues: “Teach them to observe all that I have commanded you” (Matthew 28:20) — and his commandments are not theological formulas but concrete ways of being: love of enemies, forgiveness without calculation, truth lived without a mask, nonviolence, the presence that heals.

The Great Commission is not, therefore, about the expansion of a religion, but about the multiplication of a state of consciousness; not about convincing minds but about awakening lives. And the criterion remains the same as throughout Yeshua’s teaching: not the label, not the declaration, but the fruit — “by their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16).

Why Does Yeshua Say, “You Will Do Greater Things Than I”?

This statement is one of the most radical and most often neutralized by later interpretations. “Whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do; and he will do still greater ones than these” (John 14:12). Yeshua does not say this in order to diminish himself, but in order to decentralize. He does not position himself as an inaccessible summit but as a prototype. “Greater” does not mean more spectacular, but more widespread, more mature, more collective. Yeshua is one.

Those who live from the same state can be many. He does not want admirers but continuers. “I am the vine, you are the branches” (John

15:5). Life does not remain concentrated in a single body. It flows onward.

What the Old Testament Actually Says About Yeshua

For Yeshua, the Old Testament is not a collection of cryptic predictions about the future, but a history of the human search for God that converges into a way of being. He does not say, “The Scriptures described me,” but “The Scriptures testify about me” (John 5:39). Testimony is not a photograph but a direction. They speak of: liberation from fear, a justice deeper than the law, mercy more important than sacrifice, a direct relationship with God.

Yeshua does not appear as a character inserted into the Scriptures, but as their lived meaning. Yeshua says that the Old Testament speaks of him not because it predicted him in detail, but because all of Scripture converges toward a life lived from God — a life that he embodies without compromise. Scripture, for Yeshua, is not proof. It is a witness. It is not authority against man. It is a guide toward life.

And when Scripture is used against life, Yeshua does not defend it. He sets it free.

How Would Yeshua Want Us to Understand Isaiah 53?

Isaiah 53 is one of the most frequently cited prophetic texts when Christianity speaks about the suffering of Yeshua. “Despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows and acquainted with grief... He has borne our sufferings and carried our pains” (Isaiah 53:3–4) became, in the classical Christian reading, the anticipated description of the cross as a substitutionary sacrifice for the sins of humanity.

The text continues: “He was pierced for our transgressions, crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brings us peace fell upon him” (Isaiah 53:5). From these verses was born the interpretation according to which God demands satisfaction for sin, and Yeshua pays this debt in our place. Isaiah 53 thus becomes the foundation of the

theology of juridical atonement: someone must be punished, and the Messiah accepts the punishment in the place of human beings.

If, however, we look at the way Yeshua speaks about suffering, sin, and forgiveness, we notice a different emphasis. Yeshua never says that God needs to be satisfied through someone's suffering. He forgives before the cross: "Take heart, son, your sins are forgiven" (Matthew 9:2), without invoking any future payment. He says of God that he "makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good" (Matthew 5:45) and that the Father is "merciful" (Luke 6:36), not juridical.

When he reaches the cross, his words are not addressed to a God who demands punishment, but to the people who do not understand: "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing" (Luke 23:34). Suffering is not presented as a price demanded by God, but as the result of human violence and blindness. In Isaiah 53 there appears the statement: "We considered him punished, struck by God, and afflicted" (Isaiah 53:4). This sentence is often overlooked, though it is essential.

The text does not say that God punishes him, but that people interpret his suffering as divine punishment. "We considered" describes human perception, not the action of God. In the light of the way Yeshua reveals the Father, this nuance becomes decisive: people see punishment where God sees faithfulness, love, and self-giving to the very end.

When Isaiah says, "Like a lamb that is led to the slaughter... he did not open his mouth" (Isaiah 53:7), Christianity sees the image of the paschal sacrifice. Yeshua, however, lives this silence not as submission to a divine demand, but as a refusal to answer violence with violence. Before the accusations, he is silent (Matthew 27:12–14), but this silence is inner coherence, not the acceptance of a necessary punishment.

It is the same logic that he preaches in the Sermon on the Mount: "Do not resist the one who is evil" (Matthew 5:39). Suffering becomes the consequence of faithfulness to truth, not the currency of a spiritual transaction. Isaiah continues: "By his wounds we are healed" (Isaiah 53:5). In the contemporary reading, this healing is often understood as

the result of a juridical payment. But in Yeshua, healing comes from encounter, from truth, from forgiveness spoken on the spot.

“Your faith has saved you; go in peace” (Luke 7:50) shows that healing is the restoration of relationship, not the effect of a compensation. His wounds heal because they reveal how far love goes when it does not defend itself. They unmask fear and show the alternative: a life that does not answer evil with evil. Another key verse says: “The Lord has laid on him the iniquity of us all” (Isaiah 53:6). In the juridical reading, this means the transfer of guilt.

In the light of Yeshua, this can be understood as the exposure of all human iniquity upon the body of someone who does not respond to it. All the violence, all the rejection, all the blindness is discharged upon him, and he does not multiply it but absorbs it without retaliation. The cross becomes the mirror of humanity: we see what fear does and we see what love does when it does not withdraw.

Christianity today reads Isaiah 53 almost exclusively through the lens of substitutionary sacrifice: God punishes Yeshua in our place. Yeshua, however, reveals God differently: not as a Father who demands blood, but as one who “seeks and saves what was lost” (Luke 19:10). If Isaiah 53 is read through the life of Yeshua, the text no longer describes a transaction between God and the Son, but the encounter between divine love and human violence.

In this light, Isaiah 53 does not speak of a God who needs punishment, but of a man of God who enters all the way into the suffering of the world without stepping out of love. “He bore the sins of many” (Isaiah 53:12) — not in order to pay for them, but in order to show their consequences and to open another way.

That is why Yeshua does not invite people to believe in a sacrifice, but to live on the same road: “Whoever wants to come after me, let him take up his cross and follow me” (Mark 8:34). Not in order to pay for anything, but in order to no longer live from fear. Read in this way, Isaiah 53 becomes less a juridical scheme and more a prophetic description of how love looks when it meets a world dominated by fear. Christianity sees in it the payment for sin.

Yeshua would see in it the mirror of sin and the revelation of a love that does not withdraw in its presence.

The Scriptures Speak of a Messiah, but Yeshua Changes Their Meaning

The Old Testament speaks of an anointed one of God, but the dominant expectation had become a political, restorative, often violent one. Yeshua acknowledges this expectation, but he inverts it. He cites the Scriptures about service, suffering, justice for the marginalized, but he refuses the interpretations that justify domination.

When he is tempted to turn stones into bread, to throw himself from the temple, or to accept the dominion of the world (Matthew 4:1–11), Yeshua answers exclusively with Scripture. But the way he uses it is revealing: not in order to affirm his power, but in order to refuse it. Scripture becomes for him the criterion of non-abuse, not of triumph.

Yeshua suggests that the Old Testament does not speak of a Messiah who conquers, but of one who reorients consciousness. The suffering servant of Isaiah, the psalms of lament, the prophets who denounce worship without mercy — all of these are, for Yeshua, testimonies of a God who does not impose himself but gives himself. Perhaps the most radical position of Yeshua is that Scripture must be read from the standpoint of life, not against it. “You have heard that it was said..., but I say to you...” (Matthew 5) is not an annulment of Scripture. It is a disclosure of its spirit.

Yeshua does not correct the texts; he corrects the way they are used. He heals on the Sabbath and cites Scripture to justify life against the letter (Mark 2:27). “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath.” This statement is the key to Yeshua’s hermeneutics: Scripture exists for life, not life for Scripture. Any reading that produces fear, exclusion, or rigidity is, for him, a wrong reading, even if it is textually correct.

“The Son of Man” — Yeshua’s Preferred Term

It is significant that Yeshua speaks of himself far more often as “the Son of Man” than as the Messiah. This term is ambiguous, open, profoundly symbolic. It points both to human fragility (“man”) and to an apocalyptic figure from Daniel who receives authority not through violence but through divine recognition (Daniel 7:13–14). Through “the Son of Man,” Yeshua avoids the title that triggers false expectations and proposes an identity that includes suffering, service, and vulnerability.

The Messiah, for Yeshua, is not the conqueror but the one who “did not come to be served, but to serve” (Mark 10:45). This statement is incompatible with the dominant messianic expectation. For Yeshua, the Messiah is not a role of power. He is a function of revelation. He does not come to establish a regime. He comes to show what a life lived from God looks like. Messiahship is not about domination but about alignment.

Not about controlling the world, but about transforming the way of being in the world. That is why Yeshua constantly binds his identity to suffering: “The Son of Man must suffer many things” (Mark 8:31). This necessity is not masochism but the inevitable consequence of the fact that truth, when it does not negotiate with power, comes into conflict with it. Yeshua’s Messiah does not save the world from pain through force, but passes through it without fear.

In parables and gestures, Yeshua completely rewrites messianic meaning. The entry into Jerusalem on a colt, not on a warhorse (Matthew 21:5), the refusal of violence, the closeness to the excluded — all these are the signs of a Messiah who undermines the expectation instead of fulfilling it literally. For Yeshua, to be the Messiah does not mean to be recognized, but, at the height of it, to be misunderstood. It does not mean to be followed by the masses, but to be abandoned.

This is perhaps the most radical redefinition: the Messiah is not the figure of religious success. He is the figure of faithfulness to truth, even when truth leads to isolation. And so, Yeshua does not proclaim himself the Messiah in the sense in which the world awaited a Messiah. He

accepts the title only in order to empty it of its violent and political content and to fill it with an existential and relational meaning.

The Messiah, for Yeshua, is not: a political leader, a guarantor of order, a symbol of victory through force. The Messiah is a man of presence, a revealer of God, a life lived without fear. Yeshua never asks, “Do you believe that I am the Messiah?” His question is always another: “Do you follow me?”

John 3:16 — How Yeshua Wants the Most Famous Verse in the New Testament to Be Understood

“For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, so that whoever believes in him should not perish but have eternal life” (John 3:16). This verse has become the central axis of modern Christianity. But its meaning changes radically depending on who explains it, from what level of consciousness, and with what purpose. For Yeshua, John 3:16, rather than a slogan of salvation, is a revelation about the nature of reality.

He does not speak of a God who “offers a solution” to a juridical problem. He speaks of a God who is love in motion. “God so loved the world” is not the beginning of a contract but the description of a permanent state. When Yeshua says “to believe in him,” he is not referring to the acceptance of a doctrine about his person. In his language, to believe means to trust, to let oneself be permeated, to enter into a way of being.

Faith is not an opinion but a living relationship. That is why he says, in the same dialogue with Nicodemus: “Unless one is born again, he cannot see the Kingdom of God” (John 3:3). He is not speaking of heaven after death, but of a change of consciousness. “Should not perish” does not mean, for Yeshua, escaping punishment, but not remaining stuck in inner death: fear, separation, ego. And “eternal life” is not an infinite duration after death, but a quality of life lived in the present.

“And this is eternal life: that they know you, the only true God” (John 17:3). To know, in Yeshua, is not intellectual but existential. In his vision, John 3:16 speaks of an invitation to awakening: God offers himself entirely so that man may come out of the illusion of separation and enter into life. There is no threat, no coercion, no prior moral condition. Paul shifts the emphasis from experience to explanation.

For him, “to believe” becomes the key to salvation in a juridical and soteriological sense. Faith is the act by which man is reckoned righteous before God. “Man is justified by faith, apart from the works of the Law” (Romans 3:28). And so, John 3:16 is read through the filter of original sin and justification: the world is condemned, man is guilty, and faith in Christ is the mechanism by which the sentence is annulled.

“Should not perish” takes on a penal sense, and “eternal life” becomes a post-mortem reward. For Paul, the cross is the center: “We preach Christ crucified” (1 Corinthians 1:23). God’s love is translated into the language of a sacrifice necessary to satisfy divine justice. John 3:16 thus becomes a theological formula: God offers a substitute, man offers faith, the result is salvation. This interpretation is not necessarily wrong, but it is partial.

It explains how salvation works within a system of thought, not what salvation is as lived experience. Paul speaks above all to communities that needed structure, coherence, and belonging. Christianity today, in most of its forms, has carried the Pauline interpretation to the extreme and simplified it to the level of a slogan. John 3:16 is presented as an ultimatum: believe correctly — go to heaven; do not believe — go to hell. The verse becomes an instrument of demarcation, not of revelation.

“To believe” is reduced to the acceptance of a doctrinal statement. “Should not perish” is transformed into fear of punishment. “Eternal life” is moved entirely into the future, while the present often remains unchanged: the same fear, the same lack of love, the same separation. In this reading, God seems to love the world in principle but to condemn it in practice if it does not follow the correct formula. John 3:16, which in Yeshua was an opening, becomes a filter of selection.

A verse about love ends up being used for exclusion. The irony is that the following verse is rarely mentioned: “God did not send his Son into the world to condemn the world, but in order that the world might be saved through him” (John 3:17). Here we see the rupture between Yeshua and the later interpretation. Where Yeshua excludes judgment, Christianity has built entire systems of judgment.

Yeshua Does Not Teach Theology

This was one of the most disturbing things for me when I realized it. Paul is a theologian. Yeshua is not. If in Yeshua we find narrative, parables, and confrontations of the heart, in Paul we find, for the first time, systematic theological construction. In his epistles there appear developed concepts such as justification by faith, the relationship between Law and grace, the nature of the Church as the Body of Christ, the theology of sin and salvation, eschatology, and an articulated Christology, as can be seen in Romans, Galatians, Ephesians, or 1 Corinthians.

Paul operates through argument, logic, and explanation, translating the experience with Yeshua into a coherent language for communities and for the generations who did not meet him directly. In time, Christianity comes to be built far more on this theological inheritance. Creeds, councils, dogmas, theological systems, and doctrinally defined denominations appear. Theology becomes essential for defining truth, delimiting heresy, and establishing confessional belonging.

What in Yeshua was lived experience becomes doctrinal formulation; what was encounter becomes system. The Gospels are very little about religion and very much about the human being. The epistles and the history of Christianity become very much about religion and system. I am not saying that one annuls the other, but that they operate on different planes: Yeshua transforms man, Paul explains what happened to man, and Christianity tries to preserve this explanation over time.

When he is provoked religiously, Yeshua does not respond religiously. He responds existentially. And the history that follows feels the need to translate this existential dimension into theological language.

Yeshua Refuses to Be Idealized

One of the most unsettling of Yeshua's gestures is his refusal to be idealized. "Why do you call me good? No one is good except One: God" (Mark 10:18). This answer is not theatrical modesty. It is a defusing of idolatry. Yeshua refuses to be the endpoint of human projection. He does not want captive disciples. He wants awakened people. A master who agrees to be followed endlessly becomes an obstacle. Yeshua seems to know this.

That is why his teaching does not create attachment but maturation. He does not say "look at me," but "you do likewise." One of Yeshua's most radical statements is also one of the most ignored. "Whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do; and he will do still greater ones" (John 14:12). This is not a promise conditioned on perpetual submission. It is a declaration of equalization. The disciple does not remain beneath the master; he surpasses him through integration.

An authentic master is not confirmed by how long he is followed, but by how quickly he becomes unnecessary. In Yeshua's logic, discipleship ends when the message no longer needs an external bearer.

Why Yeshua Addresses God as "Father"

The way Yeshua addresses God is one of the most revolutionary shifts in spiritual history. The word "Father" is not a decorative metaphor, nor an abstract theological title; it is a relational change of meaning. Through this language, Yeshua redefines not only the way of praying but the very image of God and the way man relates to him.

In the Jewish tradition, God was invoked through sacred names, titles of reverence, and formulas that preserved distance: "the Lord," "the Most High," "the Almighty." The relationship was marked by deep

respect, but also by separation. When Yeshua addresses God as “Father,” he does not deny sacredness. He draws it near. He does not diminish God’s greatness; on the contrary, he makes it relationally accessible.

This nearness is even more radical in the language Yeshua uses in the most intimate moments. In the prayer at Gethsemane, he says: “Abba, Father, all things are possible for you” (Mark 14:36). “Abba” is not a theological term but a familial, affectionate word, used by children. Yeshua does not speak of God as a distant authority, but presents him as a trustworthy presence, even in extreme suffering.

This would have been inconceivable in a religion built on fear and distance. It is essential to notice that Yeshua does not use “Father” in order to position himself exclusively. On the contrary, he shares this mode of address. In the prayer he offers to his disciples, he does not say “my Father.” He says “our Father” (Matthew 6:9). This is a decisive shift: the relationship that Yeshua lives with God is not reserved for him alone but becomes a model for all.

So, why does Yeshua call God “Father”? Because he does not start from a theology of separation but, I would say, from a theology of belonging. God is not presented as a judge before being a parent. Judgment is not denied, but it is subordinated to relationship. “If you, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven” (Matthew 7:11). The comparison is not juridical. It is affective.

Through this language, Yeshua makes visible the fact that man’s fundamental problem is not a lack of obedience. It is a lack of trust. Fear disappears when God is experienced as Father. That is why the discourse about “do not be afraid” is constantly tied to the image of the Father who knows, sees, and cares (Matthew 6:26–32). God does not need to be convinced to be good; he is already good. Should we, too, address God as “Father”?

The answer, in Yeshua’s logic, is not normative. It is invitational. Yeshua does not impose a formula; he offers a way of relating. To say “Father” is not a liturgical obligation but the expression of an inner

state. If, for someone, the word “father” is charged with fear, absence, or abuse, Yeshua does not force this language. He does not ask us to utter a word, but to enter into a relationship of trust. In this sense, “Father” is not about gender, social role, or paternal projection. It is about source, care, and belonging. Yeshua does not say that God is “like a human father,” but uses the closest experience of safety in order to speak of God. Where this experience is missing, the meaning must be healed, not imposed. Likewise, Yeshua makes a clear distinction between “my Father” and “your Father,” without creating a hierarchy. He lives the relationship fully and invites others to enter into it.

After the resurrection, he says: “I am ascending to my Father and your Father” (John 20:17). This phrase is extremely dense: God does not become our Father through Yeshua as a juridical mediator, but together with Yeshua as a brother in humanity. Thus, addressing God as “Father” is not a technique of prayer. It is a shift of consciousness. It does not change God; it changes us. It takes us out of the position of anxious servants and places us in the position of children who can trust.

That is why Yeshua says that the Kingdom belongs to those who can receive it “like a child” (Mark 10:15) — not infantile, but trusting. Yeshua addresses God as “Father” because he lives from belonging, not from fear. And he invites us to do the same, not through obligation but through inner maturation. To call God “Father” is not a magic formula. It is the sign that the relationship has passed from fear to trust.

Why Yeshua Prays to the Father

The question of why Yeshua prays to the Father cannot be understood correctly without first clarifying what prayer is for him. Prayer, in Yeshua, is not an instrument for obtaining things from God, nor a mechanism for repairing a separation. It is the expression of a relationship already lived. Yeshua does not pray in order to reach God; he prays in order to remain in the truth of this relationship.

The Gospels consistently show that Yeshua withdraws for prayer before decisive moments or after periods of intensity (Mark 1:35; Luke

5:16). These withdrawals are not ritual acts. Prayer does not change the Father's will, but keeps Yeshua inwardly aligned, free from the pressure of the crowd, of success, or of fear. Prayer is the place where Yeshua does not lose himself.

The prayer at Gethsemane makes this definition clear. "Abba, Father... not what I will, but what you will" (Mark 14:36). Here, prayer does not annul suffering and does not negotiate an escape. It is the space in which fear is acknowledged and allowed to dissolve into trust. Yeshua prays not in order to avoid the cross, but in order to pass through it without losing his inner truth. Prayer is living contact, not strategy. Yeshua also teaches his disciples to pray, but he immediately defuses any form of spiritual magic.

"When you pray, do not babble on... your Father knows what you need" (Matthew 6:7–8). Prayer is not about convincing God, but about entering into accord with his reality. That is why the model prayer begins with the orientation of consciousness ("hallowed be your Name; your Kingdom come") and only afterward includes the requests (Matthew 6:9–13). For Yeshua, prayer is alignment, not demand. Yeshua never says, "pray to me."

He leads people to pray to the Father, as he himself prays (Matthew 6:9). People ask him directly for help, and Yeshua responds, but this belongs to his concrete presence, not to the establishment of a cult centered on his person. Even when he says, "whatever you ask the Father in my name" (John 16:23), "the name" is not a formula but his way of being: praying from the same perspective of trust, truth, and love.

By contrast, in Paul, prayer begins to take on another function. Paul prays much and constantly exhorts to prayer ("pray without ceasing" — 1 Thessalonians 5:17), but his prayer is integrated into a theological framework of salvation, spiritual struggle, and the building up of the community. Prayer becomes a means by which one asks for power, protection, strengthening, deliverance from evil (Ephesians 6:18–19). The emphasis shifts from alignment to intervention.

In Paul, prayer begins to be linked to the idea that the world is a field of spiritual conflict, and the believer needs constant help in order to resist sin, the flesh, and the unseen powers (Romans 7; Ephesians 6). God remains Father, but he becomes more and more the agent who intervenes, not merely the presence in which you settle. Prayer takes on a defensive function. Christianity from Yeshua's time until today will amplify this shift.

Prayer often becomes: insistent requests for results, negotiation with God, an instrument of protection, proof of piety, a spiritual obligation. In many forms of contemporary Christianity, prayer is used to change circumstances, to obtain success, health, safety, or certainty. People pray much, but often out of fear, not out of trust. Prayer ends up being a refined form of spiritual control: if I pray correctly, God must respond.

This use would be foreign to Yeshua. He does not pray in order to control reality; he prays in order to remain true within it. He does not pray in order to force the Father's hand. He does it in order to keep his own openness. That is why Yeshua warns that prayer can become a spectacle, empty repetition, or an instrument of validation (Matthew 6:5–6).

A prayer that does not change the inner place from which you live is not prayer but noise. In Yeshua, prayer is living relationship; in Paul, prayer becomes spiritual support; in Christianity today, prayer often becomes a technique of intervention. Yeshua prays to the Father because he lives from trust and remains anchored in it. He invites us to pray not in order to obtain more, but in order to live from the same place. He does not want us to pray to him. He wants us to pray as he prays.

For Yeshua, prayer is not about changing God's will. It is about changing the place from which man lives.

Yeshua and the Trinity

"Truly, you are the Son of God!" (Matthew 14:33) appears in a moment of existential intensity: their lives are saved, fear dissolves, and the reality of God is perceived as at work through Yeshua. This sentence is

often read, retroactively, as a Trinitarian confession. In its historical and biblical context, however, it is an experiential recognition, not a metaphysical definition.

The disciples do not formulate a doctrine; they express gratitude and wonder in the language available to them. In the Hebrew Scriptures, “Son of God” does not automatically mean ontological divinity in the later sense. The title can designate the anointed king (Psalm 2:7), the one called into a special relationship with God, or the one through whom God works visibly.

That is why, when the disciples use this expression, they recognize a unique relationship and a transparency of God in Yeshua, not an intra-divine structure. It is significant that Yeshua never transforms such recognitions into an obligatory creed. He does not say, “this is how you must believe about me,” he does not define ontological relationships, and he does not demand adherence to a theological scheme.

On the contrary, he constantly redirects attention to the Father: “My teaching is not mine” (John 7:16), “I do not seek my own glory” (John 8:50), “The Father is greater than I” (John 14:28). His language is relational and performative, not speculative. When Yeshua speaks of unity with the Father (“I and the Father are one” — John 10:30), the context is mission and work, not the definition of the divine nature.

The same Gospel preserves, simultaneously, statements of unity and of subordination, which shows that Yeshua does not intend to offer a metaphysics of God, but seeks to make his character visible through a life lived. The question naturally becomes: where does the Trinity come from? Historically speaking, the Trinitarian formulation does not appear as an explicit doctrine in the preaching of Yeshua. It crystallizes gradually in the life of the Church, in dialogue with communal experience and with the philosophical language of the age.

The decisive formalization takes place at the Council of Nicaea (325 AD) and at Constantinople (381 AD), where the ontological terms are established (“of one being” — *homoousios*). The purpose was the protection of the unity of the faith and the provision of a common language, not the faithful reproduction of Yeshua’s sermons. Here it is

important to distinguish between triadic passages and the doctrine of the Trinity.

The New Testament contains formulations that mention the Father, the Son, and the Spirit in the same context, without formulating a theory of intra-divine relations. A clear example is the First Epistle of Peter: “chosen... according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, through the sanctification of the Spirit, for obedience and sprinkling with the blood of Yeshua Christ” (1 Peter 1:2). Here we have a functional triad (the Father — initiator, the Spirit — sanctifier, Yeshua — the medium of salvation), not an ontological Trinitarian definition.

The text describes the experience of faith, not the structure of God. It is crucial not to confuse this triad with the dogmatic formula of the Trinity. 1 Peter 1:2 does not say that God is “three persons of one being”; it articulates the way believers experience the work of God. Precisely for this reason, passages of this kind do not contradict the fact that Yeshua did not preach a Trinitarian theology: they belong to communal reflection after Easter.

Often, when “a clearly Trinitarian text” from the New Testament is invoked, it is confused with the First Epistle of John, the passage known as the Comma Johanneum (1 John 5:7–8, in some translations: “the Father, the Word, and the Holy Spirit, and these three are one”). It is important to state, with historical honesty, that this passage is regarded by the great majority of textual scholarship as a late addition, absent from the oldest Greek manuscripts and appearing in the medieval Latin tradition.

This very fact shows the later pressure to formulate the Trinity explicitly in the biblical text — a pressure that does not come from the preaching of Yeshua, but from the doctrinal needs of the later Church. Why did Yeshua not explicitly say, “God is a Trinity”? Because this was not his purpose. Yeshua did not come to explain the structure of God. He came to reorient the life of man: “do not be afraid,” “follow me,” “love,” “the Kingdom is near” (Mark 1:15).

A metaphysical formula would not have healed fear, would not have freed consciousness, and would not have created life. Yeshua’s language

is therapeutic and revelatory, not ontological. In this sense, “You are the Son of God!” (Matthew 14:33) remains true as recognition, not as definition. Yeshua accepts this recognition because God was seen at work. But he does not transform it into a doctrine and does not demand it as a test of belonging.

The Trinity, as theological language, will appear later in order to explain an experience; Yeshua, through his life, makes it possible. The conclusion is clear and balanced: Yeshua never positioned himself explicitly as “part of the Trinity.” The New Testament contains triadic passages (including 1 Peter 1:2), not a formulated Trinitarian doctrine. The formulation of the Trinity appears later, out of the need for clarity and doctrinal unity. Yeshua did not come to teach us how God is constituted.

He came to show us how God is encountered.

The Holy Spirit in Yeshua

If we want to understand who Yeshua truly is, we must dwell on an essential element, often mystified, at other times dogmatized: the Holy Spirit. Without it, Yeshua becomes either an exceptional moralist or a religious magician. With it, Yeshua becomes what the Gospels actually describe: a man who lives from God, not separate from God. In the story of Yeshua, the Holy Spirit is not a theological accessory. It is the medium in which Yeshua lives.

The moment of the baptism is often misunderstood. The text does not say that Yeshua becomes, at that point, something he was not before. It says that what already was becomes visible. The Spirit that descends upon Yeshua does not transform him. It reveals him. Instead of adding power to him, it shows the source from which Yeshua already lived.

It is as if heaven says: “This is what a man in full relationship with God looks like.” Yeshua does not speak of the Spirit as a force that dictates from outside, and he never invokes it as an authority that commands or coerces. He does not say, “the Spirit commanded me,” but

lives in a calm clarity, in an obedience free of fear. “I always do what is pleasing to the Father” (John 8:29).

In him there is no tension between will and truth, no inner conflict, no negotiation with the self. There is an inner accord, a unity and a stillness from which life flows naturally. “My peace I give to you; I do not give to you as the world gives” (John 14:27). For Yeshua, the Spirit is not an external authority. The Spirit is the inner space of truth.

There, where man is no longer fragmented, where he is no longer pulled by fears and no longer driven by the need for validation, there appears this stillness from which action is born naturally. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32). That is why Yeshua does not react impulsively, does not defend himself obsessively, and does not constantly justify what he does. “When he was reviled, he did not revile in return; when he suffered, he did not threaten” (1 Peter 2:23). The Spirit does not make him stronger in the worldly sense, but makes him whole. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21).

Why the Spirit Does Not Produce Fear, Guilt, or Control

Wherever the Spirit appears in the life of Yeshua, the same fruits appear, repeated with a consistency that leaves no room for interpretation: healing, liberation, life, truth, clarity. “God anointed him with the Holy Spirit and with power; he went about doing good and healing all who were under the power of the devil” (Acts of the Apostles 10:38). “I have come that the sheep may have life, and have it in abundance” (John 10:10).

Never, however, do threat, shaming, coercion, or religious manipulation appear. “In love there is no fear, but perfect love casts out fear” (1 John 4:18). Where religion produced fear, Yeshua produced breath. “Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28). Where the law produced condemnation, Yeshua produced encounter. “Neither do I condemn you; go and sin no more” (John 8:11).

The Holy Spirit is not the instrument of moral correction but the medium of inner healing. “Where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is freedom” (2 Corinthians 3:17). Perhaps the most radical statement of Yeshua is that the Spirit which is in him will also be in others. “He remains with you and will be in you” (John 14:17). Yeshua does not say, “I have, you do not,” but “I show you.” He does not claim a privilege; on the contrary, he opens a possibility.

“I have given you an example, so that you also may do as I have done” (John 13:15). The difference between Yeshua and other people is not the possession of the Spirit but the degree of openness. Yeshua does not put up resistance to truth, does not defend himself against the light, does not identify with the ego, and does not flee from pain. “Not my will, but yours be done” (Luke 22:42). That is why the Spirit flows freely, because there is no dam. “Whoever believes in me, out of his heart will flow rivers of living water” (John 7:38).

Blasphemy Against the Holy Spirit. Why It Is the Only Unforgivable “Sin” in Yeshua

When Yeshua speaks of blasphemy against the Holy Spirit, he does not introduce a supreme moral category, nor does he threaten an irreversible divine punishment. It is not about a particular deed, nor about a doctrinal error or an extreme ethical deviation. It is about an inner state of total closure to truth when truth manifests itself alive. “Every sin and blasphemy will be forgiven people, but blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven” (Matthew 12:31).

The context is essential. Yeshua heals, liberates, and brings life, and the religious leaders, instead of seeing the living reality of the healing, rigidly reinterpret it and call it a work of evil. Here it is not about ignorance. It is about the deliberate refusal to recognize the good when you see it. The light is present, but it is rejected in order to protect a system of interpretation. That is why the problem is not moral but existential. You can err morally and you can be corrected.

You can err theologically and you can be enlightened. You can wrong people and you can be forgiven. But if you refuse the very reality that heals, if you call the light darkness and truth a threat, then no space remains through which transformation can enter. “The light has come into the world, but people loved the darkness more than the light” (John 3:19). This is not a sentence pronounced by God. It is the observation of a total closure on the part of man.

The Holy Spirit as the Fluid of Communication, Not as a Dogmatic Arbiter

In Yeshua, the Holy Spirit is not the one who establishes who is right in a theological dispute. It is not an arbiter of ideas, nor a judge of interpretations. The Spirit does not come to confirm one camp against another, but to make fluid the space between people, so that truth may circulate without fear. “When he comes, the Spirit of truth, he will guide you into all truth” (John 16:13). Truth here is not a set of correct propositions, but a living clarity that makes relationship possible.

The Holy Spirit is not an interpreter of Scriptures. The Scriptures can be read without the Spirit and can become weapons. The Spirit is the inner wise one who says what illuminates, even if it is undoctinal, even if it does not align with a tradition, even if it destabilizes a rigid certainty. That is why Yeshua speaks freely, answers each person differently, and does not repeat formulas. “The wind blows where it wishes... so it is with everyone who is born of the Spirit” (John 3:8).

When the Spirit is present in a conversation, tension subsides, defensiveness dissolves, and people can hear without defending themselves. When the Spirit is absent, even truth becomes violent. Blasphemy against the Spirit appears precisely when someone prefers to be right rather than to be open, to defend an interpretation rather than to let reality speak.

Why Yeshua Calls the Spirit “the Comforter”

Yeshua also calls the Holy Spirit “the Comforter.” “I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Comforter, to remain with you forever” (John 14:16). He does not call it the Judge, nor the Corrector, nor the moral Overseer. He calls it the Comforter because the Spirit appears where fear dissolves. Comfort does not mean superficial consolation, but the restoration of inner safety. When man is no longer on the defensive, truth no longer hurts.

When the ego is silent, clarity no longer threatens. The Spirit comforts because it makes truth bearable. It makes life breathable. It makes relationship possible. That is why blasphemy against the Spirit is the only real blockage. Not because God would not forgive, but because man refuses the only medium in which forgiveness, healing, and truth can be received. Where the Spirit is rejected, only rigidity remains. And rigidity cannot be healed from within.

What “Blessed Are the Poor in Spirit” Means

“Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven” (Matthew 5:3) opens the Sermon on the Mount not as a command but as the description of a state of consciousness. Yeshua does not begin with “do,” but with “blessed are those who are,” not with a moral requirement but with an inner reality. The Kingdom is not presented as a future reward. It is a present reality for those who live this state. In his logic, it is not behavior that brings the Kingdom.

It is the state of the heart that allows the Kingdom to be seen. To be “poor in spirit” does not mean intellectual deficiency, inferiority, or forced humiliation. It means, rather, an inner emptying of false certainties and of the rigid identity of the ego that leans upon itself. The same idea appears when Yeshua says: “Unless you turn and become like little children, you will not enter the Kingdom of Heaven” (Matthew 18:3).

The child is “poor in spirit” not because he does not know, but because he does not defend himself through what he knows. He is open,

receptive, alive, without the need to extract his value from status, morality, knowledge, or religion. This is the state to which Yeshua refers. This poverty is freedom, not inferiority. The one who is poor in spirit is not empty. He is available. Yeshua describes it through humility: “Whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted” (Luke 14:11).

Humility is not self-annulment, but the absence of the need to defend oneself. Only the one who is empty of self can see. That is why he also says: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). Those who are full of opinions, dogmas, certainties, and religious identities no longer have inner space for this reality; poverty of spirit creates this space. Yeshua begins with this verse because he knows that nothing of what follows can be lived without this state.

Love of enemies, nonviolence, forgiveness, and truth require a self that does not defend itself compulsively. That is why he says: “If anyone wants to come after me, let him deny himself” (Mark 8:34). Self-denial is not self-contempt. It is the renunciation of the ego as center. This is, in essence, poverty of spirit. In many contemporary contexts, however, “poor in spirit” has come to mean people who consider themselves unworthy, who constantly affirm their sinfulness and reduce their own value.

The verse thus ends up supporting an identity of spiritual inferiority. But Yeshua says, in the same discourse: “You are the light of the world” (Matthew 5:14). He cannot affirm simultaneously that man is “nothing” and that he is “the light of the world.” The confusion arises when humility is translated as self-annulment, and poverty of spirit as a lack of value. Yeshua does not cultivate guilt; he frees from it. Before the woman caught in adultery he says: “Neither do I condemn you” (John 8:11).

To be poor in spirit does not mean to live with bowed head, but to live with an open heart. Guilt closes; poverty of spirit opens. Over time, this verse has been used to keep man in a dependence on authority, suggesting that any inner clarity or strength would be pride. Yeshua does exactly the opposite: he dissolves pride through truth, not through

humiliation. Those who are poor in spirit are free because they have nothing to lose. They are not defended by image, status, or ideology.

“The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) describes this freedom that comes from the emptying of self. That is why “theirs is the Kingdom”: not because they are more moral, but because they are no longer full of themselves. Read from within the words of Yeshua, “Blessed are the poor in spirit” is not a call to diminishment. It is a call to emptying. Not to shame, but to availability; not to inferiority, but to presence. Yeshua does not bless weakness; he encourages transparency.

He does not praise the lack of value. He rewards the lack of ego. Any reading that turns this verse into an invitation to self-annulment misses precisely the meaning that Yeshua places at the beginning of his entire teaching: not small people who believe correctly, but people empty of self who can see.

3. How Yeshua's Teaching Works

Why Yeshua Speaks in Parables and Not in Doctrines

When you go looking for “doctrine” in Yeshua, you run into a problem: there isn’t much to find. What you find instead are parables. And parables are not didactic lessons in the classical sense. They are devices that break the linear mind and force it to see. Doctrine tells you what to believe. A parable provokes your perception. Doctrine closes; a parable opens. This is why Yeshua prefers the parable: because he does not want mental assent, he wants awakening.

Yeshua says outright that he speaks in parables precisely because there is a difference between hearing and understanding: “This is why I speak to them in parables: because seeing they do not see, and hearing they do not hear, nor do they understand” (Matthew 13:13). This is not elitism but a diagnosis: there are people who have religion but no sight. They have information but no transformation. The parable slips past the defense mechanism of the religious ego. If you told a Pharisee directly, “You are a hypocrite,” he would defend himself.

But if you tell him a story about two men who go up to pray, one boasting and the other humbling himself, and God justifies the second, the story gets past the guards and settles into the conscience (Luke 18:9–14). Then the inner work begins. The parable is an instrument of freedom. A doctrine can be memorized and used as an identity. A parable, by contrast, demands participation. It does not hand you the answer to wear as a badge; it sets you in front of a mirror.

“Who is my neighbor?” asks the expert in the law, searching for a definition. Yeshua gives no definition. He tells the story of the Samaritan. And at the end he asks, “Which of these became a neighbor?” (Luke 10:29–37). Notice the inversion: not “who deserves my love?” but “into what do I transform myself?” Doctrine asks about a category. The parable asks about being. Yeshua avoids doctrines because doctrines are easily confiscated by power.

A doctrinal system quickly creates a correctness police: who is “inside,” who is “outside.” Parables, by contrast, cannot be fully administered. They remain living provocations. This is why the Kingdom is described through fluid images: seed, leaven, treasure, a net (Matthew 13). You cannot build a tribunal out of leaven. You cannot control people with a seed. What you can do is wake them. There is another reason as well: Yeshua wants to speak on many levels.

A parable can be heard by a child, a fisherman, an intellectual, a Pharisee. Each takes what he can. Doctrine standardizes. The parable respects differences of maturity without humiliating them. “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” is not an insult. It is an invitation toward maturing (Mark 4:9). In the end, the parable preserves the mystery. And preserving the mystery is essential, because the reality of God is not a mental object.

Any doctrine, even when true, can become an idol if it replaces the encounter. Yeshua does not want to give you a system about God. He wants to bring you to the point where the Kingdom becomes visible.

When Challenged Religiously, Yeshua Responds Existentially

Yeshua almost never engages in doctrinal disputes in the classical religious sense. He does not enter into theological polemics, does not construct treatises, does not defend a system, and does not try to reform Judaism through argument. He enters conflicts, but not over doctrine; he enters tensions, but not over systematic theology. And when it seems the

discussion is about religion, it is in fact about the heart, about hypocrisy, and about real life.

Time and again, the context in which he is placed would have been ideal for deep theological debate. Instead, his responses constantly shift the conversation out of the sphere of religion and into the sphere of the human being's inner state.

How Yeshua Preaches and How Today's Preachers Preach

Yeshua does not preach a doctrine but rather a way of being. His words are not explanations about God. They are invitations to awakening. He does not say "believe this," but "follow me." He does not build a system of ideas; he opens a path of inner transformation. His preaching is performative: what he says happens within the one who listens. "Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near" (Matthew 4:17). Repentance, for Yeshua, does not mean guilt.

It means a change of mind, a shift in the center of consciousness. Yeshua speaks in parables not in order to be poetic. He does it to avoid rigidifying the truth. A parable cannot be turned into dogma without being killed. "Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear" (Matthew 11:15). His truth is not meant to be repeated. It is meant to be recognized. He does not explain the Kingdom; he points to it. "The Kingdom of God is within you" (Luke 17:21). Yeshua's preaching is always about now.

He does not promise a future salvation in exchange for correct belief; he promises present life through lived truth. "Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father" (Matthew 7:21). The emphasis is on being, not on affirming. On living, not on belonging. Paul changes the register radically. He does not preach the Kingdom. He preaches salvation. He does not preach a state of consciousness, but the central event: the cross.

"We preach Christ crucified" (1 Corinthians 1:23). The message becomes explanatory, theological, soteriological. In place of "follow

me” comes “believe that.” In place of immediate inner transformation comes justification by faith. In Paul, truth is no longer recognized inwardly but accepted intellectually.

“A person is justified by faith apart from the works of the law” (Romans 3:28). Here the subtle rupture appears: the life one lives is no longer the primary criterion, but rather adherence to a correct formula. Faith becomes a substitute for transformation, not its natural expression. This shift makes the message transmissible on a large scale. Paul builds the language, the structure, the theology that allow a global religion to arise. But at the same time, the message can become separated from life.

You can believe without changing. You can confess without living. You can be “in Christ” theologically without being alive existentially. Today’s preachers carry this shift even further. In many contexts, preaching is no longer either an invitation to awakening or deep theological reflection, but emotional management, moralizing, or spiritual marketing. The sermon becomes either a list of rules, a promise of prosperity, or a motivational speech dressed in religious garb.

Truth is no longer something that changes you, but something that soothes or validates you. In contemporary preaching, the emphasis often falls on sin, fear, belonging, and authority. “Believe correctly so you’ll be safe.” “Belong so you’ll be saved.” “Respect the doctrine so you’ll be accepted.” Within this framework, Yeshua is often presented not as a model of life but as a legal solution to a theological problem. The cross becomes a contract, not a revelation. Yeshua, however, does not preach fear.

He preaches freedom. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32). Paul preaches liberation from the Law through faith, but he leaves room for a new law: the law of doctrine. Today’s preachers, in many cases, preach psychological security, not freedom. Order, not life. Conformity, not awakening. The essential difference is not one of meaning. Yeshua preaches from being to being. Paul preaches from interpretation to belief. Today’s preachers often preach from institution to behavior. Yeshua awakens. Paul explains. The preachers administer. “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6). In Yeshua, truth is alive. In

Paul, truth is formulated. Among today's preachers, truth is often defended. But a truth that must be defended no longer sets free. A truth that is lived does.

Yeshua did not ask to be preached, but to be embodied. "You are the light of the world" (Matthew 5:14). Not "talk about the light," but be light. Here the circle closes. Authentic preaching is not the discourse from the pulpit, but the life that becomes visible. The rest are echoes—some useful, others distorting.

Why Yeshua Accepts Gestures of Reverence Without Cultivating Idolization

In the Gospels there are episodes in which people throw themselves at Yeshua's feet, call him "Lord," or prostrate themselves before him (Matthew 14:33; John 9:38). Read through a modern lens, these gestures look like acts of cultic adoration. But read in the context of the ancient world and of biblical language, they are first of all gestures of gratitude, recognition, and thanksgiving for life received or restored—not attempts to turn Yeshua into an idol.

In the Semitic culture of the first century, prostration (*proskynesis*) carried a wide range of meanings: deep respect, recognition of an authority, thanksgiving for help received, or acknowledgment of God's presence in an event. It was not reserved exclusively for divine worship in the strict theological sense. People prostrated themselves before kings, prophets, or benefactors as a form of total thanksgiving and as an acknowledgment of their dependence in that moment.

Yeshua accepts these gestures because they express the truth of lived experience, not because he demands adoration. The episode of the calming of the storm is telling. The disciples "worshiped him," saying, "Truly you are the Son of God!" (Matthew 14:33). The reaction comes after their lives have been saved. The gesture is an explosion of gratitude and recognition, not the inauguration of a ritual. Yeshua does not request it, does not standardize it, and does not turn it into a criterion of belonging.

He receives it because the truth that was seen—a life saved—calls for a bodily language to match. Likewise, in the case of the man born blind, the “worship” (John 9:38) comes at the end of a journey of awakening to sight. The man says, “Lord, I believe,” and prostrates himself as a sign of thanksgiving for the life regained and the meaning rediscovered. Here, worship is gratitude made flesh, not a cultic act.

Yeshua accepts it because it is the expression of a heart that sees, not because he wishes to be the object of devotion. The same logic appears in the episodes of pleading: the Canaanite woman (Matthew 15:25), the father of the sick child (Mark 9:20–24), the cleansed leper (Mark 1:40). People throw themselves at Yeshua's feet not to adore him theologically, but to give thanks, to ask for life, and to acknowledge the help received.

The gesture says: “I no longer control; I receive.” Yeshua does not correct the form, because the form is true to their inner state. A decisive clue is that Yeshua does not turn gratitude into obligation. He never says “do this always,” and he does not make healing conditional on prostration. On the contrary, in the episode of the ten lepers, only one returns to give thanks (Luke 17:15–19). Yeshua does not condemn the others.

He underscores the value of gratitude as an opening of the heart, not as a cultic norm. Thanksgiving is appreciated, not imposed. The contrast with the scene of the temptations is illuminating. There, Yeshua refuses the worship demanded as currency in exchange for power: “You shall worship the Lord your God, and him only shall you serve” (Matthew 4:10). Yeshua rejects worship that produces dependence, fear, or control, because that is exactly what destroys relationship.

By contrast, he accepts the free gestures of gratitude because they create no hierarchies and demand no submission. They are responses to life, not instruments of domination. Moreover, Yeshua constantly redirects the glory from himself toward the Father. “I do not seek my own glory” (John 8:50). “My teaching is not my own” (John 7:16). When he is called “good,” he sends the goodness back to God (Mark 10:18).

These statements would be contradictory if Yeshua had wanted his own person to be idolized. They become coherent once we understand

that the gratitude he receives does not stop at him. The gratitude passes through him toward God. In the Gospels, the “worship” Yeshua receives is, in essence, thanksgiving made flesh and an acknowledgment of the truth that has been seen. Yeshua accepts it because to refuse it would mean denying the truth of a person's experience.

But he does not ask for it and does not organize it, precisely in order to prevent idolization. The conclusion becomes clear: worship, in that time, was often the language of total gratitude, not the cult of an idol. Yeshua accepts gratitude for life received, but refuses any form of worship that would turn gratitude into dependence. He does not gather worshippers. He receives the thanks of those who have seen.

Why Yeshua Does Not Build a Religious Identity

Yeshua enters a deeply religious world, yet he constantly refuses to build a religious identity. Because identity is easier than change. He offers no badges of belonging, imposes no formulas, and creates no clear lines between “our people” and “the others.” This absence is not an oversight; it is intention. Yeshua sees that religion, when it becomes an identity, replaces transformation with belonging.

Religious identity offers security: you know who you are, where you belong, who is right. But this security comes at a cost: rigidity, exclusion, fear of error. This is why Yeshua harshly criticizes not a lack of belief but religious certainty. “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees” (Matthew 23) is not an attack on Scripture. It is an attack on the use of Scripture as identity armor. Yeshua constantly shifts the center of gravity from “who you are” to “how you are.” He does not ask what you believe. He asks how you love. He does not ask where you are going, but what you see. “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the Kingdom” (Matthew 7:21). Verbal identity guarantees nothing. The only criterion is a living relationship with the truth. By refusing to build a religious identity, Yeshua keeps the message open. The Kingdom cannot be confiscated by any one group. This is why he

praises the faith of a Roman (Matthew 8:10), speaks with Samaritans (John 4), and constantly breaks through religious boundaries.

Truth, for Yeshua, does not belong to an identity. It is recognized, not possessed.

Why Does Yeshua Form Apostles?

Yeshua does not form apostles in order to create a religious caste. The apostle is not a theologian but a living witness. “You will be my witnesses” (Acts 1:8). To be a witness does not mean to explain. It means to show. The apostles are sent not to defend a doctrine. They are sent to live what they have seen. “What we have heard, what we have seen with our own eyes... this we proclaim to you” (1 John 1:1–3). The formation of the apostles is necessary for continuity, but not for rigid institutionalization.

Yeshua does not give them a manual. He gives them the Spirit. “The Spirit will guide you into all truth” (John 16:13).

Why Yeshua Chose Twelve Disciples

The choice of the twelve disciples is often read superficially, as an administrative gesture: Yeshua is forming a “group,” a nucleus of followers, a first structure of the Church. But such a reading projects back onto Yeshua an institutional intention that the Gospels do not support. Yeshua does not act as the founder of an organization, nor as a strategist of religious expansion.

The choice of the twelve is symbolic, pedagogical, and existential before it is functional. It says more about how Yeshua sees reality than about how he intends to build a religion. Yeshua does not choose twelve because twelve were enough. Nor because he wanted an “optimized” number. The number twelve is loaded with meaning in the Jewish imagination: the twelve tribes of Israel (Genesis 35:22–26). Through this choice, Yeshua does not announce a new institution that replaces Israel, but a reconfiguration of the meaning of Israel. He gathers around himself not a moral or intellectual elite, but a miniature of ordinary

humanity: fishermen, tax collectors, impulsive men, fearful men, indecisive men. Their selection is not meritocratic. It is intentionally imperfect.

Through the twelve, Yeshua says without saying: the Kingdom of God is not built on exceptions; it is made of real people. If he had chosen only “good” people, the message would have been falsified. If he had chosen only the learned, the message would have become elitist. But Yeshua chooses people who have nothing spectacular about them except a willingness to go after him, even without fully understanding where the road leads (Mark 1:16–20).

This willingness, not competence, is the criterion. The choice of the twelve is not about control. It is about relationship. Yeshua does not instruct them through manuals, but through presence. “He appointed twelve so that they might be with him” (Mark 3:14). This phrasing is essential. The primary purpose is not “to do something.” It is “to be with him.” Transformation is not transmitted as information. It is a contagion of consciousness. The disciples do not become different because they receive a correct doctrine.

They become different people because they live alongside a man who does not live out of fear, status, or power. At the same time, Yeshua chooses twelve in order to show that the Kingdom is not an individual project. Though his message is profoundly inward, it is not solipsistic. The Kingdom is seen between people, not in isolation. The twelve are not called to save themselves separately, but to learn together what it means to be a community that does not run on hierarchies of domination.

This is why Yeshua corrects them constantly whenever they try to introduce the logic of power: “Whoever wants to be first must be the servant of all” (Mark 9:35). Choosing a group creates the context in which these tensions can surface and be transformed. It is significant that among the twelve is also Judas. If Yeshua had been after efficiency or image, this choice would have been a failure.

But it is precisely the inclusion of Judas that shows Yeshua does not build a “clean” group. He does not eliminate the risk. He does not

protect himself from betrayal through selection. This suggests that the Kingdom of God is not based on excluding those who might fail. It is based on the embrace of vulnerability. A group without risk would be a simulation of love, not real love. The twelve are also a prophetic act. Through them, Yeshua announces that God does not give up on the world.

He reconfigures it from within. Twelve ordinary men become the sign that transformation does not come through imposition from above, but through slow fermentation. Just as the Kingdom is compared to the leaven that works through the whole batch of dough (Matthew 13:33), the twelve are sufficient not to dominate, but to begin a process that cannot be controlled. It is important to notice that Yeshua does not grant the twelve a permanent special status.

When they argue among themselves about who is greatest, he does not clarify hierarchies; on the contrary, he undermines them (Luke 22:24–27). When Peter errs, he is rebuked publicly (Mark 8:33). When the disciples do not understand, Yeshua does not replace them with others more “capable.” This shows that their selection is not about performance but about process. The Kingdom is not a selection of the best, but a road of transformation for those who are available.

The choice of the twelve is also a silent answer to the messianic temptation of power. A political Messiah would have gathered an army. A religious Messiah would have gathered a moral elite. Yeshua gathers a small, fragile, often confused group in order to show that real change does not come through force or through purity. Real change comes through relationship. Twelve men who learn to stop defending themselves from one another are already a greater revolution than any conquest.

In the end, Yeshua chooses twelve not in order to build a religion, but in order to embody a way of being that can be transmitted only through a life lived together. They are not “founders of the Church” in the administrative sense, but witnesses to a reality that cannot be reduced to structure. After Yeshua's death, the community will become an institution.

But before the institution, there was a circle of people who learned, slowly and imperfectly, what it means to live without fear in the presence of God.

Why Sacrifice Nevertheless Appears in Christianity

After Yeshua's death, the communities that remained behind him faced a reality that was hard to integrate. The violent execution of a man perceived as righteous, a healer, a bearer of life created a deep psychological and spiritual rupture. It was not only about the loss of a teacher, but about the collapse of an expectation. If God was with him, how could it end this way?

In the face of this shock, the communities felt the need to explain, to make sense, and to integrate the event into a familiar structure. In this context, the language of sacrifice became a bridge to understanding. It offered meaning where there was trauma, coherence where there was confusion, and continuity with the Jewish tradition in which sacrifice was already a familiar theological language.

Moreover, it offered a stable juridical framework, capable of translating Yeshua's death into a logic of compensation and balance. It was not necessarily a new revelation, but a translation of an emotionally unbearable event into an already existing system of meaning. It is essential, however, to notice something that appears consistently in the Gospel accounts. Yeshua never explains his death in terms of a payment demanded by God.

He does not speak of a divine wrath that must be satisfied, nor of a cosmic debt that must be settled. He speaks of giving, of freedom, and of acceptance. "No one takes my life from me, but I lay it down of my own accord. I have authority to lay it down, and authority to take it up again" (John 10:18). The language is one of freedom, not of juridical constraint. The cross, in this light, is not God's accounting plan.

It is the consequence of the meeting between unconditional love and a religious and political system that cannot tolerate it. Yeshua does not die because God demands blood. Yeshua dies because a love without

fear, without negotiation, and without violence becomes unbearable to structures built on control, guilt, and power. "The light has come into the world, but people loved the darkness rather than the light" (John 3:19).

The cross does not say something about God's need for sacrifice, but about the world's inability to receive the truth without destroying it. During his life, Yeshua forgives without appealing to sacrifice. Forgiveness appears before the cross and independently of it. "Son, your sins are forgiven" (Mark 2:5). There is no condition, no payment, no invocation of a future sacrifice. Forgiveness is not postponed until a juridical event; it is offered in direct encounter.

This shows clearly that, for Yeshua, the relationship between humanity and God is not broken, only unperceived. In this vision, sin is not a cosmic debt that must be settled, but a state of wandering, of not-seeing, of fear. "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing" (Luke 23:34). Ignorance, not juridical guilt, is the central problem. This is why transformation does not come from payment, but from encounter. Not from the satisfaction of a divine demand.

Rather, from the awakening of the human being to truth. Forgiveness, in Yeshua's vision, is not a mechanism that changes God's attitude toward humanity. God is never presented as an offended judge who must be persuaded to forgive. Forgiveness is a recognition. It does not change God's decision, but it changes the human being's position in relation to truth. "The Kingdom of God is near" (Mark 1:15). The nearness is not the result of an accepted sacrifice.

It is the result of an awareness. So the language of sacrifice that appears later in Christianity does not describe the way God works. It is, rather, the way the communities tried to understand a traumatic loss. It is a theology of meaning after the event, not a revelation of divine intent. In Yeshua, forgiveness precedes the cross, life precedes the explanation, and relationship precedes doctrine. The cross is not the condition of God's love.

The cross is the proof that this love goes all the way to the end, even when it is rejected.

The Demons Yeshua Casts Out

The accounts of “devils” and “demons” are among the hardest to read with the modern mind, but also among the most revealing of the difference in perspective between Yeshua, Paul, and the Christianity that came after them. The language seems the same, yet the reality it points to is profoundly different.

Yeshua uses the vocabulary of his era to describe inner states of captivity and disintegration, while, gradually, demons would become in later theology external, autonomous entities, part of a logic of “spiritual warfare.” In the Gospels, Yeshua casts “unclean spirits” out of people who present very concrete symptoms: loss of identity—“My name is Legion” (Mark 5:9)—compulsive and self-destructive behavior—“night and day he would cry out and cut himself with stones” (Mark 5:5)—extreme social isolation, the inability to speak—“they brought to him a mute man who was demon-possessed” (Matthew 9:32)—violent fits that throw the body into convulsions (Mark 9:17–27).

Yeshua is not interested in the metaphysical origin of demons, but in their effect on the person. He does not explain what demons are; he recognizes them by what they produce: fragmentation, the loss of freedom, dehumanization. The demonic, in Yeshua, is not a “character” but a state in which a person is no longer himself. It is significant that, in these encounters, Yeshua always brings the person back into consciousness and identity. He asks, “What is your name?” (Mark 5:9).

He does not converse with the demon as an entity, but with the human being who has become lost in that state. After the deliverance, the criterion of healing is not victory over an invisible force, but the fact that the man is “clothed and in his right mind” (Mark 5:15). The exorcism is not a spectacle but a reintegration. On several occasions, the demons “recognize” Yeshua: “I know who you are—the Holy One of God” (Mark 1:24). Read literally, the scene seems mythological.

Read in Yeshua's logic, it takes on a deep symbolic meaning: states of disintegration are the first to react to truth. Truth is destabilizing for any structure built on fear and falsehood. Yeshua's response is simple

and free of drama: "Be silent, and come out of him!" (Mark 1:25). There is no ritual, no elaborate invocation. Clear presence and spoken truth dissolve the confusion.

An essential fact is that Yeshua never builds a demonology. He does not classify spirits, does not speak of demonic hierarchies, does not describe strategies of evil. Demons do not become a theological subject but a therapeutic context. The attention stays on the person, not on the force that captured him. When he says, "If I cast out demons by the finger of God, then the Kingdom of God has come upon you" (Luke 11:20), the emphasis does not fall on the demons; it falls on the Kingdom—that is, on restored life, on the person brought back to himself.

In Paul, the language visibly changes. He speaks of "rulers," "authorities," "the powers of darkness" (Ephesians 6:12). The demonic takes on a cosmic and structural dimension. It is no longer just an inner state of the individual, but a system of forces operating upon the world. From this comes an important shift: the problem is no longer the healing of the person. For Paul, the problem is spiritual warfare. The human being becomes a participant in an invisible conflict.

Paul urges resistance, the "armor of God," continual vigilance (Ephesians 6:13–17). The demonic is no longer dissolved through presence. In Paul, the demonic must be combated through faith and belonging. Later Christianity would carry this direction even further. Demons would be understood as autonomous personal entities, directly responsible for illness, sin, and even a person's thoughts. Evil is moved almost entirely outward.

The demonic becomes the preferred explanation for everything that is psychologically disturbing, hard to integrate inwardly, or socially uncomfortable. Exorcism becomes ritual, technique, hierarchy. Fear becomes institutionalized. The person is no longer merely wounded or fragmented; he is possessed. Inner responsibility is often displaced outward.

This vision produces concrete effects: the stigmatization of mental suffering, the avoidance of introspection, the externalization of blame,

and the consolidation of the religious authority of those who “have power over demons.” This is exactly the direction Yeshua never follows. The difference in perspective becomes clear. In Yeshua, demons are states of disintegration; the solution is presence and truth; healing means becoming whole; the person remains at the center.

In Paul, demons become cosmic powers; the solution is spiritual warfare and resistance; the person becomes part of a larger conflict. In later Christianity, demons are autonomous entities; the solution becomes ritual and authority; fear is consolidated, and the person ends up a battlefield. Yeshua did not come to create a mythology of demons. He came to heal disintegrated people. For him, the demonic is not something to be studied. It is something to be dissolved through truth.

Wherever a person recovers his mind, his voice, his freedom, and his dignity, there the demon has gone out—whatever name you might have given it.

Who Satan Is for Yeshua

The figure of Satan becomes much clearer when it is read from within Yeshua's message, rather than through the lens of late demonology. For Yeshua, Satan is not a cosmic anti-God, nor a character equal in power to God. Satan is the inner adversary of truth—a logic of separation that today can be described very precisely through the notion of the ego.

Only later, in Paul and in institutional Christianity, would Satan be projected outward, becoming a cosmic, personalized, feared entity. The word “satan” means, in its original sense, “adversary” or “accuser.” In Yeshua, Satan does not appear as a mythological being described in cosmic detail, but as the voice that opposes lived truth.

This voice does not come from outside the person, but from an inner structure built on fear, separation, and self-protection—what, in contemporary language, we call the ego. Yeshua does not develop a demonology. All he does is expose a dynamic of consciousness. In the temptations in the wilderness (Matthew 4:1–11), Satan does not invite Yeshua to crude immorality.

He invites him to the classic moves of the ego: the assertion of the self through power (“tell these stones to become bread”), the avoidance of vulnerability by guaranteeing safety (“throw yourself down”), and dominance over others (“I will give you all the kingdoms of the world”). These are the fundamental reflexes of the separate self: survival, validation, and control. Satan, for Yeshua, is not “something” external, but the inner logic that says: defend yourself, prove yourself, control.

Yeshua does not negotiate with this voice, does not dramatize it, and does not turn it into a spectacular conflict. He sees it and refuses it. This is why the temptation is not a battle but rather an act of clarity.

“The Ruler of This World Has No Hold on Me.” Zero Ego

The statement in John 14:30 is the key to this understanding: “The ruler of this world is coming. He has no hold on me.” “The ruler of this world” does not designate here a cosmic demon, but the logic of a world built on the ego: the fear of death, defensive identity, competition, justified violence, and the need for superiority. When Yeshua says that this power “has no hold on me,” he is affirming that there is no point of attachment.

There is no fear, no desire for self-assertion, no need for control, and no identity separate from the Father. In modern language, we might say that Yeshua has no functional ego. Not because he has no personality, but because his identity is not built on separation. This is why the adversary cannot operate. Where there is no fear, there is no grip. Yeshua says clearly, “He is a liar and the father of lies” (John 8:44).

The fundamental lie is not doctrinal but existential. It is the idea that a person is separate from God, that he must defend himself in order to exist, and that he is alone in a hostile world. This is the narrative of the ego. The ego says: you are not safe, you are not enough, you must defend yourself, others are a threat. For Yeshua, Satan is this false story

about who we are. This is why his solution is not the exorcism of an entity.

The solution is the truth that dissolves the lie. "You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free" (John 8:32). When the lie falls, the adversary falls. There is no need for battle; clarity is enough. The same unity reappears when Yeshua says "I and the Father are one" (John 10:30) and "Whoever has seen me has seen the Father" (John 14:9). These words do not describe superiority, but the absence of division. In Yeshua there is no inner conflict, no rupture, no cracks through which fear or falsehood might enter. Evil has nowhere to get in because there are no unintegrated spaces. Yeshua's anthropology starts here: a person can become whole. "Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God" (Matthew 5:8) does not describe moral perfection but a heart without inner cracks.

"The Kingdom of God is within you" (Luke 17:21) shows that this wholeness is not external but internal. "The truth will set you free" (John 8:32) does not mean the freedom to abstain, but the freedom to no longer carry within you anything that can be pressed. Purity of heart is the absence of vulnerable points through which fear, shame, and guilt can be activated. When we come to Paul, the language changes radically.

Paul does not describe the human being as an integrated being but as a divided one: "I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want is what I do" (Romans 7:19). "I see in my members another law, waging war against the law of my mind" (Romans 7:23). "Walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh" (Galatians 5:16). If in Yeshua evil "has no hold" on the person, in Paul evil is present in the person and must be kept under control. Yeshua describes healing; Paul describes the struggle.

Yeshua shows the person who can become whole, in whom evil no longer finds leverage. Paul shows the person who lives aware of his division and learns to manage it. In Yeshua, presence and clarity predominate. In Paul, discipline and vigilance predominate. In Yeshua

we see healing; in Paul we see the crucifixion of the flesh. Yeshua nowhere says that he struggles with himself; Paul states this explicitly.

This is why Yeshua can say “he has no hold on me,” whereas Paul could not utter this sentence without feeling it as spiritual pride. Paul says, “Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the foremost” (1 Timothy 1:15). He remains in the posture of a person in process, in tension, in continual vigilance. Yeshua speaks from the posture of a person who has reached inner unity. We see here two different ways of not reacting to evil.

Yeshua does not react because there is nothing in him to be activated: “Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing” (Luke 23:34). Paul does not react because he restrains himself: “I discipline my body and keep it under control” (1 Corinthians 9:27). One no longer has any “buttons.” The other learns not to press them. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) and “Fight the good fight” (1 Timothy 6:12), placed side by side, show two different stages of the human being.

Yeshua shows what a person looks like when there are no more cracks. Paul shows how a person lives while the cracks still exist. “The ruler of this world has no hold on me” thus becomes one of the most powerful definitions of the integrated human being in the New Testament. It is not a religious sentence but one about the inner structure of the healed person. In Yeshua we see the possibility of wholeness. In Paul we see the reality of the struggle.

Both are true, but they speak of different stages of the same human journey.

“Demonic”—Spiritual Projection or Misunderstood Suffering?

A great deal of what is called “demonic” today in Christian discourse has nothing to do with external spiritual forces, but with internal psychological processes that we do not know how to recognize and contain. Anxiety, trauma, dissociation, repressed anger, shame, insecure

attachments, and defense mechanisms become, in the absence of an inner language, realities translated religiously. Not because they are demonic in themselves, but because they are uncomfortable and hard to understand. A person who does not know his own inner life needs simple explanations for complex phenomena, and what cannot be processed psychologically is externalized spiritually. The “demonic” becomes a symbolic container for what we do not know how to manage within ourselves. In the Gospels, Yeshua does not treat human suffering as spiritual guilt.

He does not tell the anxious person that he is possessed because he is afraid, he does not declare the angry person demonic because he explodes, and he does not suspect the confused person because he asks questions. On the contrary, he draws near, listens, and heals, and his statement “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick” (Matthew 9:12) radically shifts the frame: the problem is neither moral nor demonic. The problem is curable. Illness is not a stigma. Illness is a context for compassion.

In modern Christianity, by contrast, there often appears a tendency to over-spiritualize everything that does not align with the dominant theology. Intense emotions become “spirits,” doubt becomes “temptation,” a difference of opinion becomes “deception,” a question becomes “rebellion,” and freedom of thought is suspected as a “spiritual attack.” This tendency does not arise from malice.

It arises from fear—the fear of ambiguity, the fear of losing control, the fear of destabilizing a system of meaning that offers security. “There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear, because fear has to do with punishment” (1 John 4:18). Where fear leads, discernment disappears. Psychologically speaking, the “demonic” label often functions as a defense mechanism. If I call something demonic, I am no longer obliged to understand it. I no longer have to listen. I no longer have to enter into dialogue. The case is closed by the label. This is exactly the dynamic Yeshua confronts during his life. When the Pharisees, the religious authority of the time, cannot integrate the way he heals, loves, and speaks with freedom, they resort to the harshest possible label: “He

casts out demons by the prince of demons" (Matthew 12:24). This is not a theological statement but a strategy of invalidation.

If the fruits cannot be denied, the person is discredited. Yeshua's response is disarmingly clear: "How can Satan cast out Satan?" (Mark 3:23). That is: look at the effects. Healing does not come from the demonic, deliverance does not come from darkness, life is not born from death. He moves the discussion from the label to reality, from interpretation to fruits.

Moreover, Yeshua warns of a danger far deeper than possession: the confusion of light with darkness, of healing with evil. The prophetic tradition he continues had already warned: "Woe to those who call evil good and good evil" (Isaiah 5:20). In the context of the Gospels, this confusion is called "blasphemy against the Spirit": "Blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven" (Matthew 12:31).

Not because God refuses forgiveness, but because the closed heart can no longer recognize the truth. When any light is perceived as a threat, the space for healing disappears. If Yeshua were to hear a Christian today demonizing a different opinion, a sincere question, or a symbolic interpretation, he would not begin a theological debate.

He would ask the same uncomfortable questions he asked then: "Why do you see the speck in your brother's eye, but do not notice the log in your own eye?" (Matthew 7:3). And he would continue with the same unmasking of the impeccable exterior and the unexamined interior: "You clean the outside of the cup, but inside you are full of greed and self-indulgence" (Matthew 23:25). The problem is not the other person's opinion, but your inner reaction to it.

For Yeshua, discernment is not made according to doctrinal conformity but according to the fruits of life. "By their fruits you will know them" (Matthew 7:16) remains the criterion. Where there is more life, more inner freedom, more compassion and lived truth, it is not demonic, even if it does not carry your religious language.

And conversely, where there is fear, rigidity, dehumanization, and the need for control, the demonic—in the sense of separation—is already present, even if the language is impeccably religious. In the end,

Yeshua would not condemn psychology, the question, or the difference. He would condemn the use of God as a weapon. He would stand with the one demonized by the community, not with those who demonize. For, as he says clearly: "I desire mercy, not sacrifice" (Matthew 9:13).

True liberation does not come from spiritual labels. It comes from consciousness, presence, and love.

Is There Absolute Evil?

For Yeshua, evil is neither a list of deeds nor a label placed on people. He does not operate with external moral classifications, but with a deep gaze upon the heart. Evil, in his language, is an inner state that produces blindness, separation, and a lack of love. This is why he says: "The good person brings good things out of the good treasure of his heart, and the evil person brings evil things out of the evil treasure of his heart" (Luke 6:45), and explains clearly: "Out of the heart come evil thoughts" (Matthew 15:19).

Evil is not a person's identity, but his disconnection from the source of life. It is not a condemnation of the person, but the description of a state in which the heart no longer sees. Yeshua's harshest words are addressed not to those society considers "sinners," but to those convinced that they see clearly and who judge in the name of that certainty. "If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now that you say, 'We see,' your sin remains" (John 9:41).

Elsewhere, he calls them without hesitation "blind guides" (Matthew 15:14). The supreme evil, in this light, is not the mistake, but the moral arrogance that justifies a lack of love. Blindness that believes itself to be light becomes, for Yeshua, one of the deepest forms of evil, because it can no longer be corrected. Yeshua names evil also where religion becomes an instrument of oppression, shaming, and control.

He says of the religious leaders of his time: "You shut the Kingdom of Heaven in people's faces" (Matthew 23:13). And against this attitude he sets a simple, decisive principle: "I desire mercy, not sacrifice" (Matthew 9:13). Evil is not the law itself, but the use of the law

against life. When the rule replaces compassion, when the form replaces the heart, evil installs itself under the appearance of righteousness. Equally telling is what Yeshua does not call evil.

He does not call evil those who are different, those who are socially stigmatized, those who are searching. He says clearly: "I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners" (Luke 5:32). Before the woman caught in adultery, he shifts the attention from guilt to conscience: "Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone" (John 8:7). For Yeshua, evil is not the fall. For him it is the refusal to see and to love. Closing oneself off from the truth is the central problem. Not the mistake.

In the Apostle Paul, the description of evil takes on a different nuance. He speaks of evil as an active force in conflict with the human being's desire to do good. "I find this law at work: when I want to do good, evil lies close at hand" (Romans 7:21). Paul describes this tension with honesty: "I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want" (Romans 7:19).

The solution, in his vision, is radical: "Those who belong to Christ have crucified the flesh" (Galatians 5:24). The essential difference is that Yeshua sees evil as the absence of lived love, while Paul sees it as a power that demands discipline, struggle, and constant grace. In contemporary Christianity, evil is often externalized and simplified. It becomes different behavior, "wrong" opinion, "worldly" belonging.

The label replaces discernment, and fear justifies itself religiously. Exclusion comes to seem a virtue. It is precisely here that Yeshua warns: "Why do you see the speck in your brother's eye and not notice the log in your own?" (Matthew 7:3). Moral projection—the tendency to see evil only in others—becomes the sign that evil is already at work within. Taken together, three ways of defining evil emerge. For Yeshua, evil is the closed heart that believes itself to be light.

For Paul, evil is the flesh in permanent conflict with grace. For today's Christianity, evil often ends up being the other person. But Yeshua again moves the question inward: from what source does your life flow? His criterion remains the same: "By their fruits you will know

them” (Matthew 7:16). Where the fruits are fear, rigidity, and a lack of compassion, evil is already present, even if the language is religious.

Where the fruits are life, freedom, and love, evil loses its power, even if the forms are not the ones expected.

What It Means “Not to Test God”

The expression “you shall not test God” is one of the most frequently quoted and, at the same time, one of the most misunderstood of biblical formulas. It appears on Yeshua's lips in an extremely precise context and will later be taken up by Paul and by institutional Christianity in very different registers. The words remain the same, but their meaning shifts profoundly. For Yeshua, this expression appears in the episode of the temptation in the wilderness.

When he is challenged to throw himself down from the pinnacle of the temple in order to force divine intervention, he answers simply: “You shall not put the Lord your God to the test” (Matthew 4:7; Deuteronomy 6:16). Yeshua does not refuse faith here; he refuses the manipulation of God. To test God means to demand spectacular proofs in order to quiet your fear or validate your ego, to turn the relationship with the Father into a test, an experiment, a transaction.

Yeshua refuses to use God in order to prove his identity, legitimize his mission, or eliminate his human vulnerability. This attitude is coherent with his entire message. He constantly refuses the signs demanded out of distrust: “An evil and adulterous generation seeks a sign” (Matthew 12:39). For Yeshua, the demand for signs is not a sincere desire for truth, but a desire for control.

To test God means to demand absolute security before living, to demand miracles in order to avoid taking on life, to demand protection without responsibility. This is why he does not throw himself down. He walks. He walks into insecurity, into risk, into freedom. At the same time, this expression is, in Yeshua, a refusal of religious magic. Magic says: if I do X, God is obliged to do Y. Yeshua rejects this logic.

Prayer is not manipulation, faith is not a technique, and God is not a safety mechanism. "Your Father knows what you need before you ask him" (Matthew 6:8). To test God would be to believe that he must be persuaded or activated in order to be Father. In Paul, the expression begins to take on a different register. He recalls the episode from the wilderness and says: "We should not test Christ, as some of them did, and were destroyed" (1 Corinthians 10:9).

Here the emphasis shifts. For Paul, to test God means to grumble, to rebel, to live in disobedience to the divine order. The temptation is no longer the demand for guarantees, but the breaking of the established framework. God begins to be seen more as Lawgiver than as Father, and faith increasingly takes the form of obedience. This shift is subtle, but decisive. In Yeshua, the testing is tied to distrust; in Paul, it becomes tied to disobedience. The emphasis moves from living relationship to moral order. "These things happened to them as examples and were written down for our instruction" (1 Corinthians 10:11). Faith begins to be associated with communal discipline and with the fear of consequences. In later Christianity, the expression comes to be used in a way even further removed from its original meaning.

"Do not test God" becomes a mechanism for limiting initiative, the question, and risk. It comes to mean: do not step out of line, do not ask uncomfortable questions, do not dare too much, do not expect radical change. Paradoxically, the warning against distrust becomes a justification for passivity. Fear is repackaged as spiritual prudence, and the absence of movement is presented as obedience. This use would be foreign to Yeshua.

He says exactly the opposite: "Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and it will be opened to you" (Matthew 7:7). For Yeshua, the problem is not that a person asks too much. It is that he asks out of fear, out of a desire for guarantees. When the asking comes from trust, it is not testing but the expression of a living relationship. "Do not be anxious about tomorrow" (Matthew 6:34) does not encourage passivity but frees a person from the fear that blocks life. The difference in perspective becomes clear.

In Yeshua, to test God means to demand proofs instead of trust, and to make love conditional on demonstrable protection. In Paul, it increasingly means to break an established moral framework. In later Christianity, it comes to mean stepping out of line. Where Yeshua calls to maturity without guarantees, the later systems demand conformity without question. For Yeshua, “you shall not test God” does not mean do not dare.

It means do not make the relationship conditional on safety. It does not mean do not take risks, but do not demand certainty before living. The real testing of God is not human courage. It is the refusal to live without guarantees.

Listening vs. Obedience

The word “obedience” seems simple, but in the biblical tradition it can mean almost opposite things, depending on who uses it and from what inner center he speaks. In religious language, “obedience” often comes to be confused with submission: do what you are told, do not ask, comply. In reality, in Yeshua obedience is not blind submission.

Obedience is a form of awakening and alignment. In Paul it becomes a soteriological and communal category, tied to the order of salvation and the stability of the Church; and in institutional Christianity, the meaning can rigidify into conformity with norms, hierarchies, and dogmas. The same word, three different universes—and this is precisely why the same call can produce either freedom or fear.

In Yeshua, obedience is not preached as a virtue in itself and is never separated from truth, love, and life. He does not seek “well-behaved” people in the sense of the submissive. Yeshua seeks people who are alive, permeable to reality. This is why his language is relational and inward: “Remain in me” (John 15:4) is not a command of discipline but rather an invitation to continuity of heart, to a presence that does not break.

“Learn from me” (Matthew 11:29) does not ask for external imitation. It asks for a change of perspective: to learn a way of being. And

when he says, “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” (Mark 4:9), he moves listening from the ear to the heart: it is not about receiving information, but about letting the truth penetrate to the point where it changes your life. When Yeshua speaks of the Father's will, he does not describe it as a set of arbitrary orders but as a reality that nourishes. “My food is to do the will of the one who sent me” (John 4:34) shows that obedience, in him, is not a sacrifice against life but the very source of life. To do the Father's will does not mean to execute commands in order to avoid punishment, but to live from a truth that sustains your being, as food sustains the body. This is why, when Yeshua says, “If you love me, you will keep my commandments” (John 14:15), the order is decisive: love precedes obedience.

Obedience is not the condition of love but its fruit. You do not conform in order to be loved; you are loved, and out of that security your life begins to align. Inevitably, this understanding comes into conflict with obedience understood as blind submission to the system. Yeshua explicitly dismantles the idea that obedience is the supreme value when he says: “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27).

Here he shows that any “obedience” that tramples life underfoot ceases to be obedience. If the rule becomes more important than the person, then the rule has become an idol, and obedience has become a form of moral blindness. This is why Yeshua heals on the Sabbath, touches the “unclean,” forgives without ritual, and refuses to submit to interpretations that destroy the person in the name of God.

The spirit of this gesture would later be formulated by the apostles in a sentence that describes exactly Yeshua's line: “We must obey God rather than men” (Acts 5:29). In Yeshua's logic, true obedience can mean disobedience to the system when the system has lost its heart. When Yeshua speaks of his own obedience, his language remains that of freely assumed freedom, not of constraint.

“No one takes my life from me, but I lay it down” (John 10:18) means that his obedience is not a capture of the will but a voluntary giving. Even in Gethsemane, when he says “not what I will, but what

you will" (Mark 14:36), we do not witness the annulment of the self but its integration: the human will is not crushed but brought into unity with the truth. Here the difference is seen: in Yeshua, obedience is not submission against conscience, but unity of conscience.

This is why he ties truth to freedom: "You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free" (John 8:32). The obedience that comes from truth does not enslave; it liberates. In Paul, however, the framework changes. Paul builds communities, defends a message, stabilizes a spiritual identity in a plural and often hostile world. In this context, obedience takes on a more structural and more soteriological function.

He can say that "through the obedience of the one, the many will be made righteous" (Romans 5:19), and here the obedience of Christ becomes a representative, reparative act, with juridical weight in the economy of salvation. Obedience is no longer only inner alignment but also an element within a theological architecture: the disobedience of Adam, the obedience of Christ, the justification of the many.

In addition, Paul introduces the expression "the obedience of faith" (Romans 1:5), which ties obedience to adherence to a preached message and to communal cohesion. From here arise also the exhortations that fix obedience within the register of order: "submit to one another" (Ephesians 5:21) and "let every soul be subject to the governing authorities" (Romans 13:1). The emphasis shifts: discernment does not disappear, but, increasingly visible, the need for stability, discipline, and the protection of the community enters the scene.

Later Christianity would take up this shift and amplify it to the point of rigidification. Obedience often comes to be presented as the supreme virtue: submission to religious authority, respect for dogma, moral conformity, the acceptance of "this is how it's done." In practice, "submit to God's will" can come to mean "accept what you are told," even when it produces fear, shame, or self-annulment.

At this point, obedience decouples itself from truth and attaches itself to power: it is no longer an opening of the heart but a soothing of the system. The question becomes suspect, and discernment becomes dangerous, because it can break conformity. But it is precisely here that

Yeshua's words return like a blade that cuts through the confusion: "Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father" (Matthew 7:21).

To do the Father's will does not mean to repeat slogans and observe rituals, but to live out of love and truth—that is, out of that inner center Yeshua calls life. The difference between the three perspectives is seen clearly if we follow the effect of obedience. In Yeshua, obedience is an inner alignment with living truth, and its fruit is freedom: "If you remain in my word... you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free" (John 8:31–32).

In Paul, obedience becomes also a binding agent of salvation and of the community, tied to the message, to discipline, and to coherence. In institutional Christianity, obedience can become conformity and an instrument of control, and then it no longer produces life but fear; it no longer opens the person toward truth but closes him within a structure. Yeshua did not come to create obedient people, but whole people. Obedience, for him, is not the bowing of the head but the opening of the heart.

Wherever obedience produces life, truth, and love, it is from God. Wherever it produces fear, self-annulment, and inner silence, it is no longer obedience—it is mere submission.

"If God Loves People, Why Does He Send So Many to Hell?"

Yeshua would never begin with hell. He would begin with God—and more precisely with the face of the Father. In the Gospels, Yeshua does not preach a God who hands out punishments, but a Father who seeks, waits, and heals. "Whoever has seen me has seen the Father" (John 14:9) is the hermeneutical key to all his answers.

When Yeshua speaks of being lost, he does not describe it as an arbitrary decision of God, but as a state of wandering: the lost sheep, the prodigal son, the lost coin (Luke 15). In none of these parables does the Father send anyone away. The person leaves. The Father seeks. That is

the perspective. If he were asked directly, "Why does God send people to hell?" Yeshua would probably answer by completely shifting the frame: God does not send. A person becomes lost when he refuses life.

"The light has come into the world, but people loved the darkness rather than the light" (John 3:19). Hell, in his language, is not a prison created by God, but the inner experience of separation from truth. Yeshua uses the term Gehenna not to describe a place of eternal torture, but to warn of the consequences of a life lived out of fear, hatred, and self-enclosure.

"The Kingdom of God is within you" (Luke 17:21) implies also the reverse: separation is likewise inward. Hell is not where God sends you, but what the heart becomes when it refuses love. This is why Yeshua never says, "God will condemn you," but, "Do you want to be made well?" (John 5:6). He does not speak of punishment, but of a healing refused.

Judgment, for him, is not an external act but the truth that exposes the state of the heart: "The word that I have spoken will judge him" (John 12:48). For Yeshua, "hell" is not a purpose of God's, but the ultimate expression of a relational failure, the place where love is refused, not where it is withdrawn. The Father does not create beings in order to lose them, and his intention is not destruction, but life: "God does not desire the death of the sinner, but that he turn and live" (cf. Ezekiel 18:23, in continuity with the spirit of the Gospel). When Yeshua speaks of "weeping and gnashing of teeth," he does not describe the satisfaction of a punitive God, but the inner tension of a person who resists the truth and refuses healing. Hell is not a place to which God sends, but a state in which a person remains when he closes himself off from the light.

In Yeshua's logic, love is total but not coercive: God loves everyone, forces no one, and freedom—precisely because it is real—can refuse life without God ceasing to love. In Paul, the framework changes. Paul did not know Yeshua historically; he encountered him in a post-cross mystical experience. His language becomes more juridical, more eschatological, more oriented toward justice and justification.

Paul clearly affirms the universal love of God: “God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8). But he also introduces a framework of final judgment: “The wages of sin is death” (Romans 6:23). For Paul, the problem is not that God wants to punish, but that sin produces death—an ontological rupture.

Paul would say that God does not send people to hell out of a lack of love, but because justice and truth cannot be annulled. Grace is offered, but it can be refused. “God wants all people to be saved” (1 Timothy 2:4), yet not all respond. Paul preserves an unresolved tension between God's universal desire and the reality of human refusal.

Unlike Yeshua, Paul speaks more clearly of eschatological consequences, of “wrath” as the reaction of divine justice to the destruction of life. But even here, the emphasis is not sadistic but moral-cosmic: the universe has an order, and breaking it has real effects. Contemporary Christianity, in many of its forms, has dramatically simplified the question.

Instead of keeping alive the tension between love, freedom, and truth, it has turned hell into a pedagogical instrument of fear. The standard answer has become: “God loves, but he is just; those who do not believe end up in hell.” In this form, the emphasis falls not on healing but on belonging; not on transformation but on doctrinal correctness. Hell becomes a mechanism for controlling behavior and religious identity.

This leads to a paradoxical image: a God who loves but creates billions of people knowing that the majority will be eternally lost. This version is closer to a theology of fear than to the message of Yeshua. “There is no fear in love; perfect love casts out fear” (1 John 4:18). When hell becomes the center of the sermon, love ceases to be credible.

The difference in perspective becomes clear when we look at how the center of gravity of the relationship between God and humanity shifts. In Yeshua, God is named and experienced as Father, not as a tribunal, and “hell” appears not as a place administered from outside but as a state of inner separation, born of the refusal of truth and love; being

lost is not a sentence but the missing of life, and salvation is first of all healing, a return to wholeness and to communion.

In Paul, the image grows tense: God remains loving but is also affirmed as just, and hell takes on the contour of a real consequence of sin; salvation is grace, but a grace that can be received or refused, and judgment exists as a serious reality, held nonetheless in a fragile balance with love.

In today's Christianity, this living tension often rigidifies into a scheme: God is perceived predominantly as a judge, hell becomes the final punishment, salvation is reduced to correct belonging and conformity, and fear becomes the main engine of the spiritual life. So, as the perspective shifts from relationship to rule, from healing to verdict, what is lost is precisely the heart of the original message: the call to a life lived out of love, not out of fear.

Why Is There Suffering, If God Is Good?

Yeshua explicitly rejects the idea that suffering is a direct punishment for sin. When he is asked about the man born blind, his reaction is clear: "Neither this man sinned, nor his parents" (John 9:3). Suffering is not read as guilt, nor as moral failure. In a world where people seek causal explanations for pain, Yeshua refuses moralizing. He unties suffering from culpability and places it in a space of mystery, not of judgment.

When a public tragedy is brought up—the tower of Siloam that fell on people—Yeshua again refuses the punitive interpretation: "Do you think they were worse sinners than others? No" (Luke 13:4–5). Suffering is not proof that God chose to strike someone. For Yeshua, tragedy is not a divine message but a human context. He does not explain why it happened; he calls to awakening: not to live more correctly out of fear, but more fully out of truth.

Yeshua's central answer is this: God is not the author of suffering, but the present one within it. He says: "Blessed are those who mourn" (Matthew 5:4), not because mourning is good, but because God is there. The blessedness does not come from the pain, but from the fact

that the pain is not abandoned. God does not stand at a distance explaining; he draws near, comforting. Yeshua does not offer a theoretical answer but an embodied one. When he sees suffering, he does not preach; he weeps.

“Yeshua wept” (John 11:35). His tears do not explain Lazarus’s death, but they reveal God: a God who is not indifferent, not cold, not above pain. In that moment, Yeshua does not defend God’s goodness through arguments but shows it through compassion. For Yeshua, suffering is tied to the condition of a fragmented world, not to the will of the Father.

He speaks of “the world” as a space of fear, falsehood, and violence (John 16:33), but immediately adds: “Take courage, I have overcome the world.” The victory does not consist in the immediate elimination of suffering, but in its inability to destroy love. Evil produces pain, but it does not have the last word. Yeshua moves the center from “why” to “how”: not how to avoid suffering at any cost, but how not to lose our heart within it.

“Do not be afraid” (Matthew 10:31) is one of his most repeated calls, precisely because fear amplifies suffering more than the pain itself. Fear tears a person away from God; suffering, paradoxically, can become a place of encounter. The culmination of Yeshua’s answer is not a discourse but the cross. There, God does not explain suffering—he takes it on.

“My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?” (Matthew 27:46) is not a theological lesson but the total entry into the human experience of abandonment. In Yeshua, God does not stand above the pain but passes through it without closing himself off. This is why the cross does not justify suffering but disarms it: it shows that not even the greatest pain can annul love. In Yeshua’s logic, God is good not because he has eliminated suffering, but because he does not leave us alone in it.

Evil exists, pain exists, death exists—but they are no longer spaces without God. “I am with you always” (Matthew 28:20) is the final answer, not an explanation but a presence. So Yeshua does not answer

the question by saying why suffering exists, but by saying who God is in the midst of it.

And the answer is this: God is the Father who descends, not the judge who explains; the healer who remains, not the architect of pain; the love that does not leave, even when the world hurts.

Yeshua and War: On the Invisible Root of Violence

If we were to ask Yeshua what he thinks of those who start wars, he probably would not begin with geopolitics, nor with military strategy, nor with collective guilt. He would begin with the heart. Because in his vision, war does not begin on the battlefield but within the human being. In Matthew 15:19, he says: “For out of the heart come evil thoughts, murders, adulteries...”—and this short sentence is, in fact, an X-ray of human history.

War is merely the macro-level manifestation of an unintegrated heart. For Yeshua, the problem is not the weapon. The problem is fear. The problem is attachment to power. The problem is identity built on separation. In John 18:36, when Pilate asks him about his kingdom, Yeshua answers: “My kingdom is not of this world. If it were of this world, my servants would fight...” This is not a denial of political reality, but a delimitation of paradigm.

The kingdom that defends itself by the sword belongs to fear. The kingdom that has no need of the sword belongs to trust. War begins when a leader or a people feels that its identity is threatened. When inner security is lacking, external control is sought. When collective esteem is fragile, territorial expansion is sought. When there is historical shame or humiliation, revenge is sought. The need behind it is not violence. It is security. It is validation. It is the fear of disappearing.

Yeshua would see in those who start wars not merely aggressors, but people profoundly separated from their own source. In Luke 23:34, on the cross, he says: “Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing.” This is not a moral excuse. It is a spiritual diagnosis. Ignorance—not informational, but existential—is the fuel of violence.

In Mark 10:42–45, Yeshua says: “You know that those considered rulers of the nations lord it over them... But it shall not be so among you.

Rather, whoever wants to be great among you must be your servant.” This is the inversion of the paradigm of power. In the logic of the world, power imposes itself. In the logic of the Kingdom, power gives itself away. Those who start wars are seeking, in essence, control. But control is a strategy of fear. It is the attempt to manage the unpredictable through domination. The need behind it is profoundly human: the desire for stability, for continuity, for recognition.

But when this need is not integrated inwardly, it projects itself outward and becomes expansionism. For Yeshua, true authority does not come from constraint but from alignment with the will of the Father. “Whoever takes the sword will perish by the sword” (Matthew 26:52). This is not a karmic threat but a law of consciousness: the energy you cultivate becomes the environment in which you will live.

In Matthew 5:9, Yeshua says: “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God.” To be a peacemaker does not mean passivity. It means to restore unity. War is possible only when “the other” becomes dehumanized. When the image of God in a person is no longer seen. When difference becomes a threat. Yeshua breaks this logic when he says: “Love your enemies” (Matthew 5:44). Not because the enemy is right.

But because love disarms the mechanism of separation. To love the enemy means to refuse to confirm his identity as an enemy. He probably would not begin with condemnation but with a question—just as he does in John 8, when he brings the mirror into the consciousness of the accusers: “Let him who is without sin among you...” He would turn the gaze toward the heart.

He would perhaps tell them what he says in Mark 8:36: “What does it profit a person to gain the whole world and lose his soul?” Because a war won externally can mean inner loss. He would not deny geopolitical complexity, but he would insist that real transformation begins at the level of consciousness. Without the conversion of the heart, the cycle of

violence repeats itself. In essence, people start wars because they want to protect something: territory, identity, resources, belief.

Behind these objects there is a deeper need—the need for belonging and continuity. But Yeshua offers a belonging that does not depend on borders: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). When belonging is internal, there is no longer any need for external expansion in order to be validated. War begins in the heart that does not feel itself to be enough. In the heart that seeks security in control and worth in domination. Yeshua does not offer a military strategy. He offers an inner transmutation.

A shift from fear to trust, from competition to communion, from separation to unity. Not everyone will receive this message. But without this alchemy of the heart, history will continue to repeat the same lesson, in different forms. For Yeshua, the true victory is not over a people. It is over the fear in one's own heart.

4. Discipleship

Discipleship as a Process of Disidentification

Discipleship, in Yeshua's sense, is neither the accumulation of religious knowledge nor conformity to a set of rules. It is something far deeper and more destabilizing: disidentification. To follow Yeshua means to allow your ordinary identities — religious, moral, social — to be called into question and, little by little, left behind. Yeshua does not reinforce existing identities; he undermines them.

He tells his disciples that it does not matter who is “the greatest” (Mark 9:34–35), that titles confer no worth (Matthew 23:8–10), that religious belonging is no guarantee of nearness to God (Matthew 7:21). All these statements strike directly at the mechanisms by which people construct a solid, defensive self. Disidentification does not mean the loss of personality, but the loss of the illusion that our identity is what saves us.

Yeshua observes that people define themselves through roles: “I am righteous,” “I am faithful,” “I am chosen.” Such definitions create separation, pride, and fear. Discipleship dismantles these labels not through direct criticism, but through experience: the disciples are constantly placed in situations where their image of themselves collapses. Yeshua does not explain this process in theory; he creates it. He sends them out without provisions (Luke 10:4), exposes them to failure, lets them get things wrong.

Not in order to humiliate them, but to free them from the need to be “someone.” True discipleship begins when a person no longer has

anything to defend. In this sense, disidentification is the condition of freedom. When you no longer identify with your roles, you can love without controlling, you can speak the truth without defending yourself, you can lose without being destroyed. Yeshua says: “Remain in me” (John 15:4). To remain is not an attachment of identity, but a presence beyond identity.

Discipleship comes to an end, paradoxically, through the disappearance of the need for discipleship. Yeshua says it is to their advantage that he go away (John 16:7). A leader who set out to build identity would never say such a thing. But Yeshua does not want disciples dependent on him; he wants free people who live from the same source. Disidentification does not lead to emptiness, but to an identity that no longer needs to be asserted.

Following Yeshua Beyond Mother and Father

Yeshua speaks some of the most disquieting words in the Gospels when he declares: “Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me” (Matthew 10:37), and “If anyone comes to me and does not hate his father and his mother... he cannot be my disciple” (Luke 14:26). These statements have often been read literally, moralized, or used to justify family ruptures. But Yeshua’s language is not one of emotional abandonment, but of disidentification. He is not calling for the absence of love, but for a love freed from dependence. In the Semitic context, “to hate” does not mean to detest, but to relativize a priority. Yeshua does not ask for the severing of blood ties, but for moving beyond the stage in which your identity, your values, and your decisions are dictated by them.

“Let the dead bury their own dead” (Luke 9:60) is not an invitation to cynicism, but a line drawn between a life lived out of inertia and a life lived out of consciousness. To follow Yeshua presupposes stepping out of unconscious loyalties: inherited patterns, the fears of one’s parents, beliefs passed on without discernment. “No one who puts his

hand to the plow and looks back is fit for the Kingdom of God” (Luke 9:62).

Looking back is not memory, but dependence on the past as a source of identity. When he is told that his mother and brothers are looking for him, Yeshua replies: “Who is my mother, and who are my brothers?... Whoever does the will of my Father is my brother and sister and mother” (Matthew 12:48–50). Here a radical mutation takes place: family is no longer defined biologically, but relationally and consciously. It is not blood that creates belonging, but inner alignment.

This statement does not diminish the family; it enlarges it. It does not deny the family; it removes it from exclusivity. To follow Yeshua means to cease living your life as an extension of your parents’ history and to begin living out of the truth of the present. For the first time, Yeshua clearly separates love from unconscious submission. “Whoever does not give up all that he has cannot be my disciple” (Luke 14:33).

“All that he has” includes emotional identities as well: “the good son,” “the daughter who never disappoints,” “the child who fixes everything.” Following is not a new obedience, but a freedom that can love without losing itself. That is why, paradoxically, Yeshua reaffirms the command to honor your parents (Mark 7:10), but he does so from a higher level: not out of fear or duty, but out of maturity. True honoring appears only when you no longer need approval.

Yeshua’s call is not an escape from relationships, but full presence within them. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) — free even from the family roles that suffocate you. This freedom does not destroy bonds; it cleanses them of manipulation, guilt, and fear. When he says “Come, follow me” (Mark 1:17), Yeshua does not offer a path of substitution, but a path of alignment. To follow him means to live from the center, not from the periphery of other people’s expectations.

It means loving your parents not because “you have to,” but because you can.

What “Losing Your Life” Means for Yeshua

Yeshua’s statement, “Whoever loses his life for my sake will gain it” (Mark 8:35), is one of the most badly misunderstood in the Gospels. Read literally, it has been used to glorify suffering, pointless sacrifice, or even physical death. But in Yeshua’s language, the “life” he speaks of is not biological existence, but the identity a person constructs in order to protect himself from fear.

The word used in the Greek text is *psyche*, which points rather to “the soul,” “the self,” “the center of identity.” To lose your life does not mean to cease existing, but to let that self dissolve — the self built out of defense, comparison, status, and control. It is a matter of relinquishing the false life in order to discover the real one. Yeshua observes that most people live in a constant effort of self-preservation. They defend their image, their position, their rightness, their security.

This life is tense, anxious, fragile. Any threat destabilizes it. That is why he says that whoever tries to “save” this life will lose it. The more tightly you cling to your defensive identity, the more of a prisoner you become. To lose your life, in Yeshua’s sense, is an act of detachment. It is the relinquishing of the false center of the self so that another center may emerge, one that no longer needs protection.

“Whoever remains in me and I in him bears much fruit” (John 15:5). Fruit appears not from the effort to become someone, but from giving up the defense of what you are. This loss is not a dramatic moment, but a process. The disciples live through it gradually, through failures, misunderstandings, shames, and fears laid bare. Peter “loses his life” when his image of himself as a courageous disciple collapses through denial. Yet it is precisely there that a truer relationship appears.

The life that is gained is not more spectacular, but freer. For Yeshua, true life is not the life that defends itself, but the life that gives itself without calculation. Not in order to be martyred, but because it is no longer built on fear. “I came that the sheep may have life and have it abundantly” (John 10:10). Abundance is not quantitative, but qualitative: a life that no longer has to be saved at every moment.

Does Yeshua Want to Be Defended?

From this arises an uncomfortable question: does Yeshua want to be defended by his followers? The Gospels show that he does not. He does not ask his disciples to protect him, but to follow him: “If anyone would come after me, let him deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me” (Matthew 16:24). He does not tell them to fight for him, but to live as he lives. Before Pilate, he explains plainly why: “My kingdom is not of this world. If it were, my servants would have fought” (John 18:36).

If a fight is needed to defend the faith, then the source of that fight is not his kingdom. Truth, in Yeshua’s vision, does not need protection, but living witness. The moment his followers begin to “defend” him through force, control, pressure, guilt, or fear, they are using the very instruments he refused. They defend him by means that contradict him. Thus the phrase “Get behind me” takes on its real meaning. It is not an insult. It is a realignment of places.

Do not try to tell me which way I must go; come behind me. Peter tries to lead Yeshua onto a safer road. Yeshua sets him back in the right position: that of a disciple. The deep meaning of this episode is clear: Yeshua does not want to be defended, but reflected. He does not seek people to protect him, but people who live without fear, as he does. Because, paradoxically, the moment you begin to defend Yeshua by force, you have already moved away from him.

To follow him means to walk the same road of truth — even when it is uncomfortable, vulnerable, and stripped of human protection.

Why Yeshua Wants to Be Followed

If Yeshua refuses political power, another question immediately arises: why does he ask to be followed? At first glance, the call “Follow me” seems to create a personal dependence, a new center of authority. But a careful reading shows exactly the opposite: Yeshua asks to be followed not in order to be confirmed, but so that a person may be transformed. Yeshua never says: “Admire me,” “Venerate me,” or “Believe the correct things about me.” He says: “Follow me” (Mark 8:34).

This call is not intellectual, but existential. To follow Yeshua means to enter a process of unlearning: the unlearning of fear, of attachment to status, of the security offered by power and control. That is why the call is not comfortable and is not addressed to everyone in the same way. Following presupposes movement. It is not a static adherence to a doctrine, but a change of direction.

“Come after me” does not mean “stay where you are and think differently,” but “learn to live differently.” That is why Yeshua offers no guarantees of safety: “Foxes have dens..., but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head” (Luke 9:58). To follow him does not mean to gain protection, but to give up the illusions of control. Yeshua wants to be followed because the truth he lives cannot be handed over as information. It can be understood only through direct contact with a way of life.

That is why he calls his disciples “to be with him” (Mark 3:14). Transformation takes place through proximity, through observing a man who reacts without fear, who loves without controlling, who tells the truth without defending himself. Following is not an end in itself. Yeshua does not gather followers in order to consolidate his influence. The proof is that he constantly prepares them for his departure. “It is to your advantage that I go away” (John 16:7). A leader dependent on his followers would never say such a thing.

Yeshua does not want people bound to his person, but people who can live out of the same freedom. Following is temporary; the goal is inner autonomy. That is why Yeshua tells his disciples that they will do greater works than his (John 14:12). Such a statement would be absurd for someone seeking veneration. But it is perfectly coherent for someone who sees in being followed a process of maturation, not a permanent hierarchy.

The call to follow Yeshua is, in essence, the call to learn to live without fear in a world dominated by fear. “Whoever loses his life for my sake will gain it” (Mark 8:35). Here “life” is not biological existence, but the identity built on defense, status, and control. To

follow Yeshua means to let this identity dissolve in order to discover one that no longer needs to defend itself.

Yeshua wants to be followed not in order to be the center of the world, but to show that the world can be lived from another center. Following is not submission, but initiation. It is not obedience, but learning. It is not the loss of the self, but its liberation from fear.

“Get Behind Me, Satan” — The Disciple’s Place and the Teacher’s Road

Few moments in the Gospels are more unsettling than this one. Peter has just uttered the highest confession concerning Yeshua’s identity: “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God” (Matthew 16:16). Yeshua answers him with a rare blessing: “Blessed are you, Simon... for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven” (Matthew 16:17). In just a few moments, Peter is the bearer of a revelation that comes “from above.”

And yet, only a few verses later, the same Peter hears one of the harshest replies recorded in Scripture: “Get behind me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to me, for your thoughts are not the thoughts of God, but of men” (Matthew 16:23). This abrupt shift is not about Peter’s worth as a man, but about the mentality he expresses in that moment. The context explains the tension.

“From that time on, Jesus began to tell his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem, suffer much... be killed, and on the third day be raised” (Matthew 16:21). Peter takes him aside and rebukes him with friendly concern: “God forbid it, Lord! This shall never happen to you!” (Matthew 16:22). There is no malice here. There is love, loyalty, protectiveness — the natural reflex of someone who cannot bear the thought of loss.

Peter loves Yeshua with a human, protective love, born of the fear of suffering. It is precisely here that the thread breaks. Because, in that moment, Peter voices the same logic Yeshua had already encountered in the wilderness: “If you are the Son of God...” (Matthew 4). The tempta-

tion to avoid suffering, to use power to save yourself, to choose safety over truth.

In the language of the Gospels, this is “the logic of Satan”: the logic of fear, of self-protection, of avoiding the cross. It is not Peter who is “Satan,” but the perspective he brings: do not go down this road; protect yourself. Yeshua recognizes in these words the same vibration of fear that tries to turn him aside from the road of obedience to the very end. The irony runs deep.

Peter, who has just received the promise that he will be a “stone” in the building (Matthew 16:18), becomes in the next moment a “stumbling block.” Why? Because he tries to align Yeshua with the human logic of survival rather than with the will of the Father. “Your thoughts are not the thoughts of God, but of men” (Matthew 16:23) is not an insult, but a diagnosis: man thinks in terms of safety, God thinks in terms of truth. The same theme reappears in Gethsemane.

When the soldiers come to arrest him, “Simon Peter... drew his sword, struck the servant of the high priest, and cut off his right ear” (John 18:10). Yeshua’s reaction is immediate: “Put your sword back into its sheath. Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me?” (John 18:11). And in Matthew he adds the clear warning: “All who take the sword will perish by the sword” (Matthew 26:52).

Yeshua refuses violent defense because it is born of fear and of the illusion that truth needs protection.

“I Came That the Sheep May Have Life, and Have It Abundantly” (John 10:10)

“I came that the sheep may have life, and have it abundantly.” (John 10:10) This statement is neither a material promise nor a moralizing metaphor. It is a declaration of existential intent. Yeshua does not speak of a life prolonged, protected, or conformed, but of a life intensely lived from within, a life that flows freely, unfragmented, unafraid. The “life” of which he speaks is not survival, but full participation in the real.

In Yeshua's language, life is not something that comes after death, but something that begins here, through awakening. "The Kingdom of God is within you." (Luke 17:21) To have life abundantly means to be alive before dying, present before being saved, whole before being correct.

Why Does Yeshua Call People "Sheep"?

Yeshua calls people "sheep" not to humiliate them, but to describe a state of consciousness. The sheep is not an evil animal, but a vulnerable one — easily led, easily lost, dependent on a shepherd. The metaphor is not about inferiority, but about the lack of inner orientation when a person lives out of fear, conformity, and imitation. "We all wandered astray like sheep, each one going his own way." (Isaiah 53:6) The sheep follows the flock, not the truth.

It follows the loudest voice, not the truest one. Yeshua does not condemn people for this; he is noting a psychological and spiritual reality. That is why he says: "My sheep hear my voice; I know them, and they follow me." (John 10:27) his voice is not coercive, but recognizable. The sheep is not forced, but drawn. This is the key: Yeshua does not create dependence, but awakening. He does not want to be followed out of fear, but recognized from within.

Why Does Yeshua Heal People?

Healings occupy a central place in the Gospels, but it is precisely this centrality that has produced one of the most persistent confusions: the idea that Yeshua heals in order to demonstrate his divinity. A careful reading, however, shows something else. Yeshua does not treat healing as a theological argument, but as a natural expression of the Kingdom of God.

He never says: "I heal you in order to prove who I am"; rather, he acts as though healing were what happens naturally when fear and exclusion are suspended. Consistently, Yeshua refuses to turn healings into spectacle or proof of authority. When he is challenged to perform

signs to validate his identity, he refuses (Matthew 12:38–39). When he heals, he often asks people to tell no one (Mark 1:44).

This behavior would be paradoxical if the aim were the confirmation of his divinity. But it becomes coherent if the aim is the restoration of the human being, not the consolidation of a sacred image. For Yeshua, illness is not merely a biological problem. It is often bound up with social exclusion, shame, fear, and the loss of one's place in the community. Leprosy, blindness, paralysis remove people not only from health, but from relationship. Healing, in this sense, is an act of reintegration.

When Yeshua heals, he touches what was untouchable, draws near to those considered impure, speaks with the “invisible” ones (Mark 1:40–42). Healing is the sign that the Kingdom restores dignity, not merely the functioning of the body. It is significant that Yeshua frequently links healing to faith, but not in a dogmatic sense. “Your faith has healed you” (Mark 5:34) does not mean the acceptance of a doctrine, but openness to life, the stepping out of isolation and fear.

Healing is not a reward for faith, but the consequence of a reconnection. Yeshua creates a space in which a person can come out of the state of inner contraction that held him captive. That is why Yeshua's healings are often accompanied by forgiveness. “Your sins are forgiven,” spoken to the paralytic (Mark 2:5), precedes his rising.

This is not a demonstration of divine power, but a shift of meaning: the fundamental problem is not only the body, but a person's relationship with himself, with God, and with the community. Healing appears as the effect of this realignment. The healings are not presented as logical proof of divinity, but as signs of the Kingdom. Even John the Baptist, when he doubts, receives not a definition but a descriptive answer: “The blind see, the lame walk...” (Matthew 11:4–5).

Not “I am,” but “look at what is happening.” Yeshua's identity is not proven, but recognized through its effects. In this light, healing does not confirm Yeshua's divinity in a metaphysical sense, but shows what life looks like when God is no longer perceived as a judge, but as a presence that restores. Healing is not an argument; it is revelation lived.

Yeshua Did Not Ask to Be Followed Forever

Christianity turned “Follow me” into an eternal commandment. But in Yeshua’s context, this call is temporary. It has meaning only until a person can walk alone. To follow Yeshua endlessly means, paradoxically, not to have understood him. Because Yeshua did not come to be the center of a crowd, but to awaken minds capable of standing alone in the truth. Discipleship ends not through abandonment, but through fulfillment. Not through betrayal, but through maturity.

Not through separation, but through interiorization. In this sense, Yeshua does not ask to be followed forever. He asks to be surpassed through ownership. And it is precisely here that his message becomes most uncomfortable — and most liberating. Yeshua speaks explicitly of his departure as something beneficial. “It is to your advantage that I go away.” (John 16:7) This statement is impossible to digest within a theology of dependence. How could the departure of the teacher be an advantage?

Only if the goal is not attachment, but spiritual autonomy. His physical presence would have maintained the relationship of discipleship. His absence forces interiorization. Yeshua does not say: “Remain bound to me.” He says: “You will know.” Another key moment appears when he redefines his relationship with those who followed him. “I no longer call you servants, because a servant does not know what his master is doing; instead, I have called you friends.” (John 15:15) The relationship of discipleship presupposes asymmetry.

The relationship of friendship presupposes equality. Through this move, Yeshua implicitly declares the end of discipleship as a structure. When you know, you no longer follow. When you see, you no longer believe. When you understand, you no longer need an intermediary.

When Discipleship Ends

Discipleship, as it appears in the relationship between Yeshua and those who followed him, is not a permanent state. It is not a lifelong identity, nor a stable hierarchy, nor a sacralized dependence. Discipleship is a

4. Discipleship

phase. A process. A road that has meaning only as long as there is a real need to be taught. Yeshua never asked to be followed endlessly. He asked to be understood. “I have told you these things while I am still with you.” (John 14:25)

This formulation already contains the idea of parting. His presence is not conceived as a permanent center around which others are to gravitate forever, but as a catalyst. He appears, clarifies, shakes things up, heals — and then withdraws. Discipleship exists only as long as a person cannot yet stand alone in the truth. In the religious tradition, discipleship was turned into a supreme ideal: to follow, to imitate, to remain attached. But for Yeshua, discipleship is not the final goal. It is the transition.

“Teacher, where are you staying?” “Come and see.” (John 1:38–39) Yeshua does not say “come and stay.” He says “come and see.” Seeing is the key. Once you see, you no longer need to be led by the hand. The disciple is not called to remain a disciple, but to become a whole person. That is why Yeshua does not create dependence. He does not position himself as an indispensable intermediary. On the contrary, he constantly shifts the center away from himself and toward the interior of the person.

“The Kingdom of God is within you.” (Luke 17:21) If the kingdom is within, discipleship cannot be eternal. At a certain point, the search on the outside becomes pointless.

5. The Commandments of Yeshua

Why Yeshua Gave Commandments

At first glance it may seem paradoxical that Yeshua, the one who criticizes legalism and religious rigidity, should nevertheless give commandments. But to understand why Yeshua gives commandments, we must first clarify what the commandments are for him and what they are not. The commandments of Yeshua are not instruments of moral control, nor legal conditions for being accepted by God. They are descriptions of a life lived out of truth.

Yeshua does not begin from the idea that human beings must be coerced into being good, but from the conviction that a person, once he sees the truth, lives differently in a natural way. This is why the commandments of Yeshua are neither arbitrary nor detached from inner experience. They flow from a certain state of the heart. “If you love me, you will keep my commandments” (John 14:15) is not a condition but an observation: love produces a certain way of living.

Yeshua gives commandments because people were living out of fear, confusion, and wandering — not because God needed additional rules. The commandments are for human beings, not for God. He says so explicitly: “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27). This statement is the key to the whole of Yeshua’s ethics. The Law exists in order to serve life; when it no longer does so, it must be reinterpreted.

When he is asked which is the greatest commandment, Yeshua invents nothing new. He quotes two texts from the Old Testament: “You

shall love the Lord your God with all your heart..." (Deuteronomy 6:5) and "you shall love your neighbor as yourself" (Leviticus 19:18). Then he makes the decisive statement: "On these two commandments depend all the Law and the Prophets" (Matthew 22:40). With this statement, Yeshua completely rearranges the architecture of religion.

He does not add a new commandment alongside the others; he offers the unifying principle. All the other commandments are valid only insofar as they express love. The Law is no longer a set of disparate obligations but a coherent expression of love. Where there is no love, the literal observance of the commandments becomes emptied of meaning. It is essential to notice that Yeshua does not say, "love replaces the Law," but that love fulfills it.

"I have not come to abolish the Law but to fulfill it" (Matthew 5:17). To fulfill, for Yeshua, does not mean to observe the letter perfectly, but to bring the Law to its real purpose. This is why he can break the Sabbath, touch the "unclean," and forgive sins without ritual, without considering himself outside the will of God. The commandments of Yeshua are few, but radical.

They do not regulate minor external behaviors; they touch the inner center: "Love your enemies" (Matthew 5:44), "Do not judge" (Matthew 7:1), "Forgive seventy times seven" (Matthew 18:22), "Do not be afraid" (Luke 12:32). These are not rules that are easy to apply; they are descriptions of a transformed consciousness. Yeshua does not give them to be checked off, but to show what life looks like when a person no longer lives out of fear and separation.

When we turn to Paul, we notice a shift of emphasis. Paul states explicitly that a person is not justified by the works of the Law (Romans 3:28). In this sense, he seems to continue Yeshua's critique of legalism. But at the same time, Paul introduces other normative centers: faith in Christ, belonging to the community, obedience to certain structures and teachings. Paul does not annul the moral commandments, but he reforms them.

Instead of the commandments of Yeshua being the central doctrine, Paul places at the center: correct faith ("if you confess with your

mouth...” — Romans 10:9), identity “in Christ,” life “according to the Spirit” as opposed to “according to the flesh” (Romans 8). Although Paul says that “love is the fulfilling of the Law” (Romans 13:10), in practice Pauline Christianity will shift the emphasis from living like Yeshua to believing about Yeshua.

The commandments of Yeshua often become lofty moral ideals, but not the central criterion of salvation. In their place appear formulas of faith, communal rules, and doctrinal norms. Later Christianity will go even further, transforming the “commandments” into: dogmas to be accepted, moral rules to be obeyed, conditions of religious belonging.

Thus, what for Yeshua was a single simple commandment — the love that manifests itself in life — becomes a complex system of norms, beliefs, and obligations. Yeshua gave commandments in order to liberate, not to constrain. He gave the great commandment in order to unify everything that was fragmented. For Yeshua, love is the criterion of all the commandments.

For Paul and for later Christianity, the commandments of Yeshua are often secondary to faith, doctrine, and belonging. To understand this difference is not to reject Paul, but to see clearly that the commandments of Yeshua were not conceived as a new law, but as the expression of a life lived out of truth.

Why Yeshua Says “Do Not Be Afraid” So Often

One of the most recurrent phrases in Yeshua’s discourse is this: “do not be afraid.” It is not a slogan of consolation, nor an emotional calming technique. Yeshua does not speak about fear in a superficial sense, as a passing emotion, but as the fundamental structure of human existence. Fear, in his view, is not merely a reaction to danger but the foundation on which attachments, violence, moralism, and the thirst for power are built.

Yeshua observes that people do not live led by truth, but by the fear of loss: the fear of losing life, status, security, belonging. This is why he says “do not be afraid” precisely in those moments when the logic of

the world would say the opposite: when he speaks of the lack of material security (Matthew 6:25–34), of persecution (Matthew 10:28), of the unknown (Matthew 14:27), of death (Luke 12:4). The message is not “there is no danger,” but “the danger is not what you think it is.”

For Yeshua, fear is the principal barrier on the path to the Kingdom. It narrows consciousness, produces rigid attachments, and justifies moral compromises. People lie because they are afraid. They accumulate because they are afraid. They judge because they are afraid. They control because they are afraid. In this sense, “do not be afraid” is not a moral exhortation but a diagnosis and an invitation: if fear disappears, the structure of life reorganizes itself.

This is why Yeshua does not propose to eliminate fear through external promises, but through a change in the center of security. “Do not be afraid, little flock, for it is your Father’s good pleasure to give you the Kingdom” (Luke 12:32). Security no longer comes from what you can lose, but from what cannot be taken. The Kingdom is not a future reward but a present foundation that renders fear useless. Yeshua understands that fear cannot be conquered by willpower.

This is why he does not say “you should not be afraid,” but “do not be afraid,” as a declaration of reality: fear loses its power when a person sees something more real than the threat. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) is not an intellectual metaphor but an existential affirmation: freedom appears when fear is no longer the meaning of life. In this sense, “do not be afraid” is the gateway into the whole of Yeshua’s message.

Without this defusing of fear, love remains an ideal, forgiveness remains impossible, and following him remains theory. Yeshua does not demand heroism; he asks for a shift of trust. When fear no longer leads, the Kingdom becomes visible.

“Do Not Be Afraid” — From Religious Fear to Filial Relationship

It is not merely a formula of spiritual consolation. It is a direct intervention upon a person's inner state. Fear contracts, closes, and isolates. Love relaxes, opens, and unites. This is why, every time people enter the presence of Yeshua, the first thing he does is to regulate this state of fear in them. When the disciples are terrified on the sea, he tells them: “Take heart, it is I; do not be afraid!” (Matthew 14:27).

When the women come to the tomb, seized by dread, the message is the same: “Do not be afraid” (Matthew 28:10). And when he sends the disciples out into the world, he tells them again: “Do not fear those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul” (Matthew 10:28). Looked at closely, these words are not merely theological teaching. They are emotional regulation. Yeshua does not begin by demanding moral performance or abstract belief from people. He begins by calming their fear.

Because a person dominated by fear cannot love, cannot see clearly, and cannot enter into an authentic relationship. Fear keeps consciousness on the defensive. Love opens it. This is why, when he teaches the disciples how to relate to God, he does not tell them to fear him, but to pray like this: “Our Father who is in heaven...” (Matthew 6:9). Not “Our Judge,” not “Our fearsome Master,” but our Father.

In this single formulation, the religious paradigm of fear is already transformed into a paradigm of relationship. And yet, within the biblical tradition there is also the famous statement from Proverbs: “The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom” (Proverbs 1:7). This sentence has often been interpreted as if the relationship with God ought to be permanently based on fear. But the text itself says something else: fear is the beginning, not the destination.

In the spiritual psychology of Scripture, fear can be the first step by which a person breaks free from arrogance and self-sufficiency. A person entirely absorbed in his own ego seeks nothing beyond himself. At times, the awareness of one's limits and vulnerability can begin in

the form of a sacred fear. But if the spiritual path remains stuck there, it no longer evolves. Yeshua seems to carry this movement to the next level.

If wisdom begins with the fear of God, spiritual maturity ends with trust in his love. In the Sermon on the Mount, he says: “Do not be anxious about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink... Your heavenly Father knows that you need them” (Matthew 6:25–32). Notice the change of tone: God is no longer the figure you must fear, but the Father who already knows what you need. Fear belongs to the beginning of the road. Trust belongs to maturity.

This transformation also appears in the way Yeshua describes the relationship with God in his parables. In the parable of the prodigal son, the father is not a figure who inspires fear but one who runs to meet the returning son: “While he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion; he ran and embraced him and kissed him” (Luke 15:20). If God were first of all an authority to be feared, this scene would make no sense.

But if God is first of all a fatherly heart, then the whole parable becomes revelatory: fear belongs to the son who returns trembling; love belongs to the father who receives him. From this perspective, the phrase “do not be afraid” takes on a far deeper dimension. Yeshua is not merely preaching a moral ideal. He is trying to lift a person out of a way of living based on fear and defensiveness.

Religious fear can control behavior, but it cannot produce authentic love. Love appears only when a person’s inner system is no longer dominated by fear. This is why he says: “Do not be afraid, little flock, for it is your Father’s good pleasure to give you the Kingdom” (Luke 12:32). In this sentence, God is no longer the source of fear but its antidote. This also explains why, for many people, the message of Yeshua is difficult.

A relationship of filial love with God is far more intimate and more vulnerable than a religion based on fear. Fear creates distance and control. Love creates closeness and inner responsibility. For some, the

fear of God is more bearable than nearness to him. It is easier to submit to an authority than to enter into a living relationship.

But the direction in which Yeshua leads is clear: from fear to trust, from submission to relationship, from religion to sonship. What begins as “fear of the Lord” can be the first step of awakening. But the destination is not fear. The destination is love. As another profound biblical statement puts it: “There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear” (1 John 4:18). If fear is the beginning of wisdom, then love is its fulfillment.

And the call of Yeshua seems to be precisely this: to move from the religion of fear to the living relationship with the Father.

How Yeshua Sees “the Fear of the Lord”

The phrase “the fear of the Lord” runs through the whole Old Testament as the foundation of wisdom: “The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom” (Proverbs 9:10). For many, this formulation has become synonymous with dread, religious anxiety, or fear of punishment. But when we look at Yeshua and at the way he reveals God, we notice a profound shift of perspective. He does not abolish “the fear of the Lord,” but he transforms it radically.

For Yeshua, the relationship with God begins not with panic but with filial trust. The prayer he offers as a model begins with “Our Father” (Matthew 6:9). This formulation is revolutionary. God is not introduced as a threatening authority but as a Father who is near. In the same discourse, Yeshua says: “Your Father knows what you need before you ask him” (Matthew 6:8). Anxious fear dissolves into a relationship of security.

If the Father knows and cares, fear can no longer be the foundation of spirituality. Yeshua constantly repeats the exhortation: “Do not be afraid” (Luke 12:32). He does not merely say “do not fear people,” but “do not be afraid, little flock, for it is your Father’s good pleasure to give you the Kingdom.” Here the essential difference becomes visible.

“The fear of the Lord” cannot mean living in terror of God, because God is the one who gives with delight.

Fear is associated with insecurity; the Kingdom is associated with gift. There is, however, a seemingly tense passage: “Do not fear those who kill the body... rather fear him who can destroy the soul as well” (Matthew 10:28). At first glance, it seems that Yeshua is reaffirming religious fear. But the context shows otherwise. He relativizes the fear of human power and reorients it toward the seriousness of the spiritual life.

He does not invite panic before God but lucidity: there is a reality deeper than physical survival. “Fear” here is awareness, not anxiety. In the Sermon on the Mount, Yeshua moves the center of morality from the outside to the inside: “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God” (Matthew 5:8). Purity of heart is not the product of fear but of integrity. If the fear of the Lord were terror, the result would be hiding, not clarity.

Instead, Yeshua affirms that the truth sets free: “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). Freedom and fear cannot coexist as a foundation. Yeshua criticizes a religiosity based on dread and appearance: “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites” (Matthew 23). These people kept the rules out of fear of the Law and of judgment, but their hearts remained far away. Their fear produced rigidity, not compassion.

This is why Yeshua says: “I desire mercy, not sacrifice” (Matthew 9:13). Mercy does not grow out of fear but out of closeness. In John 15:15, Yeshua takes a decisive step: “No longer do I call you servants... but friends.” The servant lives in fear; the friend lives in trust. If “the fear of the Lord” is the beginning, friendship is maturity. Yeshua does not deny reverence, but he transforms it into a living relationship. God is no longer a distant Master but a Father and a Friend.

On the cross, in the extreme moment of vulnerability, Yeshua does not react out of fear but out of compassion: “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do” (Luke 23:34). If he had lived out of the fear of God, he would have invoked judgment. But he lives out of unity

with the Father, and this unity produces forgiveness. “I and the Father are one” (John 10:30) does not describe superiority but integration. In this integration, fear has no place. So, how does Yeshua see “the fear of the Lord”?

Not as religious terror, nor as moral anxiety, but as the beginning of awakening — the moment in which a person realizes that life is greater than his own ego. It is reverence before reality, not panic before punishment. It is the awareness of truth, not the fear of sanction. For Yeshua, the beginning may be wonder and humility before God. But the end is not fear, but love. “Take heart; I have overcome the world” (John 16:33).

Where love becomes mature, fear loses its function. “Do not be afraid” is not merely consolation; it is the invitation to a relationship in which God is no longer perceived as a threat, but as life.

What “Taking Up Your Cross” Means

For Yeshua, the phrase “taking up your cross” is not a religious metaphor, nor an ideal of suffering, and still less an invitation to resignation. In the historical context in which he speaks, the cross is the unmistakable symbol of the end of one’s social identity. The one who took up his cross was already a man dead to the world: without status, without rights, without a negotiable future. Yeshua uses this symbol to show that discipleship begins precisely where the life lived out of fear comes to an end.

“If anyone would come after me, let him deny himself and take up his cross and follow me” (Mark 8:34). “Self-denial” is not self-annihilation but the disidentification from the false self — that self built out of the need for control, validation, and belonging. To take up your cross means to live no longer in order to be accepted, but in order to be true.

This is why Yeshua immediately links the cross to the losing and gaining of life: “For whoever would save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for my sake will gain it” (Matthew 16:25). The

life that is lost is not biological life but the life of the ego — the identity maintained through compromise. The cross is the moment when a person stops trying to save his image, even if this brings conflict, loss, or solitude.

“Whoever does not bear his own cross and come after me cannot be my disciple” (Luke 14:27). The cross, for Yeshua, is the assuming of truth all the way to the end, even when truth breaks relationships, destabilizes systems, and exposes the falseness of social peace. Suffering is not sought, but the consequence of truth is accepted. In Paul, the cross remains central, but the emphasis shifts.

For him, the cross is no longer merely an inner process of disidentification; it becomes the theological center of salvation. Paul speaks of an inner crucifixion, but he links it explicitly to the act of faith: “I have been crucified with Christ, and I no longer live... but Christ lives in me” (Galatians 2:20). In Paul, the cross is the place where the “old self” dies, but this death is understood through the lens of a saving event already accomplished by Christ.

From here arises a subtle but major difference: in Yeshua, the cross is the path you walk; in Paul, the cross is the reality you believe in. “The word of the cross is folly to those who are perishing, but to us who are being saved it is the power of God” (1 Corinthians 1:18). Although Paul speaks of real transformation — “our old self was crucified” (Romans 6:6) — in the theology that develops afterward the emphasis falls more and more on faith in the cross, not on the daily living of the cross as the death of the false self.

The cross begins to be venerated, explained, and defended more than it is existentially assumed. In contemporary Christianity, the phrase “taking up your cross” often ends up completely severed from its original meaning. The cross becomes synonymous with an unavoidable suffering, with a toxic relationship accepted, with a diminished life lived out of obligation. “That is my cross” comes to mean resignation, not truth. Suffering is no longer the consequence of courage but the justification of the fear of change.

This interpretation does not come from the words of Yeshua but from a confusion between patience and self-annulment. And yet, Yeshua says clearly: “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). The cross is not meant to keep you captive in a false life but to let that life die. It is not a call to psychological martyrdom but to freedom through truth. Looked at together, the three meanings separate clearly.

In Yeshua, the cross is the death of the false self so that true life may begin. In Paul, the cross is the foundation of salvation, interiorized through faith. In contemporary Christianity, the cross is often reduced to suffering that is tolerated, without transformation. In its original form, the cross is not punishment and it is not virtue. It is the end of negotiation with the ego.

It is the point at which a person ceases to protect himself through lies and accepts the loss of everything that is false, so as not to lose what is alive. To take up your cross does not mean “suffer more,” but: stop living against your own truth.

Loving Your Enemies: What It Dissolves in Us

One of the most radical statements of Yeshua is the call to love one’s enemies. “Love your enemies” (Matthew 5:44) is not an exaggerated moral ideal, nor a demand for spiritual performance. It is a direct blow struck at the mechanism by which a person constructs his identity. The enemy is not merely a hostile person; he is the mirror of your defensive identity. He exists because there is an “us” and a “them,” a “good” and an “evil,” a “righteous” and an “unrighteous.”

Yeshua understands that human identity is often constructed through opposition. We know who we are because we know whom we are against. Morality becomes an instrument of demarcation: I am good because someone else is evil. The enemy is necessary in order for the self to feel coherent. When Yeshua says to love him, he is not asking for an artificial feeling but for the dissolution of the structure that needs an enemy. Loving your enemies is not about tolerating abuse or denying evil.

Yeshua does not say that evil becomes good. He says that evil must not define your identity. “If you love those who love you, what reward do you have?” (Matthew 5:46). This is not about recompense, but about freedom: conditional love does not set you free, it confirms you within the same circle. When love extends beyond the boundaries of identity, something breaks within: the need for superiority, the need to be right, the need to win.

This is the true function of the commandment: not to create moral saints, but to disidentify a person from his defensive self. Loving the enemy is impossible as long as the self must be defended. This is why it becomes possible only when fear is no longer the center of life.

“Follow Me”

The call “Follow me,” spoken by Yeshua, is not, first of all, an invitation to doctrinal adherence, but to a radical change of perspective on life. When he says, “Come after me, and I will make you fishers of men” (Matthew 4:19), he is not describing enrollment in a system of ideas but the beginning of an existential journey. To follow him means to enter a movement of transformation in which life acquires a different source.

This is why Yeshua speaks of remaining: “Abide in me” (John 15:4). This abiding is not loyalty to a name, but letting his life become the form of your own, until behavior flows naturally out of a new consciousness. In this process, Yeshua points to a profound disidentification: the renunciation of ego, of fear, of status, and of the attachments that define the old “I.”

He says without circumlocution: “If anyone comes after me and does not deny himself, he cannot be my disciple” (Luke 14:27). To follow him means to lose the old life in order to gain the true one: “Whoever loses his life for my sake will gain it” (Matthew 16:25). Yeshua promises not only forgiveness but freedom; he asks not only for belief but for living. His method remains simple and alive: “Come and see.”

Yeshua does not present himself as an inaccessible ideal, reserved for a divine nature impossible to replicate. On the contrary, his words presuppose that his state is, in a sense, possible for human beings as well. “Whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do; and greater works than these will he do” (John 14:12) makes no sense if Yeshua considered his own life to be unique and impossible to follow.

Likewise, the call “You therefore must be perfect, as your heavenly Father is perfect” (Matthew 5:48) is not a moral irony but an invitation to maturity of consciousness. When he affirms, “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21), he moves the center from the outside to the inside. To follow him means to discover what is already sown within you.

In this light, sin no longer appears as a legal list of prohibitions but as a state of separation, of not-seeing, of inner bondage. When he says to the woman, “Go, and sin no more” (John 8:11), Yeshua is not pronouncing an impossible ideal but affirming the possibility of coming out of this state. He explains the mechanism: “Everyone who commits sin is a slave to sin” (John 8:34), but he also shows the solution: “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32).

To live without sin, for Yeshua, does not mean moral perfection without fault, but living out of unity with the Father, where separation — the source of sin — no longer operates. In the Apostle Paul, the perspective on “following” takes on a different emphasis. Paul did not follow Yeshua during his earthly life but encountered him in a mystical experience after the cross. Hence a different lens.

“It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me” (Galatians 2:20) describes a profound identification, and “By grace you have been saved, not by works” (Ephesians 2:8) introduces dependence on gift. For Paul, to follow Yeshua means to identify with his death and resurrection and to recognize the human inability to save oneself. Paul honestly describes the inner conflict of the human being: “I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want” (Romans 7:19).

In this perspective, following is lived as a continuous struggle, sustained by grace. On the one hand, he affirms the universality of sin:

“All have sinned” (Romans 3:23). On the other hand, he proclaims the possibility of a life freed from its dominion: “Sin will have no dominion over you” (Romans 6:14) and “Those who belong to Christ have crucified the flesh” (Galatians 5:24).

For Paul, life without sin is not a stable state attained definitively, but a permanent dynamic, between fragility and grace. In the practice of today’s Christianity, the call “Follow me” has often been transformed into an invitation to belonging, to correct belief, and to the defense of a religious identity. Much is said about Yeshua, but less is lived from his way of being.

Yeshua himself speaks of this rupture: “This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me” (Matthew 15:8). And he asks directly: “Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord,’ and not do what I tell you?” (Luke 6:46). For him, following is not a title but a life that is lived. Here three different emphases appear. In Yeshua, to follow him means to become — to live out of the same consciousness, to be free of sin through truth.

In Paul, to follow him means to believe and to lean on grace in a continuous struggle. In contemporary Christianity, to follow him often comes to mean to belong. But the final question remains the one spoken by Yeshua to the sick man: “Do you want to be healed?” (John 5:6). Not “Do you want to be forgiven?” but “Do you want to be whole?”

“The Father’s Will” in Yeshua

For Yeshua, the phrase “the Father’s will” does not designate a hidden plan that a person must discover with fear and effort, nor a list of commandments demanding execution. It is a state of alignment of life with truth, with love, and with life itself. When he says that “not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of the Father” (Matthew 7:21), Yeshua is not shifting the emphasis onto religious conformity, but onto authentic living.

To “do” the Father’s will means to live out of the same source from which he himself lives. This is why, when he affirms that “whoever does the will of God is my brother and sister and mother” (Mark 3:35), Yeshua is not creating spiritual hierarchies but abolishing the boundaries between people. The Father’s will does not separate the “chosen” from “the rest”; it unites those who live out of the same heart. It is not the criterion of belonging to a group but of inner likeness.

This divine will is not a fixed doctrine but a living work. When he says, “My Father is working until now, and I too am working” (John 5:17), Yeshua shows that the Father’s will is a continuous movement of life that expresses itself through healing, forgiveness, truth, and freedom. It is not something learned as information but something that manifests itself through a person. The obedience Yeshua speaks of is not fearful submission but inner unity.

The statement “I and the Father are one” (John 10:30) shows that the Father’s will and his own are not two separate realities that must be harmonized, but the same life lived without division. This is why he can say that “my food is to do the will of him who sent me” (John 4:34): the Father’s will is nourishment, not constraint; it is what sustains life, not what limits it.

When he declares, “I seek not my own will but the will of him who sent me” (John 5:30), Yeshua is not speaking about the annulment of the self but about the dissolution of the ego. The Father’s will becomes natural when a person no longer lives out of fear, self-interest, or the need for control. It is not a loss of identity but the liberation of identity from everything that deforms it. For Yeshua, the Father’s will is inseparable from the reality of the Kingdom of God.

In the prayer “Your Kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven” (Matthew 6:10), what is requested is not the imposition of a divine law but the manifestation of a state: that what is true on the inner plane should become visible in concrete reality. The Father’s will is the coincidence between inner and outer, between truth and deed. In the Apostle Paul, the phrase “the will of God” takes on a different, more normative and more theological emphasis.

When he exhorts, “Do not be conformed to this age, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that you may discern the will of God” (Romans 12:2), the will of God becomes something that must be discerned and applied. The emphasis shifts from unity to conformity, from living to moral evaluation. The same direction appears when Paul says clearly: “This is the will of God, your sanctification” (1 Thessalonians 4:3).

Sanctification becomes the goal, and the will of God acquires a moral-disciplinary dimension. It is no longer so much a natural state of the heart as a standard a person must reach. Contemporary Christianity carries this shift even further. “The will of God” often comes to be perceived as an external authority, unpredictable and at times rigid, which says what must be done, what is permitted, and what is forbidden.

Expressions such as “It was God’s will” are used to close off questions and to justify suffering or the lack of clarity. Yeshua, however, never uses “the Father’s will” to close off life. On the contrary, he links it to fullness when he says: “I came that they may have life, and have it abundantly” (John 10:10). The Father’s will is always associated with full life, not with restriction.

The fundamental difference thus becomes clear: in Yeshua, the Father’s will is a state of unity with truth and love; in Paul, the will of God is plan, discernment, and moral order; and in today’s Christianity, it often becomes an external authority that demands submission, not awakening. This is why Yeshua never says, “Find out what God wants from you,” but shows: live out of the Father, and his will will be done through you.

When he affirms, “If you abide in me, and my words abide in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will be done for you” (John 15:7), he suggests that when a person is in this unity, his desire and the Father’s will are no longer different things. The Father’s will is not imposed. It manifests itself. It is not executed. It is lived.

“Your Sins Are Forgiven”

When Yeshua speaks the words “your sins are forgiven,” he is not performing a deferred legal act, nor invoking an invisible heavenly procedure. In his encounters with people, forgiveness is an act of immediate liberation from the state of separation, shame, and fear. When he says to the paralytic, “Take heart, my son, your sins are forgiven” (Matthew 9:2), and to the sinful woman, “Your faith has saved you; go in peace” (Luke 7:50), forgiveness does not appear as the result of a future event but as a present reality that changes the person on the spot.

Yeshua forgives because he sees the heart, not because a price has been paid. This forgiveness does not validate sin; it dissolves it. When he says to the woman caught in adultery, “Neither do I condemn you; go, and sin no more” (John 8:11), the meaning becomes clear: forgiveness is not a declaration that the deed does not matter, but a liberation that makes a new life possible. The person is not left in the state in which he was, but is drawn out of it.

For Yeshua, sin is not an accounting debt that demands punishment but a wandering of consciousness. The person is lost, not condemned. This is why his parables speak of being found again, not of payment. The father in the parable of the prodigal son does not demand compensation but says: “This my son was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found” (Luke 15:24). Forgiveness is a return to life, a turning back (*metanoia*), not a legal acquittal.

Yeshua does not change the Father’s attitude toward man; he reveals a love that is already present. Even on the cross, in the midst of violence, Yeshua says: “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do” (Luke 23:34). Forgiveness does not wait for conditions to be met and does not depend on formal repentance. It flows from the nature of love. When Yeshua affirms “your faith has saved you,” faith is not adherence to a doctrine but the opening of the heart that allows healing.

This is why he says that “unless you turn and become like children, you will never enter the Kingdom” (Matthew 18:3). Forgiveness appears at the moment when a person sees the truth about himself

without defense and without shame. In this seeing, sin loses its power. The Apostle Paul introduces a major shift of perspective. The forgiveness of sins becomes linked to the death and resurrection of Yeshua, understood as an objective substitutionary act.

He writes that “in him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins” (Ephesians 1:7) and that “Christ died for our sins” (1 Corinthians 15:3). Sin is no longer merely a wandering that calls for being found again, but an objective problem that requires an objective resolution. In this paradigm, forgiveness is no longer spoken in the living encounter between Yeshua and a person but becomes a benefit of faith in a past event.

Paul affirms that “we are justified by faith” (Romans 5:1). The emphasis shifts from healing to justification, from living to status. This shift creates a visible tension. Whereas in Yeshua forgiveness produces change on the spot, in the Pauline paradigm a person can be forgiven “in principle,” even if his life remains unchanged. This is why Paul must add moral exhortations: “Do not go on living in sin” (Romans 6:1–2).

Where Yeshua liberates and the person changes, Paul explains forgiveness and then demands change. Contemporary Christianity inherits this explanation and often simplifies it. “Your sins are forgiven” comes to mean the acceptance of a doctrine, a ritual declaration, or a legal assurance for the life to come. Forgiveness becomes something you have, not something you live.

In this context, the words of Yeshua take on a new weight: “This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me” (Matthew 15:8). Much is said about forgiveness, but less about the inner liberation it ought to produce. The consequences are visible: chronic guilt, the identity of the “forgiven sinner,” and little real transformation of life. The fundamental difference becomes clear.

In Yeshua, “your sins are forgiven” means: you are liberated now and you can live differently. In Paul, “sins are forgiven” means: you have a new status through faith in the cross. In today’s Christianity, forgiveness often becomes a theological guarantee, not a healing that is

lived. In the spirit of Yeshua, forgiveness does not manage guilt; it dissolves separation. It is not a paper signed in heaven but a door opened in the heart. This is why he says: “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32).

When Yeshua speaks the words “your sins are forgiven,” the deep meaning is: you are whole again; return to life.

6. Consciousness, Truth, and Reality

What Is Truth

To understand the deep rupture between Yeshua and dogmatic Christianity, we must look carefully at the way one and the same word — “truth” — takes on two almost opposite meanings. The language appears identical, but the experience it points to is radically different. For Yeshua, truth is a lived reality, a state into which one enters; in classical Christian theology, truth becomes a correct formulation about reality, something to be affirmed and defended. This mutation is no minor thing.

It changes entirely the relationship of the human being with God, with himself, and with others, because it shifts the center of gravity from transformation to conformity. For Yeshua, truth is not something one possesses, but something that happens. It appears when a person stops defending himself, when fear dissolves, and when reality is seen without distortion. That is why he offers no exhaustive definitions and demands no intellectual assent, but invites us to abide and to live: “If you abide in my word... you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:31–32). Truth is not separate from life, from love, or from freedom. It is not an object to be learned, but a state into which one enters. Yeshua does not say “you will learn the truth,” but “you will know,” and this knowing is experiential, liberating, transforming.

Yeshua's truth does not create borders between "those who are right" and "those who are wrong." On the contrary, it dissolves rigid identities and lifts a person out of the need for moral superiority. Truth does not validate the ego; it strips it bare. That is why Yeshua links truth to light and to the coherence of a life: "Whoever does what is true comes to the light" (John 3:21). Truth is not what you affirm, but what you live. It is not a correct proposition, but an aligned life.

In dogmatic Christian theology, however, truth is moved from the plane of experience to the plane of the correct proposition. It becomes something that must be precisely formulated, guarded, defended, and transmitted without deviation. Truth is no longer "that which sets you free," but "that which you must accept." The emphasis shifts from transformation to adherence. What matters first is no longer whether a person is inwardly free, but whether he is "in agreement" with doctrine.

Thus truth becomes a criterion of belonging and an instrument of demarcation: whoever believes correctly is "in the truth," whoever does not is "in error." For Yeshua, truth is a continuous process of unveiling. He acknowledges that people cannot bear the whole truth at once: "I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now" (John 16:12). Truth is revealed progressively, in keeping with a person's inner capacity to live it without fear.

It is dynamic, alive, bound to the maturing of consciousness. In dogma, truth is regarded as already complete: it has been formulated, fixed, and handed down. The believer's role is no longer to discover it, but to accept it. Thus truth no longer calls for inner maturity, but for outward conformity. Yeshua says of himself: "I am the way, the truth, and the life" (John 14:6), not as a definition to be defended, but as a description of a state of unity between being, word, and deed. Truth is life lived without rupture. In the dogmatic reading, this statement becomes the foundation of doctrinal exclusivity: truth is located within an identity that must be correctly recognized. Thus what in Yeshua is an invitation to transformation becomes, over time, a criterion of separation. The rupture between these two understandings of truth

explains many of the historical tensions of Christianity. When truth is lived, it frees, unites, and heals.

When truth is possessed, it demarcates, separates, and demands defense. Yeshua brings a truth that releases a person from fear. Dogma often ends up defending a truth that keeps a person in fear of being wrong. And between these two ways of understanding the same word lies the difference between a transformed life and a correctly formulated belief.

“The Truth Will Set You Free” — The Meaning of a Radical Statement

When Yeshua says “The truth will set you free,” he is making neither an intellectual promise nor a religious one in the classical sense. He is not speaking about accumulating correct information, nor about adhering to a true doctrine. Yeshua speaks of an existential liberation, of a change in the state of the human being. For him, truth does not inform; truth releases. Those who hear him react at once, insisting that they have never been slaves. Their response betrays the fundamental misunderstanding: they are speaking of political, social, or identity-based freedom. Yeshua is speaking of an inner bondage. For him, a person can be outwardly free and yet deeply captive within; he can be religious and yet unfree; he can keep the law and live in fear. The bondage Yeshua speaks of is not imposed from outside, but maintained from within.

It manifests through fear, attachments, identification with the ego, the need for control and certainty, the clinging to an image of oneself. A person becomes a prisoner not because he is constrained, but because he is perpetually defending himself against the truth. Truth threatens these defenses, and for that reason it is rejected. In this context, truth is not a correct idea about the world, but reality seen without distortion. Truth sets us free because it dissolves the lie about who you think you are.

It breaks the identification with roles, with the moral mask, with the self-image built out of fear. It adds nothing new to a person; on the contrary, it removes what is not real. This unveiling is not comfortable.

Truth hurts before it sets free, because it exposes the ego's mechanisms of defense. That is why Yeshua provokes such powerful reactions: he disturbs the self-assured, irritates those attached to their position, and scandalizes religious structures.

Truth does not confirm identities; it disintegrates them. And without this disintegration, freedom is not possible. The liberation Yeshua speaks of is, in essence, liberation from fear. The fear of punishment, of loss, of rejection, of death. Truth offers not security, but presence. In the absence of fear, a person no longer needs to defend himself, to dominate, or to justify himself. This is real freedom: not the power to control, but the absence of the need for control.

Yeshua does not say that truth is something you “know” in a moment of intellectual revelation. He speaks of “abiding” in truth. Truth is not a conclusion, but a dwelling: remaining in honesty, in openness, in the willingness to see reality without the filter of fear. Liberation does not occur instantaneously, but in the measure that a person ceases to flee from truth. In Yeshua's vision, truth cannot be separated from love.

A truth spoken without love becomes abuse, and a love without truth becomes illusion. That is why Yeshua's truth is neither a weapon nor an instrument of moral correction. It is a presence that heals precisely because it is spoken within relationship. Thus, when Yeshua says “The truth will set you free,” he is saying that truth will free you from the fear within you, from the false identity, from the need for control, and from the illusion of separation. It will not make you more correct or more religious, but more free.

And for Yeshua, freedom does not mean doing whatever one wishes, but no longer being hindered by anything from being alive. This is the statement that lies at the root of the conflict between Yeshua and the world: truth does not maintain the order of fear, but dissolves it. That is why it is so desired in words and so avoided in life.

Silence as a Form of Truth

At the key moments of his trial, Yeshua is silent. Before religious accusations and political power, he refuses to defend himself (Mark 14:61; Luke 23:9). This silence is often interpreted as humility, but it is more than that. It is the refusal to enter into an explanatory game that would legitimize the violence. Any explanation would have been a negotiation. It would have shifted the discussion onto the terrain of power and would have validated the framework that produces death. Silence, by contrast, unmask the system.

It shows the nakedness of violence without justifying it through argument. After Yeshua's death, the communities are left with a profound trauma. A man who spoke of love, freedom, and life is executed as a criminal. In order to carry on, they need meaning, order, and coherence. It is in this space that the theology of the cross appears, above all in the writings of Paul. Death becomes sacrifice, payment becomes salvation, blood becomes language. It is important, however, to notice the essential difference. This is an interpretation of Yeshua's death, not an explanation offered by Yeshua himself. It is an effort to integrate the trauma, not a revelation about the needs of God. If his death had been explained as necessary to God, violence would have become sacred. But Yeshua constantly refuses violence. He stops Peter when he draws his sword (Matthew 26:52), refuses political power (John 18:36), and forgives even from the cross (Luke 23:34).

Nothing in his conduct validates the idea that violence could be a divine instrument. His death is presented neither as an ideal nor as a goal. It is presented as the tragic result of the encounter between truth and fear.

Truth in Yeshua. Why Liberation Precedes Interpretation

For Yeshua, truth is not a correct formula, nor an exact interpretation of the Scriptures, nor even a perfect understanding of his own words. Truth is not something a person possesses through intelligence or doctrine, but

something a person enters through openness. “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). The order is essential.

For Yeshua, truth is not information that produces freedom, but a living reality that is recognized when a person ceases to defend himself. Yeshua never says that the correct interpretation of the Scriptures saves. On the contrary, he frequently comes into conflict with those who know them best. “You search the Scriptures because you think that in them you have eternal life; yet it is they that bear witness about me. But you refuse to come to me that you may have life” (John 5:39–40).

Here the fundamental rupture is visible. Scripture can be correctly interpreted and yet life can be absent. For Yeshua, truth is not in the text, but in the encounter that the text should make possible. Truth, for Yeshua, is not something that convinces through logical force, but something that is revealed when a person is inwardly free enough to receive it. “If you abide in my word, you are truly my disciples” (John 8:31).

To abide does not mean to explain, but to dwell. It does not mean to analyze, but to live. That is why truth cannot be imposed. Any imposed truth ceases to be truth and becomes coercion. For Yeshua, liberation is not the result of a correct understanding, but the condition that makes understanding possible. “If the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed” (John 8:36). Freedom does not come at the end of an intellectual process; it appears when fear disappears.

Only the free person can see clearly. Only the person who is no longer on the defensive can understand without distorting. Interpretation comes after, not before. That is why Yeshua speaks differently with each person. He does not repeat formulas and offers no universal definitions. To one he says “follow me,” to another “return home,” to another “go and sin no more.” Truth is not standardized, because people are not standardized. “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6). Truth is not something he says, but what he is when the relationship is alive. In this sense, truth in Yeshua is not opposed to intellectual error, but to fear. “The light has come into the world, and people loved the darkness rather than the light because their deeds were evil” (John 3:19).

Darkness is not the absence of information, but the closing of the heart. When truth threatens identity, status, or inner security, a person will reject it even if he recognizes it as truth.

That is why truth cannot be separated from freedom. Yeshua does not ask people to believe correctly before they are healed. He heals them, and faith often appears afterward. “Your faith has saved you; go in peace” (Luke 7:50). Peace precedes doctrine. Life precedes theology. The experience of healing precedes the explanation. Truth is recognized by the body before it is formulated by the mind. That is why, for Yeshua, truth is not something to be defended, but something to be lived.

It is not something to be demonstrated, but something to be allowed to be. “The kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed... for behold, the kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21). Truth is not a conclusion, but a state of openness. In the end, for Yeshua, it is not the correct interpretation that frees a person, but the liberation that makes him capable of interpreting without distorting.

Truth is not a weapon in the hand of the one who knows, but the breath of the one who no longer defends himself. That is why truth is not imposed. It is recognized. And only the free person can recognize it without turning it into dogma. For Yeshua, truth is not a correct proposition, but a living presence between people. He does not teach truth as information, but reveals it in encounter, in dialogue, in compassion, in the way he looks at the person before him.

When he says “I am the Way, the Truth, and the Life” (John 14:6), he offers no theological definition, but shifts the center of truth from the sphere of ideas into the sphere of relationship. Truth is not something you can separate from the person, from the context, from the inner state of the one who receives it. It is spoken to someone, in a living moment, within a concrete relationship.

That is why Yeshua never answers questions mechanically, but differently, according to the person before him: with the Samaritan woman he speaks of living water (John 4), with Nicodemus of being born again (John 3), with the Pharisees of their spiritual blindness

(Matthew 23). Truth is always personalized, not standardized. In dogmatic theology, however, truth is extracted from this relational dimension and made abstract.

It becomes a formula applied uniformly, regardless of person, context, or level of consciousness. The relationship becomes secondary, and doctrinal correctness becomes paramount. Truth is no longer something born between two people, but something pronounced from the top down, as a universal rule. What in Yeshua is a living encounter becomes, in dogma, a fixed proposition.

Truth That Dissolves the Ego vs. Truth That Reinforces It

Yeshua's truth has a profound function: it dissolves the spiritual ego. No one "has" the truth. No one is immune to self-deception. No one can claim to see perfectly. That is why he is so critical of those convinced that they "see." "If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now that you say, 'We see,' your sin remains" (John 9:41). The greatest problem is not ignorance, but rigid certainty. Not the lack of truth, but its possession.

In the Sermon on the Mount, Yeshua shifts attention from the outer law to the inner state: "You have heard that it was said... but I say to you" (Matthew 5). He does not merely correct behaviors; he dismantles the illusion that a person can be righteous through outward conformity alone. His truth does not validate religious identity, but calls it into question. That is why the Pharisees are the target of his harshest words: "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!" (Matthew 23). Not because they did not know Scripture, but because they were convinced that they had mastered it. In its dogmatic form, truth often becomes fuel for the ego: "we have the truth," "we believe correctly," "the others are lost." Truth no longer frees from the ego, but legitimizes it. It no longer produces humility, but superiority. It no longer produces compassion, but judgment. Where Yeshua's truth makes a person aware of his own blindness, dogmatic truth makes him certain of his own clarity.

When Yeshua says “you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32), the verb is not “to possess,” but “to know.” Knowing is experience, not accumulation. It is something that transforms you from within, not something you add to your identity. Truth is not an object of the mind, but a state of being. That is why, in his encounters, Yeshua does not seek to convince people that they have erred doctrinally, but to bring them into a state of inner authenticity.

With the woman caught in adultery he does not discuss the law, but says: “Neither do I condemn you; go, and from now on sin no more” (John 8:11). Truth is not used to condemn, but to free from shame. With Peter, after the denial, he does not discuss the betrayal, but asks three times: “Do you love me?” (John 21:15–17). Truth is not about guilt, but about restoration. Yeshua’s truth transforms. It does not classify people into the correct and the mistaken, but calls them into a deeper state of life.

It opens, it does not close. It heals, it does not control. The moment truth is taken out of life and put into formulas, it begins to lose its liberating power. When it becomes a system, it becomes a border. When it becomes dogma, it ceases to be a road. Yeshua says: “I am the Way” (John 14:6). A way is a journey, not a set of propositions. It is something you live, not something you memorize. But when truth is systematized, it is no longer a journey, but a condition of belonging.

It is no longer experience, but a criterion of exclusion. The rupture between Yeshua and institutional Christianity does not begin at the moral or metaphysical level, but precisely here: at the moment when truth was moved from relationship into doctrine, from life into formula, from encounter into system. From here onward, the question is no longer “what is the truth?” but: does the truth you carry make you more free or more closed? Does it make you more humble or more sure of yourself? More compassionate or more judgmental? More alive or more rigid? This is the question Yeshua leaves open. He does not close the discussion through definitions, but opens it through encounters. Dogma, by contrast, tends to close what Yeshua left alive. Yeshua’s truth is

lived, not possessed. It frees, it does not constrain. It transforms, it does not classify. It opens, it does not close. It heals, it does not control.

How Did Yeshua Preach the Truth?

The way Yeshua preached the truth is radically different from the way truth is later spoken by Paul and, even more so, by contemporary Christianity. The difference lies, first of all, not in the declarative content, but in the inner position from which the truth is spoken. And this position changes everything. For Yeshua, truth is neither information to be accepted, nor a doctrine to be understood, nor a rule to be followed.

Truth is a light that makes visible what was already there. That is why he does not say, “Believe this about God,” but rather invites: “Look.” “If your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light” (Matthew 6:22). The call is not to intellectual assent, but to inner sight. And this sight cannot be imposed. Yeshua does not try to convince, does not try to win arguments, does not construct theological systems. He exposes reality as it is, and a person either recognizes it or leaves. “Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice” (John 18:37). Truth, in Yeshua, is not persuasive, but revelatory. It does not press, does not force, does not argue — it only illuminates. This light has a clear effect: it sets free. “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32).

The essential observation is that the truth spoken by Yeshua does not burden a person with guilt, does not diminish him, does not define him through sin, and does not make him dependent. The Pharisees speak the truth of the Law, and people leave feeling guilty. Yeshua speaks the truth of the heart, and people leave feeling seen. The woman caught in adultery leaves without guilt. Zacchaeus leaves without shame. Peter leaves without condemnation. Because the truth spoken from light does not crush, whereas the truth spoken from Law crushes.

At the same time, Yeshua does not adjust the truth in order for it to be accepted. He does not negotiate it to preserve relationships, and he

does not cosmeticize it to avoid reactions. “Woe to you, Pharisees...” (Matthew 23). “Get behind me, Satan!” (Matthew 16:23). “Leave the dead to bury their own dead” (Matthew 8:22). These words are not diplomatic, but neither are they spoken out of aggression. They come from a total inner freedom. Yeshua does not speak the truth to preserve the relationship; he speaks it to preserve reality.

With Paul, a subtle but major shift occurs. Truth begins to be formulated as doctrine. Notions appear such as justification, sin, grace, salvation, correct belief, heresy, sound teaching. Truth is no longer merely a light that reveals, but becomes a structure that must be explained. That is why Paul argues much, explains much, corrects much. Yeshua never explains salvation; he shows it. Paul explains it in his epistles. The difference is also visible in the effect. In Yeshua’s presence, the disciples say: “Did not our hearts burn within us?” (Luke 24:32). In the Pauline space, the question becomes: “What is the correct teaching?” The emphasis shifts from living to understanding, from sight to correct belief. This is not necessarily a contradiction, but a change of emphasis that, over time, alters the way truth is perceived and transmitted.

In contemporary Christianity, this shift becomes more pronounced. Truth comes to be preached as morality and religious identity: what you are allowed and not allowed to do, who is saved and who is not, what you must believe, what you must confess, what sins you have. Truth becomes an instrument of moral control. For Yeshua, truth dissolves sin; in modern preaching, truth highlights sin. With Yeshua, a person leaves lightened; in modern preaching, a person leaves weighed down.

Yeshua’s invitation, however, remains simple: “Come and see” (John 1:39). Not: “Come and believe.” The difference is colossal. Belief can be imposed, learned, repeated. Sight cannot be imposed. It happens. This difference is rooted in the inner state from which Yeshua speaks the truth. “The ruler of this world has no claim on me” (John 14:30). His truth does not wound, because it is not spoken in order to be right, to correct someone, to prove something, or to win an argument. It is spoken from a place where nothing personal is at stake. For Paul, truth

defends doctrine. In Christianity, truth defends the faith. For Yeshua, truth defends nothing. It only illuminates. That is why, before him, the Pharisees feel exposed, sinners feel seen, simple people feel awakened — and no one feels condemned.

When Yeshua says “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32), he is not speaking of accumulating correct information, but of an inner state that is being restored. The context is essential: “If you abide in my word... you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:31–32). “To abide” is not intellectual agreement, but existential alignment. The freedom he speaks of is not political freedom, but the inner liberation from what fragments us.

In the same dialogue, Yeshua defines bondage thus: “Everyone who commits sin is a slave to sin” (John 8:34). If sin, for him, is more a state of separation and blindness than a mere list of deeds, then bondage is the inner conflict that makes you live divided: you know the good, but you react out of fear; you desire love, but you act out of defensiveness; you want truth, but you protect yourself through subtle lies. Truth, in Yeshua’s sense, is the light that exposes this division without destroying you. Inner unity arises when you no longer have to defend yourself against yourself. That is why he also says: “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God” (Matthew 5:8). A “pure heart” is not moral perfection, but a heart that is not fragmented, not divided between image and reality.

Truth purifies precisely by bringing you into a single line: what you think, what you feel, and what you do begin to be coherent. Freedom is the result of this coherence. When Yeshua affirms “I and the Father are one” (John 10:30), he describes the supreme model of unity. In him there is no conflict between desire and will, between outer and inner. That is why he can also say, “the ruler of this world is coming. He has no claim on me” (John 14:30). Where there are no inner fissures, evil finds no leverage. Truth is not a weapon, but integration.

Inner conflict feeds on functional lies: “it doesn’t matter,” “it doesn’t affect me,” “I’m not afraid,” “I’m fine.” When truth is allowed to penetrate, it dismantles these defenses. That is why freedom can be

uncomfortable at first. But once fear is seen, it no longer rules; once shame is illuminated, it no longer controls; once desire is acknowledged, it no longer becomes compulsion. The link is direct: truth → exposes the conflict → integrates the broken parts → restores unity → produces freedom. It is not a juridical process, but a healing one. That is why Yeshua does not say “the truth will declare you forgiven,” but “will set you free.” Freedom is the effect of restored unity.

So the truth that frees is the elimination of inner conflict, not through force, but through illumination. Not through control, but through awareness. Not through rigid discipline, but through integration. Freedom is not the absence of outer tension. It is the absence of inner rupture.

How the World Becomes Blind and Man Loses Sight — Was Man Created This Way or Did He Go Blind Along the Way?

For Yeshua, blindness is not a natural condition of the human being, nor a spiritual defect with which someone is born. It is a process, a gradual loss of inner sight, which arises when a person begins to live out of fear, attachment, and identification with forms. That is why he asks directly: “Having eyes, do you not see?” (Mark 8:18). The question shows clearly that people have the capacity to see, but have lost it. Sight was forgotten, not refused at creation.

Man is not born blind at the level of consciousness; he learns, over time, no longer to see. This becomes even clearer when the disciples ask him about the man born blind: “Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?” (John 9:2). The question reflects the religious mentality of guilt and punishment. Yeshua breaks this logic by answering: “It was not that this man sinned, or his parents, but that the works of God might be displayed in him” (John 9:3). Blindness is not condemnation, but a context in which sight can be restored. Man is not defined by his blindness, but by the possibility of seeing again.

At the individual level, a person begins to go blind when he replaces direct sight with received interpretation. When he lives from what he has been told about reality, rather than from a living encounter with it. Yeshua describes this state when he says of the religious leaders: “They are blind guides; and if the blind lead the blind, both will fall into a pit” (Matthew 15:14). Blindness is not biological, but cultural and religious. A person can be raised in a system that tells him what to see, what to believe, and what to feel, until he loses the capacity to see for himself. Blindness also arises when a person defends his identity more than the truth.

When being right becomes more important than seeing. That is why Yeshua says: “The light has come into the world, and people loved the darkness rather than the light because their deeds were evil” (John 3:19). Blindness is not passive; it is chosen when sight would demand change. The light is rejected not because it is not visible, but because it is uncomfortable. At the inner level, a person loses his sight when he identifies with fear. Fear narrows the field of consciousness until reality is perceived only as a threat. “Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” (Matthew 6:21) shows how attachments determine sight. If the “treasure” is security, control, or image, sight contracts. A person no longer sees what is, but only what defends or threatens him.

This state is described even more deeply in the words: “If the light in you is darkness, how great is that darkness!” (Matthew 6:23). It is not a matter of mere ignorance, but of the confusion between light and darkness. A person comes to believe that he sees precisely when he is completely blinded by his own convictions. This is the most profound form of blindness: false certainty. At the collective level, the world becomes blind when these individual mechanisms become general. When fear becomes political, religious, or cultural. When systems reward conformity, not sight. Yeshua observes this reality, saying: “This people’s heart has grown dull, and with their ears they can barely hear, and they have closed their eyes” (Matthew 13:15). Blindness is not imposed from outside, but accepted from within in order to avoid the discomfort of truth.

Yet Yeshua does not leave blindness as the final verdict. He describes his mission thus: “I came into this world for judgment, that those who do not see may see, and those who see may become blind” (John 9:39). This “judgment” is not punishment, but unmasking. Those who know they do not see are open. Those who believe they see close themselves off. The good news in Yeshua’s message is that sight can be recovered. Not through the accumulation of information, but through sincerity toward reality. Not through moral effort, but through the willingness to stop fleeing from truth. When he says he came “that those who do not see may see” (John 9:39), Yeshua shows that man is not condemned to blindness. He was born open, and blindness is only the result of not using this capacity. For Yeshua, to see is not a privilege of the chosen, but the natural state of the human being when he no longer lives out of fear.

Finding God or Learning to See

In contemporary religious language, people often speak of those who “found God.” The expression suggests a search that ends with the discovery of a lost object: a person searches, wanders, and at last finds. But if we read the Gospels carefully, we notice something surprising: Yeshua does not use this formulation. He does not speak of people who find God, but of people who see, enter, are born again, and become. The emphasis falls not on the discovery of God as the object of the search, but on the transformation of the one who searches. The problem is not that God is lost, but that man does not see. That is why Yeshua says: “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God” (Matthew 5:8). We notice that he does not say, “Blessed are those who find God,” but “those who see him.” Here the entire spiritual perspective changes.

God is not a place you reach, nor a doctrine you discover. He becomes visible when a person’s inner eye is purified. When the heart is no longer dominated by fear, by the desire to control, by the need to be right, then perception changes and a person begins to see reality

differently. This sight is not only a theological perception. It changes the way a person looks at the world and at other people.

The one who sees no longer lives in the perpetual logic of ranking. He no longer obsessively searches for who is right and who is wrong. He no longer classifies people into good and bad, worthy and unworthy, orthodox and heretical. Because the moment a person begins to see, he observes that reality is far deeper than these labels. That is why Yeshua says: “Judge not, that you be not judged” (Matthew 7:1). This is not merely moral advice, but a description of the way one sees whose heart has been purified. Rigid judgment disappears because perception deepens. In the same direction, Yeshua does not speak of finding the kingdom of God, but of entering into it. “Truly, I say to you, unless you turn and become like children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven” (Matthew 18:3). The image of the child is essential here. The child does not constantly rank people, does not obsessively defend his position, and does not live from the need to prove that he is right. He is open, alive, and available. To enter the kingdom means to return to this state of inner transparency, in which life is no longer filtered through pride and comparison.

In the dialogue with Nicodemus, Yeshua uses another radical image: being born again. “Truly, truly, I say to you, unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God” (John 3:3). Once again, the central verb is “to see.” Nicodemus comes with theological questions, but Yeshua moves the conversation into an existential dimension. The problem is not that Nicodemus has not found the correct answer, but that his way of perceiving reality must be born again. The old man searches for certainties and classifications; the new man sees life in its unity.

This transformation produces a profound change in the way a person lives. The one who sees is no longer preoccupied with always establishing who is right. He no longer perpetually searches for the other’s mistake. He no longer turns truth into a weapon for winning religious disputes. Because he sees that truth is not a position you defend, but a life you live. That is why Yeshua says: “You will know the truth, and the

truth will set you free” (John 8:32). The freedom he speaks of is not the freedom to prove that you are right, but the freedom of no longer being a prisoner of the need to be right.

In many places in the Gospels, Yeshua describes this reality through simple images: a light that is lit, a seed that grows, a vine in which the branches abide. “I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will not walk in darkness, but will have the light of life” (John 8:12). Light does not merely make things visible; it changes the way they are perceived. In the light of truth, a person begins to see people beyond their labels and situations beyond hasty judgments. Thus the Gospels do not describe spirituality as an intellectual discovery in which a person says triumphantly, “I have found God.” They describe a transformation of perception in which a person begins to see reality differently.

God is not an object of the search, but a presence that becomes visible when the heart is purified and the inner eye opens. The one who sees no longer lives in the rigid logic of personal righteousness, of ranking, and of perpetual judgment. He becomes free to love, to understand, and to live the truth without turning it into a weapon against others. In this light, Yeshua’s words take on a new clarity. God is not found like a lost object. He is seen when a person becomes capable of seeing. And this sight produces not spiritual superiority, but a gentler heart, a quieter mind, and a life that is no longer built on the competition over who is right and who is wrong. To see God means to live in a light in which truth no longer separates, but unites.

Who Finds Whom? The Surprising Language of the Gospels

Even more surprising is the fact that in many of the parables the direction is reversed. It is not man who finds God, but God who finds man. In the parable of the lost sheep, Yeshua says: “Does he not leave the ninety-nine in the wilderness, and go after the one that is lost, until he finds it?” (Luke 15:4). The shepherd is the image of God, and the

lost sheep is man. The message is clear: the initiative belongs to God. He is the one who searches.

The same idea appears in the parable of the lost coin: “Does she not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it?” (Luke 15:8). Once again, God is the one who searches. In these parables, man is not the hero of the spiritual search. He is the lost one who is found. That is why Yeshua states directly: “The Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost” (Luke 19:10). This reversal profoundly changes the way we understand spirituality.

If man must find God, then everything depends on his intelligence, his effort, or his spiritual technique. But if God seeks man, then the story is different. It is no longer about religious performance, but about the opening of the heart. In this context it becomes clear why Yeshua so often uses the verb to see. “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God” (Matthew 5:8). He does not say that they will find him. He says that they will see him. The problem is not that God is hidden, but that man’s inner eye is covered. That is why the transformation of the heart becomes the key to perception.

Likewise, in the dialogue with Nicodemus, Yeshua says: “Unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God” (John 3:3). Once again, the emphasis falls not on intellectual discovery, but on transformation. To be born again means to look at the world with new eyes. It does not mean that you have discovered a religious secret, but that your perception has changed. That is why the language of the Gospels is full of dynamic images: a door through which you enter, a light that is lit, a seed that grows. Yeshua says: “I am the door. If anyone enters by me, he will be saved and will go in and out and find pasture” (John 10:9). We notice once again the same movement: entering, going out, life.

God is not an object of the search, but the reality in which life unfolds when a person begins to see. This perspective explains why the expression “I found God” appears more often in later spirituality than in the words of Yeshua. It is a natural way of describing religious experience, but it is not the preferred language of the Gospels. For

Yeshua, the problem is not that God must be discovered, but that man must become capable of perceiving what is already present.

Thus the message of the Gospels takes on a surprising clarity. God is not lost somewhere in the universe. He need not be found like a hidden object. Instead, man must learn to see, to enter, to be born again. And, paradoxically, in this transformation he discovers that it was not he who found God, but God who found him.

7. Faith, Salvation, and Repentance

Faith in Yeshua

Yeshua uses the word “faith” frequently, but its meaning is existential, not doctrinal. For him, faith is living trust, openness, and a readiness to be transformed. When he says, “Your faith has saved you” (Luke 7:50), he is describing a condition of the heart that allows for healing and wholeness. Likewise, “if you had faith as small as a mustard seed...” (Matthew 17:20) does not point to the acceptance of a creed, but to a living relationship with the reality of God. This faith is not oriented toward his death, but toward the present Kingdom. It is not a mental assent, but a state that opens a person to life. Paul, by contrast, shifts faith toward the event of the cross and the resurrection: “If you confess with your mouth that Yeshua is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved” (Romans 10:9).

Confronted with this formulation, Yeshua might respond, in his paradoxical style, that a faith which does not change one’s way of living is not faith but religious opinion. This is why he warns: “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the Kingdom, but the one who does the will of my Father” (Matthew 7:21).

What Was the Role of Faith for Yeshua

The word “faith” is probably the most used and the most misunderstood term in Christianity. Everyone talks about faith, but rarely does anyone ask what it meant for Yeshua, and whether that meaning is identical to

the one it later acquires in apostolic theology. A careful reading shows that, although they use the same word, Yeshua and the Apostle Paul operate with different emphases that profoundly change the religious experience.

For Yeshua, faith is never framed as the acceptance of a set of correct ideas about God. He does not ask people to believe things about him, but to trust the reality they live together with him. The term the Gospel uses indicates trust, openness, availability, rather than intellectual conviction. This is why Yeshua frequently says, “Your faith has healed you” (Mark 5:34), not “your faith in me has saved you” in a doctrinal sense.

Faith is the act by which a person ceases to defend himself against life, ceases to contract in fear, and allows the reality of God to be active within him. It is not a spiritual performance, but a relaxing of control. It is essential that Yeshua praises faith precisely where there is no religious correctness: in a Roman centurion (Matthew 8:10), in a woman considered impure (Mark 5:28–34), in a Samaritan (Luke 17:19).

This shows clearly that, for Yeshua, faith is not religious belonging, nor conformity to the Law. It is the capacity to trust a reality deeper than your fear. Moreover, Yeshua links faith to sight: “Let it be done to you according to your faith” (Matthew 9:29). Faith is not the opposite of sight, but its condition. A person sees the Kingdom to the extent that he is no longer blinded by the need for security.

For this reason, unbelief is not morally condemned; it is treated as a form of fear or inner rigidity. For Yeshua, faith is not the goal of the spiritual life, but the gate. Once the gate is passed, the living of the Kingdom begins. This is why he does not build a “doctrine of faith,” but constantly invites people to follow a way of life. Faith is dynamic, relational, lived, not formulated.

Faith vs. Trust

One of the greatest distortions of later Christianity is the confusion of faith with the intellectual acceptance of statements about God. For Yeshua, faith is never a correct opinion about reality, but an existential positioning toward reality. It is not something you “have” in your mind, but something that happens within you when you stop defending yourself against life. Yeshua does not ask people to believe ideas about him.

He does not say, “Believe that I am the Messiah,” or “Believe the correct doctrine.” He says, “Do not be afraid” (Matthew 14:27), “Come” (Matthew 14:29), “Follow me” (Mark 1:17). All of these call for trust, not conviction. Faith, for Yeshua, is the opposite of fear, not the opposite of reason. When faith is confused with correct opinion, it moves from the heart into identity. It becomes something that defines you and separates you from others. But for Yeshua, faith does not separate. It opens.

This is why he recognizes it where religion is absent and criticizes it where religion is sure of itself.

“If You Had Faith as Small as a Mustard Seed”

Yeshua’s statement about faith “as small as a mustard seed” (Matthew 17:20; Luke 17:6) is often read as a hyperbole about power: if you have enough faith, you can move mountains. But Yeshua is not speaking here about the quantity of faith, but about its nature. The mustard seed is not powerful. It is small, fragile, almost insignificant. Its power lies not in its size, but in the fact that it is alive.

The faith Yeshua speaks of is not intense, not heroic, not spectacular. It is real. It is that minimal openness in which a person no longer completely resists the reality of God. The mountains that are moved are not geographical, but inner. They are the rigid structures of fear, of defensive identity, of the internalized impossible. Yeshua does not say that you need much faith, but that you need true faith, even if it is small. A great but false faith—that is, an ideological one—moves nothing.

This statement directly undermines spiritual performance. Yeshua does not ask you to become more believing, but to become more sincere. A grain of real faith is more transformative than a massive religious certainty.

Why Yeshua Never Asks You to “Believe in Him”

A surprising fact, yet verifiable in the Gospels, is this: Yeshua does not ask people to “believe in him” in the doctrinal sense that would later become central. He says, “Believe in the gospel” (Mark 1:15), “Believe in God” (John 14:1), but his call is always relational and existential, not confessional. The reason is simple and profound: Yeshua does not want ideological followers, but transformed people.

To believe in him as a theological figure can become a substitute for actually following him. You can believe correctly and live just as fearfully, just as rigidly, just as violently. This is why Yeshua always shifts the emphasis from statement to movement. “Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord,’ and do not do what I say?” (Luke 6:46). True faith is seen in the way you live, not in what you affirm about Yeshua.

“Believe That You Have Received It, and It Will Be Yours”

The verse “Therefore I tell you, whatever you ask for in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours” (Mark 11:24) has become, over time, one of the most quoted and, at the same time, one of the most distorted of Yeshua’s words. It is often used as a formula for obtaining what one desires, as a spiritual technique, or as proof that faith is a method of forcing reality to conform to our will.

But in the Gospels, this verse does not appear in a context of controlling reality, but in a context of purifying the heart and aligning with the Father. Immediately before, Yeshua speaks of forgiveness: “And whenever you stand praying, forgive whatever you have against anyone” (Mark 11:25). This proximity is essential. The faith Yeshua

speaks of is not an intensification of desire, but an emptying of the heart of its blockages.

Prayer is not an instrument through which you obtain, but a space in which you become free of fear, resentment, and separation. Yeshua never links faith to possession, but to sight. “Everything is possible for the one who believes” (Mark 9:23) is spoken to a desperate father, not to an ambitious man. Faith is not the power to produce results, but the capacity to remain open before reality without closing oneself in fear.

To “believe that you have received” does not mean to imagine the desired object, but to enter a state in which the heart no longer lives out of lack. The same logic appears when Yeshua says, “Your Father knows what you need before you ask him” (Matthew 6:8). If the Father already knows, then prayer is neither information nor negotiation. It is alignment. To believe that you have received means to settle into trust before the outer form appears. It means to live from relationship, not from anxiety. Yeshua never teaches that desire must be intensified, but that fear must be dissolved. “Do not be anxious about tomorrow” (Matthew 6:34) is the frame within which Mark 11:24 is understood. When a person no longer lives out of worry, he can ask without clinging. He can desire without controlling. He can wait without fear. For Yeshua, “to believe that you have received” is a state of the heart that has come out of lack and entered into trust.

It is not a technique of obtaining, but an expression of inner freedom. With Paul, the emphasis shifts. Paul does not quote this verse and does not develop the idea of prayer in this direction. He speaks of prayer as a space of dependence and of accepting the will of God: “Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer, present your requests to God” (Philippians 4:6). The result is not obtaining the thing requested, but “the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding” (Philippians 4:7). For Paul, prayer does not necessarily change the circumstances, but the person. The personal example is decisive: “Three times I pleaded with the Lord to take it away from me... and he said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you’” (2 Corinthians 12:8–9). Here the difference in tone becomes clear.

Paul does not operate from the certainty that what you ask for materializes, but from the trust that, regardless of the outcome, grace is sufficient. Faith, for Paul, is less about “already having” and more about remaining steadfast: “We walk by faith, not by sight” (2 Corinthians 5:7). Prayer becomes the space in which a person submits to the will of God, not the space in which reality aligns itself with human desire.

In later Christianity, the verse from Mark 11:24 undergoes two opposite transformations. In some traditions, it is almost ignored, because it seems too bold. In others, especially in modern currents, it becomes a formula: if you visualize enough, if you believe enough, you will receive. Prayer is transformed either into resignation or into a technique of manifestation. Both lose the living meaning of Yeshua’s words. In the first case, faith is reduced to passive acceptance.

In the second, to active control. But Yeshua speaks neither of passivity nor of control. He speaks of trust. For Yeshua, the moment of prayer is the moment in which a person comes out of fear and enters into relationship. “When you ask, believe that you have received it” means: enter already into the state of trust in which lack no longer rules your heart. Do not ask out of anxiety, but out of peace. Not out of lack, but out of fullness.

Paul would say: pray and leave the result in God’s hands. Later Christianity often says: either expect nothing, or force reality through faith. Yeshua says something else: live as if the Father is already present and attentive. Because this is the reality out of which faith is born.

How Faith Became Identity

With the development of the Christian communities, faith begins to function as a marker of identity. It is no longer merely trust, but belonging. Formulas, confessions, and boundaries appear. Faith becomes something that defines you socially and separates you from others. Yeshua never builds a group identity based on faith. He constantly dissolves boundaries: he praises the faith of those “outside”

and criticizes the security of those “inside.” Identity-faith is stable, but rigid.

Faith as trust is unstable, but alive. When faith becomes identity, the fear of doubt appears. But Yeshua is not afraid of doubt. He is afraid of dead certainty. The disciples doubt constantly, and Yeshua does not exclude them. The Pharisees are certain, and Yeshua comes into conflict with them. For Yeshua, faith is not a correct doctrine, a secure identity, a spiritual performance. It is the minimal trust that allows life to resettle.

For Paul, faith becomes the key to salvation, the principle of justification, the bond of the community. Between the two there is no contradiction, but a creative tension. Yet if Paul’s faith completely replaces that of Yeshua, what remains is a faith that knows much and transforms little. If Yeshua’s faith remains central, even a single seed is enough. Yeshua does not seek secure believers. He seeks people willing to stop defending themselves.

What Yeshua Would Say About Centering Salvation on His Death

Yeshua announces his death, but he never explains it as a juridical mechanism of salvation. He speaks of it as the consequence of fidelity to truth in a world that rejects the light: “The light has come into the world, but people loved the darkness more” (John 3:19). His death is bound to the mission of bearing witness to the truth: “For this I was born... to bear witness to the truth” (John 18:37).

If he were to comment on Pauline theology, Yeshua might say that his death is not the cause of forgiveness, but the mirror of human resistance to the truth. The cross does not change the heart of God toward humanity; it reveals the state of the human heart. The prayer from the cross expresses this clearly: “Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing” (Luke 23:34). Forgiveness is not activated by death, but is already present, even in the midst of violence.

For Paul, the resurrection is the proof of salvation and the guarantee of eternal life. Yeshua, however, speaks of eternal life as a reality

accessible now: “Whoever hears my word... has passed from death to life” (John 5:24). When he says, “I am the resurrection and the life” (John 11:25), he points not only to a future event to be believed, but to a present state to be lived.

The resurrection, in Yeshua’s language, is the coming out of fear, of hatred, and of inner death, not merely the hope of a future restoration. Yeshua would not deny the cross and the resurrection, but he would refuse to turn them into a substitute for transformation. He would say, implicitly, that his death saves no one if life remains unchanged. The truth he lived saves only when it is lived onward.

This is why his call remains: “If you remain in my word... the truth will set you free” (John 8:31–32). Thus, Yeshua would shift the emphasis from believing something about him to becoming what he lived. The cross not as a payment that closes the road, but as a door that opens it—toward a transformed life, here and now.

The Two Times Yeshua Says “Wow!”

The Gospels very rarely record moments in which Yeshua is described as marveling. Precisely for this reason, those few situations become extremely revealing. They show not only his reaction, but also what he truly considered unusual in human behavior. Surprisingly, Yeshua is never amazed by sin. He is not amazed by prostitution, by adultery, by corruption, by greed, or by lying. All of these appear, in his eyes, as the predictable consequences of human unconsciousness.

They are not events that astonish him, but natural manifestations of an inner state in which a person does not see himself. In contrast, there are two clear situations in which the text explicitly says that Yeshua marvels. Both have to do not with the morality of people, but with their level of inner sight. The first appears in the encounter with the Roman centurion, recounted in Matthew 8:10.

The centurion, a non-Jew and an officer of the occupying army, says that he is not worthy to receive Yeshua into his house, and that it is enough for him to speak a word for his servant to be healed. The text

says: “When Jesus heard this, he marveled and said to those who followed him: Truly I tell you, I have not found such great faith even in Israel.” Yeshua’s amazement is provoked by the inner clarity of a man outside religion.

A pagan sees clearly what the religious fail to see. The second situation is the opposite of the first and is recorded in Mark 6:6: “And he marveled at their unbelief.” Here, Yeshua is in Nazareth, among those who had known him since childhood. Religious people, familiar with the Scriptures, yet incapable of seeing what is right in front of them. In both cases, Yeshua’s amazement has to do with consciousness, not with moral behavior.

He marvels when someone sees very clearly, and he marvels when someone does not see at all, though he ought to see. This observation reveals something essential about his perspective: evil deeds do not surprise him, because they are the effects of unconsciousness. What is rare and surprising is consciousness, the human capacity to see beyond one’s own mechanisms. Thus, the moments of Yeshua’s amazement become precious clues to what he valued most. Not outer moral conformity, but inner sight.

For Yeshua, Does Faith Not Save?

In the Gospels, Yeshua often says, “Your faith has saved you,” or “has healed you.” But the meaning of these statements is essential to clarify. Faith is not the cause of salvation, but the condition in which salvation becomes possible. It does not produce the transformation, but allows the transformation to happen. Faith, for Yeshua, is the relaxing of defenses, the suspension of fear, the willingness to let the reality of God be active in your life.

Without this openness, nothing can change—not because God refuses, but because the person remains closed. This is why faith is often minimal, fragile, almost imperceptible. Yeshua says that a mustard seed is enough (Matthew 17:20). This statement would be absurd if salvation worked on the basis of the quantity or intensity of faith.

But it becomes perfectly coherent if salvation is the coming out of fear and closure, not the accumulation of a spiritual virtue. A single seed is enough because it is alive. Not because it is large. For Yeshua, salvation is not triggered by faith as an isolated inner act, but by the encounter that follows faith. Faith does not save; relationship saves. Faith is not the goal, but the threshold. Once the threshold is crossed, the road begins.

This is why Yeshua never stops at “you have faith”; he continues with “go,” “change,” “let go,” “love,” “forgive.” Salvation is a process, not a verdict. It is revealing that Yeshua speaks very rarely of salvation in terms of an “after death.” His emphasis is almost obsessively on the life of now: who sees the Kingdom, who enters it, who lives from it. Salvation is liberation from a way of being dominated by fear, judgment, and attachment.

Faith is not the entry ticket into a heavenly future, but the moment in which you stop opposing life. This explains why Yeshua can recognize salvation where doctrinal faith is absent. He praises the trust of a Roman, not his religious belonging. He forgives and saves without demanding theological confessions. He never asks, “What do you believe about me?” but “What do you want?”, “What are you seeking?”, “Will you follow me?”

For Yeshua, salvation is not conditioned on having correct ideas about God, but on entering into a living relationship with the truth. Therefore, for Yeshua, faith does not save in a mechanical sense. It is not the coin with which you buy salvation. It is the opening through which salvation can take place. To say that “for Yeshua, faith does not save” does not mean to minimize faith, but to free it from a function it does not have. Salvation, for Yeshua, is life lived from the Kingdom.

Faith is only the beginning of the step toward it. For Yeshua, faith is not a mechanism, not a juridical condition, not a goal. Faith is the gate. Salvation is the road. Yeshua does not say, “Believe and you will be saved.” He says, implicitly, “Open yourself and you will live.”

For Yeshua, Salvation Is a Process

For Yeshua, salvation is not a juridical moment, but a process of awakening. He says, “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21), “Today salvation has come” (Luke 19:9). Salvation is something that happens in real time, in the way a person begins to live differently. For the Apostle Paul, salvation takes the form of an event: justification by faith (Romans 5:1). The emphasis shifts from continuous transformation to status.

A person is declared saved on the basis of faith. This shift has historical and pastoral meaning, but it changes the experience. Salvation risks becoming something you have received, not something you live. Yeshua does not speak of status; he speaks of life. Paul speaks of guaranteed eternal life; Yeshua speaks of life freed from fear.

What It Means for Yeshua to Be Saved

Yeshua does not speak of salvation as a future reward or a favorable sentence in a heavenly courtroom. He uses the language of salvation to describe a change of state, a passage from one way of being to another. “Today salvation has come to this house” (Luke 19:9) does not mean that Zacchaeus received a spiritual certificate, but that his life resettled: his relationship with money, with people, with himself changed in concrete ways.

For Yeshua, to be saved means to be drawn out of captivity. But the captivity is not primarily juridical, but inner: fear, shame, rigid attachment, the need for control, isolation. Salvation is liberation from these structures that diminish life. This is why Yeshua links salvation to sight (“the blind see”), to rising (“get up”), to turning (“turn back”), to entering (“enter the Kingdom”). All of these are verbs of life lived, not of verdict.

Within this frame, salvation is inseparable from the present. It happens “today,” “now,” “here.” It is not deferred until after death, though it is not denied beyond death. The emphasis is clear: if salvation does not transform the life of now, it is not salvation in Yeshua’s sense.

For Yeshua, salvation is closely bound to the Kingdom of God. But the Kingdom is not a place you arrive at; it is a reality you enter into.

“The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). To be saved means to begin to live from this reality, to see the world differently, to react differently, to love differently. This explains why Yeshua can say that some “are near the Kingdom,” yet are not yet in it. Salvation is not binary (you either are or you are not), but processual. It is a road of awakening, not an instantaneous switch of status.

This is why Yeshua never offers a “plan of salvation” in clear steps. He offers parables, encounters, invitations. Because salvation is not a scheme, but an experience of transformation.

Why Yeshua Told the Rich Young Man to Sell His Wealth

On a superficial reading, Yeshua seems to condemn wealth in itself. On a careful reading, however, it becomes clear that money is not the problem, but the place it occupies in the inner structure of a person. The account appears in all three Synoptic Gospels (Matthew 19:16–22; Mark 10:17–22; Luke 18:18–23). A young man comes to Yeshua with a sincere question: “What must I do to inherit eternal life?” The question is already revealing.

He does not ask “How should I live?” but “What must I do?”—that is, what action, what performance, what addition he is still lacking. Eternal life is seen as an object that can be obtained. Yeshua begins by bringing him into the register of the Law: the commandments. The young man replies that he has kept them all. The text does not suggest hypocrisy. On the contrary, the Gospel of Mark adds an essential detail: “Yeshua, looking at him, loved him” (Mark 10:21).

We are not dealing with an evil, corrupt, or shallow man, but with a sincere, moral, and disciplined one. For exactly this reason, his problem is deeper. Yeshua’s response is not a universal rule, but a personalized diagnosis: “One thing you lack: sell everything you have, give to the poor... then come and follow me” (Mark 10:21). Yeshua does not say

“everyone must sell their possessions,” but “one thing you lack.” It is not wealth in itself, but attachment to it, that is the obstacle.

The young man’s reaction confirms the diagnosis: “He went away sorrowful, for he had great possessions” (Mark 10:22). The sorrow does not come from the loss of money, but from the impossibility of giving up his principal source of security and identity. Here it becomes clear that wealth is not a neutral good for him, but the center of his life. In Yeshua’s logic, the real problem is not what a person possesses, but what he lives from. “Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” (Matthew 6:21).

Money becomes dangerous when it replaces trust in God with control, accumulation, and self-sufficiency. This is why Yeshua says, immediately after the young man’s departure: “How hard it will be for those who have wealth to enter the Kingdom of God” (Mark 10:23). Not “because they are rich,” but because wealth creates the illusion of self-sufficiency. This statement shocks even the disciples. In the mentality of the time, wealth was often interpreted as a sign of divine blessing.

Yeshua overturns this logic: “What is impossible for people is possible for God” (Mark 10:27). The problem is not moral, but existential: wealth makes it difficult to abandon control. Yeshua does not condemn property as such. He does not say that money is evil, but that it cannot be served without becoming a master: “You cannot serve God and Mammon” (Matthew 6:24). Mammon is not the coin, but the principle of life based on accumulation as security.

In the case of the rich young man, Mammon had already become master. It is essential to note that Yeshua does not tell him, “Sell everything and you will be saved,” but “Come and follow me.” Selling his wealth is not the goal, but the condition of the freedom necessary for discipleship. Poverty is not the ideal, but total availability. Wealth must be abandoned only where it hinders following. This is confirmed by the fact that Yeshua does not ask the same thing of all the wealthy.

Zacchaeus, for example, voluntarily gives up only part of his wealth, and Yeshua declares: “Today salvation has come to this house” (Luke

19:8–9). The difference is clear: for Zacchaeus, money is no longer the center; for the rich young man, it still is. Through this episode, Yeshua does not preach an economic ideology, but makes visible a universal truth: anything that becomes a source of identity, security, and worth apart from God becomes an idol. For some it is money.

For others, it is status, religion, power, or morality. Yeshua does not ask everyone to give up the same thing, but each one to give up what holds him captive. The conclusion of this episode is not about poverty, but about freedom. Yeshua tells the rich young man to sell his wealth not to punish him, not to test him arbitrarily, but because he saw the exact place where his life was bound. Where a person cannot let go, there he is not free.

Yeshua did not come to make us poorer. He came to make us freer.

Salvation in Today's Christianity

In much of contemporary Christianity, salvation has been moved from the plane of lived life to the plane of theological security. To be saved often means to be “right with God,” to have a destiny settled after death. The emphasis falls on what you believe, not on how you live. On doctrinal correctness, not on the transformation of consciousness. This shift has profound consequences. Salvation becomes something static, closed, defensive. Once obtained, it is no longer called into question.

Life can remain dominated by fear, judgment, rigidity, while salvation remains intact as a status. Within this frame, salvation is no longer the power that changes life, but the assurance that life does not decisively matter. This version of salvation is, paradoxically, very institutionally efficient. It offers security, clear boundaries, belonging.

But it is hard to reconcile with the message of Yeshua, who says that a tree is known by its fruit, and that not all who say “Lord, Lord” live from the Kingdom (Matthew 7:21). The fundamental difference between Yeshua and today's Christianity is not about whether salvation exists, but about what kind of reality salvation is. For Yeshua, salvation

is liberated life; it is present and processual; it is seen in relationships, not in declarations.

It does not need to be declared, because it is lived. In dominant Christianity, salvation is a spiritual status; it is future and guaranteed; it is validated through correct faith. Yeshua asks, “Are you alive?” Christianity often asks, “Are you saved?” In this way, security, doctrinal coherence, and transmissibility are gained. But the living tension of salvation as a road is lost. Its transforming character is lost. The risk is lost.

For Yeshua, salvation is risky because it draws you out of your old structures. For today’s Christianity, salvation is safe because it allows you to remain, sometimes, exactly where you are. For Yeshua, to be saved means to be drawn out of fear, to enter a wider life, to live from the Kingdom. For today’s Christianity, to be saved often means to have a settled status, to be in the correct camp, to have a guarantee for the “afterward.”

Yeshua did not come to tell us how to get to heaven. He came to show us what life looks like when heaven enters a person.

The Kingdom of God Comes to Earth; We Do Not Go to Heaven

For many Christians, the essence of faith is an “afterward”: after death you go to heaven or to hell, depending on faith and morality. Heaven becomes the goal, life becomes the test, and God becomes the evaluator. But when you listen to Yeshua, you notice that the center of his message is not “where you end up,” but “what you see now.” He does not speak of a geography of the postmortem as the main theme.

He speaks of the Kingdom as a present reality, one that can be missed even while living religiously. Yeshua says, “The time has come and the Kingdom of God is near; repent and believe in the gospel” (Mark 1:15). “Near” here does not mean only temporally, but existentially: it is at hand, accessible, available. And when he is asked about signs, he cuts off the spectacular expectation entirely: “The

Kingdom of God does not come in such a way as to strike the eye... for behold, the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21). This changes everything. If the Kingdom is within, then it is not a future reward, but a present awakening. In the parables, the Kingdom is described as leaven that rises, as a seed, as a mustard grain, as a hidden treasure (Matthew 13:31–33, 44).

All of these are images of an inner process and of recognition, not of “transport to a place.” The Kingdom is not a heavenly resort. It is a change of perception in which the reality of God becomes visible within ordinary life. This is why Yeshua insists on “eyes to see” and “ears to hear” (Matthew 13:13–16). Not because the information is missing, but because people are blind to what is already there.

“Heaven” in the popular sense can become, psychologically, a mechanism for deferring transformation: you live with the hope that, one day, another reality will begin. The Kingdom, in Yeshua’s sense, is the opposite of deferral: it is here, and the problem is that you do not see it because you are caught in fear, worry, judgment, accumulation. This is why he says, “Do not be anxious... seek first the Kingdom” (Matthew 6:31–33). The Kingdom is not a “spiritual bonus”; it is the meaning that reorganizes anxiety.

When Yeshua speaks of eternal life, he often binds it to knowledge, not to location: “And this is eternal life: that they know you, the only true God...” (John 17:3). “Knowledge” here is not information, but intimacy, recognition, another way of being in relationship with the real. So eternal life begins as a mode of consciousness, not as a postmortem displacement.

In this light, the Kingdom of God does not completely replace the idea of an “afterward,” but places it in the background. Yeshua’s emphasis is: “Wake up now, see now, live now.” And if there is an “afterward,” it cannot be an excuse for the absence of the Kingdom here.

Did Yeshua Believe in Heaven and Hell?

Yeshua does not speak of Heaven and Hell in the sense in which they are understood today, and when he uses language that seems “eschatological,” he uses it symbolically, pedagogically, and existentially, not as a description of clearly defined metaphysical postmortem destinations. Yeshua never preaches a binary system of reward and punishment after death, as would become central in later Christianity. He does not say, “If you believe correctly you go to Heaven; if not, you go to Hell.”

The meaning of his message is the Kingdom of God, not the afterlife as a juridical system. For Yeshua, the Kingdom is not a place you reach after death, but a reality that draws near, opens, and can be lived here and now: “The Kingdom of God is near” (Mark 1:15), “The Kingdom of God is in your midst” (Luke 17:21). The language is present, not postmortem. Yeshua speaks of a change of state, not of a change of cosmic address.

When Yeshua uses language that seems to describe “hell,” he does not use the theological concept of Hell as we know it today. The term most often used is Gehenna (Matthew 5:22; Mark 9:43). Gehenna was not a metaphysical place, but the Valley of Hinnom, a real location associated with fire, destruction, and ruin—a symbol of self-destruction and of the consequences of living from violence, hatred, and fear.

When Yeshua warns about Gehenna, he is not describing a place of eternal torture, but the direction of a life lived against the truth. For Yeshua, “punishment” is not imposed from outside by an angry God, but is the inner result of a wrong orientation. “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16). A life lived from fear, judgment, and closure already produces hell.

This is why Yeshua speaks of “weeping and gnashing of teeth” as a state of inner exclusion, not as a divine juridical sentence (Matthew 8:12). The language is existential, not penal. Revealingly, Yeshua speaks very little about the afterlife and very much about how you live now. He does not motivate people through the promise of Heaven or the

fear of Hell, but through the call to full life: “I came that they may have life, and have it abundantly” (John 10:10).

The emphasis is not on where you end up, but on what you live from. The contrast with Paul is significant. With Paul, the perspective gradually shifts from the Kingdom lived to the final destiny of the person. Paul speaks of “salvation,” “loss,” “eternal death,” and “eternal life” (Romans 6:23) within a more juridical frame. Although Paul does not describe hell in detail as a place of torture, he introduces a binary logic: in Christ there is life; outside of him there is death.

With Paul, the idea of a final judgment and of definitive separation appears clearly (2 Corinthians 5:10). The emphasis falls on the ultimate destiny, not on the present state. Likewise, salvation becomes something that is “received” through correct faith, not merely an awakening of consciousness. This shift would later permit the development of a detailed eschatology of Heaven and Hell. Later institutional Christianity would amplify this direction.

Heaven and Hell become clear places, described in imagery, used as pedagogical instruments and, often, as instruments of control. Hell becomes eternal punishment; Heaven becomes eternal reward. Present life is reduced to a test for the future life. Fear and hope are used as engines of religious conformity. This use would be foreign to Yeshua. He never says, “Do this so you do not end up in Hell.” He says, “Follow me,” “Do not be afraid,” “The Kingdom is here.”

For Yeshua, God is not the judge who decides final destinations, but the Father who calls to life. Judgment, when it appears, is revelation rather than condemnation: the truth brings to light what is alive and what is dead in a person (John 3:19–21). Thus, we can state the difference in perspective very clearly: Yeshua speaks of states of being. Paul begins to speak of final destinies.

Today’s Christianity often speaks of places of reward and punishment. Yeshua does not motivate us through the fear of Hell or the desire for Heaven. He calls us to the Kingdom as life lived in truth, here and now. Therefore, Yeshua does not preach Heaven and Hell as cosmic systems of the afterlife. He speaks of directions of life, already lived in

the present. Hell is life lived against the truth. The Kingdom is life lived in communion with God.

“Today You Will Be with Me in Paradise” — The Kingdom, Death, and Yeshua’s Language

One of the most frequently invoked objections, when someone affirms that Yeshua speaks of the Kingdom of God as a present reality, lived “here and now,” is the reply addressed to the thief on the cross: “Truly I tell you, today you will be with me in paradise” (Luke 23:43). For many, this phrase seems to close the discussion. If Yeshua promises “paradise” after death, then the Kingdom can no longer be a present reality, but a future, postmortem one.

Yet this conclusion arises only if we read the sentence through the lens of later theology, not through the language, context, and intention of Yeshua. To understand this statement, we must do something essential: separate language from doctrine and return to the way Yeshua uses words, not to what they later came to mean. The word translated as “paradise” (*paradeisos*) is not a sophisticated theological term in the Gospels.

It does not appear frequently in Yeshua’s discourse, and it is not systematically defined. In the Jewish context of the time, *paradeisos* evokes the idea of a garden, a place of rest, a space of God’s presence, not a detailed map of the afterlife. What is important is that Yeshua never uses “paradise” as a central piece of his message.

The center of his message remains the Kingdom of God—a reality that “is near” (Mark 1:15), that “is within you” (Luke 17:21), and that does not come “in such a way as to strike the eye” (Luke 17:20). So when Yeshua uses the term “paradise,” he does not change his message; he responds to an extreme situation, using language accessible to the man before him. The thief is not asking for a doctrine about the afterlife. He is not asking for explanations about salvation.

He is not asking for a theological scheme. He says only: “Yeshua, remember me when you come into your Kingdom” (Luke 23:42). This

request is remarkable. The man does not ask to escape death. He does not ask to be taken down from the cross. He does not ask for the consequences of his deeds to be annulled.

He asks not to be forgotten. He asks for recognition. He asks for inclusion. He asks for relationship. Yeshua's response is not a lesson about heavens and hells, but an existential assurance: "Today you will be with me."

The emphasis falls not on "where," but on "with whom." Not on geography, but on presence. The decisive word in this phrase is not "paradise," but "today." "Today you will be with me..." does not move salvation into a distant future, but brings it into the absolute present of that moment. Yeshua frequently uses this "today" to break religious deferral: "Today salvation has come to this house" (Luke 19:9). "Today these words have been fulfilled" (Luke 4:21).

For Yeshua, "today" is the time of the Kingdom. It is the moment in which the reality of God becomes accessible, regardless of the outer context. Even on the cross. So the statement to the thief does not contradict the message about the present Kingdom; it radicalizes it: if the Kingdom can be lived "today," then it can be lived even in death. Yeshua does not say, "Today you will reach a place called paradise." He says, "Today you will be with me." This is the essence.

In Yeshua's language, salvation is not a relocation, but a communion. To be "with Yeshua" means to be in the same reality of consciousness, in the same openness toward God, in the same trust without fear. Indeed, Yeshua defines eternal life not as duration or location, but as relationship: "This is eternal life: that they know you" (John 17:3). Knowledge here is not intellectual, but relational, intimate, alive. So "paradise" becomes a bridge-word, not a doctrine.

A language of nearness, not of metaphysical cartography. Yeshua does not tell the thief, "You are mistaken; there is no paradise after death; the Kingdom is only here." Why? Because Yeshua is not interested in winning conceptual debates. He is interested in freeing a person from fear. In that moment, a conceptual correction would have been

irrelevant. What matters is that the man, in his final moments, passes from despair to trust.

Yeshua uses the language the man can receive. Just as he speaks in parables to bypass mental resistances, he speaks here in terms that can be heard by a man caught between life and death. The truth is not betrayed by symbolic language. It is betrayed only when the symbol is confused with the literal map. Something essential becomes visible here: for Yeshua, death does not interrupt the Kingdom. It does not suspend it. It does not defer it.

If the Kingdom were only a social or psychological reality, death would have annulled it. But Yeshua speaks of the Kingdom as a reality deeper than biological life. This is why he can say, without contradiction, that a person can enter this reality even while dying. We do not have here two doctrines—one for life and one for death—but a single reality that traverses both.

What Repentance Means

For Yeshua, repentance (*metanoia*) is not a condemnation of the self, nor a moral self-flagellation. It is a change in the way of seeing, an awakening of consciousness that resettles a person in truth. Yeshua does not begin by saying “you are guilty,” but “wake up,” calling a person to come out of blindness and enter into the living reality of the Kingdom. This is why his inaugural message is not about punishment, but about nearness: “Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near” (Matthew 4:17).

The nearness of the Kingdom does not demand payment, but inner availability; repentance is the living response to the presence of God, here and now. In Yeshua’s logic, repentance is verified by fruit, not by declarations. The change of mind is seen in a life that aligns naturally with the truth: “Bear fruit worthy of repentance” (Matthew 3:8). In his encounters, repentance appears as a reorientation of the heart.

The tax collector, the woman caught in adultery, the prodigal son are not forced to hate themselves; they see differently and, seeing, they live differently. The words “Go and sin no more” (John 8:11) are not a

threat, but a liberation, and the joy of the Father—"My son was dead and is alive again" (Luke 15:24)—shows that repentance, for Yeshua, is not the fear of punishment, but the coming out of inner death and the entering into life. With Paul, repentance takes on a more moral-theological form.

The person is seen first of all as a sinner in relation to the Law, and repentance becomes the awareness of this state and the turning toward God through faith in Christ. The diagnosis is universal: "All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God" (Romans 3:23), and the call is general: "God now commands all people everywhere to repent" (Acts 17:30).

Paul preserves the idea of change, but binds it to the death of the old self and the receiving of a new identity through grace. Repentance is an act of passage: "Our old self was crucified with him" (Romans 6:6), and the result is a reconfigured existence: "If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation" (2 Corinthians 5:17). The emphasis shifts from the awakening of consciousness (central in Yeshua) to the resolution of the problem of sin through faith.

Repentance becomes the juridical gate of justification and grace, more than the living process of daily transformation. In contemporary Christianity, repentance is often reduced to the acknowledgment of guilt, the expression of remorse, and conformity to moral or ritual norms. Metanoia as a change of consciousness is frequently replaced by shame or fear.

Profound verses such as "A broken and contrite heart, O God, you will not despise" (Psalm 51:17) are sometimes used to cultivate an identity of permanent sinfulness, rather than a real transformation. Thus, repentance comes to mean "acknowledge that you are bad and accept forgiveness," without speaking any further about becoming, presence, and fruit. In practice, it becomes bound to confession without inner change, to declarations of faith without a transformed life, and to moralism without love.

Yeshua had warned precisely of this danger: "This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me" (Matthew 15:8). When

repentance stops at administered guilt, life remains unchanged. For Yeshua, repentance is awakening: you see the truth and, seeing, you change. For Paul, repentance is turning through faith: you acknowledge sin and receive a new identity through grace.

In today's Christianity, repentance often becomes managed guilt: you acknowledge, you are forgiven, but you remain the same. Yet Yeshua binds repentance to full life: "I came that the sheep may have life, and have it abundantly" (John 10:10). Repentance, as Yeshua lives it, does not diminish a person—it frees him. It does not fix him in the past, but brings him into the living present of the Kingdom. "The truth will set you free" (John 8:32) does not describe a burden, but an opening.

While Paul builds a theological framework of salvation, Yeshua calls to a living transformation, here and now. Today's Christianity is invited to return to the original meaning of repentance: the change of mind that gives birth to a new life, not merely a more burdened conscience. From this perspective, repentance takes on a meaning entirely different from the moralistic one.

In the language of the New Testament, the word translated as "repentance" is *metanoia*, which means a change of mind, an awakening of consciousness. Repentance does not begin with regret over the past, but with the moment in which a person begins to see what was previously hidden. It is not primarily sorrow for what you have done, but clarity about your own contribution within relationships.

In the moment a person sees the beam in his own eye, something fundamental changes: attention is no longer directed toward the guilt of others, but toward one's own heart. This inner change is described with remarkable simplicity in the parable of the prodigal son. The decisive moment is not the physical return of the son, but the instant in which the text says, "He came to himself" (Luke 15:17). In that moment, *metanoia* takes place.

The son ceases to interpret life through the lens of circumstances and begins to see the reality about himself. This is why he says, "I will rise and go to my father and say to him: Father, I have sinned against heaven

and against you” (Luke 15:18). Repentance is not moral self-flagellation, but the lucid acknowledgment of one’s own responsibility. Thus, repentance is not primarily a return to morality, but a return to oneself.

It is the moment in which a person ceases to flee from the truth and becomes capable of seeing himself without defense. In this light, relationships become the mirror in which the beam in our own eye becomes visible. Conflicts, wounds, and tensions are not merely external problems, but revelations of our interior. They bring to the surface what would otherwise remain hidden.

This is why sin, in the profound sense of Yeshua’s teaching, is not only the wrong action, but the tendency to accuse others while remaining blind to one’s own heart. And repentance is not only the abandonment of a behavior, but the abandonment of this blindness. It is the passage from judgment to consciousness, from accusation to responsibility. In the moment this change takes place, relationships can begin to be repaired.

Not because others have changed, but because the person has begun to see clearly. Exactly as Yeshua says: “First take the beam out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly” (Matthew 7:5). Inner clarity thus becomes the beginning of the healing of relationships. Repentance, therefore, is not a return to a list of moral rules, but a return to truth, to consciousness, and to oneself.

8. Love, Forgiveness, Sin

Love in Yeshua

At the center of Yeshua's message stands love—but not as doctrine, not as an isolated moral virtue, and not as an abstract ideal. Love, for Yeshua, is a way of being. It is not defined; it is lived. It is not preached as a norm but revealed as a state of consciousness. This is why Yeshua does not offer a theory of love but creates situations in which love becomes visible: he touches the one who is excluded (Mark 1:40–42), he sits at table with the one who is despised (Mark 2:15–17), he refuses violence even when it would be justified (Matthew 26:52).

Love is not something you “must” do; it is something that happens when fear disappears. For Yeshua, the opposite of love is not sin but fear. Every time he says “do not be afraid” (Matthew 10:31; Luke 12:32; John 14:27), he implicitly opens the space in which love can arise. Love is not commanded as a moral obligation; it becomes possible as the effect of inner freedom.

This is why the commandment to love one's enemies (Matthew 5:44; Luke 6:27–36) is not a superhuman requirement but a consequence of disidentification: if you no longer have a self to defend, you no longer have an enemy to hate. Love, in Yeshua, is not conditioned by the behavior of the other but by your own state of presence. In his relationship with sin, Yeshua does not operate from a juridical logic. He does not love “in spite of” sin, nor “in order to correct” sin. He sees the person beyond the label.

“Neither do I condemn you” (John 8:11) is not the suspension of truth but the refusal to reduce a human being to their mistake. Love, here, is not moral tolerance but clear sight: Yeshua does not deny the reality of wounds, but he refuses to turn them into identity. In Paul, love takes another form. Not because Paul is “less spiritual,” but because he operates in a different register: that of organizing the community and systematizing the message.

Paul speaks of love as the supreme virtue, as the fulfillment of the Law, as the bond of the community (Romans 13:8–10; Colossians 3:14). The famous hymn to love in 1 Corinthians 13 is profound, beautiful, and true, but it is already a definition. Love becomes something that can be described, evaluated, measured: “love is patient, love is kind...” (1 Corinthians 13:4–7). This shift is subtle, but essential.

In Yeshua, love is a state; in Paul, love becomes a criterion. In Yeshua, love springs from truth (“I am the truth”—John 14:6); in Paul, love comes to be integrated into a normative framework. Although Paul affirms that love is greater than faith and hope (1 Corinthians 13:13), he nevertheless inserts it into a doctrinal architecture: there is a love that “builds up” (1 Corinthians 8:1), a love that functions within the body of the community (1 Corinthians 12).

While Yeshua dissolves the boundaries of identity through love —“you are all brothers” (Matthew 23:8), “there is neither Jew nor Samaritan,” implicit in his parables (Luke 10:33–37)—Paul is concerned with maintaining the cohesion of the community. Love becomes an instrument of order: “do not put a stumbling block in another’s way” (Romans 14:13), “maintain the unity of the Spirit” (Ephesians 4:3), “all things should be done decently and in order” (1 Corinthians 14:40).

Not because Paul is authoritarian, but because he is speaking to a community that risks falling apart. In this context, love begins to be associated with responsibility, with discipline, with conformity to the common good. Here the major difference appears: in Yeshua, love is free and unlocated; in Paul, love is contextualized within the

community. Here begins the difference that, once seen, can no longer be ignored. In Yeshua, love has no purpose; in Paul, love has a function.

It “builds up” (1 Corinthians 8:1), it “unites” (Colossians 3:14), it “covers” (1 Corinthians 13:7). This functionalization is the beginning of dogmatization: love is no longer merely the expression of truth lived, but becomes the virtue that sustains the system. In time, this Pauline love will be taken up by the institution and transformed into a moral obligation. And, without our noticing, something changes. Love no longer flows from freedom; it begins to come from conformity.

And here something essential is lost: “Love one another” becomes a normative imperative (Ephesians 5:1–2), associated with obedience, good order, and sound doctrine (Titus 2:1–2). Thus love risks becoming conditional: we love “correctly,” we love “responsibly,” we love “with discernment.” Love no longer flows from freedom but from conformity. Yeshua never says “love so that you may be saved.”

He says: “By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another” (John 13:35)—love as the sign of a reality already present. Paul, without saying so explicitly, comes to bind love to the life of the saved community and to a walk “worthy of the calling” (Ephesians 4:1–2). In Yeshua, love is the sign that the Kingdom is here (Luke 17:21). In Paul, love becomes the proof of spiritual maturity (1 Corinthians 14:20; Ephesians 4:13).

This difference shifts the emphasis: from experience to evaluation, from presence to criterion. It is not a matter of radical opposition, but of a displacement of meaning. Yeshua lives love from within truth; Paul explains love from within structure. Yeshua frees love from fear (“do not be afraid”—Luke 12:32); Paul tries to protect love from chaos (“God is not a God of disorder”—1 Corinthians 14:33).

One is love as revelation; the other is love as an organizing virtue. In this sense, Yeshua’s love cannot be dogmatized without being lost. It cannot be imposed, defined, or administered. It appears only where a person no longer lives out of self-defense. Pauline love can be taught, learned, demanded. Yeshua’s love can only be recognized when it happens.

The final difference is this: in Yeshua, love is what remains when fear disappears (John 4:18); in Paul, love is what must be preserved so that the community does not fall apart (Ephesians 4:15–16). Both speak about love. But only one speaks from love.

Empathy in Yeshua

Empathy, in its deepest sense, is not agreement with another's deed, nor the suspension of discernment, but the capacity to enter into the lived reality of a person without reducing them to their mistake. In this light, the differences between Yeshua, the Apostle Paul, and contemporary Christianity become visible not merely as theological nuances, but above all as different ways of relating to a human being. In Yeshua, empathy precedes any moral framework.

He does not begin by defining sin; he begins by seeing the person. The encounter with the woman caught in adultery (John 8) is emblematic: Yeshua does not contest the existence of sin, but he refuses to let sin be her identity. His silence before her accusers suspends the inner tribunal of everyone present. Only after the woman is rehumanized does the invitation appear: "Go, and sin no more." Correction comes after empathy, not in its place.

In this sense, Yeshua operates from a consciousness in which moral judgment is not the primary instrument but the natural consequence of truth lived. His empathy is not sentimental; it is radical presence. He enters into the other's story without analyzing, labeling, or ranking it. This is why Yeshua can say "do not judge" without relativizing good and evil: judgment blocks access to the heart, and without the heart there is no transformation.

Paul shifts the emphasis from the living encounter to the structuring of the community. He writes letters in order to organize, correct, delimit. Here a subtle change appears: empathy is present ("weep with those who weep"), but it is subordinated to doctrinal truth. A person is loved insofar as they align with the truth proclaimed. For Paul, the

danger is not only suffering but going astray. This is why his language frequently introduces moral evaluation and explicit correction.

Empathy becomes contextual: it is granted to the one who acknowledges the framework. Where Yeshua says “come and see,” Paul often says “come and set yourself right.” Not from a lack of love, but from a change of mission: from revelation to preservation.

Christianity Today: Empathy Lost in Moralism

Contemporary Christianity has taken up above all the Pauline instruments—dogmas, rules, delimitations—but often without the heart of Yeshua that would have made them alive. Thus empathy is confused with weakness, and judgment with fidelity to the truth. A person is analyzed “in terms of morality,” and this analysis automatically excludes empathy, because it turns the other into a case rather than a being. When morality becomes a filter, the relationship breaks.

To say “you have sinned” without feeling the inner burden of the one standing before you is not liberating truth but moralizing. Dogma, used as a shield, offers identity-security but blocks the encounter. This is why many Christians can speak correctly about sin and completely wrongly about the human being. As we discussed earlier, judgment presupposes a position of superiority, while empathy requires existential equality.

The moment you position yourself “above” in order to evaluate, you can no longer enter the other’s story. Dogma, when absolutized, offers answers before asking questions. Empathy, by contrast, listens before knowing. Yeshua never began a conversation with “the truth says that...,” but with presence. Paul began to do so out of communal necessity. The Christianity of today has often been left with only the proposition, and not the Spirit. And without the Spirit, truth becomes a weapon.

Empathy does not exclude correction; it makes it possible. In Yeshua, truth comes from a heart that has already been there, in the other’s suffering. In Paul, truth comes from concern for good order. In present-day Christianity, truth often comes from fear—the fear of losing

control, identity, certainty. Where there is judgment, empathy stops. Where there is rigid dogma, the heart closes.

And without empathy, Christianity ceases to be good news and becomes only a cold correction of behavior. Yeshua did not come to tell us what we are, but to see us. From there every healing begins.

Forgiveness in Yeshua

Forgiveness, in Yeshua's message, is neither a juridical mechanism nor a moral transaction between human and God. It does not appear as a response to a tallied guilt, but as the effect of an inner realignment. When Yeshua says "your sins are forgiven," he is not making an administrative announcement about a person's moral status; he is describing a reality that is already beginning to manifest: the person no longer lives separated from God through fear, shame, and self-condemnation.

This becomes clear in the episode of the paralytic lowered through the roof. Before any physical healing, Yeshua says: "Son, your sins are forgiven" (Mark 2:5). The immediate reaction of the scribes is revealing: "Who can forgive sins but God alone?" (Mark 2:7). Their question already presupposes a juridical theology: sin is an offense against God, and forgiveness is an act of vertical authority.

Yeshua does not directly deny this logic, but he undermines it from within. He shows that the human being's problem is not, first of all, guilt, but the inner rupture that keeps them paralyzed. This is why forgiveness precedes healing. Not because illness is a punishment for sin, but because shame, fear, and self-exclusion create a state of closure that blocks life. "Rise and walk" (Mark 2:11) becomes possible only after a person no longer sees themselves as separate. Forgiveness, in Yeshua, is the restoration of the flow of life, not the erasure of a moral record. When Yeshua says "your sins are forgiven" to the woman known as a "sinner" (Luke 7:48), he does not condition forgiveness on formal repentance, confession, or sacrifice. He observes that her great love is the sign of an openness already present: "her sins are forgiven, for she loved much" (Luke 7:47). The order is essential.

She does not love because she has been forgiven; she is forgiven because love has dissolved the separation. Forgiveness does not produce love; love makes forgiveness possible. Here a crucial question arises: did Yeshua have the “power” to forgive sins? In the religious logic of the time, forgiveness was tied to the temple, sacrifice, and priesthood. Yeshua breaks this tie. He does not send people to ritual in order to be forgiven; he brings them back into relationship.

The power he exercises is not juridical but revelatory: he makes visible the fact that God is not separated from the human being in the way the human being believes themselves separated from God. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). From this perspective, forgiveness is not a one-time act but a state of remembering unity. The human being is not forgiven in order to be able to love; the human being loves because they begin to live from a place in which separation is no longer real.

This is why Yeshua does not condition love on the forgiveness of sins. He never says: “you cannot love until you are forgiven.” On the contrary, he shows that love itself is the way out of sin. This leads to another uncomfortable question: can we be in love without our sins being “forgiven”? In Yeshua’s language, yes—because love is precisely the space in which sin loses its power.

Sin, in the original sense of the term (*hamartia*), means “to miss the mark,” to live from a mistaken perception of reality. When a person lives in love, the mark is no longer missed. Not because the person becomes “without fault,” but because they no longer live from separation. Yeshua does not speak of a God who keeps a record of sins in order to decide whether a person deserves love.

He says explicitly: “Your Father is merciful” (Luke 6:36) and “God did not send the Son into the world to condemn the world, but in order that the world might be saved through him” (John 3:17). Judgment, in Yeshua’s vision, is not an external verdict but the natural consequence of living in fear: “the light has come into the world, and people loved the darkness” (John 3:19). It is not God who separates; it is the human being who separates themselves.

This vision contrasts sharply with the one formulated by Paul and then taken up by the Christian doctrine that followed Yeshua, down to our own day. In Paul, sin becomes a cosmic power that ontologically separates the human being from God: “all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God” (Romans 3:23). Forgiveness becomes necessary in order to repair this separation, and Yeshua’s death is interpreted as a juridical act of satisfying divine justice (Romans 3:25; 2 Corinthians 5:21).

In this paradigm, love is no longer enough. Even if you love, you remain separated until your sins are forgiven through an external act: correct faith, acceptance of the sacrifice, belonging to the saved community. Later Christian doctrine will consolidate this logic: God loves, but cannot receive the human being without resolving the problem of sin; forgiveness becomes the condition for full love. Yeshua never says this.

He does not affirm that sin separates the human being from God ontologically. He says that sin separates the human being from life. The difference is enormous. In Yeshua, God remains present even in our wandering: “the Father makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good” (Matthew 5:45). The separation is not relational on God’s part, but perceptual on the human being’s part. This is why forgiveness is necessary not in order to change God’s attitude, but in order to heal the human being’s perception.

A person needs to hear “your sins are forgiven” because they live in constant self-judgment. The voice that condemns is not the voice of God, but the voice of internalized fear. Yeshua does not negotiate with this voice; he deactivates it. In Christian doctrine today, the emphasis often falls on final judgment, on definitive separation, on the verdict. In Yeshua’s message, the emphasis falls on restoration, on return, on remembrance.

The parable of the prodigal son is essential here: the father does not wait for atonement, does not demand explanations, does not pronounce forgiveness as a sentence. He runs, embraces, and restores the status of son before the son finishes his speech of guilt (Luke 15:20–24). In

Yeshua, forgiveness is not the condition of love but its expression; sin does not separate the human being from God, but makes them believe they are separated; God does not judge in order to exclude, but illuminates in order to heal.

Forgiveness is not a bureaucratic gate to love. It is the moment in which a person ceases to exclude themselves from it.

“Father, Forgive Them, for They Know Not What They Do” — The Anatomy of Unconsciousness in Yeshua

On the cross there is a sentence that concentrates, as in a seed, the entire inner pedagogy of Yeshua. While he is mocked, beaten, and crucified, he speaks the words recorded in Luke 23:34: “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do.” This phrase is not a sentimental appeal, nor a figure of speech. It is a precise spiritual diagnosis of the human condition and, at the same time, an indication of the only therapy that can heal that condition.

For Yeshua, “unconsciousness” does not mean a lack of information. The people at Golgotha know very well what they are doing on the external level: they strike, they spit, they mock, they crucify. Their unconsciousness is not cognitive but inner. They do not see the state out of which they do all this. They do not see their fear, their pride, their attachment to power, their need for control, their total identification with their roles—“soldier,” “priest,” “crowd.” They do not see the automatic mechanisms that drive them.

And because they do not see them, they mistake them for justice, for duty, for the Law, for the will of God. This is unconsciousness in Yeshua’s language: to be possessed by your own mechanisms without knowing you are possessed by them. When he says “they know not what they do,” Yeshua is not saying that they fail to realize they are killing an innocent man. His statement is far deeper: they do not know from what inner place they are doing this. They believe they are defending order, religion, God, the application of the Law.

In reality, they are discharging fear, anger; they are defending their ego, their system, their identity. And this confusion is so total that there is no distance between them and the mechanisms that animate them. From here the essential question is born: why does Yeshua not say “Show them, Lord”? Why does he not ask for immediate revelation for them? Because to show them, in that moment, would have produced shame, guilt, humiliation, and a forced exposure of the ego.

And this does not awaken consciousness; it activates defense. A person caught in their mechanism, confronted with it brutally, does not say “you are right,” but “no, we are right.” The mechanism is still functioning, so it defends itself. This is why Yeshua’s solution is not confrontation but forgiveness. For him, forgiveness is not a moral gesture but a therapeutic one. To forgive means to no longer resist the other’s mechanism, to no longer press it, to no longer force it, to no longer expose it.

It means to let time extinguish the anger, the fear, and the exhaustion of the ego, until a person can arrive on their own at the point where they say: “What have I done...?” If you show them beforehand, they defend themselves. If you forgive them, you create the space in which, later, they can see themselves. Yeshua’s order is clear: first forgiveness—that is, the calming of the inner field. Then awareness becomes possible. Only at the end can the truth be seen. Conversely, truth thrown over an unforgiven person produces only defense.

In this light, the unconscious person is the one who believes they are right when they do evil, who feels moral when they are violent, and who believes they are defending God in the very moment they crucify him. They see no contradiction, because they have no access to the inner mechanism that drives them. This is why Yeshua does not say “they know not that they do,” but “they know not *what* they do.”

It is not the absence of the deed that is the problem, but the absence of seeing the state from which the deed proceeds. The essence of Yeshua’s perspective thus becomes clear: unconsciousness is total identification with the inner mechanism; sin is to act from it without seeing it; and the solution is not confrontation but forgiveness—because

forgiveness offers time. Time in which consciousness can appear without pressure, without shame, without defense. On the cross, Yeshua does not ask for revelation for them. He asks for time for them.

Forgiveness as the Withdrawal of Conflict, Not the Rewriting of Morality

In the words spoken on the cross and recorded in Luke 23:34—“Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do”—Yeshua does not propose a new morality, nor does he relativize evil. He does not say that what is happening is not grave, nor that violence, mockery, and injustice become acceptable. What he does is far more subtle and far more profound: he withdraws the conflict between himself and those who crucify him, without withdrawing the truth about the deed. This distinction is essential.

Ordinarily, when we see an evil, our spontaneous reaction is to enter into conflict with the person who commits it. Not only to name the deed as evil, but to identify the person with the evil produced. In that moment, our struggle is no longer only with the deed, but with the person. And this struggle becomes the fuel for the inner mechanisms of both. Yeshua breaks this circle. He leaves the deed in its truth, but he refuses to enter into conflict with the people who do it.

This is why he does not say “what they are doing is not evil,” but “they know not what they do.” In this way, evil is not denied, but the person is no longer reduced to the evil they do. This attitude harmonizes with his entire teaching, including the radical call in Matthew 5:44: “Love your enemies.” To love your enemy does not mean to declare that the enmity is not real, but to refuse to turn the person into the enmity itself. It means to withdraw the personal conflict, without rewriting morality.

When you tell an unconscious person “what you are doing is evil,” they often hear “you are evil.” The identification hardens, and the inner mechanism defends itself. When, however, you see that the person is driven by mechanisms they do not see, a radical change appears: you no

longer struggle with them. Not because the deed has become good, but because you see that the direct struggle with the person feeds the very mechanism that produces the deed. Forgiveness, in this sense, is the withdrawal from this struggle.

It is the refusal to keep feeding the conflict that keeps the mechanism alive. The inner mechanisms—fear, pride, the need for control, shame—live on opposition, tension, guilt, and confrontation. When someone no longer enters this game, the mechanism is left without fuel. This is the profound meaning of forgiveness in Yeshua. It is not a declaration that evil is no longer evil. It is a declaration that the person is no longer treated as identical with the evil they do.

The evil remains named as evil, but the personal conflict is withdrawn. In the light of this understanding, it becomes clear why Yeshua does not ask “Show them, Lord.” A forced revelation would have produced shame and defense. Instead, forgiveness creates the space in which, when the inner mechanism quiets, the person can come on their own to see the truth about their deed. Thus forgiveness is not the weakening of morality, but the condition in which morality can be seen without defense.

It is the withdrawal of conflict that allows the appearance of consciousness. The evil remains evil, but the person is no longer held captive in the identity of “evil.” This is the liberating force of forgiveness in Yeshua’s teaching: it does not change the truth about the deed; it changes our relationship with the person who did it.

Yeshua Rebukes Rarely

In the Gospels, Yeshua rarely rebukes vulnerable persons and often rebukes rigid structures. His rebuke does not aim to make anyone “feel small,” but to bring to light the mechanism in which someone is caught. When he says to Peter “Get behind me, Satan” in Matthew 16:23, he does not humiliate Peter; he unmask the source of his thinking in that moment. Peter is not reduced to his mistake; immediately afterward, he remains in Yeshua’s proximity.

When he pronounces the series of “woes” against the Pharisees in Matthew 23, the rebuke is public and cutting, because the target is not fragile but a system consolidated in hypocrisy. There the rebuke serves to break the moral armor into which nothing any longer penetrates. By contrast, toward those caught in shame, Yeshua does not rebuke but creates space. To the woman caught in adultery he says “Neither do I condemn you” in John 8:11.

To Peter after his denial he does not deliver a sermon, but restores him through a gentle dialogue in John 21:15–17. In Yeshua, rebuke appears when a person is identified with a rigid, powerful mechanism. And even then, the aim is not punishment but unmasking. In Paul, rebuke takes on a more organizational role. The communities are fragile, moral and doctrinal slippages appear, and he uses rebuke as an instrument for preserving order.

In Galatians 2:11, Paul says that he rebuked Peter “to his face, because he stood condemned.” Here the rebuke is public and direct, because what is at stake is the influence over the community. In 2 Timothy 4:2, Paul explicitly urges: “reprove, rebuke, exhort.” Rebuke becomes part of the pedagogy of the spiritual leader. In Paul, rebuke is no longer so finely calibrated to the inner state of the person, but to the effect of their behavior on the community.

The emphasis shifts from healing the mechanism to correcting the behavior. In many forms of contemporary Christianity, rebuke has become predominantly moral. It aims to show a person that they are wrong, often with the intention of making them feel guilty so that they will change. Here an inversion of Yeshua’s logic appears. Rebuke no longer unmask the mechanism; it labels the person. It no longer creates space for consciousness; it activates shame and defense. This is why, in practice, modern rebuke often produces outward conformity or inward rebellion, but rarely consciousness. In Yeshua, rebuke is rare, precise, and directed toward the mechanism, not toward the person’s identity. In Paul, rebuke is a necessary instrument for the health of the community. In the Christianity of today, rebuke is frequently used as a moral instrument, losing its original therapeutic finesse.

This is why, in Yeshua, rebuke can coexist with forgiveness without contradiction. Because it does not enter into conflict with the person, but brings to light what holds them captive.

Conflict in Yeshua

The image of Yeshua is often reduced either to a gentleness without edges, or to a prophet permanently in opposition. Both directions miss the reality in the Gospels: Yeshua does not seek conflict, but he does not avoid it when truth and life are threatened. His conflict is asymmetrical. It is not with people, but with the structures that produce fear, exclusion, and falsehood.

While in Paul conflict shifts toward the defense of the message and the community, in later Christianity conflict often becomes identity and, sometimes, even strategy. Yeshua frequently enters into conflict, but not out of reaction. He does not engage in polemics to win debates, and he does not seek to humiliate his adversaries. When conflict appears, it appears as a side effect of truth lived.

“You have heard that it was said... but I say to you” (Matthew 5) is not gratuitous provocation but a reorientation of consciousness. His conflicts are oriented vertically—truth versus falsehood—not horizontally, us versus them. This is why he can be extremely direct with the religious leaders (“Woe to you...”, Matthew 23) and at the same time profoundly empathetic with the marginalized. The target is not the persons, but the roles and systems that weigh down on life.

“The Sabbath was made for man” (Mark 2:27) becomes a frontal confrontation with legalism, without hatred and without fear. Yeshua avoids escalation. When he is asked for a sign out of distrust, he refuses: “An evil and adulterous generation seeks for a sign” (Matthew 12:39). When he is pushed toward a political stance, he withdraws: “Jesus, knowing that they intended to come and take him by force to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself” (John 6:15).

When Peter draws the sword, Yeshua stops him: “Put your sword back in its place” (Matthew 26:52). His conflict does not seek victory,

but clarity. This is why “Blessed are the meek” (Matthew 5:5) is not opposed to firmness, but is its foundation. This attitude is seen most clearly in the way Yeshua redefines conflict through active non-violence: “Love your enemies” (Matthew 5:44). This is not capitulation, but a way out of the spiral of reaction.

Truth is not defended by force; it is shown through presence. “My kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36) clarifies the method: without coercion, without demonization. In the maximum moment of conflict—the cross—Yeshua remains within this logic: “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do” (Luke 23:34). The conflict does not turn into hatred; it remains lucidity. In Paul, the context shifts the emphasis. Fragile communities, external pressures, and internal confusions demand delimitation.

Conflict becomes an instrument for protecting the message. Paul polemicizes harshly against “a different gospel” (Galatians 1:6–9), defends apostolic authority (2 Corinthians 10–12), and draws moral and doctrinal boundaries. The language of battle appears as metaphor: “Fight the good fight of the faith” (1 Timothy 6:12). His conflict is rhetorical and normative: letters, warnings, communal discipline. The aim is not to humiliate the person, but to preserve cohesion and fidelity to the message.

“Purge the evil person from among you” (1 Corinthians 5:13) shows this protective function. This shift is pragmatic and necessary for survival, but it changes the perspective. Conflict is no longer only the effect of truth lived; it also becomes a means of preserving order. Truth is no longer only shown; it is also defended. Tension begins to be accepted as the price of stability. In later Christianity, this displacement intensifies.

Conflict is no longer the exception but the norm. The defense of doctrine, the combating of “heretics,” the maintenance of boundaries become central aims. The language of battle becomes normalized, and fear becomes the fuel. Yeshua’s essential distinction between person and system is lost. People come to be treated as problems. Gentleness becomes suspect, and non-violence seems naïve. “They tie up heavy

burdens and lay them on people's shoulders" (Matthew 23:4) takes on a painful resonance.

The difference of perspective becomes clear. In Yeshua, conflict is not sought, but it becomes inevitable when life is being defended. "The light has come into the world, and people loved the darkness rather than the light" (John 3:19). The target is the falsehood that holds a person captive, not the person themselves. The method remains consistently non-violent: truth spoken, presence assumed, the refusal to answer evil with evil. "I came that they may have life" (John 10:10) shows the aim: life, not victory.

In Paul, conflict protects the community and the message. In later Christianity, conflict comes to protect the system. There the inversion occurs. When conflict defends life, it is legitimate. When conflict defends the structure, it becomes an idol. Yeshua was not non-conflictual, but non-violent. He did not avoid tension; he refused hostility. Truth, for him, has no need of wars in order to remain truth.

It remains truth through what it produces: life, freedom, and whole human beings.

Temptation in Yeshua

In the Gospels, Yeshua is "tempted" (Matthew 4:1–11), but the temptation is not associated with shame or guilt. On the contrary, the episode in the wilderness has an initiatory character. The temptation does not defile Yeshua; it reveals the perspective from which he lives. It appears not as a moral threat, but as an existential clarification. The three temptations in the wilderness do not propose obvious immoralities, but apparently reasonable solutions.

The first proposes survival without trust—the reduction of life to immediate need: "Tell these stones to become bread" (Matthew 4:3). The second proposes security without responsibility—the forcing of God as guarantee: "Throw yourself down" (Matthew 4:6). The third proposes power without truth—control as a shortcut: "I will give you all the kingdoms" (Matthew 4:9). For Yeshua, temptation is the voice of the

ego, the logic of separation that says: solve it yourself, secure yourself, take control.

His response is not struggle but clarity. He sees the temptation and refuses it through truth—"It is written..." (Matthew 4:4, 7, 10). Temptation becomes the place where the ego is unmasked. This is why Yeshua can say: "The ruler of this world has no claim on me" (John 14:30). To be tempted does not mean to be weak, but to be set face to face with a choice of perspective.

The Lord's Prayer—"lead us not into temptation" (Matthew 6:13)—does not ask for the avoidance of difficult situations, but for protection from the logic of separation. In Yeshua, temptation is the danger of exchanging trust in the Father for the solutions of the ego. This is why he warns: "Watch and pray, that you may not enter into temptation" (Matthew 26:41). To "enter" into temptation means to adhere to the narrative of fear. Yeshua does not moralize temptation; he contextualizes it. Temptation is a proposal, not a guilt.

What matters is what you live from when it appears. This is why, in Yeshua, temptation does not define the person; the perspective from which they respond does. In Paul, temptation takes on a different tone. He recognizes its reality and promises help: "God will not let you be tempted beyond your strength" (1 Corinthians 10:13). Temptation becomes a test of fidelity and discipline. The tension between "flesh" and "Spirit" appears (Romans 7–8). The emphasis shifts from clarity to resistance.

Temptation is something to be overcome, not merely to be seen. Although Paul affirms that the struggle "is not against flesh and blood" (Ephesians 6:12), the language becomes militarized: armor, resistance, perseverance (Ephesians 6:13–17). The ego as an inner structure is less thematized; temptation is externalized as pressure or force. This shift helps fragile communities, but it changes the perspective: the spiritual life becomes a regime of tension.

Temptation is no longer an occasion for seeing, but a threat to salvation. In institutional Christianity, temptation is often hypermoralized (especially in the area of sexuality), externalized (the devil "attacks

you”), personalized (guilt and shame), and made permanent (anxious vigilance). The ego is no longer recognized as the source, but projected outward. The paradoxical result is that fear grows and the ego strengthens.

Temptation comes to be seen as proof of weakness, not as an invitation to awakening. The spiritual life becomes avoidance, not responsibility. This vision is foreign to Yeshua, who says: “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32). For him, temptation falls away when the falsehood is seen. In Yeshua, temptation is the proposal of the ego; its nature is existential, not moralistic; the solution is clarity and trust; temptation becomes a place of revelation.

In Paul, temptation is test and conflict; the emphasis falls on resistance and discipline; the language of battle appears; the community is protected. In later Christianity, temptation becomes an omnipresent threat; fear and shame are amplified; responsibility is externalized; the ego remains unseen. For Yeshua, to be tempted does not mean to be close to falling, but close to truth. Temptation is the moment in which the ego makes its offer. When the offer is seen, its power disappears.

It is not through struggle that temptation is passed, but through clarity. Temptation does not define you. The perspective from which you live does.

Sin According to Yeshua

When we read the New Testament attentively, we discover that the term “sin” is used for different realities, depending on the author who is speaking. Yeshua uses the language of sin rarely, relationally, and therapeutically; Paul transforms it into a central theological category; and later Christianity fixes it within a moral-juridical system. This is not a matter of simple terminological evolution, but of a change of perspective that modifies the image of the human being, of God, and of salvation.

For Yeshua, sin is neither a list of broken prohibitions nor an inherited ontological state. He never says that the human being is born

sinful or separated from God. On the contrary, he speaks of people as children of the Father (Matthew 5:45) and of a relationship that already exists, not one that has been lost.

In Yeshua, sin is not defined juridically and is not formulated as an accounting violation of a divine law; it is described through profoundly existential images that speak of the human being's condition. He calls it blindness, not deliberate guilt: "If you were blind, you would have no sin" (John 9:41), suggesting that the problem is not intentional wickedness but the incapacity to see.

He describes it as wandering, through the image of the lost sheep (Luke 15:4–7), where sin is not rebellion but a loss of direction. He speaks of spiritual sleep, of the dozing of consciousness (Matthew 25:5), of a hardened heart—that is, an inner rigidity that can no longer receive the truth (Mark 8:17)—and of a radical inattention to reality, summed up in the words from the cross: "they know not what they do" (Luke 23:34).

In all these images, sin is not presented as an offense against God, but as a state of not-seeing, of not-hearing, of not-being-present to the truth. In all these images, sin is not an offense against God, but a loss of inner orientation. The human being is not "evil," but disoriented. This is why Yeshua does not condemn but illuminates: "the truth will set you free" (John 8:32). Liberation comes through seeing, not through punishment.

When Yeshua says that "out of the heart come evil things" (Matthew 15:19), he is not affirming that the heart is corrupt by nature, but that an unclarified interior produces destructive behaviors. The solution is not external control, but the purification of the heart (Matthew 5:8). In Yeshua, what he does not do is as eloquent as what he says. He does not classify sins by degrees and does not construct exhaustive lists that order guilt into a moral hierarchy.

He does not condition forgiveness on a ritual atonement and does not require the carrying out of a sacred mechanism for the relationship to be restored. Moreover, Yeshua refuses to transform sin into an identity. He does not fix the human being in the label of "sinner," but sees beyond

the deed, toward the person and their possibility of return. In this way, sin remains a state that can be overcome, not a definition that closes the human being into a destiny.

In the episode of the woman caught in adultery (John 8:3–11), Yeshua acknowledges the reality of the deed but refuses to transform it into an existential sentence. “Neither do I condemn you” precedes any invitation to change. In Yeshua, forgiveness precedes correction. In Paul, the language changes decisively. Sin is no longer only individual wandering, but a universal condition: “all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God” (Romans 3:23).

Sin becomes a power that dwells in the human being and dominates them (Romans 7:17–23). In Paul, an important theological mutation appears in the way sin is understood. He introduces the idea of a sin that enters the world through Adam and that affects all of humanity as a transmitted condition, not merely as a personal state (Romans 5:12). Sin is no longer only wandering or not-seeing; it becomes a force that operates in history.

Within this framework, the opposition between flesh and Spirit appears, a structural tension within the human being, in which the desire for the good coexists with the inability to accomplish it. “For the good that I want to do, I do not do” (Romans 7:19). The human being is described as powerless to free themselves on their own, caught in a condition that surpasses them, and from this follows the necessity of an external saving intervention.

Salvation is no longer only awakening or return; it becomes liberation from an ontological state in which the human being cannot save themselves through their own consciousness. The scene of the woman caught in adultery is essential for understanding this order. Yeshua does not deny the deed, but he refuses to transform it into identity. “Neither do I condemn you” comes before “go, and sin no more” (John 8:11).

Forgiveness is not the moral reward for setting things right, but the fertile soil from which the setting-right can arise. For Yeshua, condemnation does not heal; clear seeing heals. In the Sermon on the

Mount, Yeshua radically shifts the meaning of sin from the deed to the heart. It is not killing that is the final problem, but the hatred that precedes it (Matthew 5:21–22). It is not external adultery that is the center, but the lust that fragments the interior (Matthew 5:27–28).

Sin is not the breaking of a rule, but a state of divided consciousness, lived out of fear, comparison, and self-defense. This is why Yeshua constantly attacks hypocrisy, judgment, and moral rigidity (Matthew 23): not because he minimizes evil, but because he sees its root more deeply. With Paul, the language changes decisively. Sin is no longer described predominantly as wandering, but as a universal condition into which the human being is born.

“Through one man sin entered the world” (Romans 5:12). “All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God” (Romans 3:23). Sin becomes a transpersonal power, almost a law that operates in the human being independently of their will (Romans 7:23). This shift produces a major change: sin precedes the deed. The human being no longer errs and then becomes estranged; they are already in a state of separation before any personal choice.

From this reading will later be born the doctrine of original sin, taken up and consolidated by institutional Christianity, even though Yeshua nowhere affirms that a child is born guilty or condemned (Romans 5:18–19). Pauline language is profoundly juridical: guilt, condemnation, justification, payment. “The wages of sin is death” (Romans 6:23). Salvation becomes the resolution of a legal problem between the human being and God.

Yeshua’s death is interpreted as the satisfaction of divine justice, as the necessary substitution for a guilt that must be paid (Romans 3:25; 2 Corinthians 5:21). This logic does not appear in the direct preaching of Yeshua, who does not speak of a God who must be appeased, but of a Father who must be recognized. The shift in meaning is subtle but profound. For Yeshua, transformation comes from “seeing”: the truth liberates because it dissolves fear (John 8:32).

For Paul, the emphasis shifts to faith in an external saving event: “if you confess with your mouth...” (Romans 10:9). Sin is no longer

overcome through an awakening of consciousness, but through doctrinal adherence. The Christianity that followed Yeshua—and largely the Christianity of today—has chosen the Pauline paradigm. Not because Yeshua was insufficient, but because religious systems function more efficiently on guilt than on freedom, on fear than on seeing.

Guilt can be administered, forgiveness can be conditioned, salvation can be distributed. Inner awakening, however, cannot be controlled. Yeshua did not come to convince us that we are lost. He came to show us that we live from a mistaken perception about ourselves and about God. For him, sin is not a sentence. It is inattention to life. And salvation is not the way out of a condemnation, but the return to what has always been true.

“The Sinful Nature” in Yeshua

Yeshua never formulates a theory about “the sinful nature” as a human nature that is irremediably corrupt. His language is oriented constantly toward seeing and blindness, toward consciousness and unconsciousness. When he says on the cross “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do,” recorded in Luke 23:34, the problem he names is not an ontologically evil nature but a lack of seeing. People are not presented as evil in essence, but as blind to the mechanisms that drive them.

The same perspective appears when he speaks of “the log in your eye” in Matthew 7:3–5. The emphasis falls not on a corrupt nature, but on an inner mechanism that distorts perception. The problem is not what the human being is in essence, but how they see. This is why Yeshua says in Matthew 6:22 that “if your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light.” The language is one of inner clarity, not of a condemned identity.

When he affirms that “out of the heart come evil thoughts” (Matthew 15:18–19), he is not suggesting that the heart is evil by nature, but that it is unclear, unilluminated, caught in unconscious mechanisms. Evil appears as the effect of this lack of clarity, not as the expression of an

irremediably corrupt essence. In Paul, the perspective takes on a different language. In the epistles, the idea appears of a “nature” that works actively against the human being.

In Romans 7:18, Paul says that “nothing good dwells in me, that is, in my earthly nature.” In Galatians 5:17, he affirms that “the nature desires against the Spirit.” Here, sin is no longer described as a lack of seeing, but as an inner force, a principle that pushes the human being in the wrong direction. The language shifts from clarity and blindness to inner conflict between two natures. The solution is no longer only illumination, but death to this nature and life in the Spirit.

The emphasis falls on struggle, not on seeing. In many forms of contemporary Christianity, this Pauline perspective has been amplified to the point of becoming identitarian. The human being is defined first of all as having a sinful nature. The emphasis falls on guilt, on inner corruption, and on the need for moral correction. In this framework, the principal problem is no longer blindness, but the nature of the human being itself. Thus Yeshua’s nuance is often lost.

Instead of sin being seen as the result of unconsciousness and of unseen inner mechanisms, it becomes an identity label. Instead of the solution being clarity and consciousness, the solution becomes moral discipline and the continual struggle with oneself. The difference between these perspectives radically changes the approach. In Yeshua, healing comes through inner illumination and the recovery of sight. In Paul, healing comes through the conflict between nature and Spirit.

In present-day Christianity, healing is often sought through moral correction and outward conformity. In Yeshua’s language, the human being is not evil by nature, but blinded by mechanisms. This is why he speaks of seeing, forgiveness, and clarity, not of a nature irremediably corrupt.

Why Are People “Evil”?

Yeshua and Paul sometimes use the same vocabulary—sin, evil, guilt—but they speak of different realities. This difference will profoundly

shape later Christianity and the way the human being comes to look upon themselves. For Yeshua, evil is not the essence of the human being. He never says that the human being is evil by nature or that they were born irremediably corrupt. His language is diagnostic, not condemnatory.

When he speaks of evil, Yeshua locates it in ignorance, fear, and disorientation. The statement spoken on the cross, “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do” (Luke 23:34), is the key to his anthropology: evil does not come from a conscious satanic will, but from the lack of seeing. People do evil because they do not see the consequences, do not see the truth, do not see the other as themselves.

This is why Yeshua constantly uses metaphors such as blindness —“For judgment I came into this world, that those who do not see may see” (John 9:39–41)—wandering, as in the parable of the lost sheep (Luke 15:4–7), sleep and inattention, as in the parable of the sleeping virgins (Matthew 25:5), or the hardened heart: “Do you not yet understand? Are your hearts hardened?” (Mark 8:17). Evil is not a substance, but a state of consciousness. The human being is not “evil,” but disconnected.

When Yeshua says that “out of the heart come evil thoughts” (Matthew 15:19), he is not affirming that the heart is fundamentally corrupt, but that an unformed interior produces destructive behaviors. The “heart” is the center of a person’s orientation. If this center is dominated by fear, comparison, judgment, and the desire for control, the result will be evil. But the solution is not to replace the heart, but to awaken it.

This is why Yeshua’s response is not punishment, but truth—“you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32)—love —“love your enemies” (Matthew 5:44)—forgiveness—“seventy times seven” (Matthew 18:22)—and purity of heart—“blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God” (Matthew 5:8). For Yeshua, the human being is curable. Even when he acknowledges human ambivalence, Yeshua does not demonize the human being.

“If you, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children...” (Matthew 7:11) shows that people can be immature, reactive, wounded, and yet capable of good. Evil does not annul the good; it overshadows it. This is why Yeshua eats with sinners and tax collectors and says: “I came not to call the righteous, but sinners” (Matthew 9:10–13). The human being is not reduced to their worst deed. In Paul, the perspective changes profoundly. Evil is no longer first of all blindness, but a state.

“All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God” (Romans 3:23) becomes the universal statement about the human condition. Paul speaks of sin as a power that dwells in the human being: “It is no longer I who do it, but sin that dwells within me” (Romans 7:17). The human being does not merely do evil; they are under sin. From here arises the idea of a radical powerlessness: “I want to do good, but I cannot” (Romans 7:18). This is a major change from Yeshua.

In Paul, the problem is no longer only the lack of seeing, but captivity. The explanation becomes theological: “Through one man sin entered the world” (Romans 5:12). Ignorance is no longer sufficient as an explanation. The human being needs external intervention. From here comes the necessity of the cross as a juridical and ontological resolution of the problem of sin. Later Christianity will accentuate this direction to the very end.

The human being comes to be described as sinful by nature, guilty before any deed, ontologically separated from God. Evil is no longer something that happens within the human being, but something that defines the human being. From this derive the theology of guilt, the fear of punishment, the obsession with individual salvation, and the permanent need for justification. Forgiveness is no longer light that heals, but a sentence annulled. The human being is no longer seen as a sick person who needs truth, but as a guilty person who needs acquittal.

The difference of perspective is clear. In Yeshua, evil springs from a lack of seeing: the human being does evil because they live in a fragmented consciousness, blinded by fear and separation. The solution is awakening. In Paul, the human being is under sin, caught in a

condition from which they cannot free themselves on their own. The solution is the intervention of grace.

In later Christianity, the human being becomes almost exclusively defined by sin, and the present life is pushed into the background, in expectation of a resolution beyond it. Yeshua starts from the idea that people are blind. Paul starts from the idea that people are guilty. Later Christianity often comes to start from the idea that people are dangerous. The difference is not one of nuance, but of vision about the human being. Yeshua sees in the human being something to be awakened.

Later theology sees in the human being something to be corrected. And from this difference are born two completely different ways of living one's faith.

The Value of the Human Being in Yeshua

In Yeshua, the value of the human being is the premise, not the reward. The human being does not acquire value after they change; they are treated as valuable before any change. This is why he draws near without conditions, eats with tax collectors and sinners, and says that he came precisely to call those who do not fit the religious standards: "I came not to call the righteous, but sinners" (Luke 5:32).

The call does not proceed from moral evaluation, but from the recognition of a dignity already present. When the disciples want to keep the children at a distance, Yeshua stops the filter and says: "Let the children come to me" (Mark 10:14). When the crowd wants to punish the woman caught in adultery, he restores her dignity before any correction: "Neither do I condemn you" (John 8:11). In the parable of the Samaritan, value does not depend on religious identity, but on compassion lived (Luke 10:33).

For Yeshua, the human being is not defined by their fall, but by the possibility of becoming whole. "Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God" (Matthew 5:8) presupposes that the heart can become clear, and "the Kingdom of God is within you" (Luke 17:21) presuppos-

es that the place of the encounter with God is already within the human being. The value of the human being is the starting point of his work, not its result. In Paul, the perspective starts from a different place.

“All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God” (Romans 3:23) describes the human being first of all as lacking and fallen. This is why their value no longer appears as a premise, but as the result of Christ’s intervention: “God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8). For Paul, the dignity of the human being is real, but it must be restored.

The human being is a “vessel of clay” (2 Corinthians 4:7), the bearer of a treasure that does not come from themselves. The emphasis falls on grace, and value is not denied, but is understood as vulnerable and dependent on salvation. This is why Paul’s language is tense and often internally conflicted: “I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want is what I do” (Romans 7:19). The human being is precious because they are loved by God, but also fragile because they are under sin.

The value is real, but wounded, and needs continual support through grace. In many forms of contemporary Christianity, a subtle shift has occurred. The value of the human being comes to be conditioned by their correct positioning. It is no longer a premise, as in Yeshua, nor a restored gift, as in Paul, but a status granted to those who believe correctly and conform. Verses such as “whoever does not believe will be condemned” (Mark 16:16) are read as a delimitation of identity.

The emphasis falls on belonging, on doctrine, on visible morality. The human being is easily reduced to labels, and shame and guilt become pedagogical instruments. Dignity sometimes seems suspended until one is set right. Now the paradox appears: while Yeshua starts from the value of the human being in order to heal them, some forms of Christianity start from the human being’s problem in order to offer them value only after correction. The difference of perspective becomes clear when it is stated simply.

Yeshua sees in the human being something to be awakened. Paul sees in the human being something to be restored. Contemporary Christianity often sees in the human being something to be corrected. This is

why Yeshua can sit calmly with sinners without first demanding their change. Paul calls for transformation in order to protect the new life. And the Christianity of today sometimes demands the change in order to grant acceptance. For Yeshua, the human being is valuable before they are good. For Paul, the human being becomes valuable through grace.

For contemporary Christianity, the human being is often valuable if they align themselves. And here one feels the different tone of the Gospels. Yeshua does not speak with worthless people whom he must save, but with valuable people who have forgotten who they are. “You are the light of the world” (Matthew 5:14) is not a promise for later, but a recognition for now.

“The Log in Your Eye” — The Order of Consciousness Before Correction

In the Sermon on the Mount, Yeshua speaks one of the best known and, at the same time, least understood images: “Why do you see the speck in your brother’s eye, but do not notice the log in your own eye? ... First take the log out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your brother’s eye” (the Gospel according to Matthew 7:3–5). This statement is not a lesson in moral politeness, nor an exhortation to passive tolerance.

It is a profound lesson about the mechanisms of unconsciousness and about the order in which consciousness appears. The “speck” represents the visible mistake of the other, their behavior, what bothers us about them and what we feel the need to correct. It is the external part, easy to observe, easy to name, easy to judge. The “log,” however, is not a visible mistake, but the inner state from which we look at the other.

It is our irritation, our moral superiority, our need to correct, our pride that we “see better,” the inner trigger activated by the other’s behavior. The very fact that we see the speck so clearly shows that the log is active. Yeshua suggests that the intensity with which the other’s mistake bothers us is, in fact, an indicator of our own inner mechanism.

He does not say that the speck does not exist, nor that it should not be removed.

He says that the order is essential: first the log, then the speck. This order completely changes how we understand correction. If the log is still in our eye, the correction will come from pride, from irritation, from the need to prove ourselves, from inner tension. Even if what we say is morally correct, the inner place from which we say it is unconscious. Truth spoken from a mechanism does not bring consciousness, but conflict. This is why Yeshua adds: “then you will see clearly.”

Clear seeing is not about observing the other’s mistake more keenly, but about seeing them without the filter of our mechanisms. After the log is removed, there is no more irritation, no more superiority, no more tension. There is no more need to correct in order to confirm ourselves. In this state, correction becomes possible without conflict. It is no longer a confrontation between two prides, but a clear gesture of consciousness.

Only here is the help real, because it is no longer contaminated by the personal mechanism. The connection of this image with forgiveness is direct. The log is exactly what forgiveness dissolves. Forgiveness withdraws the tension, withdraws the inner conflict, withdraws the need to judge and to prove. In the absence of this tension, seeing becomes clear. For Yeshua, correcting another is the last step, not the first. The first step is your own healing from the mechanism out of which you would want to correct them.

Only after this healing can you see the speck without still carrying the log.

Why Yeshua Does Not Rebuke the Prostitutes

In the Gospels, a fact appears that stands out by contrast: Yeshua never rebukes the prostitutes. Not because he considers the deed good, but because he sees clearly the inner state of the person before him. In the encounter with the woman known as a sinner in the Pharisee’s house,

recorded in the Gospel according to Luke 7:36–50, Yeshua does not scold her, does not expose her, does not moralize her.

Instead, he says to her: “Your sins are forgiven... Your faith has saved you; go in peace.” For Yeshua, this woman has no need of rebuke, because her mechanism is already broken by shame, pain, and awareness. She does not come with defensiveness, but with inner brokenness. In this state, rebuke would be useless and even harmful. This is why Yeshua offers exactly the opposite: space, dignity, and forgiveness.

The same pattern appears in the encounter with the woman caught in adultery in the Gospel according to John 8:3–11. Before a crowd ready to condemn her, Yeshua shifts the attention from her deed to the state of those who accuse her: “Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone.” Then he says to the woman: “Neither do I condemn you. Go, and sin no more.” There is no rebuke, but a restoration of consciousness without humiliation.

In Yeshua, rebuke is reserved for those who are blocked in moral pride and self-assurance, not for those already inwardly broken. The prostitutes, the tax collectors, the public sinners are treated with gentleness, while the Pharisees, certain of their own righteousness, receive the harshest words, as is seen in Matthew 23. In Paul, the tone changes visibly. In the epistles, prostitution is mentioned directly as a practice to be avoided in the community.

In 1 Corinthians 6:15–18, Paul says clearly: “Flee from sexual immorality... The one who joins himself to a prostitute becomes one body with her.” Here the emphasis is no longer on the inner state of the person, but on protecting the community and preserving a clear moral standard. In Paul, rebuke has an educative and disciplinary role. It is no longer finely calibrated to a person’s level of inner brokenness, but to the necessity of correcting behaviors that affect communal life.

In contemporary Christianity, this Pauline line has become dominant. Prostitution is often treated first of all as a moral problem, and the person is viewed through the lens of the deed. Frequently, the approach is one of condemnation, shaming, or moral pressure, losing the finesse with which Yeshua saw the human being behind the behavior.

The essential difference remains this: Yeshua looks first at the inner state of the person and decides whether rebuke would awaken consciousness or deepen the shame. Paul and later Christianity look first at the behavior and at its effect on the community. This is why, in the Gospels, the prostitutes are not rebuked, but restored. In the Pauline writings and in the practice of many forms of Christianity today, they are first of all morally corrected.

Why Yeshua Forgives Without Sacrifice

One of the most unsettling differences between Yeshua's message and later Christian theology is this: Yeshua forgives without sacrifice. Not just occasionally. Not as an exception. But as a constant way of being. For a practicing Christian, this idea sounds like blasphemy. Christianity affirms clearly, "Yeshua forgave on the basis of the sacrifice that was to be himself." But that is what Paul says, not Yeshua. Yeshua never said, "I forgive you because I will die for it."

In a religious world in which forgiveness was tightly bound to the Temple, to blood, to the altar, and to intermediaries, Yeshua grants forgiveness directly, personally, and unconditionally. He does not send the human being to bring an offering before forgiving them; on the contrary, forgiveness often precedes any correction or visible change (Mark 2:5; Luke 7:48). This practice is not a theological oversight. It is a radical affirmation about the nature of God.

In classical religious logic, sin creates a debt, and forgiveness presupposes a compensation. Sacrifice is the mechanism by which the balance is restored. This logic is present in the Levitical system and will be taken up, reinterpreted, and amplified later in Pauline theology. Yeshua, however, does not operate within a transactional framework. When the paralytic is brought before him, Yeshua does not say: "bring a sacrifice," nor "pray for forgiveness," nor "go to the priests."

He says simply: "Son, your sins are forgiven" (Mark 2:5). The reaction of those present is revealing: "Who can forgive sins but God alone?" (Mark 2:7). Their question is correct. Yeshua's implicit answer

is even more radical: God is not separated from this act of forgiveness. In Yeshua's encounters with people considered "sinners," forgiveness does not appear as a reward for repentance, but as the unveiling of a reality already present.

The woman who washes his feet with her tears does not receive forgiveness because she wept; she weeps because something has already been recognized within her. Yeshua says: "Her sins, which are many, are forgiven; therefore she loved much" (Luke 7:47). The order is important. Love does not buy forgiveness; forgiveness frees love. In this framework, sacrifice becomes unnecessary—not because sin is trivial, but because forgiveness does not repair a broken relationship; it unveils a relationship that was never interrupted.

God Need Not Be Appeased

One of the most profound things Yeshua does is to eliminate the idea of a God who must be convinced, persuaded, or satisfied. In the parable of the prodigal son, the father does not wait for explanations, does not demand compensation, does not require penance. He runs toward the son before he finishes his speech of guilt (Luke 15:20). This image is essential. The God of Yeshua is not a heavenly creditor. He is a presence that restores without keeping accounts.

If God is not offended in a juridical sense, then sacrifice is no longer necessary as a mechanism of reconciliation. Yeshua does not speak of sin as an ontological rupture between the human being and God. He speaks of blindness, loss, wandering, inattention (Matthew 13:15; Luke 19:10). If sin does not create a real separation, then sacrifice cannot "repair" something that was not broken.

What needs to be healed is not the relationship between God and the human being, but the human being's perception of this relationship. This is why Yeshua says: "Those who are well have no need of a physician, but those who are sick" (Mark 2:17). The physician does not pay for the illness. He treats it. Yeshua forgives not as the priest of a system, but as a spiritual authority who operates from within the divine

reality. This is why his gesture is perceived as scandalous. He bypasses the institution, the altar, the blood, the intermediaries.

Not because he despises them, but because he surpasses them. When he says: “I desire mercy, not sacrifice” (Matthew 9:13), Yeshua does not reject the tradition but reveals its limit. Sacrifice belongs to a stage of consciousness in which the relationship with God is mediated by fear. Mercy belongs to a stage in which the relationship is direct.

The Gravest Sins in Yeshua

The idea of a “grave sin” is not identical across all the strata of Christianity. It changes along with the perspective on the human being: in Yeshua, sin is what breaks the living relationship; in the Apostle Paul, sin is what threatens the truth and the community; in the Christianity of today, sin often becomes what violates a norm. The difference is not one of list, but of level of consciousness.

For Yeshua, the gravest sins are not the “visible” or scandalous ones, but those that close the heart. He does not insist obsessively on sexuality, money, or ritual, but on hypocrisy, the lack of mercy, voluntary blindness, and judgment. The Pharisees are rebuked not because they sin “more,” but because they can no longer see the human being. “Woe to you” is not a moral condemnation, but a diagnosis: you have lost contact with life. Yeshua identifies as grave the refusal of truth lived.

“The sin against the Holy Spirit” is not a one-time mistake, but the definitive closure toward correction, toward light, toward reality. Where a person can no longer recognize the good when they encounter it, transformation becomes impossible. In this logic, adultery, theft, or lying are curable; the hardening of the heart is not. For Yeshua, grave sin is anything that separates: it separates the human being from themselves, from the other, and from God.

This is why he can forgive deeds but harshly confront attitudes. It is not behavior that is the center, but the state of the heart from which behavior springs. In Paul, the emphasis shifts. Not because he denies

empathy, but because his mission is different: the building and protecting of communities. For him, the gravest sins become those that corrupt the truth or tear apart the body of the community.

Idolatry, immorality, division, heresy—all are dangerous because they pull the human being and the group in the wrong direction. Paul introduces a clearer hierarchy of sins, because he operates within a normative framework. The grave sin is what cannot coexist with the new identity in Christ. From here comes the language of temporary exclusion, discipline, and correction. Not out of cruelty, but out of the conviction that truth precedes comfort.

Yet this shift has a side effect: sin begins to be defined more through conformity than through consciousness. The human being is loved, but is constantly evaluated against a standard. Empathy remains, but it is conditioned by acceptance of the framework.

9. The Cross, Death, and the Christian Narrative

The Cross: Consequence, Not Plan

In classical Christianity, the cross becomes the absolute center: the plan of God, the mechanism of salvation, the pivot point of cosmic history. But in the Gospels, when you follow Yeshua step by step, you discover something else: the cross appears as the outcome of an inevitable collision, not as a plan explained, taught, and administered.

Yeshua enters a world structured on fear, purity, status, religious control, and political domination, and what he brings is a freedom that these systems cannot manage. The cross is born of the incompatibility between a man who cannot be bought and a system that cannot tolerate the existence of an unbuyable man.

Yeshua does not preach a God who demands blood in order to be able to forgive. He preaches a Father who already makes the sun rise on the good and the evil alike (Matthew 5:45), a God who seeks out the one who is lost (Luke 15:4–7), not a God who waits for payment in order to change his disposition. If forgiveness can be spoken directly, in front of a paralytic, without altar, without priest, without sacrifice (Mark 2:5), then the cross cannot be interpreted simply as the “price” without which God does not forgive. That would mean Yeshua forgave “illegally” before the price had been paid. It would turn the Gospels into an internal contradiction.

It is more coherent to see the cross as a historical event produced by a religious-political system that, confronted with freedom, responds by elimination. In this sense, the cross is not “the proof that God had to do this,” but the proof of how the world reacts to truth.

When Yeshua enters Jerusalem and strikes directly at the heart of the sacred economy—the space in which religion, commerce, and status keep one another alive—the gesture is not “mystical” but one of unmasking. He overturns the tables of the money changers and refuses to let “the Father’s house” be a marketplace (Mark 11:15–17). From here on, the conflict is no longer underground but frontal.

In the language of systems, Yeshua becomes a risk: not because he “taught beautifully,” but because his teaching produces people who can no longer be controlled through fear. When Peter raises his sword, Yeshua stops him: “Put your sword back in its place” (Matthew 26:52). This shows that Yeshua does not construct his death as a military victory or as an instrumental martyrdom. He does not seek to win through force.

He does not use violence to impose truth, because truth imposed is no longer truth but domination. Yet the refusal of violence has a cost in a violent world: the man who does not defend himself with the same weapons becomes vulnerable. The cross appears as the price of nonviolence, not as a divine requirement. Even the “must” in the passion announcements has this nature: “The Son of Man must suffer” (Mark 8:31).

Not because God demands it, but because this road is the logical consequence of how power works. Truth, when it does not negotiate, triggers a reaction. Love, when it cannot be corrupted, becomes a threat. Yeshua does not glorify suffering. He shows that, in a world built on fear, unconditional love will be interpreted as a danger. If you read the cross as a plan, you are left with a God who needs blood in order to forgive.

If you read the cross as a consequence, you are left with a God who forgives, and the cross becomes the mirror of the world: this is what the world looks like when it meets freedom. It is not a theory. It is a

revelation. When Yeshua speaks about the cross, he does so almost exclusively in relation to the disciples. “Whoever wants to come after me must deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me” (Mark 8:34). The cross is not presented as something he does in their place, but as something that discloses the truth about life.

Love without defense, truth without negotiation, and freedom without guarantees have a cost in a world governed by fear. Yeshua does not say “my cross saves you”; he shows what happens when a person lives without fear. The cross is not a theological instrument but a mirror. It does not explain; it exposes.

Why Yeshua’s Death Is Not Explained by Yeshua

For Yeshua, his death is not an object of theological explanation but an event he takes upon himself. He does not construct a doctrine of the cross, and he offers no theory about the necessity of his death. He never says that God demands blood, nor that his death is the condition of forgiveness, nor that it is a legal payment for sin. In his words, life is central, not death. “I have come that they may have life, and have it abundantly” (John 10:10).

To explain death would have shifted the center of gravity from life toward justification, from presence toward mechanism. Yeshua speaks about death only in the language of freedom and self-giving, not of divine necessity. “No one takes my life from me, but I lay it down of my own accord” (John 10:18). This statement does not explain why he must die, but how he enters death. Not as the victim of a heavenly plan, but as a free man who does not negotiate truth in order to save his biological existence. Death is not presented as the goal, but as the possible consequence of fidelity to love.

Another reason Yeshua does not explain his death is that the explanation would immediately have become an object of religious power. A theory about the cross could have been used to control, to make guilty, or to constrain. Yeshua constantly avoids this kind of authority. “My kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36).

To explain death in causal terms would have turned it into an instrument. His silence protects truth from becoming a weapon. In his teaching, Yeshua always shifts attention from explanation to relationship. He does not say: understand what is going to happen; he says: remain with me. “Remain in me, and I in you” (John 15:4). Death is not something to be understood beforehand, but something to be crossed without fear. Truth is not a logical conclusion but a state of presence.

This is why Yeshua does not prepare the minds of the disciples for a theory of the cross, but prepares their hearts for absence, loss, and disorientation. Yeshua also avoids explanation because his death is an act of disclosure, not an argument. The cross shows what happens when unconditional love meets fear organized into a system. “If they persecuted me, they will persecute you too” (John 15:20).

Death is not necessary in order to convince God; it becomes inevitable in a world that cannot tolerate truth lived to the very end. When Yeshua anticipates death, he does so in existential, not juridical, language. “Unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit” (John 12:24). This is not an explanation of a divine requirement, but a description of a pattern of life. True life does not defend itself at any price.

It gives itself away. Death is not the goal, but the risk that love takes upon itself in a world governed by fear. Yeshua does not explain his death because the explanation would have come too soon. Before the resurrection, any theory would have been interpreted as failure. After the resurrection, the explanation would have been redundant. The resurrection does not explain death; it relativizes it. “He is not here; he has risen” (Luke 24:6). Meaning is not attached to death, but to the life that passes through it.

In the end, Yeshua does not explain his death because he does not want people to relate to God through fear or duty. He does not say: believe correctly about the cross and you will be saved. He says: follow me. “Whoever wants to come after me must deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me” (Mark 8:34). The cross is not a concept to be

understood, but a reality to be taken on when truth becomes more important than safety.

Yeshua's silence is not a lack of meaning, but the protection of meaning. His death is not explained because it does not need to be justified. It does not explain the love of God; it exposes it. And what is exposed is not defended through theory, but recognized through encounter.

Yeshua Speaks About Death, but Not About Its Theological Function

Yeshua speaks repeatedly about the fact that he will be rejected, will suffer, and will be killed. The announcements are clear and repeated, without ambiguity: "The Son of Man must suffer many things, be rejected... and be killed" (Mark 8:31; Mark 9:31; Mark 10:33–34). Yeshua is not naïve about the consequences of the road he is walking.

He sees clearly that truth spoken without compromise provokes reaction, and that inner freedom threatens structures built on fear and control. The essential observation, however, is this: although he speaks about death, Yeshua never speaks about its theological function. He does not say that the Father demands blood; he does not affirm that divine justice must be satisfied; he does not speak of his death as the price of a cosmic debt. His language is not juridical but descriptive.

He says that "the Son of Man must suffer," not because God demands it, but because this is how systems of power react when they are confronted with truth (Mark 8:31). The word "must" appears frequently in Yeshua's speech, but this "must" has no legal or sacrificial sense. "The Son of Man must be lifted up" (John 3:14). "The Scriptures must be fulfilled" (Luke 24:44).

This "must" does not express a demand of God, but a coherence of reality. It describes what happens inevitably when truth is lived without negotiation in a world built on fear, moralism, and control. Yeshua's death is not necessary for God. It does not repair a relationship broken

in heaven. It does not change a divine disposition. It becomes inevitable in a world that cannot tolerate inner freedom and undefended love.

“If they persecuted me, they will persecute you too” (John 15:20). This is not a theology of sacrifice, but an anthropology of fear.

Why Yeshua Refuses to Offer a Complete Explanation

Yeshua refuses systemic explanations because explanations can become substitutes for living. If he had explained his death as a mechanism of salvation, people would have been tempted to believe something about him rather than to follow him. They would have transferred the responsibility for their transformation onto an external event and replaced presence with theology. This is why Yeshua does not say “understand what is going to happen to me,” but “follow me” (Mark 8:34). The call is not intellectual but existential.

His silence is not a lack of answer but pedagogy. It does not allow his death to become a mental object before it has been a living confrontation with fear, attachment, and the desire for safety.

Did Yeshua Die for Our Sins?

The statement “he died for our sins” is one of the most repeated formulas in Christianity. It seems clear, stable, definitive. And yet, when we view it through three different windows—Paul, Yeshua, and John—its meaning takes on unexpected depths. They do not contradict one another, but neither do they say exactly the same thing. Each places the emphasis differently: one theological, one existential, one relational. In Paul’s writings, the cross becomes the center of the formulation of salvation.

He affirms it without equivocation: “Christ died for our sins, according to the Scriptures” (1 Corinthians 15:3). The language is clear, almost juridical. Sin appears as an objective reality, as a real rupture between humanity and God, and Yeshua’s death is the act by which this rupture is resolved. From this logic is born the idea that a person is “justified by faith, apart from the works of the Law” (Romans 3:28).

The order is clear: first you are forgiven, then you are called to live differently. First comes the objective event of the cross, then the inner process of transformation. The emphasis falls on what Yeshua did for the human being.

If, however, we return to the words and life of Yeshua, we notice something surprising: he never preaches the theory “I will die for your sins.” His message is something else: “Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near” (Matthew 4:17).

He speaks of metanoia, of a change in the way of seeing and of living, of a life that comes out of fear and enters into truth. His death is not announced as a payment demanded by God, but as the natural outcome of a life that refuses compromise with violence, power, and falsehood. When he says, “There is no greater love than to lay down one’s life for one’s friends” (John 15:13), he is not describing a divine transaction, but the nature of love carried to the very end.

In this light, “he died for our sins” takes on a different meaning: Yeshua enters fully into the human condition, bears our rejection, our hatred, our fear, and our violence without responding in kind. On the cross we do not see God demanding satisfaction, but humanity revealing its own blindness and Yeshua revealing a love that does not withdraw. His words, “Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing” (Luke 23:34), are not a juridical ritual, but an unmasking of sin and its dissolution in light.

Sin is not “paid for,” but exposed in all its reality, and love is not defeated by it. John, in the famous verse, brings a third nuance: “For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, so that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life” (John 3:16). Here the language is not juridical but relational. God “gives” not in order to demand satisfaction, but in order to reveal himself.

This is why the continuation is essential: “God did not send the Son into the world to judge the world, but in order that the world might be saved through him” (John 3:17). The emphasis falls on the love that is revealed, not on the punishment that is avoided. In John, “to believe” does not mean to accept a theological transaction, but to enter into a

living relationship. “Whoever remains in love remains in God” (1 John 4:16). Eternal life does not begin after death; it begins now, as participation in this love.

It is not a future reward but a present state. If we set these three perspectives side by side, a subtle but decisive difference appears. In Paul, the order is: death → forgiveness → transformation. In Yeshua, the order is: truth lived → conflict with the world → death → revelation. In John, the order is: love revealed → faith as relationship → eternal life. They do not exclude one another, but neither do they say the same thing. Paul formulates the theological meaning of the cross.

Yeshua lives the existential meaning. John discloses the relational meaning. Spoken in the language of Yeshua, Paul’s statement can be heard differently: he died “for our sins” not in order to pay for them in our place, but in order to show us where they lead. Not in order to change the heart of God, but in order to open ours. The cross is not a gesture by which God is reconciled to humanity, but a mirror in which the human being sees what fear produces and what love produces when it does not withdraw.

In this mirror, the words “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) take on a concrete meaning. This is why, if we remain only with Paul’s formulation, we risk having a doctrine of the cross without transformation. If we listen to Yeshua, the cross ceases to be merely something we believe in and becomes a way of living. “Whoever wants to come after me must deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me” (Mark 8:34) is not an invitation to suffering, but to coming out of fear.

It is not the call to die physically, but to stop living out of the mechanisms that led to the cross. Thus, “he died for our sins” can be read in three registers that complete one another: as sacrifice in the language of Paul, as love carried to the very end in the life of Yeshua, and as an invitation to living participation in the language of John.

And the full meaning lies not in choosing one against the others, but in seeing them together, as three ways of describing the same mystery: love that does not withdraw in the face of sin, but transforms it from within.

Why Did Yeshua Not Come Down from the Cross?

Perhaps Yeshua does not come down from the cross because, in that moment, there is no longer anything to defend. Not an image. Not status. Not personal vindication. Not even his own biological life. The cross is the place where the ego's last negotiation with existence disappears. It is the total acceptance of loss. And the ego cannot do this.

The ego can temporarily sacrifice something for a greater gain; it can endure if it knows it will be rewarded; it can even suffer if suffering grants it a special identity. But it cannot accept pure loss. It cannot go all the way without the guarantee of recovery. The entire structure of the ego operates through self-preservation. Let me not lose control. Let me not lose validation. Let me not lose love. Let me not lose the image I have of myself. Let me not lose my position.

Let me not lose the meaning I have built for myself. Even many of the religious forms a person adopts preserve the same logic: I humble myself in order to be exalted, I love in order to be loved, I forgive in order to be forgiven, I give up in order to receive more later. The ego knows how to hide even within spirituality. It can turn even sacrifice into an investment.

But in Yeshua there seems to be something that goes beyond transaction. Beyond calculation. Beyond the need to recover something for oneself. This is why the cross is so hard to look at. Because it exposes the fundamental illusion of the human being: the conviction that his existence depends on what he can keep. Perhaps it is precisely here that sin takes on a deeper meaning than the mere breaking of a rule. Sin becomes inner separation. The rupture between a person and what he is before the mask. Before fear. Before the defensively constructed identity.

A person becomes so identified with his mechanisms of defense that he no longer knows who he is without them. He defends his image until he loses his soul. He defends his ego until he separates himself from life. The cross thus becomes the place where this separation begins to die. Not through violence, but through total surrender. Because when a

person accepts the possibility of complete loss, something paradoxical appears: an inner unity that the ego can never produce.

As long as you have to win in order to exist, you will live fragmented. You will always be dependent on the outcome. Always at war with reality. Always in fear. Yeshua seems to enter the cross without this inner struggle. This is why he is so silent. The ego constantly needs to justify itself, to prove itself, to defend itself. Truth does not. Truth can be rejected without becoming violent. It can be mocked without hating. It can be crucified without turning into its opposite.

And perhaps the most profound thing is not that Yeshua dies, but that he does not try to save himself through the same logic by which the world is always trying to save itself. The crowd says: "If you are the Son of God, come down from the cross" (Matthew 27:40). But it is precisely here that the difference between the consciousness of the ego and the consciousness of the kingdom is revealed. For the ego, power means the capacity to avoid loss.

For Yeshua, true freedom seems to begin in the moment when you are no longer defined by what you can lose. And yet, the question of the resurrection remains. Because there is a way of understanding the resurrection that completely cancels the meaning of the cross. If the resurrection becomes merely the hero's final triumph, then the cross risks being reduced to a temporary stage before victory. As if the loss had not been real. As if everything had been merely a cosmic strategy for winning.

In this reading, the ego can go on functioning calmly, because it knows that in the end it is the one who will receive the trophy. But perhaps the resurrection is not the return of the glorified ego. Perhaps it is not the psychological "self" that rises. Not the identity that needed to be validated, defended, and continued. Perhaps the resurrection is the revelation that what is real in a human being cannot be destroyed by death because it was never born of the ego.

Then the cross and the resurrection are no longer opposites. The cross is the death of the false. The resurrection is what remains when the false falls away. The cross destroys the illusion of the separate self.

The resurrection reveals the life that already existed beyond this illusion. In this light, Yeshua does not “win” after he loses. Because where there is still a need for victory, the ego has not died completely. Rather, through the cross, everything that could be lost disappears.

And through the resurrection, what could never be lost is revealed. Perhaps this is why truth sets free. Not because it offers the ego a more sophisticated spiritual victory, but because it dissolves the very structure that permanently needed victory.

10. Yeshua vs. Paul

Did Yeshua Want a Doctrine Developed After Him? Did He Want a Paul?

Yeshua leaves behind no doctrinal blueprint, but a way of life. He does not ask for theological systematization, but for discipleship; not for metaphysical clarifications, but for transformation. Yeshua never speaks of “developing doctrine.” His constant call is: “Follow me” (Mark 1:17), “Remain in me” (John 15:4), “Learn from me” (Matthew 11:29). These are not invitations to theological elaboration, but to living imitation.

Truth, for Yeshua, is not a formula to be refined, but a reality to be lived: “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6). Here, “the truth” is not a set of correct propositions, but an existential direction. This is why Yeshua establishes no theological schools, leaves no treatises, and sets up no canon of interpretation. He says explicitly that understanding will remain partial: “I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now” (John 16:12).

This statement is not an invitation to a future doctrine, but a recognition of the gradual maturing of consciousness. Its continuation is entrusted to the Spirit, not to theologians: “The Spirit of truth will guide you into all truth” (John 16:13). The emphasis falls on guidance, not on codification. Did Yeshua want the message to reach the nations? Yes — but not in the form of an exportable doctrine, but as a visible life.

Yeshua says that the news of the Kingdom will reach “to the ends of the earth” (Matthew 24:14), yet he himself limits his public mission to

Israel: “I was sent only to the lost sheep of the house of Israel” (Matthew 15:24). The opening toward the nations appears through concrete examples, not through a systematic missionary plan: the Roman centurion praised for his faith (Matthew 8:10), the Canaanite woman who is heard (Matthew 15:28), the Samaritan held up as a model (Luke 10:33–37).

The universal, for Yeshua, is the recognition of truth wherever it appears, not the imposition of a single framework. The “Great Commission” (“go and make disciples of all nations” — Matthew 28:19) is often cited as a global doctrinal mandate. Even here, however, the language is that of discipleship, not of dogmatizing: “teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you.” Yeshua’s commandments are ethical and relational (love, forgiveness, truth), not theological schemes. Did Yeshua want an apostle Paul?

In the Gospels, Paul does not appear and is not explicitly anticipated. The Twelve are chosen symbolically (Mark 3:14–19) to represent the reconstitution of Israel, not to inaugurate a worldwide theological elite. Yeshua does not say that other apostles will come with independent revelations, nor does he explicitly open the way for a parallel authority. On the contrary, he warns: “Many will come in my name” (Matthew 24:5), calling for discernment.

Why Does Paul Claim That Yeshua Appeared to Him?

Paul grounds his authority in a personal revelatory experience: “Have I not seen Jesus our Lord?” (1 Corinthians 9:1; Galatians 1:15–16). For Paul, this experience is equivalent to the apostolic calling. He stresses that he did not receive the gospel “from man” (Galatians 1:12), but through revelation. This statement is decisive: Paul founds his legitimacy not on historical continuity, but on direct experience.

Is Paul’s self-proclamation as an apostle legitimate? The answer depends on the criterion used. From the standpoint of religious experience, Paul is consistent: he describes a calling that changes his life radically (Acts 9). From the standpoint of the community, his

legitimacy is negotiated: Paul enters into tensions with the apostles in Jerusalem (Galatians 2), is contested (“is he not an apostle?” — 2 Corinthians 10–12), and constantly defends his authority.

This shows that his apostleship was neither self-evident nor unanimously accepted from the start. Moreover, Paul explicitly takes on the role of interpreter and systematizer. He shifts the center of gravity from the lived Kingdom to the Christ-event (the cross and the resurrection) and to justification by faith (Romans 3–5). This shift is decisive for the birth of Christian doctrine. But it is, at the same time, a development that does not appear as such in Yeshua’s direct preaching.

From this arises a difference of perspective: Yeshua calls people to follow. Paul calls people to believe in a message. Yeshua lives the truth and invites imitation. Paul explains the truth and demands assent. This does not automatically make Paul’s enterprise “illegitimate,” but it makes it distinct. Paul does not simply continue what Yeshua said; he interprets and translates the message for a new world, at the price of introducing a more juridical, more doctrinal, more universalizable theology.

From this comes both the force and the tension of later Christianity. Yeshua did not leave a plan for doctrinal development. He left a life to be lived. Paul is not “the voice of Yeshua,” but his interpreter. His authority comes from experience and from the reception of the communities, not from an explicit mandate of Yeshua in the Gospels. Today’s Christianity rests, in large part, on this Pauline interpretation. To understand this is not to reject Paul, but to avoid confusing him with Yeshua.

How Yeshua Would Have Seen Someone Like Paul

The first thing Yeshua would have seen in Paul is intensity. Paul is a man of the absolute: before, a persecutor “full of zeal” (Philippians 3:6); after the experience on the road, a herald just as radical. Yeshua does not reject passionate people. On the contrary, he often meets the “fiery”

ones (Peter, the sons of thunder) and transforms them. For Yeshua, the problem is not the fire, but the direction of the fire.

That is why he probably would not have condemned Paul for his zeal, but would have asked him: from what does it spring? (cf. Matthew 7:16). Yeshua would also have recognized Paul's real experience. In the Gospels, Yeshua validates experiences that produce transformation: "by their fruits" (Matthew 7:20). Paul's conversion is profound and verifiable: from persecutor he becomes servant; from violent man, sufferer; from self-assured, vulnerable (Galatians 1:13–24; 2 Corinthians 11).

Yeshua does not deny an authentic experience merely because it fails to conform to an institutional structure. He says: "The wind blows where it wishes" (John 3:8). But Yeshua would have paid attention to the language. Here is where the tension appears. Yeshua's language is relational, paradoxical, oriented toward the heart: "follow me," "do not be afraid," "love." Paul's language is explanatory, juridical, systematizing: justification, condemnation, death, life, faith, flesh, law.

Yeshua does not reject explanation, but he constantly warns against substituting explanation for life: "You search the Scriptures... yet you refuse to come to me that you may have life" (John 5:39–40). Here Yeshua would have challenged Paul: do you explain life, or do you replace it with explanation? Yeshua would also have noticed the tension of authority. Paul affirms his apostleship through personal revelation (Galatians 1:12) and constantly defends his legitimacy (2 Corinthians 10–12).

Yeshua, however, is reserved toward self-assumed authority: "The greatest among you shall be your servant" (Matthew 23:11). It is not impossible that Yeshua would have called Paul not to prove that he is an apostle, but to rest from the need to prove it. A decisive point would have been the center of the message. Yeshua proclaims the Kingdom of God as a reality lived now (Mark 1:15). Paul proclaims the crucified and risen Christ as the central saving event (1 Corinthians 2:2).

Yeshua would have recognized the value of the testimony about the cross, but he would have asked: are you leading people to live the

Kingdom, or to subscribe to an explanation about salvation? For Yeshua, the truth is not merely believed, but followed (John 14:6). Yeshua would probably have been ambivalent: affirming toward Paul's transformation; cautious toward his systematization; demanding toward the effects of his message on people's fear, freedom, and love.

Most certainly, Yeshua would not have rejected Paul as "false," but neither would he have confused him with himself. In the Gospels, Yeshua distinguishes between the witness and the model. Witnesses speak about the light; the model lives the light (John 1:7–9). Paul is, in this sense, a powerful witness. Yeshua remains the model. Perhaps most important of all: Yeshua would have looked at the historical fruits. Wherever Paul's message brought freedom, courage, and living communities, Yeshua would have said: good.

Wherever it produced fear, guilt, and rigidity, he would have said: here you have misunderstood. For Yeshua, the truth does not defend itself through authority, but is recognized through life. Yeshua would not have seen in Paul a "replacement" for himself, but a man touched by truth who chose to interpret it. Yeshua does not judge the intention, but he does not negotiate the meaning: a truth that does not set free is not yet the full truth. Yeshua does not seek perfect theologians. He seeks people who, even when they explain, do not cease to live.

How Faith Is Transformed in Paul

In Paul, faith takes on a different function. The context is essential: Paul is not speaking to a small circle of disciples who knew Yeshua personally, but to scattered, multicultural communities that must be united without the Mosaic Law. In this context, faith becomes the principle of cohesion and justification. For Paul, faith is the human response to the Christ-event: the death and the resurrection.

"One is justified by faith apart from works of the law" (Romans 3:28). Here, faith is no longer merely existential trust, but an act of accepting a saving truth. Not just "I trust," but "I believe that Christ died and rose for me." This shift is decisive. Faith becomes the means

by which a person is justified before God. It takes on a formal soteriological function: without faith, there is no salvation.

Inevitably, faith begins to be formulated, preached, defended. The distinction appears between “believing correctly” and “not believing.” In Paul, faith is oriented toward the event, not only toward experience. It looks back, toward the cross and the resurrection, and forward, toward justification and eternal life. This structuring makes faith transmissible within the community, but it also distances it from the immediate living we see in Yeshua.

The fundamental difference between Yeshua and Paul is not opposition, but emphasis. In Yeshua, faith is trust that opens life, comes before explanation, is relational, and is situated in the present. In Paul, faith is a response to a saving event, is formulated theologically, and becomes a criterion of belonging. Yeshua says: “Come and see.” Paul says: “Believe and you will be saved.” Both formulas speak of access to life, but on different levels.

Yeshua works at the level of direct consciousness; Paul works at the level of the community, of history, and of theological reconciliation. Through Paul, faith becomes universalizable. It can be transmitted without the physical presence of Yeshua. Communities can exist, can be united, can endure in time. This is an undeniable gain. But something is lost of the fluidity and simplicity of Yeshua’s faith.

Faith risks becoming a condition, not an opening; a criterion, not a process; an identity, not a relationship. When faith becomes something you have, rather than something you live, it can turn from a gate into a wall. Yeshua never asks: “Do you believe correctly?” His question is always: “Do you trust?” So, for Yeshua, faith is the trust that makes life possible. For Paul, faith is the means by which a person is declared saved. Yeshua treats faith as the beginning of the road. Paul treats it as the central element of salvation. Between the two there is no contradiction, but there is a difference of level. The problem arises when Paul’s faith completely replaces Yeshua’s, and living trust is reduced to doctrinal assent. Yeshua does not ask to be believed. He asks to be followed.

Why Yeshua Does Not Speak of “Grace,” While Paul Speaks of It So Much

One of the most surprising things, when we read the Gospels attentively, is this: Yeshua almost never uses the concept of “grace” as a distinct theological term. Paul, by contrast, will make “grace” (*charis*) one of the central pillars of his theology. This difference is not accidental and is not a matter of vocabulary, but of existential positioning. Yeshua lives what Paul explains. Yeshua embodies the reality that Paul conceptualizes.

For Yeshua, grace is not a subject for preaching because it is the medium in which he lives. He does not speak about grace, just as a fish does not speak about water. His entire relationship with God is one of assumed intimacy, not of negotiation. Yeshua does not begin from the premise that the human being is excluded and then re-included. He begins from an already existing relationship: “Your Father knows what you need” (Matthew 6:8). This statement would be impossible within a theology of the absence of grace.

In the Gospels, what theology will later call “grace” appears under other forms: compassion, mercy, nearness, the absence of judgment, the restoration of dignity. Yeshua says: “The Father makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good” (Matthew 5:45). This is not a definition of grace, but a description of an already active reality. Grace is not offered; it is observed. God does not begin to be good when a person changes. Goodness precedes any change.

That is why Yeshua never says: “You have received grace.” He says: “Do not be afraid,” “rise up,” “come,” “follow me” (Mark 1:17; Matthew 9:2). His language is relational, not conceptual. He does not explain why God loves without conditions; he lives this love publicly, scandalously, visibly. Grace, for Yeshua, is not a doctrine to be accepted, but a reality to be recognized. This positioning also explains the absence of transactional language.

Yeshua does not speak of “merit” and “demerit,” of “earning” or “losing” grace. He says: “Your Father is merciful” (Luke 6:36). Mercy

is not a juridical exception, but the nature of the relationship. Grace is not the solution to a problem; it is the context in which the problem appears and dissolves. In Paul, the situation is radically different. Paul enters Christianity from within a theology of the Law, of guilt, and of justice.

For him, the fundamental problem is this: how can a just God accept a guilty person? Out of this tension is born the need to conceptualize grace. “By grace you have been saved, through faith” (Ephesians 2:8). Grace appears as a theological solution to a juridical problem. For Paul, grace is necessary because sin is defined as ontological separation: “all have sinned” (Romans 3:23). Grace becomes that which repairs a real rupture between God and the human being.

That is why Paul speaks so much about grace: he needs a concept to counterbalance the Law, condemnation, and the human being’s inability to save himself. Grace is the antidote to a severe diagnosis. This shift is decisive. In Yeshua, grace is implicit; in Paul, grace becomes explicit. In Yeshua, grace is the air of the relationship; in Paul, grace is the intervention that changes a person’s status. From this comes the juridical language: “justification,” “righteousness,” “the free gift” (Romans 5:1; 5:15). Grace is no longer the medium of life, but the act by which life becomes possible again. The Christianity that comes after Yeshua will inherit this Pauline paradigm on a massive scale. Grace will become the opposite of the Law, the currency of salvation, the criterion of belonging: you are “under grace” or “outside of grace.”

Although grace is said to be free, it often ends up conditioned by correct belief, by adherence to doctrine, by the acceptance of an explanation about the cross. Thus grace ceases to be the medium of freedom and becomes an administrable concept. Yeshua never built a theology of grace because he did not begin from a theology of separation. He did not have to explain why God loves without conditions, because he never doubted this fact.

Paul, by contrast, had to construct a language that would allow the passage from guilt to acceptance without giving up the idea of justice. The final difference is profound. For Yeshua, grace is what is already

true about God. For Paul, grace is what makes the truth bearable for a guilty conscience. Yeshua did not preach grace. He lived it. Yeshua did not build a theology of grace because he did not begin from a theology of separation.

One of the most revealing contrasts between Yeshua's message and the Christian theology formulated later is this: Yeshua never felt the need to construct a theology of grace. Not because he ignored the reality of suffering, of going astray, or of evil, but because he never began from the premise that the human being is ontologically separated from God.

Grace, as a doctrine, appears only where separation is considered real, structural, and definitive without a special intervention. In Yeshua's discourse, the relationship between God and the human being is presupposed as existing before any moral correction. He does not speak of a God who is withdrawn, offended, or inaccessible, but of a Father who is present, involved, and near: "Your Father knows what you need before you ask him" (Matthew 6:8).

This statement would be impossible within a theology of separation. If God were fundamentally distant, grace would have to be explained. In Yeshua, it is not explained because it is not negotiated. That is why Yeshua never says that God begins to love when a person repents. On the contrary, he describes a love that precedes any change: "He makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good" (Matthew 5:45).

This is not a conditional promise, but an observation about the nature of reality. Grace is not a response to sin; it is the background against which sin appears as a going astray. The absence of a theology of grace in Yeshua is directly connected to the way he defines sin. Sin is not, for Yeshua, an ontological state of separation, but a state of not-seeing. "I came so that those who do not see may see" (John 9:39). Blindness does not call for a juridical act of rehabilitation, but for light.

That is why Yeshua does not speak of grace as "forgiveness granted," but of truth that sets free (John 8:32). Liberation does not come from a divine exception, but from the recognition of a reality already present. In Yeshua's parables, God never appears as a judge who must be persuaded to be merciful. The father of the prodigal son is not

softened by repentance; he runs out before the speech of guilt is even spoken (Luke 15:20).

The shepherd does not negotiate the value of the lost sheep; he seeks it because it belongs to him (Luke 15:4–7). These images do not describe grace as an exceptional intervention, but as the normality of the relationship. Yeshua does not need to define grace because he does not operate with a God who could, in principle, not be good. Goodness is not a decision, but a nature. “Be merciful, just as your Father is merciful” (Luke 6:36).

The human being is not asked to fulfill conditions in order to receive grace, but to align himself with what is already true about God. Grace is not something that comes from outside; it is something recognized from within. This positioning changes radically with Paul. Paul begins from a different perspective: sin is a universal condition that separates the human being from God (“all have sinned” — Romans 3:23), and the Law makes this separation visible through condemnation.

Within this framework, grace becomes absolutely necessary as a theological solution. If the human being is, by definition, separated, then it must be explained how reconnection is possible. Thus grace appears as an unmerited gift, as a unilateral act of God that repairs a real rupture (“by grace you have been saved” — Ephesians 2:8). In Paul, grace is explicit because the problem is explicit. Grace becomes the answer to guilt, to powerlessness, to the human being’s inability to save himself.

The language inevitably changes: justification, righteousness, payment, substitution (Romans 5:1; 3:24–26). Grace is no longer the medium of life, but the intervention that changes a person’s status before a just God. The Christianity that comes after Yeshua will inherit this theology of grace precisely because it will also inherit the theology of separation. God is seen as being, by nature, at a distance; the human being is seen as being, by nature, guilty.

Grace becomes the necessary bridge between two separated realities. Although it is proclaimed as free, it often ends up conditioned by correct faith, correct doctrine, and correct belonging. Thus grace ceases

to be freedom and becomes a system. Yeshua did not build a theology of grace because he did not need to explain why God is on the side of the human being. He lived this reality without conceptualizing it. In his presence, people did not receive “grace”; they woke up. They rose. They came back to themselves. Grace was not announced, but breathed.

The final difference is this: in Yeshua, grace is what never ceased to be true; in later theology, grace is what becomes necessary in order to repair what was assumed to be broken. Yeshua did not preach grace because he did not preach separation. He preached the Kingdom — a reality already present, which makes grace unnecessary as an explanation and sufficient as life.

Paul Transforms the Human Ego into a Spiritual Power

Yeshua’s statement, “I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven” (Luke 10:18), is often read as a cosmic vision. But in Yeshua’s logic, the meaning is simpler and more radical. The ego collapses wherever the truth is lived. The disciples return rejoicing that “the spirits submit to us,” and Yeshua immediately shifts the emphasis. Not onto power, but onto liberation from the logic of the adversary. The power of the ego falls not when it is attacked, but when it is no longer fed.

In Paul, this inner reality begins to be externalized. Satan becomes “the god of this age” (2 Corinthians 4:4), a power that “blinds the minds” and part of a cosmic struggle against “the rulers of the darkness” (Ephesians 6:12). What in Yeshua is a structure of consciousness becomes, in Paul, a transpersonal force. The emphasis shifts from clarity to conflict, from awakening to resistance.

This shift makes sense within a context of persecution and historical tension, but it changes the perspective. The human being is no longer called merely to step out of illusion, but to fight an external power. The adversary is no longer something to be seen, but something to be combated.

In Christianity the Ego Becomes Projected as an Absolute Demon

The Christianity that comes after Paul takes externalization to the extreme. The ego is projected entirely outside the human being in the form of a personalized devil, of demons, and of omnipresent malevolent forces. The result is paradoxical. The ego remains untouched, fear is amplified, responsibility is moved outward, and the struggle becomes permanent. Instead of being dissolved through truth, the ego is fed through religious conflict: “us against them,” “good against evil,” “God against Satan.”

This is exactly the dynamic that Yeshua never uses. In Yeshua, Satan is the ego, the logic of separation. The adversary is internal, the solution is truth and presence, and fear vanishes together with the ego. In Paul, Satan becomes a cosmic power, the adversary is external, the solution is resistance and struggle, and spiritual tension becomes central.

In later Christianity, Satan ends up as an absolute personalized enemy, the ego is projected outward, fear becomes the engine, and conflict is sacralized. For Yeshua, Satan is not something to be defeated, but something to be seen. It is the ego that vanishes the moment the truth is lived. “The ruler of this world has no hold on me” means that the ego has no grip on a free consciousness. The adversary falls not through struggle, but through the absence of fear.

The Lists of “Sins” in Paul

Paul begins to enumerate behaviors considered incompatible with life “in Christ” (1 Corinthians 6:9–10; Galatians 5:19–21). These lists appear in concrete communal contexts and serve a disciplinary role. But they produce a major shift: sin becomes a catalogable behavior, not merely a state of the heart. Although Paul affirms explicitly that “love is the fulfillment of the Law” (Romans 13:10), in pastoral and communal practice the emphasis begins to move.

Love remains the declared ideal, but the management of concrete communities requires boundaries, rules, and criteria of belonging. Thus

the concern gradually shifts toward defining the borders, establishing norms of behavior, and clarifying what it means to be “inside” or “outside.” Love no longer functions only as an inner principle that orients the conscience, but is accompanied by structures meant to protect the unity and coherence of the group.

In this process, the emphasis does not disappear from the discourse, but it begins to be mediated by rules, and belonging becomes an ever more clearly defined reality. Institutional Christianity will take up Paul’s language and systematize it until it becomes a stable theological architecture. Sin becomes the central criterion of identity, with the human being defined as “sinful by nature,” not merely as a being capable of going astray or of not-seeing.

It becomes the very point of preaching, the place from which the message sets out and toward which religious discourse constantly returns. Within this framework, sin becomes the justification of fear and the reason for institutional mediation: the sacraments, the hierarchies, and the mechanisms of authorization are presented as necessary in order to manage a condition considered structurally guilty.

Out of this systematization develop hierarchies of sins, an obsessive attention given to sexuality, an ever stronger emphasis on guilt and shame, and, in the end, the fear of eternal punishment. Sin is no longer a state to be overcome through awakening and relationship, but becomes an instrument of organization, control, and delimitation.

Thus, what at first was pastoral language meant to explain human fragility ends up structuring a culture of fear, in which the believer’s identity is built around guilt rather than around freedom. Within this framework, sin is no longer a state of inattention, but a condemnation. The human being is no longer someone to be awakened, but someone to be corrected. The relationship with God is mediated by the resolution of the problem of sin.

This direction would be foreign to Yeshua, who says: “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick” (Matthew 9:12). For him, sin is a sickness to be healed, not a crime to be punished. The difference of perspective is clearly stated when we observe the way sin is understood

and, implicitly, the way the human being is understood. In Yeshua, sin is described through existential images such as blindness, going astray, or inattention to the truth, not as ontological guilt.

The problem is not that the human being is evil by nature, but that he does not see, does not hear, or is not present. That is why the solution is not condemnation, but the truth that illuminates, the love that restores the relationship, and the healing that reestablishes life. Forgiveness is unconditional and precedes any correction, because the human being is considered recoverable at any moment, capable of returning when he sees. In Paul, sin takes on another density.

It is no longer merely an individual going astray, but a universal state and a power that acts upon all humanity. The human being is caught in a condition from which he cannot free himself alone, and the solution becomes salvation through Christ as a decisive intervention from outside. Forgiveness is no longer merely a relational recognition, but a soteriological act that changes a person's status. The emphasis shifts from awakening to rescue, from healing to justification.

In later Christianity, this displacement reaches a rigid form. Sin becomes the defining guilt, the central element of human identity. The solution is no longer the encounter that heals, but conformity to a framework and the acceptance of institutional mediation. Fear and shame become the engines of religious life, and the human being is permanently regarded as suspect, always in danger of erring again.

Thus, what in Yeshua was hope and recovery is gradually transformed into a system of control, in which freedom is replaced by vigilance, and truth by fear. In later theological Christianity, sin comes to be defined first of all as an offense committed against God, as an affront to a divine will, a violation of a sacred order or of a revealed law. The emphasis falls on the broken vertical relationship, on accumulated guilt, and on the necessity of a reparation that comes from outside the human being. The human being is regarded as guilty before he is regarded as wounded, and the principal problem becomes his status before God.

In Yeshua, however, sin has a radically different meaning. It is not described as an offense against God, but as a wrong committed against oneself, against one's own life, and against one's inner truth. That is why Yeshua speaks of blindness, going astray, sleep, a hardened heart, and inattention. Sin is not something that wounds God, but something that disintegrates the human being. God is not the one harmed; the human being is the one who loses himself.

In this logic, sin is not a spiritual crime, but a form of existential self-betrayal. To sin means to live beneath the level of one's truth, to separate oneself from life, to break away from one's own conscience. That is why the solution, in Yeshua, is not payment or atonement, but awakening. It is not the satisfaction of a divine justice, but the healing of an inner rupture. Forgiveness does not change God's attitude toward the human being, but frees the human being from self-condemnation and from not-seeing.

Thus, if in Christianity sin is defined as "to wrong God," in Yeshua sin is, more deeply, "to wrong oneself." Not because God would be excluded from the equation, but because God is not separate from life. To lose oneself means to lose oneself from the truth, and the truth is already the place of the encounter with God. In this vision, sin does not call for punishment, but for light, and salvation is not an acquittal, but a return to oneself. Yeshua did not come to convince us that we are sinners. He came to show us where we do not see. For him, sin is not condemnation, but an invitation to awakening.

When sin becomes more important than life, more important than love, more important than healing, we are no longer speaking of Yeshua's message, but of a theology built after him.

How Yeshua Would Regard the Message of Salvation Formulated by Paul

If we were to hear Yeshua commenting on the message of salvation as it is articulated by the Apostle Paul, the tone would be neither one of rejection nor of full endorsement. There would be an attentive silence, a

repositioning of the center, a shift of emphasis from inherited guilt to lived life, from juridical status to inner transformation. Yeshua never preached the idea that the human being is ontologically condemned because of Adam's sin and that he bears a juridical guilt transmitted biologically.

He speaks of people as being "lost," not "guilty from birth." Lostness, for Yeshua, is not a legal state, but a state of the wandering of consciousness. "The Son of Man came to seek and to save what was lost" (Luke 19:10). He does not say "to discharge the guilt," but to find again what had drifted away from life. When Paul affirms that "all have sinned" and that death entered the world through Adam (Romans 5:12), Yeshua would see here a symbolic language, not a metaphysical sentence.

Yeshua does not meet people as defendants in a heavenly court, but as beings who live in fear, separation, and unconsciousness. He does not tell them: "You are guilty for what Adam did," but: "Do not be afraid," "the Kingdom of God is within you," "come and follow me." For Yeshua, the human being's problem is not inherited sin, but the inability to love, to see, and to live in the truth.

That is why he heals, forgives, and eats with tax collectors and sinners without first demanding a doctrinal declaration. Forgiveness precedes the change, it does not condition it. "Neither do I condemn you. Go and sin no more" (John 8:11). There is no theology of universal condemnation here, but one of awakening. When Paul shifts the center of salvation onto "faith in Christ" as an act necessary in order to go to heaven, Yeshua would immediately reorient the meaning of faith.

For him, faith is not intellectual adherence to an affirmation about him, but a living trust that manifests itself through transformation. "Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father" (Matthew 7:21). Yeshua does not say that salvation comes through believing something about him, but through living what he lives. Yeshua would observe that, in Paul, salvation becomes to a large extent a post-mortem event: heaven as a destination.

By contrast, he speaks constantly of the Kingdom of God as a present reality. “The Kingdom of God does not come in a way that can be observed... for behold, the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21). Salvation, for Yeshua, is not a ticket for the afterlife, but a passage from death to life here and now.

If he were to comment on the idea that his death was a necessary sacrifice in order to satisfy a divine justice wounded by Adam’s sin, Yeshua would once again shift the perspective. He never speaks of the Father as a judge who demands blood in order to be able to forgive. His Father “makes his sun rise on the good and on the evil” (Matthew 5:45). The cross, in Yeshua’s language, is not a juridical mechanism, but the supreme expression of a love that does not defend itself and does not withdraw, even when it is rejected. Yeshua would say that he did not come to change God’s attitude toward people, but to change people’s perception of God. “Whoever has seen me has seen the Father” (John 14:9).

If the Father had been a God of universal condemnation, Yeshua could not have lived as he lived: free, open, non-accusing, present. In the end, Yeshua would not entirely deny Paul’s language, but he would consider it secondary and dangerous if it became central. He would say that salvation is not about escaping punishment, but about coming out of unconsciousness. Not about believing correctly, but about loving truly. Not about Adam, but about now.

Not about heaven as a reward, but about life as a state. “I came so that my sheep may have life and have it abundantly” (John 10:10). For Yeshua, this is salvation.

Did Yeshua Preach a Different Gospel from Paul?

Yes. If we read directly the words of Yeshua from the Gospels and then read Paul’s theology from the epistles, we observe that the emphasis, the language, and even the structure of the message are different. Yeshua never preaches a “gospel of the cross” in the sense in which Paul formulates it. He preaches the Gospel of the Kingdom of God.

About his own mission he says clearly: “I must proclaim the good news of the Kingdom of God to the other towns as well, because this is why I was sent” (Luke 4:43).

His preaching constantly begins with the call: “Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near” (Matthew 4:17). The center of the message is not faith in a future theological event, but the human being’s entry into a present spiritual reality: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). In Yeshua’s teaching, the emphasis falls on the transformation of the heart and on living out the will of the Father.

He says clearly that entry into the Kingdom is not a matter of religious declaration: “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord!’ will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father who is in heaven” (Matthew 7:21). For Yeshua, the fundamental problem is not the human being’s theological status, but the state of the heart.

That is why he says that “a tree is known by its fruit” (Matthew 7:16) and that true judgment is made according to concrete compassion toward people: “I was hungry and you gave me something to eat... whenever you did these things for one of the least of these brothers of mine, you did them for me” (Matthew 25:35–40). In Paul’s epistles, however, the center of the gospel is formulated differently.

Paul defines the gospel explicitly as the death and resurrection of Christ: “I delivered to you first of all... that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, that he was buried and rose on the third day” (1 Corinthians 15:3–4). He even affirms that the core of his preaching is the cross: “We preach Christ crucified” (1 Corinthians 1:23) and “I decided to know nothing among you except Jesus Christ and him crucified” (1 Corinthians 2:2).

Thus, in Paul’s theology, the central event of the gospel is the cross, not the Kingdom. This difference appears also in the way each speaks about salvation. Yeshua speaks almost exclusively about living and transformation. He says: “Whoever loses his life for my sake will gain it” (Matthew 16:25) and calls the human being to become like the

Father: “Be perfect, just as your heavenly Father is perfect” (Matthew 5:48).

For Yeshua, salvation is entry into a new way of being, a transformation of the heart that produces visible fruit. Paul, by contrast, describes salvation in theological terms of grace and faith: “A person is counted righteous by faith, apart from the works of the Law” (Romans 3:28) and “by grace you have been saved, through faith... not by works” (Ephesians 2:8–9).

In this perspective, salvation becomes first of all a divine act accomplished through faith in the work of Christ, not a transformation that begins through entering the Kingdom. Another difference appears in the way each treats the question of doctrinal authority. Yeshua does not ask people to defend a theological formula about him. He says simply: “If anyone wants to come after me, let him deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me” (Matthew 16:24).

His message is a call to transformation, not to the defense of a doctrine. Paul, however, warns very firmly against any other gospel: “Even if we ourselves or an angel from heaven should preach to you a gospel other than the one we preached to you, let him be accursed” (Galatians 1:8). Here the gospel becomes a precise theological formula that must be preserved and defended. Therefore, if we read the texts without the filters of tradition, we observe two different messages.

Yeshua preaches the Gospel of the Kingdom — the inner transformation through which the human being becomes like the Father. Paul preaches the Gospel of the cross — faith in the death and resurrection of Christ as a saving act. This difference also explains a tension that has run through the history of Christianity to this day: the emphasis on living like Christ or the emphasis on believing in Christ. Yeshua invites the human being to a transformation of the heart that makes the Kingdom of God possible within him. Paul invites the human being to believe in the event of the cross through which God reconciled the world to himself. And the question that remains for every reader is simple but profound: do we follow the religion about Christ or the way lived by Christ?

Does Yeshua See Himself as the Agent of Salvation?

Yeshua speaks of salvation, but he does so in a language of healing and awakening, not of juridical transaction. For him, to be “saved” means to be brought back to life, to be made whole. When he says: “Your faith has saved you” (Luke 7:50) or “Today salvation has come to this house” (Luke 19:9), salvation appears as the effect of a real transformation, visible in a person’s life. It is not a spiritual label, but a change of state.

Yeshua never says: “Believe something about me and you will be saved,” but constantly invites people to return, to see, and to live. That is why he warns clearly: “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord!’ will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father” (Matthew 7:21). For Yeshua, he is the way not because he replaces the road, but because he shows it and embodies it. Salvation, in this perspective, is not separate from becoming.

The Apostle Paul shifts the center of gravity of the message. In him, Yeshua becomes predominantly the agent of salvation through his death and resurrection, more than the direct model of living. “We preach Christ crucified” (1 Corinthians 1:23), says Paul, and “by grace you have been saved, through faith” (Ephesians 2:8) becomes the key formula.

In this perspective, Yeshua is unique in a sense that makes him, to a large extent, inimitable: the Son of God who does what the human being cannot do alone. The emphasis falls on trust in the saving act of Christ, not on replicating his state of consciousness. Even when Paul speaks of imitation, it remains secondary and mediated: “Follow my example, as I follow the example of Christ” (1 Corinthians 11:1).

Faith precedes life, and ontological becoming remains tense and incomplete. Contemporary Christianity carries this shift to its conclusion. Yeshua is perceived predominantly as an external Savior, and the idea of being “like him” is often considered either blasphemy or impossibility. The implicit message becomes: Yeshua is too high, the

human being is too low, and the human being's role is to believe, not to become.

In this way, Yeshua is separated from ordinary humanity and transformed into an inaccessible ideal. But it is precisely this separation that makes his central invitation impossible: following. "By their fruits you will know them" (Matthew 7:16) remains Yeshua's criterion. When the fruits are missing, yet declarative faith remains, the contradiction appears that he had already anticipated. Yeshua wants us to relate to him as to a living example, not as to a sacred impossibility.

He is the agent of salvation in the sense that he awakens, shows, and calls. For Yeshua, salvation means becoming, awakening, and living from the truth. For Paul, salvation is grace received through faith. For the Christianity of today, salvation often ends up being doctrinal acceptance of a past act. Yeshua never says: "You will never be like me." He says, simply and unequivocally: "Follow me." This is not an invitation to admiration, but to transformation.

How Yeshua Would Comment on Paul's Emphasis on Faith in His Death and Resurrection as "Payment for Sins"

If Yeshua were to regard the way the Apostle Paul centers salvation on faith in his death and resurrection as a reparatory act for sins, the first thing he would notice would be the change of the message. In his teaching, Yeshua never begins with his own death, nor with a theological mechanism of forgiveness, but with present life: the human being's heart, his relationships, the truth lived, concrete love, and lucid presence.

His initial call is not an explanation about what is going to happen to him, but an invitation to an immediate change of the way of being: "Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near" (Matthew 4:17). For Yeshua, the criterion is not the acceptance of a narrative about death, but the fruits of life: "By their fruits you will know them" (Matthew

7:16). Sin, in this perspective, is not a juridical debt awaiting payment, but a state of going astray, of blindness, and of inner separation.

That is why he does not tell people that their problem is the lack of faith in a future event, but the lack of inner seeing and hearing: “Do you have eyes and not see? Do you have ears and not hear?” (Mark 8:18).

How Yeshua Would Respond to the Idea of “Payment for Sins”

Yeshua speaks of forgiveness as a living act of the heart, not as the effect of a substitutionary transaction. In his parables, forgiveness springs from the turning of consciousness, not from the discharge of a theological debt. The father in the parable of the prodigal son does not wait for compensation, but runs toward the lost one when he sees him returning: “His father saw him, was moved with compassion, and ran and threw himself on his neck” (Luke 15:20).

In the prayer he offers his disciples, Yeshua ties forgiveness to the dynamic of relationship, not to a sacrifice: “Forgive us our trespasses, as we also forgive” (Matthew 6:12). If he were to comment on the idea that sins are “paid” through his death, Yeshua would immediately shift the emphasis from accounting to transformation. For him, forgiveness does not repair an abstract balance, but reunites what was broken in the human being.

That is why the words “Go and sin no more” (John 8:11) remain essential: forgiveness is inseparable from the change of the way of living. A forgiveness that does not lead to a new life is not, in Yeshua’s logic, salvation.

“If Christ Has Not Been Raised”?

For faith, the resurrection is neither a metaphor nor a symbol of the continuity of the teaching. It is a real, physical event, occurring in time and space. This is expressed unequivocally by Paul in 1 Corinthians 15:14, where he affirms: “If Christ has not been raised, your faith is in

vain.” The radicalism of this sentence shows that for the first Christians everything stands or falls on this point. Not ethics, not the miracles, not the parables are the foundation, but the resurrection.

History, however, has clear limits. It can observe that very early, only a few years after the crucifixion, a group of people affirmed that they had seen him alive. It can note that this conviction radically changed their behavior and led to the emergence of a movement that spread rapidly. It can analyze the traditions about the appearances recorded in 1 Corinthians 15:3–8, where Paul lists witnesses of the encounters with the Risen One. But history cannot verify whether a dead man returned to life.

This is where its method stops. That is why the formulation of historians remains cautious: the disciples sincerely believed that they had seen him alive after his death. Beyond this we enter into theology and philosophy. What is interesting, however, is that even if we were to remove the resurrection entirely from the discussion and read the Gospels merely as historical documents about a first-century Jewish teacher, Yeshua remains profoundly unusual. His message has features that radically distinguish him from most religious leaders.

The radicalism of forgiveness is one of them. In Matthew 18:22, Yeshua says: “I do not tell you up to seven times, but up to seventy times seven.” This is not a balanced, juridical morality, but an abolition of moral accounting. Forgiveness no longer has a limit, no longer has conditions, no longer pursues the balance of justice. Very few religious leaders call for such a stance. Another feature is the elimination of the distinction between sacred and profane.

In Mark 7:15, he affirms: “There is nothing outside a person that, by going into him, can defile him; but the things that come out of a person are what defile him.” The sacred is no longer tied to ritual, to space, to the temple, but to the interior of the human being. Religion is moved from the exterior into consciousness. At the same time, Yeshua shows no interest in authority, structure, or system. He does not create institutions, leaves no social rules, formulates no juridical codes. He does not say how society should be organized.

The emphasis falls almost exclusively on the transformation of the heart. This shift of emphasis is seen clearly in Matthew 5, where he does not say only “do not kill,” but “anyone who is angry with his brother is guilty.” It is no longer about the deed, but about the intention. Not about external conformity, but about the inner state. Surprisingly, his harshest criticism is not addressed to sinners, but to religious leaders.

In Matthew 23, the Pharisees are sternly rebuked for hypocrisy, while tax collectors and prostitutes are welcomed at the table. The moral logic of the age is overturned: the problem is not visible sin, but the hardened heart. All these features can be observed directly in the text, regardless of one’s position on the resurrection. From a historical point of view, Yeshua remains one of the most atypical religious teachers through the very nature of his message.

From a theological point of view, the resurrection makes him categorically unique for the believer. Compared with other religious leaders who offer systems, practices, laws, and paths, Yeshua offers almost exclusively a call to the transformation of the heart and to forgiveness. Thus the conclusion that reconciles the two planes becomes clear: if you remove the resurrection, Yeshua remains a remarkable teacher through the depth and radicalism of his message.

If you accept the resurrection, he is no longer merely one teacher among others, but becomes, for the believer, categorically unique.

One of the most subtle changes that have taken place in the history of Christianity is the shift of the emphasis of the resurrection from within the human being to the exterior of history. In the Gospels, the resurrection often appears as a present reality, an awakening of consciousness, a passage from inner death to spiritual life. But in later theological development, the emphasis was moved almost exclusively onto the physical event of Christ’s resurrection and onto the resurrection of bodies at the end of the world.

Thus, what could be lived as a transforming experience in a person’s life became to a large extent a doctrine about the future. In the Gospels, Yeshua speaks of eternal life not as a post-mortem reward, but as a

reality that begins now. He says: “Truly, truly, I tell you, whoever hears my word and believes in the One who sent me has eternal life and does not come into judgment, but has passed from death to life” (John 5:24).

We notice the present tense: has eternal life and has passed. It is not merely a future promise, but a present transformation. Death and life are not only biological states, but states of consciousness. This idea appears again a few verses later: “The hour is coming, and is now here, when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God; and those who hear will live” (John 5:25). If we read literally, it seems absurd: how can the dead hear? But it is precisely here that the spiritual meaning is hidden.

“The dead” are those who live without consciousness, without love, without inner life. The voice of Yeshua is the call to awakening. This perspective is confirmed also by the way Yeshua speaks of the Kingdom of God. He says: “The Kingdom of God does not come in a way that can be observed... for behold, the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21).

If the Kingdom is within, then the resurrection too — which is the entry into this new life — must be, at least in part, an inner transformation. Over time, however, the message began to be understood more and more in external terms. Instead of the resurrection being seen as a spiritual experience accessible to every human being, it became first of all a unique historical event and an eschatological promise.

In this shift of emphasis, the human being becomes a spectator rather than a participant. Christ has risen — and we wait. But the language of the New Testament suggests an active participation. Paul says: “We were buried with him through baptism into death, so that, just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life” (Romans 6:4). Christ’s resurrection thus becomes the model of a personal transformation.

It is not merely a miracle to be contemplated, but a path to be followed. In the same spirit, Paul affirms: “If you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above” (Colossians 3:1). Again, the verb refers to something already accomplished: if you have been raised. This suggests that the resurrection can be lived already as a change in the

way of seeing the world, the way of loving, the way of being. The danger of externalizing the resurrection is that inner transformation becomes secondary.

A person can remain in the same consciousness dominated by fear, resentment, and separation, and yet believe that the resurrection nonetheless concerns him — because it is a doctrine he accepts. In this case, the resurrection is no longer an awakening of consciousness, but merely a theological affirmation. But if we return to the spirit of the Gospels, the resurrection appears as a change of perspective upon life. It is the passage from fear to trust, from judgment to compassion, from ego to love.

The Apostle John expresses this transformation in a simple phrase: “We know that we have passed from death to life, because we love the brothers” (1 John 3:14). Here the criterion of the resurrection is not an external event, but the appearance of love. In this sense, the resurrection can be understood as a passage from a fragmented consciousness to an integrated one. From separation to unity. From reaction to presence.

This is what spiritual traditions sometimes call transcendence: the surpassing of the previous level of consciousness. That is why the resurrection must not be thought of merely as a single moment, but as a continuous process. Every time a false identity dies and a deeper understanding is born, a resurrection takes place. Every time fear gives way to love, a resurrection takes place. Every time the human being gives up separation and discovers unity, a resurrection takes place.

Yeshua himself describes this process through the metaphor of the seed: “Unless a grain of wheat falls to the ground and dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit” (John 12:24). The death of the seed is not destruction, but transformation. This is exactly the logic of the resurrection. Thus, the resurrection is not merely coming out of a tomb. It is coming out of a limited consciousness. It is the passage from a life lived in fear to a life lived in love.

It is the moment when death — in its inner form — loses its power. That is why Paul says about Christ: “Christ, having been raised from the dead, dies no more; death no longer has dominion over him” (Romans

6:9). But this affirmation becomes also an invitation. Because when the human being passes through his own inner resurrection, death begins to no longer have the same power over him either. In this profound sense, Christ's resurrection is not merely an event to be celebrated. It is a map of the transformation of human consciousness. And the central question is no longer only whether Christ rose, but whether his resurrection produces a resurrection in us as well.

“Faith Comes from Hearing” — but Not in Yeshua

Paul formulates one of the most influential sentences in Christian theology: “Faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ” (Romans 10:17). In Paul's logic, faith arises through the transmission of a message. Someone proclaims, someone listens, and the listening produces faith. That is why he asks rhetorically: “How will they believe in the One of whom they have not heard? And how will they hear without a preacher?” (Romans 10:14).

The structure is simple and powerful: the preacher transmits the message, the person hears it, and the hearing becomes faith. This structure has an extraordinary force of expansion. A message can be transmitted from city to city, from generation to generation, without people having to verify personally the reality of which they hear. Faith thus becomes transmissible through the word.

For this reason, Paul's model is one of the most effective mechanisms for the spread of a religion. But it is precisely this effectiveness that conceals a profound vulnerability. If faith comes first of all from hearing, then the believer becomes dependent on the one who speaks. The truth is no longer encountered directly, but mediated through someone else's interpretation. Modern psychology has observed this long after Paul.

The experiments on influence and persuasion show that people can come to believe affirmations simply because they have heard them many times. In the famous experiment conducted by Hasher, Goldstein, and Toppino (1977), participants were presented with false and true

statements. After some statements were repeated several times, people began to consider them more true simply because they had become familiar.

The researchers called this phenomenon “the illusion of truth”: what we hear repeated begins to seem true, even if we have never verified the reality of the statement. History shows that this mechanism has been used constantly by propaganda. The radio, public speeches, and repeated sermons were among the most effective instruments of psychological influence.

The voice creates a relationship of intimacy with the listener, and the confident tone of the speaker can increase the perception of truth even when the content is not verified. The same phenomenon appears in the famous experiment by Stanley Milgram on obedience. The participants were willing to administer painful electric shocks to other people simply because an authority told them verbally to continue.

About 65% of the participants went all the way to the maximum level of the experiment, demonstrating how powerful the effect of the voice of authority can be on human behavior. These modern discoveries help us better understand a paradox: hearing is one of the fastest ways by which a conviction can appear, but it is not necessarily the surest way to truth.

In Yeshua’s preaching, faith appears in a different manner. He does not say that faith comes from hearing the sermon. His language is almost always tied to knowing and seeing. That is why he says: “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). Freedom does not come from accepting a heard message, but from the encounter with a reality that becomes evident. In the Gospels, faith often appears after a direct experience.

People encounter Yeshua, see something, experience something, and faith appears as the recognition of that experience. After the encounter with him, the Samaritans say: “We no longer believe just because of what you said, but because we ourselves have heard and know that this is indeed the Savior of the world” (John 4:42). Here an important

principle appears: hearing may awaken curiosity, but faith becomes stable only when a person sees and knows for himself.

This difference between transmitted faith and discovered faith has been observed also by modern thinkers. The American writer Mark Twain ironically formulated a famous observation: “The best cure for Christianity is reading the Bible.” The idea was not an attack on Scripture, but a critique of a religion based exclusively on the interpretation of others. When people encounter the text directly, without the filter of the preacher, they begin to ask questions and to seek the personal meaning of the words.

If we reformulate this observation in a form closer to the spirit of Yeshua, it would sound like this: when Scripture is only explained by others, faith can become an inheritance; when Scripture is encountered directly, the search for truth begins. Yeshua seems to support precisely this inner freedom. He says: “Why do you not judge for yourselves what is right?” (Luke 12:57).

Elsewhere he warns that religious traditions can come to replace the very intention of Scripture: “You have nullified the word of God through your tradition” (Mark 7:13). The problem was not Scripture, but the filter through which it was transmitted. Here the profound contrast between the two models appears. In Paul’s model, faith begins with the message. In Yeshua’s model, faith begins with the truth recognized within the human being.

The message may kindle the spark, but the fire appears only when a person sees for himself. Psychology confirms this. Auditory messages are processed rapidly and often superficially. The listener cannot stop the discourse in order to verify the affirmations, and the confident tone of the speaker can replace critical analysis. By contrast, reading and direct experience slow down the processing. They offer time for reflection, comparison, and verification.

That is why propaganda prefers the repeated discourse, not dialogue. Repetition creates familiarity, and familiarity is often confused with truth. In this context, Yeshua’s method seems surprisingly different. He does not create dependence on the preacher. On the contrary, he invites

people to discover reality for themselves. He says: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21).

Authority is no longer in the exterior, but in the human being’s capacity to recognize the truth. That is why the final criterion for Yeshua is not how well someone repeats the message, but what kind of life that message produces. He says simply: “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16). Hearing can produce a quick faith. The encounter produces a stable faith. The first can build religions. The second transforms people. And when faith comes from seeing and knowing, it no longer depends on the preacher. Because it is no longer merely something you have heard. It becomes something you know.

What Yeshua Would Say About Paul’s Verse, “Everything That Does Not Come from Conviction Is Sin”

There are verses that, without seeming explosive, have changed for many the meaning of faith. One of them is Paul’s affirmation: “Everything that does not come from faith is sin” (Romans 14:23). In the letter to the Romans, Paul is not making here a metaphysical declaration about the universe, but is speaking extremely practically about communal life: food, customs, days, rules.

Within this framework, he says that a thing neutral in itself can become sin if it is done against one’s own conviction, that is, against one’s conscience. Sin is no longer defined by the object, but by the inner rupture between what you do and what you believe to be good. That is why he immediately adds the nuance: “Blessed is the one who does not condemn himself in what he approves” (Romans 14:22).

Paul is in fact describing an inner mechanism: when a person divides himself, when he does something while condemning himself within, he breaks in two, and this rupture becomes “sin” in his sense of a slipping away from integrity. From this verse, however, there was born in time an interpretation stronger than the original intention: if you are

convinced, it is good; if you are not convinced, it is bad. Here a dangerous confusion slips in: conviction is confused with truth.

History shows that deeply convinced people have erred gravely, sometimes with a terrifying consistency. Conviction offers inner coherence, but does not guarantee truth. Paul himself knows this and says it in a phrase that cuts the idolatry of certainty off at the root: “Knowledge puffs up, but love builds up” (1 Corinthians 8:1).

It is not conviction that automatically makes you pure, but its fruit; it is not certainty that automatically makes you near to God, but the way in which this certainty shapes your heart. The problem appears when conviction becomes an idol. When the human being no longer says “this is how I see it now,” but “this is how it is,” and projects his certainty as a divine authority.

It is interesting that Paul preserves, at times, an interpretive modesty that was later lost in institutional Christianity: “I think that I too have the Spirit of God” (1 Corinthians 7:40). The wording “I think” is a revealing detail. It acknowledges a zone of discernment, not of infallibility. The moment this nuance disappears, conviction can no longer be put into dialogue; it can no longer be examined; it can no longer be refined by truth.

And where certainty can no longer be touched by light, it ceases to be faith and becomes an idol: a psychological absolute clothed in religious language. Yeshua does not equate faith with intellectual certainty. He does not ask for adherence to formulas, but for an inner availability that is verified in life. That is why he says: “If anyone wants to do his will, he will come to know whether the teaching is from God” (John 7:17).

The order is radically different from what the religious mind usually does. Not “be convinced and then live,” but “live in the truth and you will see.” Knowledge does not come from the rigidity of conviction, but from a movement of the heart that accepts being changed. Paradoxically, Yeshua is not frightened by intellectual uncertainty; he even uses it as pedagogy.

He says: “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” (Mark 4:9), that is, he does not give you a closed system, but invites you to discernment. And when the question stripped of any definition appears before him — “What is truth?” (John 18:38) — he offers no formula. His silence is a refusal to reduce the truth to a proposition. The truth, in Yeshua, is not something that is possessed; it is something into which you enter. That is why faith, in Yeshua, resembles trust more than certainty.

“Do not be afraid, little flock” (Luke 12:32) shows that the core of the struggle is not the lack of arguments, but fear. When the disciple wavers, Yeshua does not accuse him of intellectual sin, but touches exactly the nerve: “Why did you doubt?” (Matthew 14:31). Doubt, in his vision, is not a crime of the mind, but a symptom of a heart that has been gripped by fear. He does not ask “how is it that you are not certain?” but “why are you afraid?” Here the fundamental difference appears.

In Paul, in this context, sin is to act against your own conscience — to do something while condemning yourself within. In Yeshua, the most dangerous sin is not the lack of conviction, but the rigidity that closes the heart and blocks life. That is why his harshest rebuke does not strike doubt, but the certainty that becomes a barrier: “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, for you have shut the Kingdom of Heaven in people’s faces” (Matthew 23:13).

Here the “sin” is not that you lack conviction, but that you have a conviction so rigid that you no longer let life enter, neither into you nor into others. In this light, Paul’s verse can be reread without becoming an idol. Paul warns against self-division: do not live against your own conscience. Yeshua warns against rigidification: do not turn today’s conscience into an absolute that closes your heart.

Faith, in Yeshua’s sense, is not “I am sure that I am right,” but “I am willing to be changed.” That is precisely why the truth is not the prize of certainty, but the result of a liberation: “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). Not because you strained to be convinced, but because you ceased to cling to what your ego defends.

Here connects also the affirmation: “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6).

If you read it as an exclusivist dogma, it becomes a wall. If you read it in Yeshua’s way, it becomes the description of an alignment: the truth is not a label, but a way of being without rupture between heart, word, and deed. That is why Yeshua does not present himself as the owner of the truth, but as its witness: “For this I was born, and for this I came into the world: to bear witness to the truth” (John 18:37). Witnessing presupposes a reality that precedes you.

He shows the truth through how he lives, not through the fact that he claims it. Even more clearly, Yeshua ties truth to practice, not to a slogan: “Whoever does the truth comes to the light” (John 3:21). The truth is not declared; it is done. It is not defended by rank; it is seen through fruit. That is why he also gives the simple criterion of discernment: “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16).

Not by the intensity of the conviction, not by how loudly someone affirms that he is right, but by what it produces in him and around him: more life or more fear, more love or more superiority. Yeshua speaks also of a truth that remains alive, in motion, that continues to guide: “When he comes, the Spirit of truth, he will guide you into all truth” (John 16:13). If the truth were only a final formula, there would be no need for guidance.

But Yeshua describes the truth as a reality into which you enter step by step, as you give up fear and the mask. That is why he shatters the confusion between title and living through a cutting question: “Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord!’ and do not do what I say?” (Luke 6:46). To name is not to live. To recite is not to see. Verbal conviction can coexist perfectly with the blindness of the heart.

By contrast, a heart that opens can live the truth even before it can formulate it impeccably. And then comes one of the most liberating affirmations in the whole story: “Whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do” (John 14:12). Yeshua does not create dependence on a monopoly of truth, but responsibility and participation. He does not

say “you need intermediaries to believe in your place,” but: enter into the same way of being.

The truth is not learned through delegation; it is verified through living. If we were to condense it all, Paul says: do not divide yourself; do not do what you yourself condemn, because it breaks you within. Yeshua would say: do not turn your conviction into an idol; do not shut the Kingdom with certainties; remain open to being changed. Faith, in his sense, is not rigidity, but trust; it is not “I am right,” but “I let myself be touched by the truth.”

And the truth, precisely because it is alive, has no need to be defended by force: when it is lived, it shows on the person.

Can You Be Saved Without Believing in Yeshua?

In Yeshua’s discourse, salvation is not conditioned by the acceptance of a theological identity about him, but by entry into a state of life. That is why he says that “the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) and that “whoever hears my word and believes in the One who sent me has eternal life and has passed from death to life” (John 5:24).

To “hear” here does not mean to sign a doctrinal declaration about the person of Yeshua, but to live the truth that he shows: love, forgiveness, presence, truth. In his encounters, Yeshua saves people who do not know who he is in a theological sense: lepers, marginalized women, Romans, Samaritans.

When he says: “Your faith has saved you; go in peace” (Luke 7:50), this faith is not formulated as “I believe that Yeshua is the Son of God,” but as trust, openness, and the absence of resistance toward life. The person is healed because he opens himself, not because he recites a doctrine. Yeshua never says: “Believe in me so that you may be saved” in a confessional sense.

He says simply: “Follow me” (Matthew 9:9) and shows that entry into the Kingdom belongs to “the one who does the will of my Father” (Matthew 7:21). For him, salvation is visible in the fruit, because “by their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16). That is why he

can affirm something radical for any religious exclusivism: “Many will come from the east and from the west and will sit at the table in the Kingdom of Heaven” (Matthew 8:11).

He does not say that they will come because they recognized him correctly, but because they lived the truth, even without knowing his name. This idea becomes clear in the scene of the judgment in Matthew 25, where those called “blessed” are surprised and ask: “Lord, when did we see you hungry and gave you something to eat?” (Matthew 25:37). They do not know that they served Yeshua, but they lived concrete love.

And he tells them: “Whenever you did these things for one of the least of these brothers of mine, you did them for me” (Matthew 25:40). You can be united with him without knowing who he is, if you live from the same heart. The Apostle Paul changes the framework of this understanding. For him, salvation is explicitly tied to faith in the death and resurrection of Yeshua.

He writes that “if you confess with your mouth Yeshua as Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved” (Romans 10:9) and that “by grace you have been saved, through faith” (Ephesians 2:8). Yeshua is no longer merely the way lived, but becomes the object of faith. Yet even Paul leaves a door ajar when he says that “the Gentiles, who do not have the Law, do by nature the things of the Law and show that the work of the Law is written on their hearts” (Romans 2:14–15).

But this affirmation remains secondary in his theology. The emphasis remains on explicit faith in Christ as an act necessary for full salvation. Contemporary Christianity, in many of its forms, absolutizes the Pauline reading and simplifies it: salvation becomes equivalent to the correct faith verbally formulated.

Thus, a person full of love, truth, and compassion, but from another tradition, is considered “lost,” while a person without fruit but with the correct declaration is considered “saved.” It is precisely this danger that Yeshua had anticipated when he said that “not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord!’ will enter the Kingdom, but the one who does the will of my Father” (Matthew 7:21). The difference becomes clear.

In Yeshua, salvation is a state of life, accessible to anyone who lives the truth, even without knowing his name. In Paul, salvation is a spiritual status received through explicit faith in Christ. In the Christianity of today, salvation often ends up conditioned confessionally, not existentially.

When Yeshua says “I am the Way, the Truth, and the Life” (John 14:6), the meaning is not the restriction of access to those who know the formula, but the revelation of the fact that wherever the truth is lived, there he is as well. Yeshua does not ask for verbal recognition. He asks for living transformation.

The Role of Baptism in Yeshua

For Yeshua, baptism does not appear as a technical condition of salvation, nor as a ritual that automatically produces a spiritual state. It is a visible sign of an inner movement already begun: awakening, turning, availability toward the truth. When Yeshua comes to John to be baptized and says: “Let it be so now, for thus it is fitting for us to fulfill all that must be fulfilled” (Matthew 3:15), he does not do it because he would need cleansing, but in order to confirm a work and an alignment already existing.

That is why, immediately after the baptism, “the heavens opened and the Spirit of God descended upon him” (Matthew 3:16). It is not the water that produces this opening, but the inner state that the baptism merely shows. In his message, Yeshua does not place baptism at the center of the call, but the Kingdom of God and lived repentance: “Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near” (Matthew 4:17).

He does not tell people “be baptized and you will be saved,” but “Follow me” (Matthew 9:9), and he shows that entry into true life depends on “the one who does the will of my Father” (Matthew 7:21). For Yeshua, salvation is visible in the fruit, not in the ritual. This becomes evident in the scene on the cross, when he tells the thief: “Today you will be with me in paradise” (Luke 23:43). The thief is not

baptized, undergoes no ritual, yet he is in a state of truth, humility, and openness.

This confirms clearly that, in Yeshua's perspective, baptism is not the obligatory gate of salvation. Moreover, Yeshua uses the term "baptism" also in a metaphorical sense, when he says: "I have a baptism with which to be baptized" (Luke 12:50). Here, baptism has nothing to do with water, but with a profound inner crossing, with fidelity to the truth to the very end. The essence of baptism is not the water, but the death of the old self and the birth of a new life.

The Apostle Paul takes up the image of baptism and gives it a clearer theological structure. He says that "all of us who were baptized into Christ Yeshua were baptized into his death" and that "we were buried with him through baptism" (Romans 6:3–4). For Paul, baptism is no longer merely a sign of an inner reality, but the act by which the human being enters symbolically into the death and resurrection of Christ.

It marks the rupture between the "old self" and the "new creation," so that "if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation" (2 Corinthians 5:17). Yet Paul lets an important tension be seen when he affirms: "Christ did not send me to baptize, but to preach the Gospel" (1 Corinthians 1:17). This shows that, although baptism has a significant role in the community, it is not the essence of transformation. The essence remains the message and the new life that flows from it.

Institutional Christianity took up to a large extent the Pauline reading and carried it further, transforming baptism into a sacrament necessary for salvation, into an act of erasing original sin, and into an indispensable condition of religious belonging. In many traditions, baptism comes to replace inner transformation. The person is baptized but remains unchanged. The ritual remains, the life is missing.

Yeshua had warned against this danger when he said: "This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me" (Matthew 15:8). In time, baptism often became an automatic act, sometimes performed without consciousness, without personal choice, and without visible fruit in life. The fundamental difference is clear. In Yeshua,

baptism is the external sign of an inner awakening and does not save through itself.

In Paul, baptism becomes the act of entry into Christ and into the new spiritual order. In the Christianity of today, baptism is often a sacramental condition, sometimes separated from real transformation. Yeshua, however, offers the simple and direct criterion: “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16). Not by baptism, not by ritual, but by the life lived. In the spirit of Yeshua, baptism is not a saving ritual, but the visible symbol of a death to the ego and the birth of a new life.

Water does not save, and ritual does not transform. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) remains the essence: freedom comes from the life lived in truth, and baptism is only the sign of this reality.

What Yeshua Understands by “Spiritual Warfare”

For Yeshua, spiritual warfare is not a war with external entities, but a process of awakening from blindness. He does not describe the human being as caught in a cosmic battle between equal forces, but as a being who suffers because he lives in untruth, fear, and separation. Evil is not personalized as an “external enemy,” but identified as an inner state that darkens vision.

“Know the truth, and the truth will set you free.” (John 8:32) “If the light within you is darkness, how great is that darkness!” (Matthew 6:23) Spiritual warfare, in Yeshua, is the struggle for clarity, not for domination. It is the confrontation between truth and illusion, between life and fear. That is why he does not call people to attack evil, but to remain in the light. He does not drive out fear through spiritual violence, but dissolves it through presence.

“Do not resist the one who is evil.” (Matthew 5:39) “The Kingdom of God is within you.” (Luke 17:21) For Yeshua, the greatest spiritual victory is the love that remains when it would have every reason to withdraw. That is why the climax of his “warfare” is not a spectacular exorcism, but the cross — the place where he refuses to answer evil with the same logic.

“Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing.” (Luke 23:34) Even when he speaks of demons, Yeshua does not treat them as a rival empire, but as manifestations of inner division. He does not construct a demonology, does not classify spirits, does not call to fear. He heals. “If Satan drives out Satan, he is divided against himself.” (Matthew 12:26) The real problem is not the existence of demons, but the divided house — the fragmented human being, the broken community, the divided heart.

Spiritual warfare is the restoration of unity, not the hunting of entities. In Paul, the language changes visibly. Spiritual warfare takes on a more conflictual and dualistic character. He speaks of powers, authorities, dominions, of a real confrontation between spiritual forces. “For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of the darkness of this age.” (Ephesians 6:12) For Paul, the human being is caught in a conflict in which inner clarity alone is not enough; armor, discipline, spiritual protection are needed.

“Put on the whole armor of God.” (Ephesians 6:11) The struggle is no longer only about seeing, but about resistance. Sin appears as an active force that “works” in the human being. “I see in my members another law, at war with the law of my mind.” (Romans 7:23) In Paul, spiritual warfare is continuous, tense, in which the human being remains fragile and dependent on grace. He does not speak of a stable state of freedom, but of a permanent inner battle.

The difference between Yeshua’s perspective and Paul’s is not one of belief, but of the level at which spiritual reality is approached. In Yeshua, spiritual warfare does not take the form of a conflict with external entities or powers, but is described as a coming out of blindness, as an awakening of consciousness. The principal enemy is not a personalized force, but the fear and untruth that darken the human being’s vision and separate him from life.

The method is not confrontation, but the truth lived, the love that remains, and the presence that illuminates without forcing. The aim of this struggle is not victory over someone, but the wholeness of the

human being, the restoration of inner unity. In Paul, by contrast, spiritual warfare takes the form of a real confrontation: evil is understood as active sin and as the powers that sustain it, and the human being is caught in a tension that requires discipline, grace, and a spiritual “armor” in order to be able to resist.

The aim becomes salvation and perseverance to the end — not so much the complete exit from the conflict as the crossing of it with faithfulness. Both speak of evil, but from different registers: Yeshua dissolves it through light, making it lose its power when it is seen, while Paul confronts it through structure, organizing spiritual life as a battle that must be waged and sustained.

Contemporary Christianity has come to understand “spiritual warfare” through a selective and amplified appropriation of Pauline language, to the point of transforming it into a dominant framework for interpreting reality. The struggle is no longer seen as a process of inner clarification, but as a permanent conflict with externalized “spiritual enemies”: demons, influences, invisible attacks.

In this register, inner discomfort, doubt, the crisis of meaning, or a difference of opinion are quickly reinterpreted as spiritual threats, not as natural stages of the maturing of consciousness. Evil is moved outward, and the human being is no longer called to see, but to defend himself. The profound irony is that exactly what Yeshua treated as blindness in need of light, modern Christianity treats as a danger to be combated.

Instead of the truth setting free, fear becomes the engine of spiritual life, and continuous vigilance takes the place of trust. “There is no fear in love; perfect love casts out fear” (1 John 4:18) thus remains not merely a beautiful verse, but a criterion that shows the rupture: where fear leads, spiritual warfare is no longer a road toward freedom, but a state of perpetual alertness that keeps the human being captive in exactly what it claims to want to overcome.

For Yeshua, spiritual warfare is never formulated in the terms that religion prefers when it feels threatened. He does not describe it as a hunt for the guilty, as an identity confrontation of the “us versus them”

type, nor as a justification of violence, be it even symbolic or “spiritualized.”

On the contrary, exactly these reflexes are radically stopped by him: “Put your sword back in its place” (Matthew 26:52) is not only a refusal of physical violence, but a deactivation of the entire conflictual logic by which the human being tries to defend the truth through force. Likewise, “Blessed are the peacemakers” (Matthew 5:9) is not a sentimental ideal, but a criterion of spiritual discernment: where peace is produced, the struggle has already ended.

For Yeshua, the true battle is not waged against others, but against the fear that demands enemies in order to feel legitimate. Spiritual warfare ceases the moment fear ceases, and victory consists not in winning an invisible war, but in the definitive exit from the logic of war itself.

Does the Christian Fight Against the Spirits and Powers?

One of the ideas that has profoundly shaped Christian spirituality is the image of spiritual warfare. In many traditions, the believer’s life is described as a continuous confrontation with invisible forces, with spirits, powers, and authorities. This image comes largely from Paul’s words: “For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of the darkness of this age, against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly places” (Ephesians 6:12).

In this vision, the world is a field of spiritual battle, and the believer is called to fight. But an essential question arises: is this also Yeshua’s perspective? If we read the Gospels attentively, we observe that Yeshua’s language and energy are radically different from the paradigm of spiritual warfare. Yeshua does not describe spiritual life as a continuous war with the forces of darkness. He describes rather a transformation of the heart.

Instead of saying that we must fight with the spirits, he says: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). The emphasis falls not on

the confrontation with an external reality, but on the awakening of an inner reality. In Yeshua's vision, the central problem of the human being is not a battle with invisible entities, but the blindness of the heart. That is why Yeshua does not teach people to fight with evil, but to transform their relationship with it.

When someone strikes him, he says: "If someone strikes you on the right cheek, turn to him the other also" (Matthew 5:39). When someone becomes an enemy, he does not say he should be combated spiritually, but says: "Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you" (Matthew 5:44). This approach is almost the opposite of the idea of spiritual confrontation. Instead of creating a battlefield between light and darkness, Yeshua proposes the disarming of the conflict through love.

Even when he speaks of evil, Yeshua does not treat it as an adversary that must be permanently combated. He says: "Do not resist the one who is evil" (Matthew 5:39). This affirmation is surprising if we compare it with the paradigm of spiritual warfare. In the logic of spiritual war, evil must be confronted, combated, and defeated. In the logic of Yeshua, evil is overcome through the transformation of the heart.

This difference becomes even clearer if we observe the way Yeshua speaks of light. He does not say that the light must fight with the darkness. He says: "The lamp of the body is the eye. If your eye is sound, your whole body will be full of light" (Matthew 6:22). The solution is not the fight with darkness, but the kindling of the light. Here the contrast with Paul's language appears.

Paul describes the believer's life in an almost military framework: "Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the schemes of the devil" (Ephesians 6:11). He speaks of the shield of faith, the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit. The image is clear: the believer is a soldier in a cosmic confrontation. But if we look at Yeshua's life, we observe that he does not live like a soldier in a spiritual war. He lives like a presence that dissolves the conflict.

When he is insulted, he does not counterattack. When he is accused, he remains silent. When he is killed, he does not call the angels to fight for him, but says: “Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing” (Luke 23:34). In this light, evil is not defeated through confrontation, but through consciousness. That is why Yeshua says: “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called sons of God” (Matthew 5:9). It is not the spiritual warriors who are declared blessed, but those who dissolve the conflict.

This does not mean that Yeshua denies the existence of evil or of suffering. But he shifts the emphasis from struggle to awakening. The central problem of the human being is not that he is attacked by spirits, but that he lives in a state of unconsciousness. That is why he says: “If the light that is in you is darkness, how great must that darkness be!” (Matthew 6:23). Thus, if we were to ask: what is the role of the Christian? — Paul would probably answer: to fight with the powers of darkness.

Yeshua would probably answer differently: to become light. That is why he says: “You are the light of the world” (Matthew 5:14). The light does not fight with the darkness. The light simply appears, and the darkness vanishes. In this perspective, true spiritual transformation does not come from a war with the darkness, but from an awakening of the heart.

And when the heart becomes light, what seemed to be a cosmic struggle begins to dissolve into a simpler and more profound reality: the kingdom of which Yeshua spoke is not a battlefield, but a state of consciousness in which love becomes stronger than fear.

From Healing to Control

The fundamental difference between the perspectives that have succeeded one another in the history of Christianity can be read in the way the human being in difficulty is regarded. In Yeshua, the encounter always begins with the wounded person. Yeshua does not begin from the deviation, but from the heart. He creates a space of truth in which a

person can be seen without shaming and called without constraint. “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick” (Luke 5:31).

The healing is inner, relational, and it occurs when fear withdraws and the truth can be breathed. In the Apostle Paul, the perspective shifts. Paul sees first of all the risk for the community and for the message that must be preserved. His intervention is disciplinary and corrective, not in order to exclude definitively, but in order to set the direction straight.

“Restore him gently” (Galatians 6:1) expresses this intention: the correction has a pedagogical purpose, and the community must be protected from disintegration. The truth is defended so that the common life may remain coherent. In the Christianity of today, the displacement often reaches another level. Instead of seeing a person or a risk of going astray, it sees a deviation from the norm. The reaction becomes defensive, meant to protect the image of the institution and the established framework.

The norm comes to count more than the human being, and conformity more than healing. “You tie up heavy burdens and lay them on people’s shoulders” (Matthew 23:4) describes exactly this shift. Yeshua heals from within, because he stakes everything on the truth that sets free. Paul corrects in order to preserve the direction, aware of the fragility of the community. Modern Christianity, however, often comes to control in order to calm its own fear.

And where fear leads, love withdraws. “There is no fear in love” (1 John 4:18) remains the criterion that unmask this inversion. The irony is profound and painful. In the name of holiness, exactly what Yeshua placed at the center is lost: the living human being. “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27) remains the conclusion that separates healing from control and shows, once again, the perspective that Yeshua refused to abandon.

Heresy in Yeshua

In the history of Christianity, the word “heresy” has come to mean almost exclusively a deviation from the correct formulation of the faith.

This meaning, however, is the result of a late evolution, tied to the institution, to authority, and to the need to mark doctrinal boundaries. If we return to Yeshua himself, the perspective changes radically. He does not judge the truth through concepts, but through life. He does not ask what you believe about God, but from what source you live.

In this light, “heresy” is not, first of all, a wrong idea, but a separation from the heart — a rupture between word and being. Yeshua does not condemn people because they think differently, but because they live in a fragmented way. He does not attack the question, but the hypocrisy; not the difference, but the lack of mercy; not the search, but religious self-sufficiency.

One of his harshest affirmations is not addressed to obvious sinners, but to those correct in doctrine yet absent in heart: “This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me” (Matthew 15:8). Here lies the implicit definition of heresy in Yeshua. You can utter true words and yet be outside the lived truth. Heresy is not the error of interpretation, but the life that does not flow from what is affirmed.

That is why the center of his message is not a doctrine, but a transformation. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) is not an abstract theological affirmation, but the shifting of the center from system to consciousness. The truth is not something that is accepted, but something into which one enters. And this entry produces visible fruit. “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16) becomes the supreme criterion. Not ideological conformity, but the life that is born from within.

In this light, the heretic is not the one who asks questions or explores new meanings, but the one who lives without love, even if he speaks “correctly.” The sign of authenticity is not doctrinal exactness, but the living relationship between people: “By this all will know that you are my disciples: if you have love for one another” (John 13:35). Heresy, in Yeshua, is not the deviation from a formula, but the loss of the living center. It is not the error of the mind, but the closing of the heart.

The question is no longer “who is right?” but “from what does your life live?” When we come to Paul, the perspective begins to shift. His

context is different. He does not speak in Galilee, among people who encounter Yeshua directly, but in young, fragile communities, set within a plural world full of competing doctrines, philosophies, and cults. Here a new need appears: protecting the message and maintaining communal coherence.

For Paul, heresy becomes, first of all, a deviation from the message received. “If anyone preaches to you a gospel other than the one you received, let him be accursed” (Galatians 1:9). The truth is no longer merely lived, but formulated, transmitted, and defended. In the same spirit, he writes: “As for a divisive person, after a first and second warning, have nothing to do with him” (Titus 3:10). Exclusion is not the aim, but an instrument of protection.

Heresy is what tears the common fabric, what produces confusion and weakens the community. And yet, even in this firmer approach, Paul does not entirely lose Yeshua’s perspective. He affirms, with a force that relativizes any doctrine separated from love: “Even if I had all faith... but did not have love, I would be nothing” (1 Corinthians 13:2).

Doctrine and love coexist, but the balance begins to tilt in favor of structure, because Paul builds communities within an unstable environment. In the institutional Christianity of today, this shift reaches its logical end. Heresy is no longer evaluated through the fruits of life, nor through the quality of the relationship, but through alignment with a set of dogmas, confessions, and authorities. The truth becomes a system of correct ideas, not a reality that transforms.

The paradox becomes evident: you can live without love and be “orthodox”; you can live in love and be “suspect.” Paul’s words take on a painful irony: “The letter kills, but the Spirit gives life” (2 Corinthians 3:6). Looking deeply, the difference between Yeshua, Paul, and the Christianity of today is not one of nuance, but of center of gravity. In Yeshua, heresy is the life that no longer flows from love and lived truth. In Paul, heresy is the message that breaks the unity of the community.

In present-day Christianity, heresy becomes deviation from dogma. From life, to message, to system — this is the trajectory. In this landscape, Yeshua’s question remains impossible to neutralize: “Why do

you call me ‘Lord, Lord!’ and do not do what I tell you?” (Luke 6:46). The ultimate criterion is not “what do you believe?” but “from what do you live?” Not theological correctness, but the source of your life. In the light of Yeshua, the greatest heresy is not the wrong idea, but the closed heart.

A heart that becomes rigid, that defends itself, that prefers the safety of the system to the risk of love, becomes the place where the truth can no longer enter. The truth has no need of ideological defense. It is recognized through life, through the freedom it produces, through its capacity to heal and to unite.

When Yeshua says: “I am the Way, the Truth, and the Life” (John 14:6), he does not point to a system that must be guarded, nor to a doctrine that must be defended, but to an existence lived from presence. Wherever the truth is reduced to a concept, heresy becomes inevitable, because life is sacrificed in the name of correctness. Wherever the truth is lived, the labels lose their meaning, because what is alive no longer needs to justify itself.

In this place, heresy can no longer be defined through what you think wrongly, but through what you refuse to love.

Would Paul Have Considered Yeshua a Heretic?

The Apostle Paul is a theologian of structure, of formulated truth, of doctrinal delimitation. He operates with clear formulas: “if anyone preaches another gospel...” For Paul, deviation from the message is an existential risk for the community. Yeshua, however, does not preach “a formulated gospel,” but an experience of the truth. He speaks in parables, fertile ambiguities, silences, questions. He refuses to answer directly. He does not define doctrines about himself.

In Pauline terms, this style might seem dangerously unclear. Especially if Yeshua were to relativize the application of the Law, criticize the religious leaders, and place love of one’s neighbor above conformity. It is perfectly plausible that Paul, in his phase as a defender of the truth, would suspect him of heresy — not because Yeshua would

be wrong, but because lived truth precedes formulated truth. And Paul operates in the opposite direction.

11. Yeshua in the Real World

Was Yeshua a Conservative or a Progressive? A Socialist or a Capitalist?

The question of whether Yeshua was a conservative or a progressive, a socialist or a capitalist, arises naturally from the modern desire to place him within a familiar political grid. The problem is that these categories are historically anachronistic and ontologically insufficient for Yeshua's message. He does not come to adjust an existing social system, nor to propose a new one; he comes to change the meaning from which people live. From that changed meaning, social structures rearrange themselves—but not through ideology, rather through inner transformation. Seen superficially, Yeshua appears conservative. He quotes the Scriptures, speaks about the Law, moves within Jewish tradition, and declares: “I have not come to abolish the Law, but to fulfill it” (Matthew 5:17). This statement has often been used to align him with a conservative position, one of preserving order.

But the way he “fulfills” the Law undermines any classic conservatism: he shifts the center from the letter to the heart, from the norm to conscience, from control to lived truth (Matthew 5). Conservatism preserves the form; Yeshua preserves the meaning and abandons the form when it kills life. At the same time, Yeshua appears deeply progressive. He breaks down social barriers, speaks with women in a patriarchal culture (John 4), touches the “unclean” (Mark 1:40–42), eats with the marginalized (Mark 2:15–17), and proclaims radical reversals of hierarchy: “the last will be first” (Matthew 20:16). These gestures

resemble a social progressivism *avant la lettre*. Yet Yeshua does not fight for rights through political confrontation, and he does not demand changes to the laws of the state.

His progressivism is not programmatic but ontological: he changes the way one sees the human being before changing any structures. When we shift the discussion to the economic plane, the temptation to call him a “socialist” arises quickly. Yeshua speaks harshly about wealth, warns against accumulation (“do not store up treasures on earth”—Matthew 6:19), demands renunciation where attachment becomes an idol (Mark 10:21), and describes communities of sharing (Acts 2:44–45, as a later effect).

But Yeshua does not propose imposed redistribution and does not create an economic system. He does not ask the state to confiscate and distribute; he asks the individual to detach. For Yeshua, solidarity is voluntary, born of freedom, not of coercion. On the other hand, Yeshua is not a capitalist. Capitalism presupposes the maximization of self-interest, competition, and accumulation as a virtue.

Yeshua says explicitly that life does not consist in an abundance of goods (Luke 12:15), that you cannot serve money as a master (Matthew 6:24), and that security built on accumulation produces fear (Matthew 6:25–34). In his parables, the critique is not against work or initiative, but against the reduction of life to profit (Luke 12:16–21). He does not demonize property; he demonizes identification with it. Yeshua constantly refuses political power.

After the multiplication of the loaves, when the crowd wants to make him king, he withdraws (John 6:15). To the question about taxes, he answers without legitimizing or contesting the system: “Give to Caesar what is Caesar’s” (Mark 12:17). This refusal shows clearly that Yeshua does not want to be a political reformer. He does not change the world by seizing power, but by changing the center from which people live. This is why his language is consistently trans-ideological.

He does not say “change the system,” but “do not be afraid” (Luke 12:32). He does not say “redistribute by law,” but “sell, give, and follow me” (Mark 10:21). He does not say “revolt,” but “blessed are the

meek” (Matthew 5:5). These are not slogans of the left or the right; they are shifts of consciousness that make both camps uncomfortable. Conservatism feels threatened by the relativizing of religious form. Progressivism feels frustrated by the absence of a coercive program. Capitalism is undermined by the critique of the idol of money. Socialism is contradicted by the refusal of constraint. Yeshua aligns himself with no ideology, because he does not begin from the question of the distribution of power, but from the healing of the fear that makes power necessary. In conclusion, Yeshua is neither conservative nor progressive in the political sense. He is neither socialist nor capitalist. He is radical in another register altogether. He changes the human being before changing the world.

And when the human being changes, the world rearranges itself without any further need for labels. Yeshua did not come to choose a system. He came to show what happens when a person no longer lives out of fear.

Yeshua and Money

The way Yeshua speaks about money and social status is one of the most radical and most uncomfortable aspects of his message. Not because he condemns possession in itself or the social order as such, but because he sees in money and status the most subtle forms of idolatry: mechanisms by which a person shifts the source of his security away from God and onto control, accumulation, and external validation.

Yeshua does not treat money as a mere economic instrument, but as a spiritual indicator. “Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” (Matthew 6:21) is not a moral warning but an existential diagnosis. The heart follows whatever promises security. This is why the problem is not that a person has money, but that money comes to possess the person. This perspective explains one of Yeshua’s harshest statements: “You cannot serve two masters... you cannot serve God and Mammon” (Matthew 6:24). Mammon is not merely money as an object, but money as a master, as a principle of life. Yeshua does not say that

money is evil, but that it becomes incompatible with God when it occupies the place of the ultimate source of security. Here, economics becomes theology. Yeshua observes that attachment to money produces fear.

This is why his discourse about money is always tied to his discourse about fear: “do not be anxious about your life” (Matthew 6:25). The obsessive concern for accumulation is not prudence but the expression of a life lived out of lack. For Yeshua, true wealth is not the quantity of resources, but the absence of the need to defend oneself through them. The episode of the rich young man is essential. When Yeshua tells him, “sell all you have... and come, follow me” (Mark 10:21), he is not proposing a universal economic program. He identifies precisely the place where that man’s heart is bound. The young man’s sadness does not come from the loss of his goods, but from the impossibility of giving up his false source of identity. This is why Yeshua concludes: “How hard it will be for those who have wealth to enter the Kingdom of God” (Mark 10:23). The difficulty is not moral but inner. The same logic applies to social status. Yeshua lives in a world deeply organized by hierarchy: pure–impure, rich–poor, learned–unlearned, man–woman.

He does not deny the existence of these structures, but he constantly undermines them from within. He draws near to those without status, eats with the marginalized, praises the faith of the despised (Mark 2:15–17; Luke 7:44–50). Status is not a criterion of truth. Repeatedly, Yeshua inverts the social logic: “the last will be first” (Matthew 20:16).

This statement is not a promise of social revenge, but the disclosure of the fact that status is a fragile construction, without relevance in the order of the Kingdom. True worth is not given by position, but by presence and inner freedom. Yeshua is especially attentive to the danger of religious symbolic capital. The Pharisees are not criticized for being rich, but for drawing their identity from their moral and religious position. “Woe to you... for you love the place of honor” (Matthew 23:6). Status becomes an idol when it is used to feel “above” others. Here, religion and status meet in a refined form of possession. Another essential element is the way Yeshua refuses political power and mass

appeal. After the multiplication of the loaves, the crowd wants to make him king, and he withdraws (John 6:15).

Yeshua understands that popularity is a form of symbolic wealth, and that power is a form of accumulation. Both create dependence and distort the message. This is why he prefers to lose followers rather than gain influence (John 6:66). In Yeshua's parables, the rich are not automatically condemned, but they are constantly warned. The rich man whose land produced a good harvest is called a "fool" not because he gathered, but because he reduced his life to material security (Luke 12:16–21). The rich man in the parable of Lazarus is not accused of active cruelty, but of an indifference born of comfort (Luke 16:19–31). For Yeshua, wealth numbs the senses. In the end, Yeshua's vision of money and status is not ascetic but liberating. He does not demand poverty as a virtue, but freedom from anything that promises security in place of God. Money and status are not evil in themselves, but they become dangerous when they replace trust.

So, for Yeshua, the problem is not how much you have, but what you live from. Money and status can be used. But they cannot be served.

Yeshua on Sexuality

Although Christianity is often perceived as profoundly preoccupied with sexuality, Yeshua speaks surprisingly little about this subject. And when he does, he does not construct a detailed sexual morality, but shifts the attention toward the heart, relationship, and responsibility. Yeshua does not preach about sexuality as a central theme. He does not classify practices, he does not build a code of the permitted and the forbidden, he does not fix sexuality as a major theological problem.

In the Gospels, the dominant themes are: the Kingdom of God, fear, money, power, religious hypocrisy, love, and forgiveness. Sexuality appears rarely and always in relational rather than doctrinal contexts. This silence is not accidental. It shows that, for Yeshua, sexuality is not the center of the human problem. A person is not called to correct his

biological impulses in order to be accepted by God, but to clarify the inner center from which he lives.

When Yeshua addresses sexuality explicitly, he does so to reveal an inner dynamic, not to institute rules. “Anyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in his heart” (Matthew 5:28). This statement is often read as a moral tightening, but its intention is different: Yeshua shifts the problem from the act to objectification.

For Yeshua, sexuality becomes problematic when the other is reduced to an object of desire, when relationship is replaced by consumption. The sin is not eros, but dehumanization. This is why Yeshua speaks about the purity of the heart (Matthew 5:8), not about the obsessive control of the body. Yeshua does not moralize about the sexuality of the marginalized. His relationship with the woman caught in adultery (John 8:3–11) is emblematic: he refuses to condemn her, refuses to shame her publicly, and refuses to turn her sexuality into a permanent identity. “Neither do I condemn you” precedes any invitation to change. Likewise, Yeshua eats and sits at table with those considered “immoral” (Matthew 9:10–13). Sexuality does not become a criterion for exclusion from nearness to God. For Yeshua, the problem is not what you have done, but what you live from now.

When he speaks about marriage, Yeshua quotes Genesis: “the two will become one flesh” (Matthew 19:5). The emphasis is not on the sexual act but on relational unity. Sexuality is understood as the expression of a whole relationship, not as an autonomous zone that must be controlled. Even here, Yeshua avoids constructing a sexual legislation. He acknowledges human complexity (“not everyone can receive this word”—Matthew 19:11) and leaves room for discernment, not for rigid standardization. With Paul, sexuality becomes much more visible and much more regulated. Paul writes to young communities confronted with moral chaos and cultural confusion, and sexuality becomes a sensitive terrain. He introduces a new language: the body as a “temple of the Holy Spirit” (1 Corinthians 6:19).

This metaphor moves sexuality from the relational sphere into the sphere of the regulated sacred. Sexuality is no longer only about the other, but about right relation to God. Paul speaks about debauchery, sexual immorality, self-control (1 Corinthians 6–7) and even recommends abstinence as an ideal, with marriage as a pragmatic solution: “it is better to marry than to burn” (1 Corinthians 7:9). In Paul, a hierarchy clearly appears: virginity is preferable, marriage is a concession, sexuality is potentially dangerous. This hierarchy is absent in Yeshua. The Christianity that came after Paul would amplify this direction. Sexuality becomes: the principal ground of guilt, a criterion of purity, an instrument of moral control, a zone of religious obsession. Detailed rules develop about what is permitted and forbidden, and the body is often regarded with suspicion.

Desire is associated with sin, pleasure with danger, and sexuality becomes one of the principal sources of religious shame. This shift has profound effects: people who feel separated from God not because they live in hatred or injustice, but because they feel desire. This would be a grave distortion of Yeshua’s perspective, for whom the real problem was fear, not eros. In the Gospels, sexuality does not appear as a central theme of Yeshua’s teaching. He does not construct an obsessive moral discourse about the body, desire, or sexual behavior, but constantly shifts attention toward the heart and toward the way people relate to one another. When he addresses the subject, he does so not to shame, but to expose objectification and the absence of love.

“Anyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in his heart” (Matthew 5:28) is not a condemnation of desire, but of the transformation of the other into an object of inner consumption. The problem is not attraction, but the loss of the living relationship and the reduction of the person to a function. Yeshua refuses to shame and to exclude. Before the woman caught in adultery, he does not feed the crowd’s moralizing spectacle, but simply says: “Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone” (John 8:7). When the accusers leave, his words are liberating: “Neither do I condemn you” (John 8:11). Yeshua does not treat sexuality as a dirty

zone of the human being, but as a place where shame and judgment can be dissolved through truth and where dignity can be restored.

His emphasis remains on the interior, on the quality of the relationship, and on the purity of the heart: “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God” (Matthew 5:8). Purity is not rigid behavioral control, but an inner transparency in which the other is not used but loved. In this logic, sexuality is one of the expressions of life, not the center of the human problem. With Paul, however, the tone changes. Sexuality becomes a sensitive zone in the life of the Christian community, a space that must be regulated in order to preserve the cohesion and holiness of the group. “Flee from sexual immorality” (1 Corinthians 6:18) is a direct exhortation, and his argument is theological and bodily: “Your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit” (1 Corinthians 6:19). The body takes on a sacral dimension that demands discipline and control.

Paul idealizes abstinence as the preferable state: “It is good for a man not to touch a woman” (1 Corinthians 7:1), and he sees marriage as a solution for avoiding the burning of passion: “if they cannot control themselves, they should marry” (1 Corinthians 7:9). Sexuality thus becomes a domain that must be carefully administered, so as not to deviate from the spiritual calling. The emphasis is no longer only on the heart and relationship, but on discipline and communal order.

In later Christianity, this concern is amplified and often transformed into a moral obsession. Sexuality comes to be treated as the principal field of spiritual struggle, and shame and guilt become pedagogical instruments. The body becomes suspect, desire becomes dangerous, and fear is used to shape behavior. What in Yeshua was freed from shame becomes once again laden with it.

Thus a subtle but profound shift occurs: from the healing of the relationship to the control of behavior, from the purity of the heart to the surveillance of the body. Yeshua frees the person from shame and brings them back into dignity; later theology reloads the body with suspicion and fear. Yeshua did not come to correct people’s sexuality, but the way people look at and use one another. For him, the problem is not desire but objectification; not the body but the heart that loses love. When

sexuality becomes a religious obsession, it is a sign that attention has moved from truth and relationship to control and fear. Yeshua frees the body from shame; later interpretations loaded it again.

Yeshua on Homosexuality

The subject of homosexuality has become one of the most emotionally charged in contemporary Christianity—not because Yeshua spoke about it at length, but precisely because he did not speak about it at all. While later theology transformed this subject into a major moral criterion, the Gospels preserve a complete silence. This silence is not an accidental omission, but a profound theological indication of what Yeshua considered truly central in human life.

In the Gospels, Yeshua speaks extensively about fear, about money and power, about religious hypocrisy, about judgment, about love, forgiveness, and compassion. By contrast, he does not discuss sexual orientations, he does not classify types of relationships, and he does not construct an ethics of desire based on gender. This absence is all the more relevant given that homosexuality was known in the Greco-Roman world of the time. If he had considered it a central problem of the human condition, he would have addressed it.

Instead, Yeshua constantly shifts attention from labels to the heart: “Do not judge, so that you will not be judged” (Matthew 7:1) and “Out of the heart come evil thoughts” (Matthew 15:19) show that, for him, the human problem is not whom one loves, but from what inner center one loves. And this completely shifts the discussion. When Yeshua speaks about morality, the supreme criterion is love: “Love your neighbor as yourself. On these two commandments hang all the Law and the Prophets” (Matthew 22:39–40). Love becomes the measure of all relationships, not conformity to a social or biological pattern. In his encounters with people, Yeshua constantly refuses to exclude on the basis of reputation or the perception of “immorality.” He eats with those considered undesirable (Matthew 9:10–13), refuses public shaming, and restores the dignity of the stigmatized.

I know this is hard for many to accept, but any reading that turns Yeshua into an arbiter of sexual orientations comes into direct tension with his concrete behavior. It is often invoked that Yeshua quotes Genesis: “From the beginning, God made them male and female” (Matthew 19:4) as an argument for the exclusion of other forms of relationship. But the context is essential: Yeshua is answering a question about divorce and the superficiality with which men abandoned their wives. He uses Genesis to protect the fidelity and dignity of the relationship, not to create a doctrine of exclusion. His emphasis is on responsibility and permanence, not on limiting love to a single formula. With Paul, however, the discourse changes.

Paul explicitly mentions relationships between persons of the same sex in passages such as Romans 1:26–27 and 1 Corinthians 6:9. These texts appear in a cultural context marked by practices of sexual exploitation, pederasty, relationships of power, and idolatrous rituals in which sexuality was used as an instrument. Paul does not analyze orientation as a psychological identity—a concept that did not exist then—but behaviors that he sees as expressions of moral disorder in a world far from God. Still, by including these behaviors in a list of sins, sexuality enters into a juridical logic of guilt, different from Yeshua’s relational approach. Later Christianity would take a further step and transform these verses into criteria of identity.

Homosexuality is no longer regarded as a behavior within a specific historical context, but as a sign of depravity, an ontological deviation, and a threat to the divine order. From this shift derive stigmatization, exclusion, and shaming, and love comes to be associated with guilt. In many traditions, homosexuality becomes graver than a lack of compassion, injustice, or hypocrisy—a hierarchy of sins foreign to Yeshua’s priorities.

The difference in perspective is clear. In Yeshua there is no explicit discourse about homosexuality and no attempt to define or condemn it. He evaluates relationships by truth, fidelity, and the capacity to love without dominating or objectifying. In Paul, homosexuality appears as part of a list of behaviors within a logic of moral order. In later

Christianity, it becomes a condemned identity, and fear and shame are amplified theologically. Yeshua did not come to classify people's sexual orientations, but to free relationships from fear, shame, and violence. If someone were to ask him what he says about homosexuality, his answer would not be a label, but a deeper question, in keeping with everything he says and does: "Do you love in truth?" and "By their fruits you will know them" (Matthew 7:16). For Yeshua, this is the measure. The rest are constructions that appeared later.

How Yeshua Views Monogamy

Yeshua does not speak about monogamy as a social rule, but as a consequence of inner truth. When he is asked about marriage, he does not begin with norms but with unity: "the two will become one flesh" (Genesis 2:24, quoted in Matthew 19:5). For Yeshua, monogamy is not a contract of exclusivity but the expression of a wholeness. Where a person is fragmented, the relationship becomes possessive. Where a person is whole, exclusivity appears naturally, not by imposition.

Yeshua does not praise monogamy as a virtue in itself. He does not elevate it to the rank of a separate moral ideal. He speaks about truth and about the heart. "Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also" (Matthew 6:21). Monogamy, in Yeshua's logic, is the stability that appears when the heart is no longer pulled in opposite directions by fear, lack, or the need for validation. This is why Yeshua does not construct a discourse about fidelity as an obligation, but about presence. Betrayal, adultery, flight are not, for him, behavioral problems, but signs of a heart that can no longer remain. "Anyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in his heart" (Matthew 5:28). Here Yeshua shifts the discussion from the exterior to the interior: the problem is not the act, but the inner detachment that precedes the act.

What Yeshua Says About Divorce

Divorce is one of the few subjects on which Yeshua appears harsh. “What God has joined together, let no one separate” (Matthew 19:6). But the harshness is not juridical but ontological. Yeshua does not defend the institution of marriage; he defends the reality of the union. When two people have become “one flesh,” separation is not neutral. It tears something real, not merely a contract.

Yet Yeshua introduces an essential nuance: “Moses permitted you to divorce your wives because of the hardness of your hearts” (Matthew 19:8). Here Yeshua explicitly acknowledges that there are situations in which the heart can no longer live the truth of the union. Divorce is not the ideal, but neither is it condemned as an absolute sin. It is a concession made to human fragility, not a command. What matters is that Yeshua never says: “stay together at any cost.” He says: the truth of the union cannot be mimicked. When the relationship has become a place of fear, domination, lies, or inner death, preserving the form no longer serves life. Yeshua is radical not in the direction of preserving the institution, but in the direction of authenticity. Paul takes up Yeshua’s words about marriage, but moves them into a different framework. He thinks in terms of the organization of the community, not of inner experience.

In 1 Corinthians 7, Paul says explicitly: “Each one should remain in the condition in which the calling found him” (1 Corinthians 7:20). Stability becomes a value in itself, in order to avoid communal chaos. For Paul, marriage is often a practical solution: “it is better to marry than to burn” (1 Corinthians 7:9). Here the major difference from Yeshua becomes visible. In Yeshua, the relationship is the expression of a whole heart. In Paul, the relationship becomes a mechanism for regulating desire. This is not wrong, but it is clearly a different level of approach. Regarding divorce, Paul introduces explicit rules, including situations of accepted separation (1 Corinthians 7:15). The emphasis falls on order, peace, functionality. Paul does not speak from the realm of existential revelation, but from the realm of administering reality. He

does not directly contradict Yeshua, but neither does he remain at the same depth.

Institutional Christianity took up mainly the Pauline reading and transformed it into moral law. Monogamy became a criterion of belonging. Divorce became a label. The relationship was removed from the realm of inner truth and moved into the realm of religious status. Today, in many Christian contexts, marriage is defended even when it is inwardly dead. The form is defended at the expense of life. Divorce is condemned without asking what has already died inside.

This is exactly the inversion of Yeshua's message, who said that "the Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath" (Mark 2:27). The relationship was made for life, not life for the relationship. Today's Christianity speaks much about fidelity and little about presence. About covenant and little about truth. About sin and little about fear. Within this framework, monogamy becomes constraint, not expression. Divorce becomes shame, not the sign of a human limit. For Yeshua, monogamy is the truth of a whole heart. For Paul, it is a solution of order and stability. For today's Christianity, it has often become a norm of identity. Yeshua does not ask: "Did you stay?" His question is more radical: "Did you stay alive?"

The Family in Yeshua's Vision

For Yeshua, the family is neither abolished nor absolutized. He does not attack it, but neither does he raise it to the supreme rank of human life. In his words and gestures a positioning appears that differs from the traditional one: the family is important, but it is not the ultimate authority over a person's conscience. Yeshua honors the old commandment: "Honor your father and your mother" (Exodus 20:12). He rebukes those who empty it of meaning through religious artifices, showing that respect for parents must be real, not merely declared: "You have nullified the Word of God by your tradition" (Mark 7:9–13). For him, the family deserves genuine care and responsibility. But this honoring is not blind. It does not mean unconditional submission, nor the sacrifice

of inner truth for the apparent peace of the family. Honoring does not cancel discernment.

The rupture appears when the family becomes an obstacle in the path of lived truth. “Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me” (Matthew 10:37). The statement is not emotional but axiological: nothing external can take priority over truth. For Yeshua, blood ties can sustain life, but they cannot define it. When the family demands conformity at the expense of conscience, it must be relativized.

This relativization is seen clearly when he is told that his mother and brothers are looking for him. Yeshua answers: “Who is my mother, and who are my brothers?... Whoever does the will of my Father is my brother and sister and mother” (Matthew 12:48–50). He does not reject the biological family but extends the meaning of family. Belonging is no longer dictated by blood, but by the level of consciousness. The family becomes a community of meaning, not a structure of possession.

Yeshua also refuses the idea that duty to family can justify postponing one’s personal calling: “Let the dead bury their own dead; you go and proclaim the Kingdom of God” (Luke 9:60). This is not a lack of compassion, but a delimitation between a life lived out of inertia and a life lived out of calling. When the family becomes an excuse for not living authentically, it ceases to be a support and becomes a chain.

In Yeshua’s vision, relationships are not meant to preserve emotional childhood, but to facilitate maturation. “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). This freedom includes liberation from unconscious loyalties, from inherited guilt, from imposed roles. The family that demands the sacrifice of the self is not supported by Yeshua. The family that allows becoming, yes. Is the family the most important thing for Yeshua? The answer is clear: no. The most important thing is lived truth and the Kingdom of God as an inner state: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). The family is important only insofar as it does not replace this calling. Paradoxically, it is precisely through this relativization that the family can be loved more purely. Not out of fear, not out of obligation, but out of freedom.

“Seek first the Kingdom of God” (Matthew 6:33). In this order, the family is not lost—it is healed.

Yeshua on Alcohol

Yeshua drank wine. He takes part in meals, at weddings, at feasts, and his religious contemporaries criticize him precisely for this freedom, saying that “the Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, ‘Here is a glutton and a drunkard’” (Matthew 11:19). At the wedding in Cana, Yeshua not only accepts the presence of wine but turns water into wine, and the guests observe that “you have kept the good wine until now” (John 2:10). Such an episode would be incomprehensible if Yeshua had been against alcohol in itself. Along the same line, he affirms that “it is not what enters the mouth that defiles a person, but what comes out of the mouth” (Matthew 15:11). The problem is not the substance, but the inner state of the person. Yeshua does not preach abstinence and does not turn the spiritual life into an austere regimen. He shifts attention from the object to consciousness.

When he speaks about drunkenness, Yeshua does not treat it as a ritual violation, but as a loss of presence and inner watchfulness. He warns: “Watch yourselves, lest your hearts be weighed down with dissipation, drunkenness, and the cares of this life” (Luke 21:34). Drunkenness is, for him, a state of numbing of consciousness, the opposite of the call to lucidity. This is why he says: “Watch and pray” (Matthew 26:41). The call is not to puritanism but to sobriety. Yeshua clearly distinguishes himself from the radical asceticism of John the Baptist. “John came neither eating nor drinking... the Son of Man came eating and drinking” (Matthew 11:18–19). This opposition is essential: Yeshua’s spirituality is not manifested through the refusal of life, but through the free and conscious way of living it. He shows that the Kingdom does not depend on dietary rules or prohibitions, but on the state of the heart.

If he were asked about drunkenness, Yeshua would not place the emphasis on quantity, but on motive. A pure heart, of which he says

“blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God” (Matthew 5:8), is a lucid, unfragmented heart. Drunkenness does the opposite: it breaks contact with oneself, with others, and with God. The apostle Paul approaches the issue in a more normative way. He accepts the existence of wine, but draws clear lines against excess, saying: “Do not get drunk on wine, which is debauchery” (Ephesians 5:18) and “let us live decently... not in carousing and drunkenness” (Romans 13:13). For Paul, the body is a “temple,” and behavior must be managed with discernment. This is why he affirms: “Everything is permitted to me, but not everything is beneficial” (1 Corinthians 6:12). Yet Paul is not a radical abstainer. He recommends to Timothy: “Stop drinking only water, and use a little wine because of your stomach” (1 Timothy 5:23). So he does not condemn alcohol, but the loss of measure and self-control.

Contemporary Christianity often oscillates between extremes. Some currents promote a moralizing abstinence and try to forcibly reinterpret the Gospel episodes; others adopt a freedom without discernment; and still others accept wine only in a liturgical context, but regard it with suspicion in real life. None of these positions fully reflects Yeshua’s lucid freedom. His words “the Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27) can be applied here as well: things are for the human being, not the human being for things. Consumption in itself is not the problem, but the relationship you have with it. From Yeshua’s perspective, you can drink wine and remain spiritually awake if you remain present, free, and unattached. From Paul’s perspective, you can do this if you remain in measure and self-control. From the rigid religious perspective, the rule tends at times to replace discernment. Yeshua drank wine, but he did not lose himself in it. He celebrated life, but did not let himself be absorbed by it. He says that he came “so that the sheep may have life, and have it abundantly” (John 10:10). The abundance he speaks of is not excess, but a living, conscious, and free presence in everything you do.

How Yeshua Would Heal a Person Addicted to Drugs

The Gospels reveal a surprising pattern: Yeshua never begins with the symptom, but with the person. He does not treat the behavior before restoring belonging. He does not demand change before giving back dignity. In our modern language we would say that he does not begin with the “drug problem,” but with the “problem of the lost son.” This is why, if we ask ourselves how Yeshua would heal an addicted person, we must shift our gaze from the substance to the soul, from consumption to identity, from shame to belonging. In the parable of the prodigal son, the father does not demand explanations before the embrace. “While he was still far off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion; he ran and fell on his neck and kissed him” (Luke 15:20). This order is essential: first the nearness, then the conversation.

An addict often lives in an inner exile, in shame, self-contempt, and isolation. Yeshua would first restore belonging: “You still belong. You are still a son.” Only afterward would the call to change come. The same thing happens when Yeshua eats together with tax collectors and sinners. “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick” (Luke 5:31). The table is not a reward for virtue, but a medicine for alienation. His presence at the table is the declaration that the person is not reduced to his label. In the case of addiction, where identity compresses into “you are a junkie,” Yeshua would break this reduction through communion, not through preaching. Another constant pattern is the separation of the person from the behavior. In the episode of the woman caught in adultery, Yeshua says: “Neither do I condemn you. Go, and sin no more” (John 8:11).

The order matters: first he removes the condemnation, then he calls to a new life. Addiction feeds on shame; shame sustains the cycle. By removing the condemnation, Yeshua would cut the inner fuel of addiction before speaking about renunciation. The Gospels show something else subtle: around him, people grow calm. The storm subsides: “He commanded the wind and said to the sea, ‘Be still!’ The wind ceased, and there was a great calm” (Mark 4:39). The possessed

man of Gadara comes to be “clothed and in his right mind” (Mark 5:15). In contemporary language, we would say that his presence regulates the nervous system. Addiction is often a desperate search for regulation through chemical shortcuts. Yeshua would offer what the substance promises and cannot give: security without escape, peace without numbness. Yeshua does not first offer new rules, but a new identity. “You are no longer slaves... but sons” (Galatians 4:7).

When identity changes, behavior begins to follow. The world tells the addict: “You are weak, you are broken, you are a problem.” Yeshua would say: “You are a son. You are a daughter.” Not: “Stop the drugs so that you may be worthy,” but: “You are worthy; that is why you no longer need them.” His call is an invitation, not a constraint: “Come, follow me” (Matthew 4:19). Addiction is compulsion, the loss of choice. Yeshua restores inner freedom through nearness and meaning. When a person feels once again that he can choose, he begins to step out of the circle in which he was trapped. What would this healing look like, concretely? It would not begin with detox, with prohibitions, or with moralizing. It would begin with sitting together, with the shared meal, with the gaze that does not recoil in disgust. It would be followed by the word that names who you are, not what you do. It would continue with the calm that settles into the body, with the breath that slows, with the shame that melts away.

And only then would the simple sentence come: “You no longer need this.” And the person, for the first time, might be able to believe it. The essence is this: Yeshua would not first try to remove the drug from the person, but the reason the drug became necessary. When the cause disappears, the symptom loses its power. This is why healing in the Gospels is not a program for correcting behavior, but a restoration of the person. And where the person is restored, addiction no longer has anywhere to dwell.

12. Yeshua in Today's World

The false prophets of the last days

“In the last days many false prophets will arise” (Matthew 24:11). Few of Yeshua’s statements have been so frequently invoked to instill fear, justify exclusions, and reinforce religious authorities. Read, however, in his own logic rather than in the institutional logic that developed later, this sentence describes not an apocalyptic scenario populated by mysterious figures, but a condition of human consciousness.

The “last days” are not merely a historical moment, but those recurring periods in which a person loses inner discernment and begins to seek truth on the outside: in the spiritual leader, in doctrine, in the promise of salvation offered by someone else. That is why Yeshua’s immediate warning is surprisingly personal: “See to it that no one deceives you” (Matthew 24:4). The emphasis does not fall on identifying others, but on inner vigilance.

He does not say who will come, but what can happen to you. The problem is not the appearance of false prophets, but the loss of your own capacity to see. In his vision, the false prophet is not defined primarily by doctrinal error, but by the absence of living fruit. The criterion shifts radically from “what he says” to “what he produces.” This shift becomes explicit when Yeshua says: “Beware of false prophets, who come to you in sheep’s clothing but inwardly are ravenous wolves. You will know them by their fruits” (Matthew 7:15–16). A false prophet may speak impeccably, may quote Scripture, may invoke the name of God, but his fruit is fear, separation, and

dependence. He does not bring you closer to truth, but to himself. He does not make you alive, but compliant. Precisely for this reason, Yeshua warns against seeking truth on the outside, as an exclusive presence or a sacralized place: "If they say to you, 'Look, here is the Christ' or 'There he is,' do not believe it" (Matthew 24:23).

Truth does not come in order to be followed blindly, but in order to be recognized inwardly. It does not create attachment to a person, but clarity within you. In Paul's writings, however, an important shift of emphasis appears. His context is different: young, fragile communities, exposed to multiple influences. The danger is no longer authority without love, but the wrong message, which can destabilize the shared faith. Discernment is no longer predominantly inner, but doctrinal.

That is why he writes: "The time is coming when people will not endure sound teaching, but will gather to themselves teachers to suit their own desires" (2 Timothy 4:3). For Paul, the false prophet is the one who preaches "another gospel," and truth becomes something that must be guarded, delimited, and defended: "Even if we or an angel from heaven should preach to you a gospel contrary to the one we preached to you, let him be accursed" (Galatians 1:8).

This shift would decisively influence the way institutional Christianity would understand, over the centuries, the idea of the false prophet. In many contemporary contexts, Yeshua's warning is applied almost exclusively to those outside the accepted boundaries: other denominations, other religions, other interpretations. Discernment turns into suspicion, and truth becomes property.

Thus we arrive at the painful paradox that Yeshua himself was considered a false prophet by the religious authority of his own time, precisely because he did not align himself with the dominant interpretation. Of him it was said: "He has a demon and is leading the people astray" (John 7:12). Read in the spirit of Yeshua, the warning about false prophets is not an invitation to hunt down others, but to recognize any voice that interposes itself between a person and the truth.

Any teaching that produces fear, dependence, and separation, no matter how theologically correct it sounds, does not come from truth.

Because, as he says clearly: “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32). If it does not make you free, if it does not bring you closer to yourself, to life, and to love, then it is not truth.

This, in the end, is the true “last days”: the moment in which a person is placed before a subtle but decisive choice, between authority and presence, between fear and living truth, between following someone and seeing with one's own eyes.

What Yeshua would say about today's Christianity

The Gospels show clearly that Yeshua was never a validator of religious systems, but a discerner of the heart. That is why his reaction would not be a global one (“good” or “bad”), but a differentiated one: He would separate life from ideology, love from fear, truth from power. Yeshua's first question would not be about dogma, morality, or ritual, but about the Kingdom. “The Kingdom of God is near... it is in your midst” (Mark 1:15; Luke 17:21).

Today's Christianity speaks much about salvation, but relatively little about the Kingdom as life lived now. For Yeshua, the observation would be quiet but radical: the Kingdom has been moved from the present into the future, from life lived into doctrine formulated, from real transformation into a deferred promise. What he proclaimed as a living reality, accessible here and now, has gradually become a distant horizon, conditioned by the correctness of one's belief and by belonging to a system.

The Kingdom, which for Yeshua was encounter, awakening, and a change of inner position, has been transformed into an explanation about what will come later. Thus life has been replaced by waiting, presence by doctrine, and the call to transformation by a promise that no longer asks for living, but only for acceptance.

Yeshua would be troubled by the centrality of fear

For Yeshua, one of the most troubling mutations would be the centrality of fear. Yeshua constantly says “do not be afraid” and ties this call to

trust in life and in the Father who provides (Matthew 6:25–34; Luke 12:32). By contrast, today's Christianity, in many of its forms, ends up being structured on fear: fear of sin, fear of punishment, fear of hell, fear of doctrinal error. Yeshua would immediately recognize this dynamic, because he already confronted it during his own life: "You tie up heavy burdens and lay them on people's shoulders" (Matthew 23:4). His critique is not aimed at moral care or responsibility, but at the use of fear as a spiritual instrument, as an engine of conformity.

For Yeshua, fear is not proof of holiness, but a sign that a person is not living from relationship with the Father, but from insecurity, from distrust, and from a distorted image of God.

Yeshua would distinguish between faith and faith-ism

For Yeshua, faith is never confused with intellectual assent to a doctrine. Yeshua does not ask people to believe something correct about him in order to be accepted; he calls them into a way of life. "Come, follow me" (Mark 1:17) is not an invitation to theological definition, but to existential following. The emphasis falls on walking, not on formulating; on living, not on declaring. Faith is inner movement and a change of perspective, not ideological positioning.

Today's Christianity, however, has shifted the emphasis from following to adherence. To be "a believer" has come to mean upholding a set of correct statements, defending a doctrine, and identifying with a camp. Yeshua would probably observe much talk about him, much defense of him, and very little imitation of his way of living. His question would remain the same, just as uncomfortable: "Why do you call me 'Lord, Lord,' and not do what I tell you?" (Luke 6:46).

Yeshua does not seek admirers, nor apologists, but people who live from the same perspective of love, truth, and freedom.

Yeshua would be critical of excessive institutionalization

Yeshua did not build an institution. He set in motion a movement of life. He went from place to place, touched people, healed, disturbed con-

sciences, and called to awakening. Today's Christianity, however, is largely a consolidated institution, with hierarchies, rules, clear boundaries, and mechanisms of exclusion. The structure has become stable, but life has often been moved to the background.

Yeshua would immediately recognize the signs he already denounced: authority that legitimizes itself, administered truth, conditioned access to God, spiritual power confused with office. "You have taken away the key of knowledge" (Luke 11:52) is not a critique of organization, but of monopolization. For Yeshua, the problem is not the existence of institutions, but the moment when structure replaces life. Wherever form becomes more important than the person, meaning is lost.

Yeshua would be surprised by the obsession with sexuality

One of the greatest distortions would be, for Yeshua, the centrality of sexuality in contemporary Christianity. He speaks relatively little about sexuality and a great deal about money, power, judgment, hypocrisy, and fear. Today's Christianity often does exactly the opposite. Sexuality has become a major criterion of spiritual evaluation, while the lack of compassion, greed, and the abuse of power are treated as secondary.

Yeshua would observe how sexuality has become a criterion of exclusion, how shame has been sacralized, and how relationships are judged more harshly than the absence of love. His words would remain just as scandalously current: "The tax collectors and the prostitutes go into the Kingdom of God ahead of you" (Matthew 21:31). Not because sin is negligible, but because moral rigidity without love blocks life.

Yeshua would affirm what is alive

At the same time, Yeshua would not reject all of Christianity. He would immediately recognize what is alive. He would see the communities that heal, the people who live love without conditions, those who draw near

to the excluded, and faith lived in silence rather than displayed. “Do not stop him” (Mark 9:39–40) remains his criterion. Yeshua is not jealous of religious forms, nor of “incorrect” language. He is attentive to life.

Wherever someone loves, forgives, heals, and lives from truth, Yeshua would say that the Kingdom is already there. For Yeshua, the Kingdom comes before doctrine, life before the system, love before fear, and truth is that which sets free. In many forms of today's Christianity, the order has been reversed: doctrine has come before life, the institution before the person, fear before freedom, and truth has become conditioning rather than healing.

If Yeshua were to look at today's Christianity, he probably would not ask whether it is doctrinally correct, but whether it is alive. He would not ask whether it observes the rules, but whether it sets people free. And, most likely, he would repeat exactly the same words that troubled religion from the beginning: the Kingdom of God is here, now, in life. But you have grown accustomed to speaking about it without living it anymore.

How would Yeshua react if He walked into a church today?

Yeshua does not judge by denominational labels, rituals, or doctrinal correctness, but by life. Where there is healing, freedom, truth, and love, there he recognizes the Kingdom (Matthew 11:4–6; Luke 17:21). Yeshua would not be impressed by architecture, symbols, or antiquity. “Not one stone here will be left upon another” (Matthew 24:2). His gaze would rest upon the people: fear or freedom, shame or dignity, life or constraint.

Just as he entered the Temple and observed what was being done in the name of God (Matthew 21:12–13), he would assess whether the religious space eases burdens (Matthew 11:28) or multiplies them (Matthew 23:4), whether it brings people closer to the Father or makes them dependent on intermediation. Yeshua would recognize a profound tension: much talk about him and relatively little living like him.

He would see emphasis on correct beliefs more than on transformed hearts, an obsession with sin more than with healing, fear of error more than trust in the Father. He would repeat the uncomfortable question: “Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord,’ and not do what I tell you?” (Luke 6:46). He would not reject Christianity as a whole, but he would separate living faith from ideology, the communities that heal from those that control, love from fear.

Yeshua in a Catholic church

If Yeshua were to enter a Catholic church, he would immediately recognize the weight of historical memory. He would sense the continuity of the centuries, the awareness of a tradition that has crossed empires, collapses, and rebirths. He would see the institutionalized care for the poor, for the sick, for those forgotten by the world, and he would recognize in this an authentic echo of his own words: “I was hungry and you gave me food; I was a stranger and you welcomed me” (Matthew 25:35–40).

The sense of universality, the desire to embrace all of humanity, would not be foreign to him. At the same time, Yeshua would be troubled by the excessive hierarchy and the great distance between the clergy and the people. He would observe how access to God is often strictly mediated, administered, and conditioned, how grace risks becoming a good distributed from the top down. The theology of structural guilt — the idea that a person starts from a position of culpability that must be managed sacramentally — would come into tension with his way of forgiving directly, through encounter. The words “You have taken away the key of knowledge” (Luke 11:52) would resound not as a condemnation of the sacraments in themselves, but as a radical question: do these symbols set free or condition? Do they bring a person closer to the Father or make him dependent on intermediation?

For Yeshua, the problem would not be the richness of ritual, but the risk that structure might take the place of life.

Yeshua in an Orthodox church

In an Orthodox church, Yeshua would immediately recognize the silence. He would recognize the inner space, the mysticism, the deep breathing of a prayer that does not explain but contemplates. The emphasis placed on the healing of one's being, on the transformation of a person from within, would be in agreement with his call to wholeness. The liturgical continuity and the living bond with the past would not seem foreign to him. But Yeshua would also observe the risks.

He would see how ritual can become formalism, how tradition can be confused with truth itself, how the gesture can become separated from life. He would sense the sacralization of fear in expressions such as "you are not worthy," which shift the center of gravity from the love of the Father to the assessment of human unworthiness. He would observe the distance between the liturgy and concrete life, between the beauty of the service and the way people treat one another.

"This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me" (Matthew 15:8) would not be said as rejection, but as a gentle and firm call for the return of the heart. Yeshua would love the silence, but he would ask whether it gives birth to compassion. He would love the mystery, but he would ask whether it heals fear or hides it beneath the sacred.

Yeshua in a neo-Protestant church

In a neo-Protestant church, Yeshua would immediately recognize the desire for a direct relationship with God. He would see the emphasis on Scripture, on personal reading, on the living community, and on the simplicity of forms. He would recognize the hunger for authenticity and the desire to live the faith without ritual intermediaries. At the same time, he would be attentive to other risks.

He would observe the tendency to reduce faith to correct doctrine, to absolutize "the correct decision" as the saving moment, to turn spiritual life into a continuous test of conformity. Moral pressure and the fear of error would appear as constant tensions, and the Gospel would risk

becoming a system of evaluation rather than a space of healing. “I desire mercy, not sacrifice” (Matthew 9:13) would remain his criterion.

He would not reject the zeal, nor the seriousness, nor the desire for truth, but he would ask whether these produce life or tension, freedom or anxiety. For Yeshua, Scripture is not a weapon of correctness, but a window toward truth, and the community is not a tribunal, but a place for lifting up those who have fallen. In all these forms, Yeshua would not seek institutional perfection. He would seek the signs of life.

Where people are freer, more whole, more capable of loving, there he would say the Kingdom is present. And where fear, control, and conditioning take the place of truth, there he would call again — not to a change of label, but to a change of heart. Most likely, Yeshua would not deliver a theological discourse, would not make denominational comparisons, and would not validate or invalidate institutions. He would stand beside the one who is shamed, the one who is excluded, the one who is tired of religion, the one who feels “unworthy.”

And he would say what he always said: “Do not be afraid.” “Take courage.” “The Kingdom of God is near.” Yeshua would not ask which denomination is right, but where life is. He would not seek the perfect church, but the open heart. And he would probably leave the building, walking toward those who no longer enter churches but still long for truth. “The Kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed” (Luke 17:20).

Yeshua does not preach a doctrine, but a state of being. His words are not explanations about God, but invitations to awaken. He does not say “believe this,” but “follow me.” He does not build a system of ideas, but opens a path of inner transformation. His preaching is performative: what he says happens in the one who listens. “Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near” (Matthew 4:17). For Yeshua, repentance does not mean guilt, but a change of mind, a shift of the center of consciousness. Yeshua speaks in parables not to be poetic, but to avoid the hardening of truth. A parable cannot be turned into dogma without being killed. “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” (Matthew 11:15). His truth is

not meant to be repeated, but to be recognized. He does not explain the Kingdom; he points to it.

“The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). Yeshua’s preaching is always about now. He does not promise future salvation in exchange for a correct belief, but present life through truth lived. “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the Kingdom of Heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father” (Matthew 7:21). The emphasis is on being, not on affirming. On living, not on belonging.

Paul radically changes the register. He does not preach the Kingdom, but salvation. He does not preach a state of consciousness, but the central event: the cross. “We preach Christ crucified” (1 Corinthians 1:23). The message becomes explanatory, theological, soteriological. Instead of “follow me,” there appears “believe that.” Instead of immediate inner transformation, there appears justification by faith. For Paul, truth is no longer recognized inwardly, but accepted intellectually.

“A person is justified by faith, apart from the works of the law” (Romans 3:28). Here the subtle rupture appears: life lived is no longer the primary criterion, but adherence to a correct formula. Faith becomes a substitute for transformation rather than its natural expression. This shift makes the message transmissible on a large scale. Paul builds the language, the structure, the theology that allow a global religion to emerge. But at the same time, the message can become separated from life.

You can believe without changing. You can confess without living. You can be “in Christ” theologically without being alive existentially. Today’s preachers carry this shift even further. In many contexts, preaching is no longer either an invitation to awaken or a profound theological reflection, but emotional management, moralizing, or spiritual marketing. The sermon becomes either a list of rules, or a promise of prosperity, or a motivational speech dressed in religious clothing.

Truth is no longer something that changes you, but something that soothes you or validates you. In contemporary preaching, the emphasis

often falls on sin, fear, belonging, and authority. “Believe correctly in order to be safe.” “Belong in order to be saved.” “Observe the doctrine in order to be accepted.” Within this framework, Yeshua is often presented not as a model of life, but as a legal solution to a theological problem. The cross becomes a contract rather than a revelation.

Yeshua, however, does not preach fear, but freedom. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32). Paul preaches liberation from the Law through faith, but leaves room for a new law: that of doctrine. Today’s preachers, in many cases, preach psychological safety rather than freedom. Order rather than life. Conformity rather than awakening. The essential difference is not one of style, but of meaning. Yeshua preaches from being to being. Paul preaches from interpretation to belief.

Today’s preachers often preach from the institution toward behavior. Yeshua awakens. Paul explains. The preachers administer. “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6). For Yeshua, truth is alive. For Paul, truth is formulated. For today’s preachers, truth is often defended. But the truth that must be defended no longer sets free. The truth that is lived, does. Yeshua did not ask to be preached, but to be embodied.

“You are the light of the world” (Matthew 5:14). Not “speak about the light,” but be light. Here the circle closes. Authentic preaching is not the discourse from the pulpit, but the life that becomes visible. The rest are echoes — some useful, others distorting.

How Yeshua would speak with the Pope

With Yeshua, the dialogue would never begin in a ceremonial register. Regardless of the person, the office, or the era, Yeshua would speak directly, personally, and without detour. That is how he spoke with the high priest, with the Pharisees, and with the rulers of the synagogues: without hostility, but also without flattery. His respect is not formal, but a respect for truth. He does not flatter roles and does not attack people; he asks questions that open or unmask.

Yeshua would recognize the care for the poor and the messages of peace, because these touch the heart of the Gospel. “I was hungry and

you gave me food; I was a stranger and you welcomed me” (Matthew 25:35–40). But precisely because he recognizes what is alive, he would ask clearly, without ambiguity. Do you bring people closer to the Father or to the institution? “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6) does not indicate a bureaucratic route, but a living relationship. Then he would ask about burdens.

Do you ease burdens or organize them better? Yeshua was consistently critical of systems that make weight more efficient instead of lifting it. “They tie up heavy burdens and lay them on people’s shoulders” (Matthew 23:4). For him, authentic service does not refine control, but reduces the weight that presses on the conscience. The question about authority would be just as clear. Does your authority heal or condition?

When Yeshua forgives and heals, he does not do it through procedure, but through encounter: “Son, your sins are forgiven” (Mark 2:5–12). Authority that comes from truth sets free at once; authority that comes from a role demands steps, approvals, and proofs. Yeshua would not contest the pastoral role nor the need for organization, but he would relativize mediation as an end in itself. “The Father seeks worshipers in spirit and in truth” (John 4:23). Here the criterion is clear: worship does not necessarily pass through a channel, but through an open heart. He would honor the service that sets free, not the one that administers access. In this dialogue, Yeshua would not demand structural reforms as the ultimate goal. He would demand clarity of perspective. Where authority heals, there it is from God. Where it conditions, there fear has crept in.

And there, Yeshua would speak not as an adversary, but as a witness of the truth who calls again to life.

How Yeshua would speak with the Orthodox Patriarch

The encounter with an Orthodox Patriarch would have a point of deep resonance. Yeshua would immediately recognize the value of silence, of inner withdrawal, and of prayer that descends into the heart. “When you

pray, go into your room, shut the door, and pray to your Father in secret” (Matthew 6:6). This call to interiority is in full continuity with Orthodox mysticism and with the emphasis placed on the healing of one's being, not merely on the correctness of behavior.

Yeshua would recognize the beauty of the tradition and the living memory of a faith preserved through the centuries. He would see in the liturgy not merely a ritual, but a lived story of the community, a language of the heart passed on from generation to generation. Continuity would not be foreign to him, because he himself is inscribed in a living history, not in an arbitrary rupture. But precisely because he would resonate with the depth, Yeshua would ask clearly. Does the ritual lead you toward the heart or replace it?

“This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me” (Matthew 15:8). When the gesture remains without life, the form risks taking the place of the encounter. Does tradition preserve life or freeze it? “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27). Where form becomes the goal, life is sacrificed in its name. Yeshua would love the liturgical silence, but he would refuse formalism. He would honor the symbol that opens, not the one that closes. He would probably say the same truth he spoke to the Samaritan woman: “The hour is coming when you will worship the Father neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem... the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth” (John 4:21–24). Yeshua would not abolish the Liturgy, nor would he minimize its sacredness. But he would ask that it go out into life, that it continue in compassion, in forgiveness, in presence.

For him, the true liturgy does not end with “Amen,” but begins where a person leaves healed and more alive than when he entered.

How Yeshua would speak with famous evangelical leaders

With charismatic evangelical leaders, Yeshua would recognize and appreciate the authentic desire for a direct relationship with God, the

accessibility of Scripture, and the vitality of a living community, there where “two or three are gathered” in his name (Matthew 18:20). But beyond this openness, he would ask questions that cannot be avoided: whether the Gospel is preached as a path of transformation or reduced to a simple verbal decision — because “not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the Kingdom” (Matthew 7:21); whether the message and the structure of the community give birth to inner freedom or, on the contrary, create emotional dependence on the leader, on the atmosphere, or on collective validation, in contrast to his call to rest and to real freedom (Matthew 11:28–30).

Yeshua would warn firmly against turning faith into a religious spectacle: “When you pray, go into your room” (Matthew 6:6). He would not reject enthusiasm and the living expression of faith, but he would draw a clear distinction between the inner fire that comes from truth lived and the group emotional pressure that can mimic presence without giving birth to it.

Would Yeshua go to church often? Would He preach in church?

Yeshua would enter churches, but he would not settle there. He entered synagogues (Luke 4:16), he preached in temples (John 7), but the greater part of his message was spoken outside them: on mountains, on the road, at the table, in homes. He would preach where there is openness, not necessarily where there is a program. When he sensed that the religious space was blocking life, he would do what he always did: He would go out. “Foxes have holes... but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head” (Matthew 8:20).

Would Yeshua observe the Sabbath?

Yeshua would observe the meaning of the Sabbath, not its letter. “The Sabbath was made for man” (Mark 2:27). He would heal, he would comfort, he would loosen burdens. He would refuse a Sabbath that

forbids the good. If the modern “Sabbath” is Sunday, Yeshua would ask: does it give the person rest, or only the program? Where the Sabbath no longer brings life, Yeshua reorients it. Repeatedly, Yeshua heals on the Sabbath day (Mark 3:1–6; Luke 13:10–17).

Each time, his justification is the same: the good cannot be postponed. “Is it lawful to do good on the Sabbath?” (Mark 3:4). The implicit answer is yes — because the Sabbath exists for man, not man for the Sabbath (Mark 2:27). If Sunday is the Christian “Sabbath,” then Yeshua’s logic would favor healing, not the liturgy. Where there is suffering, there is urgency. To postpone life for the sake of the program would be, in his terms, a reversal of meaning.

If Yeshua were not to go to church: where life moves

If Yeshua were not to go to church, he would do nothing “new.” He would do exactly what he did back then, because his perspective has never changed. He would stay with the excluded, there where shame has closed doors and where religion has raised walls. “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick” (Luke 5:29–32). He would heal, not as a demonstration of power, but as a restoration of life: “the blind see, the lame walk” (Matthew 11:5).

He would eat with people, because the table is the place of real encounter, not of moral evaluation: “He entered the house of a Pharisee to eat” (Luke 7:36). Yeshua would walk along the road, because the road is the space where life moves and where hearts open. “He walked with them along the way” (Luke 24:15). He would listen, because truth is not imposed but is born of attention. “What do you want me to do for you?” (Mark 10:46–52). In all of this, Yeshua would transform “religious” time into time for life. For him, the Kingdom is not tied to a place or an hour, to a building or a program. “The hour is coming when you will worship the Father neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem” (John 4:21).

How Yeshua would relate to worship songs

Yeshua would not reject singing. He himself sang psalms (Matthew 26:30). But he would be attentive to intention and to effect. He would ask whether the song opens or merely excites, whether it draws closer to truth or maintains an emotional state that does not transform. His criterion remains the same: “in spirit and truth” (John 4:23). Singing that gives birth to presence, humility, and love would be received without reservation. Singing that produces self-validation, emotion without change, or collective pressure would be relativized.

For Yeshua, the sound is not the problem, but the direction of the heart. Worship is not evaluated by intensity, but by fruit. Yeshua would not take the side of any denomination. He would take the side of life. He would not fight with religious leaders, but he would call each one to truth. He would not flee from churches, but he would not remain where life is replaced by form. And he would probably say the same thing as back then: “The Kingdom of God is near.”

Where Yeshua would be on a Sunday morning

The question of whether Yeshua would choose, on a Sunday morning, to preach from a church or to be in a park, healing, listening, or doing something seemingly “non-religious,” is not a speculative one. The Gospels offer a coherent pattern of his priorities. When this pattern is followed carefully, the answer becomes surprisingly clear. Yeshua enters the synagogue “as was his custom” (Luke 4:16), but he does not center his mission on the religious space.

He does not turn the place of assembly into the center of his work. He spends the greater part of his time on the roads, in motion, in unscheduled encounters: “as they were walking along the way” (Luke 24:15), on the mountain where he delivers the Sermon (Matthew 5:1), on the seashore where he teaches the crowds (Mark 4:1), in homes where he stops unexpectedly (“Zacchaeus, hurry and come down, for today I must stay at your house,” Luke 19:5), and at tables with people

considered religiously unsuitable (“He sat at table with the tax collectors and sinners,” Luke 5:29–32).

His preaching appears where the person is, not where the program is. In Yeshua’s logic, the place does not sacralize the encounter; the encounter sacralizes the place. When he is asked about the right place of worship, his answer shifts the emphasis from geography to the interior: “The hour is coming when you will worship neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem... the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth” (John 4:21–23).

This statement relativizes any religious space as being absolutely necessary. God is no more present in a building than in a park, on a road, or beside a person who is suffering. Yeshua constantly refuses to let the religious program take priority over life. “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27) shows clearly that the religious order cannot become more important than concrete human need.

He heals on the Sabbath (Mark 3:1–6), not in order to provoke, but because life cannot wait for the program’s permission. By the same logic, if on a “Sunday morning” there were a wounded person, a person searching, a person weeping, Yeshua would be there. Not because he would despise the assembly, but because he would not sacrifice life on the altar of form.

The pattern of the Gospels shows a Yeshua constantly drawn to the spaces where life unfolds freely, unfiltered by ritual: fields, roads, homes, tables, shores. There the most important conversations are born, the deepest healings, and the most living revelations. “He taught the people on the seashore” (Mark 4:1) and “He went through the towns and villages, proclaiming and announcing the Kingdom of God” (Luke 8:1) show a God in motion, not one fixed within a program.

If there were a Sunday in the modern sense, the Gospel pattern suggests that Yeshua would be drawn rather to the non-institutionalized space, where the encounter is not scheduled, where people do not come “religiously prepared,” but come as they are. Because the Kingdom is not announced by a schedule, but recognized through presence. “The

Kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed" (Luke 17:20).

Yeshua is not against the assembly, but he is constantly against the idea that God is more accessible in one setting than in another. He shifts the center of gravity from place to relationship, from program to encounter, from form to life. That is why the answer is not that he would choose "the park" instead of "the church," but that he would choose the place where life is more alive, where the person is more present, where the need is more real.

Most likely, on such a morning, Yeshua would be there where someone needs him: on a bench, on a road, at a table, beside someone searching for meaning or weeping in silence. Because, in his pattern, the Kingdom does not come through an announcement, but through presence.

If Yeshua appeared today in the churches — welcomed as Messiah or rejected as a heretic?

Imagining this scenario is not a provocative game, but a test of spiritual honesty. If Yeshua Christ were to appear today without saying who he is, without demonstrative miracles, without institutional authority — only with his teachings, with his way of seeing the person, sin, truth, and love — how would he be received? Not by the world, but by the Christian churches. The answer is not comfortable.

Yeshua, as he appears in the Gospels, is not a defender of religious institutions, but a disturber of them. He does not begin by affirming dogmas, but by relativizing them in favor of life. He says things such as: "The Sabbath is for man," "You have heard that it was said... but I say to you," "I desire mercy, not sacrifice." These statements are not theological errors, but they are structural threats to any system that draws its authority from rules, boundaries, and moral control.

If Yeshua were to speak today in the churches about judgment as blindness, about religious hypocrisy as a major sin, about empathy before correction, about the fact that "the tax collectors and prostitutes

enter the Kingdom ahead of you,” He would quickly be regarded as a dangerous preacher. Not because he would deny Scripture, but because he would refuse to use it as a weapon.

How Yeshua treats those who think differently from Him

One of the clearest indications of the profoundly different nature of Yeshua's message compared with the Christianity that would be built after him is the way he relates to those who think differently. Not to those who are “sinful” in a moral sense, but to those who do not understand, do not agree, misinterpret him, or reject him.

Here one sees not merely a difference of strategy, but a difference of spiritual ontology: Yeshua does not defend a doctrine; Paul and institutional Christianity will come to defend a formulated truth. In the Gospels, Yeshua lives constantly in the midst of misunderstanding. The disciples do not grasp the parables, they misinterpret his mission, they argue about power, they are afraid, they flee, they deny him. And yet, Yeshua does not exclude them, does not threaten them, and does not demand intellectual alignment.

“To you it has been given to know the secrets of the Kingdom, but to them it has not been given” (Matthew 13:11) is not a condemnation of those outside, but an observation about the openness of the heart. The difference is not between “correct” and “wrong,” but between open and closed. Yeshua is in no hurry to correct different thinking. Many times, he lets it run its course on its own. When he is rejected in a Samaritan village, he refuses the punishment proposed by the disciples: “You do not know what spirit you are of” (Luke 9:55).

The refusal is not interpreted as an offense against truth, but as a limit of receptivity. Yeshua does not feel threatened by disagreement. For him, truth does not need to be defended by force. Even in the tense dialogues with the Pharisees, Yeshua does not exclude them because they think differently, but because they use thinking as an instrument of superiority. His critique is not aimed at wrong interpretation, but at the rigidity that kills life (Matthew 23).

He does not say: "You think wrongly and you are lost," but: "You shut the Kingdom in people's faces" (Matthew 23:13). The problem is not the difference of opinion, but the refusal to see. Before those who do not agree with him, Yeshua often responds with silence. Before Herod, he does not defend himself (Luke 23:9). Before Pilate, he does not enter into a theological debate (John 18:36–38). The silence is not weakness, but a sign that truth is not a thesis to be demonstrated.

Yeshua does not try to win arguments; he remains in the truth. This attitude is possible because Yeshua does not tie truth to its acceptance. He says explicitly: "Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear" (Mark 4:9). Truth is not imposed; it is recognized. That is why Yeshua can sit at table with those who do not share his vision, without conditioning or correcting them beforehand (Mark 2:15–17). Difference is not a problem; the fear of difference is the problem.

With Paul, the meaning shifts visibly. Paul does not operate in a context of open encounter, but in a context of community building. The community must be protected, delimited, kept coherent. Thus, different thinking begins to be treated not as a stage of the journey, but as a danger. "If anyone preaches to you another gospel... let him be accursed" (Galatians 1:8). A difference of interpretation becomes a threat to salvation.

With Paul there appears for the first time the idea of "sound teaching" versus "wrong teaching" (Titus 1:9; 2 Timothy 4:3). Truth begins to be formulated, fixed, defended. From here, exclusion inevitably appears as well: "keep away from them" (Romans 16:17). Paul does not invite dialogue with those who think differently, but separation, in order to protect the community from contamination. This shift would be amplified by the Christianity that came after Yeshua and continues to this day. Difference of thought becomes heresy.

The question becomes dangerous. Doubt becomes a lack of faith. Institutional Christianity would develop clear mechanisms of delimitation: dogmas, creeds, anathemas, excommunications. Truth is no longer something that sets free, but something that must be guarded. Thus, while Yeshua can say, "Whoever is not against us is for us" (Mark

9:40), Christianity often comes to operate on the reverse logic: whoever is not with us is against us.

Difference of thought is no longer a space of growth, but a test of loyalty. Truth is no longer lived, but declared. Yeshua treats difference as a limit of sight, not as a fault. Paul and institutional Christianity treat difference as a threat to the formulated truth. Yeshua is not afraid that truth might be lost if someone thinks differently. Christianity is afraid that, without control, truth becomes diluted.

In the end, Yeshua never demands uniformity of thought. He demands presence. He demands sincerity. He demands openness. He does not say, "Think like me," but "Come and see" (John 1:39). Christianity will often say: "Believe correctly and you will be accepted." This is perhaps the clearest rupture: Yeshua created space for difference. Christianity created borders around the truth.

Sharp with those who possess the truth, not with those who seek it

For Yeshua, difference of thought is not a danger to be eliminated, but a space of encounter. He does not enter into disputes in order to win ideas, but into relationships in order to awaken consciences. That is why his way of responding does not depend on the doctrinal correctness of the other, but on the state of heart with which that person comes. With those who are different and open — Samaritans, Romans, sinners, women religiously excluded — Yeshua is present, curious, and non-defensive.

In the parable of the Samaritan, it is precisely the one considered a heretic who becomes the model of humanity: "A Samaritan... had compassion on him" (Luke 10:33). Before the Roman centurion, Yeshua is not scandalized by his belonging, but recognizes his authenticity: "Not even in Israel have I found such faith" (Matthew 8:10). In the dialogue with the Samaritan woman, he does not begin by correcting her theology, but by opening a living relationship: "If you knew the gift of God..." (John 4:10).

The relationship comes first; truth is born from within the relationship, not from coercion. By contrast, with those who believe they already possess the truth and use it as a weapon, Yeshua becomes unusually firm. Not because they think differently, but because they use truth to close rather than to open. “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!” (Matthew 23:27) is not a condemnation of their doctrine, but of their lack of heart.

When he says, “You are wrong, because you know neither the Scriptures nor the power of God” (Matthew 22:29), he does not reproach them for intellectual ignorance, but for the fact that they have turned Scripture into a system that excludes love. The difference is not the problem; the rigidity is. In the way he handles conflict of ideas, Yeshua does not impose truth through external authority. He asks questions that compel reflection: “What is written in the Law? How do you read it?” (Luke 10:26).

He tells parables that bypass confrontation and work from within: “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” (Matthew 13:9). When he is rejected, he does not coerce and does not insist: “If they will not receive you... shake the dust from your feet” (Matthew 10:14). For Yeshua, truth is not defended; it is offered. He accepts that some are not ready — and he does not force their ripening. With Paul, the approach changes visibly, not because love is absent, but because the context is different.

Paul is a missionary, an organizer, a theologian; he works in young communities that need coherence and stability. He has a real openness toward difference: “I have become all things to all people, that I might save some” (1 Corinthians 9:22) and “Welcome one another” (Romans 15:7).

But when difference becomes a threat to the message and to cohesion, Paul is corrective and firm: “If anyone preaches another gospel... let him be accursed” (Galatians 1:8) and “Remove the evil person from among you” (1 Corinthians 5:13). He treats difference functionally, asking what impact it has on the community, not only on the individual. The fundamental difference is clear.

Yeshua works with the individual and with the heart: truth is lived, not imposed, and difference is tolerated as long as life remains alive. Paul works with the system: truth must be protected, and difference becomes dangerous if it fragments. Yeshua awakens; Paul organizes. Today's institutional Christianity often operates from a combination of a hardened Pauline theology, identity-based fear, and doctrinal control. The result is rapid labeling — “heretic,” “lost” — exclusion, and moralizing without relationship. Thus, without intention, the words Yeshua spoke about the religious leaders of his time are fulfilled: “They tie up heavy burdens, hard to bear, but they themselves are not willing to lift a finger to move them” (Matthew 23:4). The truth about Yeshua is defended, but the way of Yeshua is lost. There are, however, things that Yeshua never does.

He does not cancel anyone's dignity because they err. He does not force the acceptance of truth. He does not confuse intellectual opposition with moral malice. He affirms clearly: “I did not come to judge the world, but to save the world” (John 12:47). This is not a weakness, but a strength that comes from the security of truth lived. Thus there remain three distinct ways of treating difference. Yeshua remains in relationship even amid disagreement, because truth flows from presence.

Paul corrects in order to protect the message and the community. Today's Christianity often excludes in order to protect its identity. The question that remains, inspired by Yeshua's rebuke to the disciples, is an essential one: “What spirit are you speaking from?” (cf. Luke 9:55). Because it is not which truth you uphold that defines you most deeply, but how you treat those who do not share it. For Yeshua, “evil” is neither a list of deeds nor a label placed on people.

Evil is a state of the heart that produces blindness, separation, and a lack of love. He shifts the emphasis from the outside to the inside when he says: “The good person brings good things out of the good treasure of his heart, and the evil person brings evil things out of the evil treasure of his heart” (Luke 6:45). In the same direction, he explains clearly: “Out of the heart come evil thoughts” (Matthew 15:19).

Evil is not an identity, but a disconnection; it is not a definitive label, but a state born of a heart torn from truth and from love. Yeshua's harshest words are not addressed to those considered "sinners" by society, but to those convinced that they see clearly and judge in the name of this conviction. "If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now that you say, 'We see,' your sin remains" (John 9:41).

In another place, he calls them without hesitation "blind guides" (Matthew 15:14). Supreme evil thus becomes the moral arrogance that justifies the lack of love. When a person believes himself to be light, he can no longer receive the light. Blindness that believes itself to be sight is, for Yeshua, one of the deepest forms of evil. Yeshua names evil also where religion becomes an instrument of oppression, shaming, and control.

He says of the religious leaders of his time: "You shut the Kingdom of Heaven in people's faces" (Matthew 23:13). And to this attitude he opposes a simple and decisive principle: "I desire mercy, not sacrifice" (Matthew 9:13). Evil is not the law itself, but the use of the law against life. When the rule replaces compassion, when form replaces the heart, evil takes hold under the appearance of righteousness. Equally important is what Yeshua does not call evil.

He does not call evil those who are different, those who are socially stigmatized, those who are searching. He says clearly: "I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners" (Luke 5:32). Before the woman caught in adultery, he shifts the attention from guilt to conscience: "Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone" (John 8:7). For Yeshua, evil is not the fall, but the refusal to see and to love. The central problem is not the error, but the closing toward truth.

For the Apostle Paul, evil is described rather as an active force, an inner principle in conflict with a person's desire to do good. "I find it to be a law that when I want to do good, evil lies close at hand" (Romans 7:21). Paul describes this tension with honesty: "I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want" (Romans 7:19).

The solution, in his vision, is radical: "Those who belong to Christ have crucified the flesh" (Galatians 5:24). The key difference from

Yeshua is that Paul speaks of evil as a power that demands discipline, struggle, and constant grace, while Yeshua speaks of evil as the absence of love lived, a state that dissolves through seeing and unity. In contemporary Christianity, evil is often externalized and simplified.

It becomes different behavior, a “wrong” opinion, “worldly” belonging. The label replaces discernment, and fear is justified religiously. Exclusion comes to seem a virtue. It is precisely here that Yeshua warns: “Why do you see the speck in your brother’s eye and not the log in your own eye?” (Matthew 7:3). Moral projection — the tendency to see evil only in others — is, in his logic, the sign that evil is already at work within. Seen together, three ways of defining evil appear.

For Yeshua, evil is the closed heart that believes itself to be light. For Paul, evil is the flesh in permanent conflict with grace. For today’s Christianity, evil often comes to be the other person. But Yeshua shifts the question once more toward the interior: from what source does your life flow? His criterion remains the same: “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16). Where the fruits are fear, rigidity, and a lack of compassion, evil is already present, even if the language is religious. Where the fruits are life, freedom, and love, evil loses its power, even if the forms are not the expected ones.

How Yeshua treated other religions

The way a tradition relates to “others” says more about its nature than any doctrinal declaration. In this sense, the difference between Yeshua and the Christianity that would later be built is one of the most visible and least discussed ruptures. Yeshua never built a theology of religious exclusivity. Paul would take the first steps toward doctrinal delimitation. Today’s institutional Christianity would turn delimitation into a system.

An essential fact is this: Yeshua nowhere speaks of “false religions.” He does not attack other religious traditions as competing systems and does not define his message through doctrinal opposition. His critique is

not directed at “others,” but at his own tradition when it becomes rigid, moralistic, and lifeless (Matthew 23).

Yeshua does not position himself as the founder of a new religion that must replace the old one; he moves within Judaism, but lives it from a different perspective. His attitude toward people of other religious traditions is consistently relational, not polemical. The Samaritans, considered heretical and impure from a religious standpoint, are not treated as doctrinally lost, but as people capable of truth and compassion.

The parable of the Good Samaritan is scandalously clear: true nearness to God is shown by someone from a religious tradition other than the “correct” one (Luke 10:33–37). Yeshua does not relativize truth; he relativizes belonging. In the dialogue with the Samaritan woman, Yeshua acknowledges the real religious difference — “you worship what you do not know” — but immediately shifts the discussion: “the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth” (John 4:22–23).

This is not a condemnation of another religion, but a transcending of religious boundaries as such. Worship is no longer tied to the mountain, the temple, or tradition, but to a quality of consciousness. Yeshua explicitly praises the faith of people from outside his own people and religion. The Roman centurion — a representative of a pagan power — is praised for his faith more than anyone in Israel: “Not even in Israel have I found such great faith” (Matthew 8:10).

Yeshua does not demand religious conversion, does not impose belonging, does not require the abandonment of one's tradition. He recognizes truth wherever it is alive. This freedom is possible because Yeshua does not identify truth with a religious system. For him, the Kingdom of God does not belong to a tradition: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). That is why Yeshua does not build a religious “we” in opposition to a “they.” He builds a way of seeing that makes the boundaries secondary.

With Paul, the situation changes. Paul operates in a missionary and apologetic context. The message about Christ must be proclaimed in a

religiously plural world: Judaism, Greco-Roman cults, philosophy. In this context, Paul begins to draw boundaries. He speaks of “false gods” (1 Corinthians 8:5–6) and of “idolatry” as spiritual error (Romans 1:21–25). Other religions are no longer possible spaces of truth, but expressions of ignorance or of error.

The discourse in Athens is emblematic. Paul acknowledges that the Athenians are “very religious” and begins from the altar to “the unknown God” (Acts 17:22–23). But this openness is strategic, not relational. The goal is not the recognition of a truth already present, but its correction through the proclamation of Christ as the only valid framework.

Truth begins to be formulated exclusively: “God now commands all people everywhere to repent” (Acts 17:30). From here onward, religious pluralism is no longer a context of encounter, but a field of mission. Other religions are no longer seen as partial expressions of the human search, but as wrong alternatives that must be abandoned. This shift would be taken up and amplified by institutional Christianity.

The Christianity that came after Yeshua and continues to this day would build a theology of exclusivity: one single way, one single formulated truth, one single valid salvation. “There is salvation in no one else” (Acts 4:12) becomes the foundation of a competitive relationship with other religions. Throughout history, this exclusivity would justify not only mission, but also condemnation, marginalization, and, at times, symbolic or real violence.

In contemporary Christianity, other religions are often treated either as “deceptions” or as “sincere but incomplete searches” that must be completed through conversion. Interreligious dialogue is tolerated, but rarely lived in the logic of Yeshua. The truth is already decided; the encounter is no longer open.

While Yeshua meets people of other religions without asking them to renounce their identity in order to be seen, Paul begins the process by which truth is tied to a specific proclamation. And institutional Christianity completes the process by turning truth into a criterion of

belonging. Yeshua did not treat other religions as errors to be corrected, but as spaces in which a person may or may not see.

Paul treated other religions as incomplete frameworks that must be transcended. Today's Christianity often treats them as spiritual rivals. Yeshua did not come to replace religions. He came to show what remains true when religions can no longer sustain life.

Why Yeshua is not against religions

A question that inevitably arises when we read the Gospels without the filter of later Christianity is this: is Yeshua against other religions or not? The answer is not simple if we use the modern categories of "true religions" and "false religions." Yeshua does not operate with this map. He does not enter into a religious competition and does not define his message through doctrinal opposition. At the same time, Yeshua speaks clearly and radically about idolatry. Only that idolatry, for him, is not what it would later become in Christian theology.

An essential starting point is this: Yeshua never uses the language of "other religions" as a theological problem. He does not say that the Samaritans have a wrong religion, that the Romans are lost because they worship other gods, or that the nations must first abandon their traditions in order to be seen by God. His critique is not directed outward, but inward, into his own tradition, there where religion becomes rigid, moralistic, and separated from life (Matthew 23). This positioning is evident in the way Yeshua interacts with people outside Judaism. The Roman centurion, a representative of a pagan power, is not corrected doctrinally, but praised for his faith: "Not even in Israel have I found such great faith" (Matthew 8:10).

Yeshua does not ask him to renounce his religious or cultural identity. He recognizes truth wherever it is alive. Likewise, the dialogue with the Samaritan woman shows clearly that Yeshua acknowledges real religious differences, but refuses to turn them into ultimate criteria. "You worship what you do not know" (John 4:22) is not a condemnation, but a contextual observation.

Immediately, however, Yeshua shifts the meaning: “the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth” (John 4:23). Worship is no longer tied to the mountain, the temple, or tradition, but to a state of consciousness. Thus, Yeshua does not attack the Samaritan religion; he relativizes religion as such. The parable of the Good Samaritan goes even further. Here, the exemplary figure of nearness to God is not the priest or the Levite — representatives of the “correct” religion — but the Samaritan, considered a heretic (Luke 10:33–37). Yeshua does not say that the Samaritan is saved because he belongs to another religion, but shows that truth is recognized through love, not through belonging. This is a profoundly non-exclusivist gesture, yet not a relativist one.

At this point the major confusion appears: if Yeshua is not against other religions, what about idolatry? The answer is decisive. Yeshua speaks about idols, but radically redefines the meaning of idolatry. For him, the idol is not primarily a foreign god or a statue. The idol is anything that takes the place of God as the source of security, identity, and meaning.

The statement “you cannot serve two masters... you cannot serve God and Mammon” (Matthew 6:24) is central. Yeshua does not oppose to God a pagan deity, but money, material security, control. Idolatry is the displacement of the inner center. It is not about what name you bear, but about what you live from. The same logic appears in the temptations in the wilderness. Yeshua refuses not only political power, but also the temptation to instrumentalize God for security and spectacle (Matthew 4:1–10). Idolatry is not only the worship of another god, but the use of God himself as an instrument of fear and control. That is why Yeshua is far harder on the religion that uses God than on the religions that seek God imperfectly.

In the Gospels, the principal idols are not “the gods of the nations,” but: money, power, the absolutized Law, religious status, self-image, fear. “This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me” (Matthew 15:8). Here, idolatry is internal, not external. It can exist even in the name of God. That is why Yeshua does not attack other

religions as systems. He attacks any form of religious or non-religious life that shifts the center from trust to fear. For him, the problem is not religious pluralism, but wrong worship. This can appear in Judaism, in paganism, in what would become Christianity, or outside any religion. This vision would change significantly with Paul and with later Christianity, which would identify idolatry primarily with other religions and with “false gods” (Romans 1:21–25), turning pluralism into a doctrinal problem.

Yeshua, however, does not start from a map of religions, but from the human heart. The conclusion is clear: Yeshua is not against other religions. He is against any worship that moves a person from truth into fear. He did not come to create a competing religion, but to reveal what remains true when all religions are set in parentheses.

How Yeshua would see Muslims

If we look at the way Yeshua evaluates people in the Gospels, we observe a constant pattern: He never begins with theological labels, but with the state of the heart. Yeshua does not use the term “heretic” to exclude; he speaks of blindness, fear, formalism, or hypocrisy as inner states, not as religious belonging. “It is not what enters the mouth that defiles a person, but what comes out of the mouth” (Matthew 15:11) immediately shifts the emphasis from doctrine to the heart.

And on the cross, his prayer — “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do” (Luke 23:34) — shows that ignorance is not treated as absolute guilt, but as a need for light. Yeshua rebukes most harshly the religious people who are convinced that they are already “in the truth.” From this perspective, Muslims — who respect Yeshua, who pray, fast, seek submission to God, and practice mercy — would not be treated as “outside” the truth, but as people on the way, not yet at the destination. For Yeshua, the decisive question is not “do you have the correct religion?” but “are you alive in the heart?”

Islam recognizes Yeshua as a prophet, born of a virgin and a worker of miracles, but rejects Yeshua's central claim about himself: “I am the

Way, the Truth, and the Life” (John 14:6). Yeshua would regard this position as an incomplete recognition — truth without existential consequence. “You call me Teacher and Lord, and you are right, for so I am” (John 13:13) ties the title to the following of his life, not merely to verbal respect. That is why Yeshua would not force belief, but would ask the same question he asked the disciples: “Who do people say that I am?” and, more personally, “But you, who do you say that I am?” (Matthew 16:13–15). To call him a prophet without following his life and taking up the cross is a form of respect that avoids transformation.

Islam denies the crucifixion of Yeshua, holding that God would not have permitted such a humiliation. For Yeshua, however, the cross is not an accident, but the core of his mission: “The Son of Man must suffer many things... and be killed” (Mark 8:31). “For this purpose I have come” (John 12:27) shows that the embrace of suffering is part of the revelation of love. Yeshua would not engage in historical polemic, but would point to the meaning: the refusal of the cross is the refusal of vulnerability and of the love that gives itself to the very end. His call remains the same for all: “Whoever wants to come after me must deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me” (Mark 8:34). Honoring without following to the end remains, for Yeshua, incomplete. “Allah” literally means “God.” Yeshua would not be scandalized by the language, but by the inner image of God.

“God is Spirit, and those who worship him must worship in spirit and in truth” (John 4:24) shifts the discussion from the name to the face. The tension arises between a God of submission through fear and a God-Father who calls to love and sonship: “Whoever has seen me has seen the Father” (John 14:9). Yeshua would say that Muslims pray to God, but do not yet know him in the revealed face of radical love. His call would not be to a change of name, but to a change of relationship.

Closer to the truth than some Christians?

Yeshua's answer would be surprisingly direct: sometimes, yes. He said clearly that mercy and sincerity can precede doctrinal correctness: "The tax collectors and the prostitutes go into the Kingdom of God ahead of you" (Matthew 21:31). And he warned: "Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the Kingdom" (Matthew 7:21). A sincere Muslim who prays, fasts, helps the poor, and lives with the fear of God may be closer to the Kingdom than a Christian who proclaims the dogma but lives in hatred and contempt. For Yeshua, the fruit of one's life weighs more than the label.

About Muhammad

Yeshua would not speak of Muhammad as a rival, but as a man who sought to orient people toward God in a violent and divided context. Nevertheless, he would make a clear distinction of role: "I am the Good Shepherd" (John 10:11). Yeshua would not validate a revelation that reduces him to an inferior status, annuls the cross, or shifts the relationship with God from sonship into legal submission. He would not condemn the person, but he would not confirm the message as being complete.

Yeshua would not begin with "You are wrong," but with "Come and see" (John 1:39). In his eyes, Muslims are not enemies, are not rejected, and are not "outside." They are invited further — not to a new religion, but to a Person. "I came that the sheep may have life, and have it abundantly" (John 10:10). Yeshua would not ask them to deny God; he would ask them to know him.

What Yeshua would say to atheists

Yeshua would not begin by proving the existence of God. There is no sermon of his in the Gospels constructed as a philosophical argument about the existence of the divine. He does not seek to win debates, but to create encounters. Before atheists, Yeshua would not say "you are

wrong,” but would look at what they live, what they seek, and what causes them pain. Yeshua does not divide people into “believers” and “unbelievers” as definitive labels. He divides between those who see and those who do not yet see.

“I have not come to call the righteous to repentance, but sinners” (Luke 5:32). Here “sinner” does not mean atheist, but a person torn from life, from meaning, from inner truth. In his dialogues, Yeshua does not force conclusions. With Nicodemus he speaks at night, without pressure. With the Samaritan woman he begins from water, not from theology. With the rich young man he leaves freedom intact, even though the man walks away. Yeshua accepts refusal without turning it into a threat.

“Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” (Matthew 11:15). Of atheists, Yeshua would not ask that they believe in him, but would invite them to observe life. “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16). He would say: look at what love produces, what fear produces, what the ego produces. If truth is alive, it will recognize itself. Yeshua does not seek assent, but resonance. Most likely, Yeshua would sit at table with atheists without opening the subject of faith.

He would speak about life, about loss, about fear, about meaning. He would love without conditions. For him, love is already a revelation of God, even if a person does not name it as such. “By this everyone will know that you are my disciples: if you have love for one another” (John 13:35). Paul, by contrast, would try to convince. Not necessarily aggressively, but systematically. In the Acts of the Apostles, Paul debates with the philosophers in Athens, argues, quotes Greek poets, and builds an intellectual bridge: “What you worship without knowing, this I proclaim to you” (Acts 17:23). For Paul, atheism is a problem of wrong or incomplete knowledge. He believes that truth must be explained, preached, articulated doctrinally. “Faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ” (Romans 10:17).

Here appears the idea that the correctly transmitted message will produce faith. Paul is willing to debate, to defend, to argue. He sees conversion as an explicit goal. Not in order to control, but in order to

save. But this approach shifts the center from experience to explanation, from living to intellectual conviction. Today's Christianity, in many of its forms, has lost both Yeshua's delicacy and Paul's depth. Instead of an encounter, it offers labels.

Instead of dialogue, it offers conclusions. The atheist is often seen as "blind," "rebellious," or "threatened by hell." John 3:16 is used as an instrument of pressure rather than as a revelation of love. The message becomes: "Believe or you will perish." Thus, God is presented as a condition rather than as a presence. Instead of manifesting the fruits of the Spirit, Christianity comes to defend ideas about God, sometimes with emotional aggression. Rarely does contemporary Christianity sit with atheists without the aim of conversion.

Rarely does it listen. Rarely does it accept that an atheist can live love, compassion, and truth without religious language. And yet, Yeshua says clearly: "Whoever does the will of my Father... is my brother" (Matthew 12:50). He does not say: whoever believes correctly.

What Yeshua would say about Buddhism and the Buddha

Yeshua would not begin by delimiting doctrinal territories. He would not first ask what you believe, but how you live. In Buddhism, Yeshua would immediately recognize an authentic search for liberation from suffering, a discipline of consciousness, and a profound attention to the nature of the mind. "Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven" (Matthew 5:3) would resonate naturally with the practice of emptying oneself of attachments.

Yeshua would see in the Buddha a man who saw suffering, refused the superficial, and sought the truth to the very end. He would recognize the discernment of desire as the source of suffering and would say, in his own language: "Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also" (Matthew 6:21). Attachment, for Yeshua, as for the Buddha, binds the heart and darkens sight. The difference would appear not as opposition, but as emphasis.

Yeshua proposes not only the exit from suffering through detachment, but the entry into life through love. "Abide in me, and I in you" (John 15:4). Where Buddhism speaks of non-attachment and non-self, Yeshua speaks of relationship, communion, and Father. He does not dissolve the person, but transfigures it through love. Yeshua would not say that the Buddha erred. He would say, rather, that he saw a part of the truth. "Whoever is not against us is for us" (Mark 9:40).

He would recognize the stillness, the compassion, and the lucidity as real fruits. But he would add that the ultimate truth is not merely a state of consciousness, but a living relationship: "This is eternal life: that they may know you" (John 17:3). Paul would have a far more cautious and exclusivist approach. For him, any path that does not pass explicitly through Christ is incomplete or wrong. "Even if we ourselves or an angel from heaven should preach another gospel, let him be accursed" (Galatians 1:8).

Paul might appreciate the moral discipline and the ethic of compassion, but he would reject the absence of a personal God. For Paul, the central problem of the human being is not ignorance, but sin. He would not see enlightenment as a sufficient solution, because it does not resolve the broken relationship with God. "The wages of sin is death" (Romans 6:23). Within this framework, the Buddha would be perceived as a moral teacher or philosopher, not as a bearer of salvation.

Paul would say that Buddhism can calm the mind, but cannot save the soul. He might recognize the "zeal," but "without full knowledge" (Romans 10:2). His emphasis would be on the uniqueness of Christ as mediator: "There is one God and one mediator between God and men, the man Yeshua Christ" (1 Timothy 2:5). Today's Christianity, in many of its expressions, has gone even further than Paul.

Most often, Buddhism is quickly labeled as a "false religion," a "deception," or a "demonic work," without any real effort at understanding. The Buddha is reduced to the status of an idol, and the practice of meditation is regarded with suspicion. In this discourse, no distinction is made between experience and doctrine. Everything that is not explicitly Christian is considered dangerous. It is forgotten,

however, that Yeshua says: “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16).

The real fruits of many Buddhist practitioners — peace, compassion, non-violence — are often ignored because they do not fit the dogma. Contemporary Christianity rarely speaks with Buddhists; it speaks about them. And that says everything. It rarely recognizes partial truth as truth. It rarely accepts that God can work even beyond the boundaries of Christian language. And yet, Yeshua says: “I have other sheep that are not of this fold” (John 10:16).

How Yeshua would relate to the Jews of today

Yeshua cannot be separated from his Jewish identity. He lives within Judaism, speaks the language of the Hebrew Scripture, and breathes the same spiritual world. We find him in the synagogue “as was his custom” (Luke 4:16), going up to Jerusalem for the feasts (John 7; John 10:22), and relating constantly to the Law and the Prophets. His statement is clear: “I have not come to abolish the Law or the Prophets, but to fulfill them” (Matthew 5:17).

But this “fulfillment” does not mean rigidity, but the restoration of the Law to its living core. When he is asked which is the great commandment, Yeshua concentrates the whole of Scripture into love: “You shall love the Lord your God... and your neighbor as yourself” (Matthew 22:37–40), taking up exactly the heart of the Torah from Deuteronomy 6:5 and Leviticus 19:18. In the same prophetic spirit, he reaffirms: “I desire mercy, not sacrifice” (Matthew 9:13). Yeshua does not abandon the tradition, but deepens it. He remains in continuity with the prophets, who always said that the purpose of the Law is life, not control.

Would Yeshua be an “Orthodox Jew”?

If by “Orthodox” one means the absolutizing of the norm as a marker of identity, delimitation through rules, and the defense of form as an end in itself, the Gospel pattern clearly suggests that Yeshua would not align

himself with this model. He heals on the Sabbath (Mark 3:1–6), relativizes ritual purity when it becomes an obstacle to truth (Mark 7:14–23), and formulates the principle that sums up his entire position: “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27).

And yet, if “Orthodox” means a profound anchoring in Scripture, prayer, ethics, and the living memory of faith, then Yeshua is profoundly within this tradition. The difference is not one of belonging, but of perspective: for Yeshua, tradition is the means by which life is preserved, not the criterion by which a person is measured.

Would Yeshua be a Zionist?

Zionism is a modern political project, born in a historical context entirely different from that of Yeshua. The Gospels, however, show clearly that Yeshua refuses any form of political messianism. When the people “wanted to make him king,” He withdraws (John 6:15). Before Pilate, he says without equivocation: “My Kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36).

Yeshua deeply loves his people — he weeps over Jerusalem (Luke 19:41) — but he does not sacralize the land, the border, or power. His fidelity is to justice and life, not to an ideological project. He would reject equally antisemitism and the confusion of God with the state, with political force, or with borders.

How Yeshua would speak with the Jews of today

Yeshua would not speak as an adversary, nor as an outsider. He would speak from within, using the shared Scripture and the prophetic language. He would recognize the continuity: “salvation is from the Jews” (John 4:22). His tone would be both familiar and uncomfortable — honoring living faith and confronting formalism.

He would not ask for conversion to Christianity, but a return to the core of the Law: “You shall love the Lord your God” (Deuteronomy 6:5) and “you shall love your neighbor as yourself” (Leviticus 19:18),

just as he himself unites them (Matthew 22:37–40). His call would be one of the heart, not of polemic.

Between Jews and Christians

Yeshua never places himself within camps. He does not belong to “the Jews” against “the Christians,” nor the reverse. His criterion is life lived: “Whoever does the will of my Father is my brother and sister and mother” (Matthew 12:50). That is why Yeshua would be closer to the Jews who live mercy and justice, closer to the Christians who live love and freedom, and equally far from any religion that defends itself instead of serving life.

Yeshua remains a Jew in depth, anchored in the prophetic core of his tradition. He refuses the absolutizing of tradition, rejects political messianism, and gathers people around what is alive. He would be neither “Zionist” nor “anti-Zionist.” He would be neither “Orthodox” in the legalistic sense nor “liberal” in the relativist sense. He would not ask who is right, but where living justice is. And he would stand exactly there — among people — not between camps.

How Yeshua would relate to “MAGA Christianity”

Exactly the same tensions existed in Yeshua's own time: religion allied with political power, sacralized national identity, fear of “others,” selective moralism, and the use of God as an instrument of legitimation. Seen through this lens, the reactions and words of Yeshua take on a surprising clarity for today's context. Yeshua never aligns himself with a political project, a national identity, or a movement of power.

He says without equivocation: “My Kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36). When the crowds want to make him king, he withdraws (John 6:15). Not because he is indifferent to social suffering, but because his perspective is the Kingdom as life lived, not as a program of governance. The Kingdom, for Yeshua, is not installed through power, but through the transformation of the heart.

In this sense, any form of Christianity that mixes the Gospel with the political project, the cross with the flag, the Kingdom with the state, would represent for Yeshua exactly the confusion that he constantly avoids. For him, this shift is not a legitimate strategy, but a clear spiritual sign that trust has moved from God to power.

When Yeshua says, "Give to Caesar what is Caesar's, and to God what is God's" (Mark 12:17), he does not bless political power, but delimits it. The political does not become theological. Power remains power, and God remains God. Yeshua refuses to turn governance into an expression of faith. In political Christianity, by contrast, the political is theologized: leaders become "anointed," policies become "biblical," and opposition is labeled "anti-God." Yeshua would immediately recognize this dynamic, because it is the same alliance of religion and power that condemned him, when the religious leaders said: "We have no king but Caesar" (John 19:15). For Yeshua, the moral criterion is not "mine first," but "the vulnerable first."

He says clearly: "I was a stranger and you welcomed me" (Matthew 25:35). When he is asked, "Who is my neighbor?" He answers with the parable of the Samaritan (Luke 10:25–37), in which the foreigner becomes the model of humanity. The neighbor is not defined by a border, but by need. The community is not protected through moralized exclusion, but through active compassion. Yeshua does not deny the existence of administrative borders, but he does not sacralize them.

He crosses cultural and religious borders: He enters Samaria (John 4), praises the faith of a Roman (Matthew 8:10), heals those considered "outsiders." For him, security is not built through walls, but through justice and truth. That is why one of his most repeated calls remains: "Do not be afraid" (Luke 12:32). A faith that lives from fear has already departed from the center of the Gospel.

His tone toward those who use religion as a weapon would be firm, just as in the Gospels. "Why do you see the speck in your brother's eye?" (Matthew 7:3). "Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord'..." (Matthew 7:21). As back then, the rebuke would be harsher toward those who consider themselves righteous than toward those

considered sinners. The problem is not moral weakness, but the use of God to justify fear, exclusion, and domination.

Constantly, Yeshua calls to the welcoming of the other: “What you have done to one of these least brothers of mine, you have done to me” (Matthew 25:40). The stranger, the migrant, the marginalized are not threats, but places of encounter with God. This is not naivety, but discernment without fear. The difference of perspective thus becomes clear.

Yeshua refuses an alliance with power, does not sacralize the nation, does not live from fear, places mercy before identity, and sees the person before the category. Any form of Christianity that sacralizes politics, absolutizes the nation, operates from fear, moralizes selectively, and excludes in the name of God is in profound tension with the Gospel pattern. Yeshua would not be captive to any ideology. Not because he would be “left-wing” or “right-wing,” but because he would not be aligned with any logic of power. He would say what he always said: the Kingdom of God is not about gaining power, but about losing fear. And, as back then, those who use religion in order to feel “righteous” would be the ones most scandalized by him.

Why Yeshua never confirmed conspiracy theories

A surprising fact becomes visible when we read the Gospels carefully: Yeshua lived in a world full of real conspiracies, but he never built his message around them. The historical context was extremely tense. Judea was under Roman occupation, there was a religious class allied with political power, and various Jewish groups believed that Rome, together with the religious elites, was conspiring against the people.

In this context, it would have been very easy for Yeshua to mobilize the masses through a rhetoric of exposing the system. And yet, he chose a completely different path. Instead of confirming narratives about political or religious plots, he constantly shifts the attention toward the interior of the person. That is why he says: “The Kingdom of God is not

coming in ways that can be observed... for behold, the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:20–21).

Instead of offering a conspiratorial explanation of the world, Yeshua points to another level of reality: the transformation of consciousness. This choice becomes even more evident when we consider that the people around him expected exactly the opposite. Many hoped for a political Messiah who would explain the evil of the world through Roman oppression and lead a revolt. But Yeshua refuses this simplistic interpretation of evil.

When he is asked about paying taxes to the empire — an extremely politically sensitive subject — he answers in a way that completely disarms the logic of conflict: “Give therefore to Caesar what is Caesar’s, and to God what is God’s” (Matthew 22:21). Through this statement, he avoids both imperial propaganda and revolutionary rhetoric. He does not confirm any global conspiracy against the people, but separates the planes: there are political structures of the world, and there is the spiritual reality of the person. His message is not a geopolitical analysis, but an invitation to inner transformation. Another reason Yeshua does not confirm conspiracies is that he sees evil in a light different from that of conspiratorial narratives.

Conspiracy theories usually presuppose the existence of conscious actors who control the system deliberately and malevolently. Yeshua, however, describes evil rather as spiritual unconsciousness. On the cross, at the culminating moment of historical injustice — when he is executed by the political and religious authorities — he does not say that he is the victim of a conspiracy. Instead he says: “Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do” (Luke 23:34).

This statement completely changes the perspective on evil. There is no omnipotent cabal controlling the world; there are people who act out of spiritual blindness. The Gospels show that Yeshua was aware of the manipulations and hypocrisy of the religious leaders. He harshly criticizes the religious structures that exploit people’s faith. For example, he says: “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you shut the Kingdom of Heaven in people’s faces” (Matthew 23:13).

Yet, even when he denounces these behaviors, he does not build a total theory about a global plot. His critique is moral and spiritual, not conspiratorial. The problem is not a secret organization that controls everything, but the state of the human heart. In many places, Yeshua even warns against the obsession with spectacular signs or secret revelations about the world.

He says: “An evil and adulterous generation seeks a sign, but no sign will be given to it except the sign of Jonah” (Matthew 12:39). This statement is important, because conspiracy theories often function precisely through the promise of a “hidden truth” that explains everything. Yeshua refuses this logic. He does not offer total explanations about the mechanisms of the world, but invites a person to see something much closer: his own heart. That is why the theme of spiritual sight appears constantly in the Gospels.

Yeshua says: “If your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light” (Matthew 6:22). This sight is not about detecting political or economic conspiracies. It is about the inner clarity that allows a person to recognize the ego, fear, pride, and the need for control. In this sense, true blindness is not the lack of information about the world, but the inability to see one's own inner mechanisms.

Another reason Yeshua does not confirm conspiracies is that they can become a subtle form of collective victimhood. If the evil of the world is explained exclusively through external plots, personal responsibility disappears. By contrast, Yeshua places responsibility at the very center of his message. He says: “Why do you see the speck in your brother's eye and not notice the log in your own eye?” (Matthew 7:3).

This question shifts the attention from the analysis of the system's flaws to the transformation of one's own consciousness. Therefore, Yeshua's silence toward conspiracies is not political naivety. It is a profound spiritual choice. He knew that explaining evil through plots does not truly change the world. People can replace an official story with an anti-official story and still remain in the same state of consciousness. That is why he does not offer an alternative ideology.

Instead, he says: “You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). The freedom he speaks of is not the political freedom obtained by exposing a plot, but the inner freedom that appears when a person sees reality without fear and without identification with his own mental stories. Thus, the Gospels suggest that the true revolution Yeshua brings is not a political or conspiratorial one, but a revolution of consciousness. He does not promise that the world will become transparent and fully explainable. Instead, he promises that a person can become enlightened within it. And this light does not come from the discovery of a hidden plot, but from the transformation of the heart.

How Yeshua would react to “sexual immorality”

The way sexuality is treated says a great deal about the level of consciousness from which a religious community operates. We are not speaking only about rules, but about what you see when you look at a person. The response of Yeshua Christ, of the Apostle Paul, and of contemporary Christianity differs radically — not in the degree of “tolerance,” but in the vantage point from which they view the problem.

If Yeshua were to learn that a member of the religious community was living in sexual relationships considered “immoral,” there is no indication in the Gospels that his first gesture would be exclusion, public exposure, or moral correction. Yeshua never treated sexuality as an isolated problem, but as a symptom of the heart. He would begin with an encounter — real, personal, free of any tribunal. The model is constant: Yeshua draws near to people before they change.

With the tax collectors, with the prostitutes, with the Samaritan woman, with the woman caught in adultery — presence comes before transformation. Yeshua does not normalize the behavior, but neither does he absolutize it. For him, sin is not the sexual act in itself, but the rupture from truth and from oneself that sometimes expresses itself sexually as well. If he were to say anything, it would be said in private, not as a sanction, but as an invitation: “What are you searching for here?”, “What is unfulfilled in you?”, “What are you hungry for?”

For Yeshua, “disordered” sexuality is a sign of thirst, not of rebellion. His correction — “go and sin no more” — comes after the person is seen, not before. For Yeshua, to remove someone from the community because of sexuality would be nonsense: it is precisely the wounded who need community. Paul reacts differently, because his mission is different. He does not go from village to village meeting individuals, but builds fragile communities, under external and internal pressure.

That is why, in his letters, “immoral” sexuality becomes a serious problem, not merely personal but communal. In the case at Corinth, Paul explicitly requests the temporary removal of the one living in a relationship considered gravely immoral. His motivation is not shaming, but contamination: “a little leaven leavens the whole lump.” For Paul, sexual sin is not merely a personal weakness, but a threat to the identity of the community and of its message.

And yet, even here, the goal is not condemnation. Paul speaks of discipline so that the person may awaken, not so that he may be lost. Empathy exists, but it is subordinated to truth and order. The person is seen through the prism of the impact of his behavior, not only through his inner suffering. It is a functional logic, but already colder than that of Yeshua. Contemporary Christianity, in many contexts, has lost both the heart of Yeshua and the discernment of Paul.

It has remained with the rule, but without the relationship. Thus, when a case of “sexual immorality” appears, the typical reaction is stigmatization: whispers, labels, public shame, rapid exclusion, or a “call to repentance” under pressure. Sexuality becomes a marker of identity: the one who errs here is “more sinful” than the one who is proud, cold, devoid of empathy, or manipulative — sins that Yeshua condemned far more harshly.

Today's Christianity often treats sexuality as the gravest sin, because it is visible, easy to judge, and offers a false sense of moral superiority. Within this framework, a person is no longer asked “what are you living?” but “why do you not observe the rule?” The moral analysis excludes empathy, exactly as we discussed earlier. Correction comes

without relationship, truth without presence, and the result is not healing, but hiding. People do not change; they only learn to lie better.

Would Yeshua have social media accounts?

If Yeshua had social media accounts today, the question would not be which platforms he would choose, but how he would relate to visibility, ego, and power. The Gospels tell us nothing about technology, but they show clearly the way Yeshua related to public attention, to fame, and to the temptation to capitalize on people's interest.

Whenever the crowd tries to turn him into a leader, a symbol, or a spiritual "brand," He withdraws: "Jesus, knowing that they intended to come and take him by force to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself" (John 6:15). For Yeshua, visibility is not the goal, but a secondary effect. If he used social media, he would do it for encounter and awakening, not for the building of an image. The platform would be a road, not a stage; a means, not an identity.

He would post, but not at the rhythm of the algorithm, rather at the inner rhythm. Yeshua does not speak constantly; he speaks when there is openness and falls silent when silence is more alive than the word. His freedom from the pressure of permanent reaction is felt in the words: "Sufficient for the day is its own trouble" (Matthew 6:34).

Instead of a continuous stream, he would probably appear with a question that stops the scrolling and turns the gaze inward: "What does it profit a person to gain the whole world and lose his soul?" (Matthew 16:26). He would post a short parable that opens, not a manifesto that closes. He would show a gesture, not explain it: a shared meal, a healing touch. He would let fall a sentence that validates no camp: "I desire mercy, not sacrifice" (Matthew 9:13).

And, above all, he would let silence remain part of the message. If he spoke about what is happening in the world, he would not do it as a political analyst or a partisan influencer. Yeshua does not comment on events in order to take a side in a camp, but in order to unmask the meaning behind them: fear, greed, lies, the idolizing of power. He

would speak about the fear that drives decisions: “Do not be afraid, little flock” (Luke 12:32).

He would speak about money as an idol: “You cannot serve two masters” (Matthew 6:24). He would denounce moral and religious hypocrisy, as he does in the rebukes of Matthew 23, and would constantly remind people of the weak: “I was hungry and you gave me food” (Matthew 25:35–40). He would say things that disturb all camps, without confirming any of them. His presence in television-type spaces would probably be rare. Not out of contempt, but out of discernment.

“Do not throw your pearls before swine” (Matthew 7:6) does not express superiority, but attention to the context in which a message can be heard. Yeshua would prefer a real conversation with a few people over a large audience without depth. When he sensed that the message was being reduced to spectacle, he would withdraw. The way he dressed would not transmit an ideological message and would not aim to impress. Yeshua does not use appearance to build status.

His clothes are so ordinary that the soldiers end up casting lots for them: “the soldiers... took his garments” (John 19:23). Simplicity would not be a statement, but the consequence of an inner freedom from image. He would stand out without trying. Of him it is said: “No one ever spoke like this man” (John 7:46). His visibility would be the effect of truth lived, not the result of a marketing strategy.

He would not seek luxury as a sign of blessing, nor would he turn austerity into a displayed virtue. He would choose the means that bring him closer to people, not those that separate him through status. He would not refuse hospitality, just as he accepts the invitation in Luke 7:36, but he would remain attentive to the warning: “Beware of all covetousness” (Luke 12:15). He would travel much, because Yeshua is itinerant by the very nature of his mission.

He does not establish a base, does not defend a territory, and does not build a stable platform. When the disciples want to stay in one place, he says: “Let us go on to the next towns... for that is why I came out” (Mark 1:38). The journey is not tourism or exposure, but encounter. The difference of perspective thus becomes clear. The digital

world demands constant presence, rewards polarization, confuses impact with visibility, and feeds the ego.

Yeshua uses the means without being defined by them, refuses the personal brand, speaks rarely but decisively, and remains free of image, status, and reaction. If he had social media, he would not become an influencer. If he had an audience, he would not build a brand. If he were visible, he would be visible because truth is seen. He would use the digital world as he used the real world: without fear, without attachment, without ego.

And he would probably leave the same simple invitation that crosses the ages and the media: “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear” (Matthew 13:9).

Would Yeshua enter strip clubs, bars, or casinos?

Yeshua was explicitly accused for where he went and with whom he kept company: “Here is a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners” (Matthew 11:19). This is not an accidental insult, but a summary of his style. Yeshua did not wait for people to come out of their spaces to meet him; he entered their spaces in order to see them. “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick” (Mark 2:17). Therefore, his criterion was not “is the place sinful?” but “is there someone here who needs to be seen?”

Would Yeshua enter a strip club?

The Gospels do not show a Yeshua fascinated by eroticism, but neither one frightened by sexuality. He speaks directly about desire, the gaze, and the heart: “Whoever looks at a woman with lustful intent has already committed adultery with her in his heart” (Matthew 5:28). Notice: the sin is not the place, but the way of looking. Yeshua would not enter for consumption, arousal, or entertainment. But he could enter for the sake of the people — not to legitimize exploitation, but to see the person behind the role.

Exactly as he sat with stigmatized women without reducing them to their sexuality (Luke 7:36–50). “Do not judge, so that you may not be judged” (Matthew 7:1) does not mean approval, but the suspension of moral superiority. Yeshua would not look at the dancers as “temptations,” but as human beings — something that religious moralism does most rarely.

Would Yeshua enter bars?

Here the answer is almost obvious. Yeshua was already called “a drunkard” (Matthew 11:19). He took part in weddings, sat at long tables, accepted invitations in controversial homes. The bar, as a space of encounter, vulnerability, and conversation, is not at all foreign to his spirit. “Where two or three are gathered in my name, there am I” (Matthew 18:20). His name is not a religious formula, but authentic presence. If in a bar people speak honestly, weep, and search for meaning, Yeshua would be closer there than in a rigid religious space.

Would Yeshua enter casinos?

The casino is different, because here the problem is not socializing, but the illusion of control and of gain without work. Yeshua is very clear about money: “You cannot serve two masters... God and Mammon” (Matthew 6:24). And: “A person's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions” (Luke 12:15). Yeshua would not be drawn to gambling as an activity. But, again, if he entered, it would be for the sake of people caught in addiction, despair, or self-deception. Exactly the kind of people that religion avoids, and Yeshua seeks.

For Yeshua, what he would not do is just as important as what he would do. Yeshua would not consume people as objects of pleasure, would not exploit vulnerability, would not lose himself in the search for sensation, and would never justify systems that dehumanize, even if these are socially accepted.

“The Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve” (Mark 10:45) clearly defines his position: wherever he enters, he enters as a

presence that sees and restores, not as a participant who dissolves into the context and takes on its logic. His presence does not validate the environment, but exposes it — not through condemnation, but through truth lived. The question “would Yeshua go there?” says more about our fear than about him.

Yeshua was never concerned with protecting his image, but with the heart of the other. He would not enter in order to “normalize sin,” but neither would he stay away in order to preserve his purity. Because his purity is not fragile. The real question remains: do we avoid these places out of holiness or out of a lack of love?

Would Yeshua have a diploma?

The question of whether Yeshua would today have a diploma as a therapist, theologian, or priest says more about our world than about him. The Gospels show clearly that his authority never came from institutional accreditation, but from truth lived, inner clarity, and the concrete fruits of his presence upon people. An encounter with Yeshua produces change before it produces consensus, healing before it produces explanations.

Yeshua is not presented as having an official rabbinic training, and the reaction of his contemporaries is explicit and uneasy: “How does this man know the Scriptures, when he has never studied?” (John 7:15). “Is this not the carpenter?” (Mark 6:3). The questions are not simple curiosities, but express the scandal of the lack of accreditation. And yet, people observe that “He taught as one who had authority, and not as the scribes” (Matthew 7:29).

His authority is recognized before it can be justified in institutional language. For Yeshua, truth is not obtained through certification, but lived through alignment. “My teaching is not mine, but his who sent me” (John 7:16). He does not reject knowledge, but refuses to confuse knowledge with transformation. That is why his harshest critique is not addressed to the ignorant, but to the religious experts who “know” but do not live: “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites” (Matthew

23:27). In his perspective, authentic formation is existential, not curricular; it is a coherence of life, not an accumulation of information. Seen from the modern perspective, Yeshua does things that strikingly resemble therapy.

He listens without judging (Luke 7:36–50), sees beyond the symptom to the root of suffering (John 4), restores the dignity of the shamed (“Daughter, your faith has saved you,” Mark 5:34), heals through relationship and truth (“Take courage, daughter!”, Matthew 9:22). But Yeshua operates through presence, not through protocol. He does not treat only the trauma, but the separation that produced it. He would respect the modern care for the protection of people, but he would refuse to reduce healing to method.

For him, the encounter remains more powerful than the technique. As a theologian or priest, Yeshua would be just as “uncomfortable.” He does not build dogmatic systems; his theology is narrative, living, tied to concrete people. As a priest, he is problematic for the system: He forgives without ritual (“Man, your sins are forgiven,” Mark 2:5), heals without authorization, and relativizes the temple: “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up” (John 2:19).

When he says, “You have one Teacher, and you are all brothers” (Matthew 23:8), he undermines the hierarchy of the sacred. Yeshua does not administer the sacred; he frees it from structures. In the modern world, Yeshua would be suspect without accreditation, contested by institutions, analyzed, labeled, invited to debates, and placed under the microscope. He would be asked for proofs, diplomas, legal frameworks. Exactly as when he is asked: “By what authority do you do these things?” (Matthew 21:23).

The only difference would be the language: expertise instead of tradition, certification instead of discipleship, external validation instead of inner recognition. The difference of perspective becomes clear. For Yeshua, authority comes from truth lived, formation is existential, healing occurs through presence, and freedom from institutions is natural.

In the modern world, authority comes from accreditation, formation is curricular, healing is tied to method, and legitimacy is conferred by institutions. That is why Yeshua would not need a diploma, because the fruits would be his diploma. “By their fruits you will know them” (Matthew 7:16) remains the decisive criterion. The essential question would not be what qualifications he holds, but whether his presence sets free, whether the encounter with him heals, and whether the truth he lives brings life. These are the only credentials that matter.

What car would Yeshua drive — a symbolic, not a technical reading

Yeshua never spoke about vehicles, but he spoke constantly about the heart, intention, and one's relationship to the world. That is why the answer cannot be mechanical, but ethical and spiritual. The way he would use an object would flow from the same inner coherence that we see in the Gospels, where things never become extensions of identity, but simple means for loving, encountering, and healing. Yeshua systematically avoids the outward signs of power.

His entry into Jerusalem takes place on a donkey, not on a warhorse, fulfilling the words: “Behold, your King is coming to you, humble and mounted on a donkey” (Matthew 21:5). The gesture is not accidental, but a declaration: not domination, but humility. In the same spirit, he asks: “How can you believe, when you receive glory from one another?” (John 5:44). Any object used as a status symbol would contradict this positioning.

A car that would say “look at me” would be foreign to his way of being — not out of moralism, but out of fidelity to inner truth. For Yeshua, things are means, not extensions of the self. He warns clearly: “A person's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions” (Luke 12:15). A car would be, in this sense, merely an instrument for reaching people — the sick, the marginalized, the forgotten.

It would not be an identity-refuge, nor a compensation, nor a confirmation of personal worth. If he drove, he would do it in order to

be available, not for ultimate comfort, keeping the same freedom he expresses when he says: "The Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head" (Luke 9:58). His mobility would be flexible, not luxurious. Yeshua lives in the logic of "enough."

"Do not be anxious about your life..." (Matthew 6:25) and the whole call to look at the birds of the sky and the lilies of the field (Matthew 6:26–28) reveal a heart unattached to accumulation. A possible car would not demand attention, would not dominate the space, and would not create distance between him and others. Simplicity in Yeshua is not ostentatious austerity, but freedom. "Blessed are the poor in spirit" (Matthew 5:3) describes exactly this state: a heart unoccupied by possessions, available for people.

In addition, Yeshua is attentive to the concrete impact of his actions on others. "Whatever you wish that others would do to you, do also to them" (Matthew 7:12) is not an abstract principle, but a profoundly practical one. Transposed into today's world, it would include care for safety, for the peace of others, for the shared space. Not out of ideology, but out of applied love.

He would choose something discreet, safe, and efficient, which puts no one in danger and humiliates no one through ostentation. And yet, it remains possible that Yeshua would not be attached even to the idea of driving. He walks much, stops, touches, listens. His rhythm is human, not hurried. Of his service it is said: "He will not break a bruised reed, nor quench a smoldering wick" (Matthew 12:20). He would not accelerate past people.

If walking allowed the encounter, he would probably prefer it. If a means of transport hurried life needlessly, he would avoid it. A car, if it existed, would not hurry his existence, but would serve love. In the end, the idea of a "Yeshua car" loses its meaning, because Yeshua does not build his identity out of objects, status, or symbols.

He would use only what is sufficient, quiet, unobtrusive, and oriented toward service, without attachment and without turning the means into a message. "Whoever wants to be first must be servant of all" (Mark 9:35) is not a moral slogan, but a perspective on life. Any

instrument is good only to the extent that it brings one closer to people and makes room for love. If a car helped him to serve, he would use it. If it created distance, he would give it up without hesitation.

And the question remains for us: does what we use bring us closer to people or separate us from them?

What Yeshua would say about tattoos, makeup, fashion, and jewelry

Yeshua never explicitly addresses tattoos, makeup, fashion, or jewelry. The complete absence of any prohibitions is not accidental. For Yeshua, the problem is not what you wear, but from what inner place you wear it. He constantly shifts the attention from the outside to the inside, from appearance to the heart, from conformity to truth. The principle is clear: “Man looks at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart” (1 Samuel 16:7), and Yeshua applies it consistently in his teaching.

That is why he can say without equivocation: “It is not what enters the mouth that defiles a person, but what comes out of the mouth” (Matthew 15:11). In Yeshua’s logic, nothing external is sin in itself. Sin is a state of the heart — fear, pride, lies, separation, the lack of love. The Kingdom of God is not played out on the stage of appearances: “The Kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed” (Luke 17:20).

If he were asked about tattoos or fashion, Yeshua would not formulate a dress code, but would ask questions that touch the source: why do you need this? what are you trying to compensate for? are you hiding or expressing yourself? do you identify with the form or with the life within you? Yeshua does not live a demonstrative austerity. On the contrary, he is criticized for his freedom from the religious codes of ostentatious simplicity: “The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, ‘Look, a glutton and a drunkard’” (Matthew 11:19). This shows clearly that Yeshua is not against forms, but against identification with them.

Can you wear expensive clothes and be humble in heart, from Yeshua's perspective?

For Yeshua, humility is not tied to one's material level, but to the absence of inner attachment. The criterion is simple and radical: "Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also" (Matthew 6:21). The problem is not that you wear expensive clothes, jewelry, makeup, or tattoos, but whether your worth depends on them, whether you feel more or less without them, whether you use them as identity.

Yeshua does not demand general poverty, but inner freedom: "A person's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions" (Luke 12:15). Therefore, from Yeshua's perspective, you can wear visible forms and still be humble, if they do not define you and do not separate you from love, truth, and presence. Humility is not the lack of beauty, but the absence of attachment. With Paul, a shift of emphasis appears.

He introduces explicit rules concerning the exterior, especially in his fragile communities, as part of the moral and communal order. For example: "Let women adorn themselves modestly... not with braided hair, gold, pearls, or expensive clothing" (1 Timothy 2:9). In the same direction: "Let your adornment not be external" (1 Peter 3:3, a text attributed to the apostolic tradition). With Paul one senses a suspicion toward the exterior, because he works with communities in which form can quickly become a source of hierarchy, pride, and separation. Personal freedom is subordinated to the common good: "All things are lawful for me, but not all things are helpful" (1 Corinthians 6:12). Here the major difference appears: Yeshua works with the conscience of the individual; Paul works with the discipline of the community.

What for Yeshua remains a matter of the heart, for Paul becomes a rule to prevent chaos. Today's Christianity, in many forms, has taken up the Pauline prohibitions and absolutized them, turning them into dress codes, moral rules, and criteria of "the true believer." Thus, tattoos, makeup, fashion, or jewelry come to be labeled as "worldly," "inappropriate," or "evidence of pride," often without any inner discernment.

Exactly the opposite of Yeshua's requirement occurs when rules are applied mechanically: "They tie up heavy burdens and lay them on people's shoulders" (Matthew 23:4). The result is paradoxical: people who are simple but full of judgment; people who are "modest" but without love; an exterior that is "clean," an interior that is rigid and defensive. Yeshua draws a single clear line: the identification of the heart with the form. "You cannot serve two masters" (Matthew 6:24).

If clothes are expression, not identity; if beauty is celebrated, not idolized; if form is worn with freedom, not with fear, then they are not a spiritual obstacle. But if personal worth comes from appearance, if form becomes superiority, if the exterior replaces the inner life, the problem is not the object — but the attachment. Yeshua is not against tattoos, makeup, fashion, or jewelry; he is against identification with them.

Paul introduces limits to protect the community and to avoid pride and chaos. Contemporary Christianity has often turned these limits into rigid moral laws. Yes, you can wear expensive clothes and be humble in heart. Humility is not seen in the label, but in inner freedom: "Blessed are the poor in spirit" (Matthew 5:3). "Poor in spirit" does not mean devoid of beauty, but unattached to form.

Would Yeshua watch TV?

If watching becomes an escape from truth, an emotional numbing, or a substitute for presence, Yeshua would not condemn the gesture in itself, but would go straight to the root and ask, in keeping with his own words: "Why are you anxious?" (Matthew 6:28). He would look for the fear, the emptiness, or the flight hidden behind the habit. By contrast, if watching becomes an occasion for understanding people, for lucidity about the world, or for compassion, nothing in the Gospels suggests a prohibition.

"The eye is the lamp of the body" (Matthew 6:22) refers not to the object watched, but to the clarity with which you watch. In the same way, Yeshua does not use competition as an existential model. His parables speak of seeds that grow, shepherds who search, fathers who

wait, and people who lose in order to gain life. When he says, "Whoever wants to be first must be servant of all" (Mark 9:35), he reverses the logic of identity built on victory.

He could watch a match as a human spectacle — joy, play, community — but the moment the game gives birth to anger, hatred, division, or tribal identification, his attention would shift immediately from the score to the heart, because "Blessed are the gentle" (Matthew 5:5) remains the criterion. The game remains a game only as long as it does not become an idol. If the idea of a "favorite team" meant identity-based belonging and a delimitation between "us" and "them," the answer would almost certainly be negative.

Yeshua affirms clearly: "My Kingdom is not of this world" (John 18:36), constantly refusing to be absorbed by camps and external loyalties. If there were any preference, it would be easy to let go, without attachment, in the spirit of his freedom expressed in the words: "The Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head" (Luke 9:58). The Apostle Paul views these things from a different perspective.

He explicitly introduces the sporting metaphor when he says: "Do you not know that in a race all the runners run, but only one receives the prize? So run that you may obtain it" (1 Corinthians 9:24). For Paul, life has a clear goal, the risk of distraction is real, and self-control is a virtue. "Every athlete exercises self-control in all things" (1 Corinthians 9:25) does not condemn the game, but subordinates it to a direction.

That is why his principle remains: "All things are lawful, but not all things are helpful" (1 Corinthians 10:23) and "I will not be dominated by anything" (1 Corinthians 6:12). Entertainment is acceptable only to the extent that it does not become a master. In the same line, Paul relativizes any secondary identity through the affirmation: "Our citizenship is in heaven" (Philippians 3:20).

He would not forbid sympathy for a team, but he would refuse the emotional absorption that competes with the goal of spiritual life. The attachments that steal attention become, for him, a loss of direction. Seen together, these two perspectives do not contradict each other, but illuminate the same truth from different angles. Yeshua would ask: what

does this do to your heart? Paul would ask: what does this do to your direction?

Yeshua operates from presence and inner freedom, Paul from discipline and responsibility. Neither promotes dependence, idolatry, or division. And the conclusion remains the same for both, expressed through the call: “Seek first the Kingdom of God” (Matthew 6:33) — not as a prohibition, but as a compass for the attention.

Would Yeshua obey all laws if He lived today?

The Gospels show that he observes the law when it serves life and transcends it when the law becomes an end in itself. That is why he says: “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath” (Mark 2:27). The law is an instrument for the good of the person, not an absolute that demands blind obedience. Yeshua does not live from the fear of sanction, but from living discernment. If he drove today, he would observe the traffic rules because they protect life.

He would not turn speeding into a gesture of spiritual rebellion, nor would he idolize the rule. In real situations, he could exceed the legal limit not out of negligence, but out of prioritizing life, exactly as he healed on the Sabbath day. When he is asked whether it is permitted to heal, he answers: “Is it lawful to do good on the Sabbath, or to do harm?” (Mark 3:4). The question is not “what does the regulation say,” but “what serves life now?”

This freedom does not mean irresponsibility. If he broke a rule and caused harm, Yeshua would not evade it, would not lie, and would not transfer the blame. Because “whoever is faithful in little is faithful also in much” (Luke 16:10). Conscience is seen in the details, not in grand declarations. If he were stopped by the police, Yeshua would enter neither into fearful submission nor into defensive conflict.

He would speak directly, simply, and responsibly, because “let your word be: yes, yes; no, no” (Matthew 5:37). He would not try to manipulate the situation in order to escape the consequences, but would remain in the truth. If he erred, he would own it. If the rule was applied

mechanically, without discernment, he could say so without aggression, not in order to absolve himself, but in order to open the conscience of the other.

When he says, “Give to Caesar what is Caesar’s, and to God what is God’s” (Matthew 22:21), Yeshua recognizes civil authority, but sets its limits. The state has its role, the law has its role, but conscience is not delegated. Moral responsibility remains in the person, not in the system. The Gospels do not present Yeshua as a technical superman, but as a person fully present. Presence reduces unconsciousness, but does not promise mechanical perfection.

If he made a mistake, he would not hide behind excuses and would not look for the guilty. That is why he says: “Why do you see the speck in your brother’s eye and not the log in your own eye?” (Matthew 7:3). Truth begins with oneself. Yeshua is not the moralist who demands flawlessness, but the one who unmasks moralism empty of heart. That is why he says: “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites” (Matthew 23:27).

Moralism corrects behaviors from the outside; Yeshua seeks to heal the inner source from which they arise. If he lived today, Yeshua would observe the laws because he respects life. He would break them when observing them would deny life. He would not use freedom as an excuse for unconsciousness, nor the rule as an excuse for the lack of heart. He would speak with the authorities without fear and without contempt. He would not evade. He would not perform virtue.

Because, in the end, “the truth will set you free” (John 8:32). And freedom, for Yeshua, is not the absence of rules, but the presence of conscience. Where conscience is alive, the law finds its natural place: not as a master, but as a servant of life.

Yeshua in uniform: when forgiveness precedes correction

If we were to imagine Yeshua in a police uniform, in a judge’s robe, or in the role of a prosecutor, the first thing that would step outside the usual pattern of the system would be the inner order of his intervention.

With him, forgiveness does not come after correction, as a reward for conformity; forgiveness precedes correction, as its condition. He does not correct in order to punish, but corrects in order to restore.

That is why, in the episode of the woman caught in adultery, before any morality or sanction, he says: "Neither do I condemn you. Go and sin no more" (John 8:11). We observe the order: first the lifting up from shame, then the invitation to transformation. If he were a police officer, Yeshua would not relativize the deed, but he would separate the deed from the person's identity. He would not say "you have not erred," but "you are not your error."

As a police officer, he would see the offense not only as a breaking of the law, but as a symptom of an inner rupture. When Peter draws the sword in Gethsemane, Yeshua does not approve of religiously justified violence, but says: "Put your sword back in its place; for all who take the sword will perish by the sword" (Matthew 26:52). This would be his philosophy of intervention: stopping evil without becoming one with it. He would defuse the situation, not feed it. He would have firmness without hatred, authority without humiliation.

In a culture of fear, he would be presence; in a culture of repression, he would be conscience. He would not negotiate the truth, but neither would he treat the person as a file. As a prosecutor, Yeshua would understand that the accusation has its role, but he would always seek a truth deeper than the raw deed.

In the scene with the Pharisees who bring the woman caught in adultery, he does not deny the Law, but turns the spotlight toward the conscience of the accusers: "Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone" (John 8:7). Such a prosecutor would pursue responsibility without feeding hypocrisy. He would unmask evil, but he would do it in such a way that the accuser too would be called to introspection.

He would know that justice without inner truth becomes legalized cruelty, and truth without love becomes an instrument of domination. As a judge, Yeshua would know that any sentence pronounced upon another passes first through one's own heart. "Do not judge, so that you

may not be judged" (Matthew 7:1) is not the abolition of discernment, but the warning against judgment contaminated by ego. His judgment would be one that seeks restoration, not exclusion.

He would see the potential for conversion in every person, even in the guilty one. On the cross, before those who were executing him legally, he says: "Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do" (Luke 23:34). This is not the cancellation of consequences, but the recognition of ignorance as the root of many crimes. Such a judge would apply the law, but would always leave open the door of repentance.

"For Yeshua, forgiveness precedes correction" means that the person is met first in his dignity, not in his deviation. The correction that comes after forgiveness is no longer a humiliation, but a call to rise. When he meets Zacchaeus, he does not begin with the indictment, but with the invitation to the table (Luke 19:5). And the transformation occurs from within: "Behold, Lord, half of my possessions I give to the poor..." (Luke 19:8).

Here we see restorative justice in its pure form: the change of heart produces the repair of the harm. If he were within a modern system, he would probably seem uncomfortable. Too gentle for those who want exemplary punishment, too firm for those who want moral relativism. But this very tension would show that true authority does not come from fear, but from inner coherence. He would not confuse compassion with permissiveness, nor the law with revenge.

He would live what he said: "I desire mercy, not sacrifice" (Matthew 9:13). Mercy does not replace justice, but fulfills it at a higher level. In the end, Yeshua as police officer, prosecutor, or judge would not be defined by the office, but by presence. He would be the one who sees first the face of God in the person, then the deed. And this seeing would change the very nature of the intervention. Because when forgiveness precedes correction, correction is no longer about crushing, but about restoring. Not about winning a case, but about saving a heart.

Who are the hypocritical Pharisees of today

When Yeshua says “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites” (Matthew 23), he does not denounce merely a religious group. He exposes a structure of human consciousness that can appear in any age and in any tradition. That is why he says: “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you clean the outside of the cup and the dish, but inside they are full of greed and self-indulgence” (Matthew 23:25). The problem is not the law, nor religion, nor spiritual discipline.

The problem is the rupture between the exterior and the interior, between displayed righteousness and truth lived. Phariseeism begins where a person becomes an expert at pointing the finger. He sees the errors of others, identifies them, denounces them, exposes them, and corrects them. Not necessarily out of malice, but often with the sincere conviction that he is defending the truth. It is precisely here that the trap lies. Phariseeism does not appear in the form of obvious evil, but in the form of moral good. The Pharisee is correct, disciplined, respectable.

He often says true things. But the truth he speaks becomes the instrument through which he separates people into two categories: those who are right and those who err. Thus, truth no longer unites, but creates distance. That is why Yeshua says: “Why do you see the speck in your brother’s eye and not notice the log in your own eye?” (Matthew 7:3). The observation about the speck may be correct. The speck really exists. But the problem is not the existence of the speck, but the direction of the gaze.

The Pharisee’s gaze is oriented almost exclusively toward the errors of the other. Truth becomes a subtle form of superiority. In this sense, the hypocrisy of the Pharisee does not necessarily consist in the fact that he does not practice what he says. Often the Pharisee does practice the discipline he preaches. He prays, fasts, observes the rules, lives a moral life. The problem is not necessarily his behavior.

The problem is the inner conviction that if he has the truth, he no longer needs humility. Truth becomes for him a justification of rigidity. Because he believes he is right, he considers that he can speak without

compassion, judge without delicacy, and expose without love. That is precisely why Yeshua says: "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you tithe mint and dill and cumin, but you have neglected the weightier matters of the Law: justice, mercy, and faithfulness" (Matthew 23:23). The Pharisee is not lacking in discipline. He is even exemplary. But this very external correctness can hide the absence of mercy. Justice becomes separated from love.

That is why Phariseeism is so hard to recognize. If it were obviously evil, it would be easy to identify. But it appears in the form of a cold righteousness. The Pharisee does not necessarily say false things. He often says correct things, but without heart. He believes that truth in itself is sufficient. But for Yeshua, truth without love is not yet truth. That is why he says: "They do all their deeds to be seen by others" (Matthew 23:5). The inner motivation thus becomes more important than external correctness.

The harshest image Yeshua uses is this: "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like whitewashed tombs, which outwardly appear beautiful, but within are full of dead men's bones" (Matthew 23:27). The whitewashed tomb is respectable, orderly, even admirable on the outside. But inside there is no life. So religion becomes when it loses love: the form remains, but the life disappears.

The modern Pharisee can appear in any religious or ideological tradition. He can be a religious leader, a preacher, a theologian, a moral activist, an online commentator, or a simple believer convinced that he is defending the truth. Wherever someone builds his identity around the idea "I am on the side of truth," the Pharisaic structure begins to take shape. Because truth becomes identity, not search.

But the most uncomfortable question remains this: how do I know if I myself am the Pharisee? The answer begins where a person notices a certain inner satisfaction when he discovers the errors of others. If truth is used to correct without love, to expose without compassion, or to demonstrate moral superiority, then the Pharisaic structure is already active.

That is why Yeshua says: "How can you believe, when you receive glory from one another and do not seek the glory that comes from the only God?" (John 5:44). When the moral approval of the group becomes more important than love, truth turns into an ideology. The parable of the Pharisee and the tax collector reveals this structure perfectly.

"The Pharisee stood and prayed thus to himself: God, I thank you that I am not like other people" (Luke 18:11). He does not necessarily lie. His life is disciplined. But his spiritual identity is built through comparison. By contrast, the tax collector says only: "God, have mercy on me, a sinner" (Luke 18:13). And Yeshua's conclusion overturns the religious logic: "This man went down to his house justified, rather than the other" (Luke 18:14).

The uncomfortable truth is that Phariseeism is not about others. It is a possibility present in every person who seeks the truth. And precisely for this reason, the only real protection against it is not doctrinal correctness, but humility. The person who believes he has the truth and therefore no longer needs humility is already in the danger of Phariseeism. By contrast, the person who seeks the truth with an open heart remains capable of love.

Thus, the question "who are the hypocritical Pharisees of today?" inevitably becomes a personal question. It is not about a religious group, nor about a denomination. It is about an attitude of the heart. Because Phariseeism begins exactly where truth is used in order to separate. And the spirit of Yeshua begins where truth is lived in humility, mercy, and love.

And perhaps the most honest question someone can ask after reading these words is not "whom is Yeshua describing?" but one much more direct and uncomfortable: "Do I use truth in order to love or in order to point the finger?"

How Yeshua sees “the Apocalypse”

For Yeshua, “the end” is not primarily a cosmic catastrophe to be anticipated with fear, but a revelation. “Apocalypse” means uncovering, the lifting of the veil. That is why, when he speaks of times of crisis, he does not do it in order to feed anxiety, but in order to awaken sight. He says clearly: “When you hear of wars and rumors of wars, do not be alarmed” (Mark 13:7). The disturbances are real, but the reaction required is not panic, but lucidity.

Yeshua shifts the emphasis from chronology to the quality of presence. He refuses to offer dates or maps of the future, saying: “Concerning that day and hour no one knows” (Matthew 24:36). This not-knowing is not a limitation, but a protection. He knows that the human mind, when it receives apocalyptic scenarios, turns them either into fear or into an obsession with control. That is why his call is simple: “Watch therefore, for you do not know on what day your Lord is coming” (Matthew 24:42).

Watching does not mean keeping one's eyes on external signs, but remaining present, not swallowed up by panic or hatred. Yeshua's apocalyptic language is symbolic, not technical. When he says that “the sun will be darkened... the stars will fall from heaven” (Matthew 24:29), he does not offer an astronomical bulletin, but describes the collapse of the reference points on which a person leans his identity. When these structures fall, crisis appears. And in this crisis, the truth comes to the surface.

That is why he affirms: “Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away” (Matthew 24:35). It is not annihilation, but transformation: the forms pass, the truth remains. In the same logic, Yeshua speaks of judgment not as a cosmic tribunal, but as the effect of the encounter with the light: “The light has come into the world, but people loved the darkness more” (John 3:19). Judgment is the revelation of what is already in the person. When the truth appears, what is false falls apart.

This is the apocalypse: the uncovering. That is why he says: "Whoever endures to the end will be saved" (Matthew 24:13). To endure does not mean to survive a disaster physically, but to remain whole, lucid, uncorrupted by fear and hatred when the world is shaken. Salvation is a state of being, not an emergency evacuation from history. By contrast, today's Christianity has often turned the apocalypse into a scenario of theological terror.

The end of the world is preached as punishment, as divine revenge, as the moment of radical separation between "us" and "the others." Verses such as "woe to those who are pregnant... woe to those who are in those days" (Matthew 24:19) are often taken out of context and used to feed fear. But Yeshua does not describe these things in order to frighten, but in order to show the natural consequences of a world that lives from violence and lies.

He says something entirely different: "When these things begin to take place, look up and raise your heads" (Luke 21:28). This invitation is impossible to integrate into a theology of panic. Yeshua does not say "hide yourselves," but "raise your heads." Crisis becomes a moment of maturing, not of spiritual collapse. In Yeshua's vision, the apocalypse is not the end of life, but the end of illusion. It is not the destruction of the world, but the destruction of the old way of inhabiting it.

That is why he remains consistent to the very end with his central message: not fear, but conscious presence. "Do not be afraid" is not merely an emotional exhortation, but the key through which crisis becomes revelation. For Yeshua, the end of the world is not something to be anticipated with terror, but a threshold of truth. Today's Christianity is called to decide whether it uses the apocalypse as an instrument of fear or rereads it as an invitation to consciousness. Yeshua chose the second path.

Will Yeshua come a second time?

The expectation of a "second coming" of Yeshua is today one of the most powerful ideas in Christianity. For millions of people, it represents

the moment when Yeshua will return to earth to judge the world, separate the righteous from the sinners, and establish the final order. But a simple, almost uncomfortable question deserves to be asked: where exactly does this expectation come from? Did Yeshua himself explicitly say that he would return physically a second time to judge the world?

When we read carefully the words attributed to Yeshua in the Gospels, we observe that the central theme of his preaching is not a future return, but the present reality of the Kingdom of God. He says: "The Kingdom of God is within you" (Luke 17:21). He does not say that it will come in a distant future, but that it is already present for the one who can see.

In another place he affirms: "Truly I tell you, there are some standing here who will not taste death until they see the Kingdom of God come with power" (Mark 9:1). If these words are taken literally, they shift the emphasis from a return thousands of years later to a transformation that was to be experienced by his contemporaries. In many passages, Yeshua describes the coming of the "Son of Man" in symbolic, prophetic language, similar to Jewish apocalyptic literature.

For example: "Then they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds with great power and glory" (Matthew 24:30). But the same discourse also includes the direct statement: "Truly I tell you, this generation will not pass away until all these things take place" (Matthew 24:34). This sentence has created major difficulties for later theology, because if "this generation" refers to the generation contemporary with Yeshua, then the events described cannot simply be projected into a future two thousand years distant.

Moreover, Yeshua seems to discourage the obsession with spectacular future events. He warns: "If they say to you, 'Look, here he is!' or 'Look, there he is!' do not believe it" (Matthew 24:23). Instead of inviting people to wait for a cosmic spectacle, he invites them to an immediate inner transformation: "Watch therefore, for you do not know on what day your Lord is coming" (Matthew 24:42).

Here "the coming" is not presented as a calendar date, but as a reality for which a person must be ready at any moment. The idea of a

dramatic and universal return becomes much more accentuated in the later apostolic writings. For example, in 1 Thessalonians 4:16 it is said: "The Lord himself will descend from heaven with a cry of command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God." Here there already appears a clearly apocalyptic image of a final cosmic intervention.

Over time, this interpretation was consolidated and became a central doctrine in institutional Christianity. But there is also another way of understanding these words, closer to the spirit of Yeshua's preaching. He says: "The Kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed" (Luke 17:20). If the Kingdom does not come as a visible spectacle, then his "coming" can be understood rather as an inner revelation, an awakening of consciousness, a recognition of truth in the heart. That is why he affirms: "Whoever hears my words and does them is like a man who built his house on the rock" (Matthew 7:24). The emphasis is not on the moment of his return, but on the transformation of the one who lives his message.

In this light, the question "whether Yeshua will come a second time" takes on a different meaning. Perhaps the issue is not whether he will appear again in the sky, but whether his message will be reborn in people's hearts. Because when a person begins to live the love, the forgiveness, and the truth that Yeshua preached, in a certain sense he comes again.

That is why he says: "If anyone loves me, he will keep my word, and my Father will love him, and We will come to him and make Our home with him" (John 14:23). Thus, perhaps the true expectation should not be for a spectacular appearance in the sky, but for his appearance in the consciousness of the person.

Because where love conquers fear, where truth conquers dogma, and where compassion conquers judgment, there Yeshua is no longer a figure of the past or of the future, but a living presence. And then the question is no longer "when will he come?" but "are we ready to recognize him?"

Does Yeshua believe the world is going worse and worse or better and better?

For Yeshua, the question of whether the world is going “worse” or “better” is already framed from an angle that misses the essential. He does not operate with graphs of historical progress or decline, but speaks of two dynamics that unfold simultaneously: the degradation of old forms that no longer sustain life, and the appearance of a more mature consciousness. That is why he says: “You will hear of wars and rumors of wars... but do not be alarmed” (Mark 13:7).

Conflicts increase, instability becomes visible, but the reaction required is not panic, but discernment. Crisis is not proof that the world “is falling apart senselessly,” but that something old is dissolving. When he affirms that “because lawlessness will increase, the love of many will grow cold” (Matthew 24:12), Yeshua describes the natural consequence of collective fear. Pressure brings to the surface the fragilities of the heart.

But he does not remain in this register of degradation; he immediately adds the criterion that changes the perspective: “whoever endures to the end will be saved” (Matthew 24:13). To endure does not mean to survive biologically, but to remain whole, lucid, and loving in the midst of tension. As the world becomes more agitated, truth becomes more visible. Not everyone goes in the same direction: some lose themselves in fear, others awaken.

This dynamic is captured from the very beginning of the Gospel: “The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome it” (John 1:5). Darkness may grow in intensity, but it does not have the last word. The paradox is that the light becomes clearer precisely against the background of the darkness. Yeshua does not say that the world will become uniformly better, but that the difference between truth and falsehood will become ever more visible.

When he affirms that “heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away” (Matthew 24:35), Yeshua does not announce total destruction, but the passing of forms. “Heaven and earth”

designate systems of meaning, structures of power, collective identities that can no longer sustain life. They collapse not because God punishes them, but because truth no longer fits within them. At the same time, Yeshua shows that true progress is not spectacular and does not dominate the news.

“The Kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed” (Luke 17:20). Real growth takes place invisibly, in people who see, forgive, and remain lucid in a fragmented world. From the outside, it may seem that the world is going worse. From within, a more conscious humanity is being born. Yeshua is realistic and affirms that “many are called, but few are chosen” (Matthew 22:14). Not everyone will choose this maturing.

The polarization is real: some radicalize in fear and violence, others become simpler and more alive. That is why he says in the parable of the wheat and the weeds: “Let them grow together until the harvest” (Matthew 13:30). Good and evil grow simultaneously. There is no pure era in which evil disappears, nor one in which good is defeated. What changes is the degree of clarity.

This clarity is expressed in the call: “When these things begin to take place, raise your heads” (Luke 21:28). It is impossible to integrate this sentence into a purely pessimistic vision. Yeshua does not say “despair,” but “raise your heads.” Crisis becomes the sign of an approaching revelation, not of abandonment. Therefore, Yeshua does not believe that the world is going inevitably worse, nor that it evolves automatically toward good. He sees the world as a field of awakening.

The pressure increases, and with it increases the possibility of seeing. For those who remain in fear, the world will seem worse and worse. For those who see, the world becomes more true. Yeshua does not promise a comfortable world, but a transparent one. He does not promise guaranteed external progress, but possible inner clarity. In this light, the question is no longer whether the world is going worse or better, but from what vantage point you view it. In his vision, the world is going toward truth. And truth, before it heals, reveals.

Yeshua lets you run away like the prodigal son

The parable of the prodigal son is one of the most profound descriptions of human psychology in all of Scripture. At first glance it seems merely a story about a young man who loses his fortune and returns home. But in reality it describes the universal mechanism by which a person tries to escape his own inner discomfort. The son does not leave only for the money. He leaves because he comes to believe that distance is freedom.

The text says: “Father, give me the share of the estate that falls to me” (Luke 15:12). This request is not merely economic, but existential. Hidden within it is a subtle idea: I want my life without my relationship with you. Here appears one of the greatest confusions of the human being: the confusion of freedom with separation. Freedom is an inner state that is born of maturity and consciousness. Separation is merely distance. The son believes that if he changes his location he will escape the tension he feels.

But the parable suggests something different. The problem was not the father's house, but the inner state of the son. That is why the text says that he “went into a far country” (Luke 15:13). This distance is not only geographical. It is the symbol of an inner distance, of a rupture from relationship and from oneself. From a psychological standpoint, flight is one of the oldest mechanisms for regulating the nervous system. When the interior becomes uncomfortable, a person seeks a quick way out.

Some fight, some freeze, and others flee. The prodigal son chose flight. The mind creates the illusion that changing the context will resolve the inner state. If I change the place, the people, or the life, I will feel better. But the reality is that a person carries his interior with him wherever he goes. That is why the parable says that “there he squandered his property in reckless living” (Luke 15:13). The text does not speak only of pleasures or excesses. It speaks of distraction.

Distraction is one of the most frequent strategies by which a person tries not to feel the emptiness. The son tries three things that almost every person tries at some point: independence, pleasure, and material

abundance. He believes that freedom lies in total autonomy, that joy lies in the consumption of pleasures, and that security lies in material resources.

But the parable introduces a short and devastating sentence: "After he had spent everything, a great famine arose in that country" (Luke 15:14). The famine is not only economic. It is the famine of meaning. When the distractions run out, a person remains alone with his interior. And what he was trying to avoid returns with even greater force. The turning point of the parable appears in an extremely simple phrase: "He came to himself" (Luke 15:17).

In Greek, the expression literally means "he came to himself." The parable does not first say that he returned to his father, but that he returned to himself. Only after this inner awakening does the decision appear: "I will arise and go to my father" (Luke 15:18). This order is fundamental. Reconciliation with the relationship always begins with reconciliation with oneself. A person cannot repair external relationships as long as he remains a stranger to his own heart.

Why did the son believe that flight was the solution? Because this is the universal error of the ego. The ego assumes that pain comes from the outside. If I change the people, if I change the place, if I change the circumstances, the problem will disappear. But the son's experience shows the contrary. When he was at home he was restless. When he left he remained restless. When he lost everything he finally began to see himself.

The parable thus reveals a profound truth: it is not distance that heals relationships, but consciousness. That is why the story of the prodigal son is surprisingly current. People continue to do the same thing: they change relationships, change cities, change partners, change careers, change identities. But very often they remain the same. The parable shows that the problem was not the father's house, but the immaturity of the son. The moment this immaturity becomes visible, the possibility of return also appears.

It is interesting that the father does not try to stop him. The text says simply: "He divided his property between them" (Luke 15:12). The

father permits the departure. In this is hidden a profound wisdom. Some truths cannot be learned through explanation, but only through experience. Some forms of maturing cannot appear in the safety of the house, but only in wandering. The parable does not condemn the son's departure. It only shows that flight does not solve the problem we are trying to avoid.

Thus, the journey of the prodigal son becomes the journey of many people. The departure begins as a rebellion, continues as a distraction, and ends as an awakening. And the moment a person comes to himself and says, "I will arise and go to my father" (Luke 15:18), he discovers something unexpected: the father never abandoned him. While the son was fleeing, the father remained where he had always been, ready for his return.

13. Levels of Consciousness

Yeshua's Imperatives and the Levels of Consciousness

One of the most interesting observations we can make when reading the Gospels is that Yeshua's imperatives are not simply moral commandments. They are usually read as ethical rules — things we should or should not do. But if we look at them closely within the context of Yeshua's whole message, another, far deeper perspective emerges: these imperatives seem to be addressed to different levels of consciousness.

In modern psychology and spirituality there are models that describe the evolution of human consciousness in stages. One of them is the scale of consciousness proposed by David R. Hawkins, where different emotional states — fear, desire, courage, love, or peace — correspond to different levels of the perception of reality. Seen through this lens, Yeshua's words take on a surprising coherence. They are not merely rules of behavior; they describe a gradual ascent of consciousness.

The first level at which Yeshua addresses people is the level of fear. In the ancient world, just as in the world today, fear dominated people's lives: the fear of want, the fear of the future, the fear of death, the fear of divine judgment. That is why one of the most frequently repeated imperatives in the Gospels is simple and radical: "Do not be afraid." In Matthew 10:31 he says: "Do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows." In the same spirit, in the Sermon on the Mount he says: "Do not worry about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink... nor about your body, what you will wear" (Matthew 6:25).

And a few verses later he adds: “Do not worry about tomorrow” (Matthew 6:34). In these words it is clear that the first thing Yeshua does is to calm the human nervous system. Consciousness cannot evolve while it is dominated by fear. Once fear begins to settle, Yeshua shifts the attention toward inner responsibility.

This is why one of his first public statements is: “Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is near” (Matthew 4:17). In modern language, this is not merely a call to moral guilt but an invitation to a change of perspective. To repent literally means to change your mind, to see things differently. In the same direction he tells the woman caught in adultery: “Neither do I condemn you; go, and from now on sin no more” (John 8:11).

Here it is no longer a matter of fear but of the awakening of personal consciousness. The human being is called to become self-aware. Another step in this transformation is the dissolution of judgment. The moral ego feeds on comparison and condemnation. That is why Yeshua says clearly: “Do not judge, so that you will not be judged” (Matthew 7:1). Immediately after this he adds a memorable image: “Why do you see the speck in your brother’s eye and not the plank in your own?” (Matthew 7:3).

Here Yeshua attacks directly the psychological mechanism of projection. The person who judges others does not see his own shadows. Through this imperative, consciousness begins to turn from the exterior toward the interior. As judgment diminishes, room appears for mature relationships. In the Sermon on the Mount, Yeshua says: “If you bring your gift to the altar and there remember that your brother has something against you, leave your gift there before the altar and go first to be reconciled with your brother” (Matthew 5:23–24).

This statement is extraordinary, because it places the relationship above religious ritual. In the same logic comes what is known as the golden rule: “Whatever you wish that others would do to you, do also to them” (Matthew 7:12). At this point consciousness begins to operate in empathy. But Yeshua does not stop here. After establishing the relational foundation, he introduces the principle of love.

In John 13:34 he says: “I give you a new commandment: that you love one another; as I have loved you, so you also are to love one another.” Love is no longer merely an emotion or a preference. It becomes the structure of consciousness. The human being begins to see in the other not a rival or a stranger but an extension of his own humanity.

Then comes one of the most radical statements in the entire spiritual tradition: “Love your enemies, bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you, and pray for those who persecute you” (Matthew 5:44). This imperative seems impossible to the ordinary mind. From the perspective of the ego, the enemy must be fought, not loved. But it is precisely here that the difference between morality and consciousness becomes visible.

Morality says: “Do no harm.” Awakened consciousness says: “Respond with love.” Finally, Yeshua arrives at imperatives that seem entirely paradoxical to ordinary logic. “Do not resist the evil one. And to the one who strikes you on the right cheek, turn the other also” (Matthew 5:39). Or the even more enigmatic statement: “Be perfect, as your heavenly Father is perfect” (Matthew 5:48). These words can no longer be interpreted as simple rules of behavior.

They describe a consciousness that no longer operates out of defensiveness or separation. The human being no longer reacts from the ego, because his identity is no longer centered on the ego. Taken together, all these imperatives form a very clear scale of inner transformation. First, fear is calmed. Then the person is called to responsibility. After that he is invited to relinquish judgment.

Then comes relational maturity, then love, then universal compassion, and, in the end, the transcendence of the ego. In this light, the Gospels can be read not as a collection of religious rules but as a map of the evolution of human consciousness. Yeshua does not seem interested in building a rigid theological system. He is interested in the transformation of the human being. That is why his imperatives are not merely commandments.

They are descriptions of what a person looks like when his consciousness awakens. That is why many of Yeshua's words seem impossible to the ordinary reader. Not because they are exaggerated, but because they are addressed to a consciousness that has not yet arrived there. In this sense, Yeshua's words are not merely a morality. They are an invitation to a profound inner mutation.

What the Hierarchy of Sins Says About the Level of Consciousness

Contemporary Christianity has inherited mostly the lists, but not the discernment that gave rise to them. Thus, “the gravest sins” come to be those that violate visible norms: “nonconforming” sexuality, lifestyle, wrong opinions, belonging to the wrong groups. The sins of the heart — pride, cruelty, the absence of empathy — are often tolerated or even justified “in the name of truth.” In this paradigm, sin is no longer what breaks the relationship but what breaks the rule.

Morality becomes a filter, and empathy disappears. The person is no longer met but analyzed. Judgment is swift, correction is cold, and love is conditioned on prior change. Paradoxically, the very sins that Yeshua considered the gravest — hypocrisy, judgment, the absence of mercy — are rarely named as such today. They are masked under “righteous indignation,” “the defense of truth,” or “faithfulness.”

The way a tradition defines “grave sin” says more about its level of consciousness than about its declared morality. For Yeshua, the sin that truly matters is the closing of the heart — the refusal to see, to love, and to remain open to truth when it appears. “The light has come into the world, but people loved the darkness more” (John 3:19) does not describe a list of deeds but an inner stance.

Sin, for Yeshua, is the blindness that prevents the encounter. For the Apostle Paul, the emphasis shifts. Grave sin becomes deviation from the truth, understood as the central message that must be preserved and transmitted. Hence the language of warning and demarcation: “Even if we or an angel from heaven should preach another gospel...” (Galatians

1:8). The truth is protected in order to save the community. It is no longer merely a matter of the heart but of fidelity to a content.

In today's institutional Christianity, the shift goes even further. Grave sin often becomes the departure from the norm. What counts becomes visible conformity, observance of the framework, the avoidance of sanction. Sin moves from the interior to the exterior, from relationship to rule. "This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me" (Matthew 15:8) remains the diagnosis that crosses the centuries. The essential difference of perspective is clear.

Yeshua seeks the healing of the human being. Paul seeks the protection of the truth. Christianity today often ends up seeking the control of behavior. As we descend from relationship to rule, sin becomes ever easier to identify and ever harder to heal. Where sin is defined without empathy, transformation stops.

Where truth is no longer lived but imposed, it ceases to liberate: "The truth will set you free" (John 8:32) does not function under a regime of coercion. And where judgment takes the place of presence, the gravest sin becomes invisible — because it is the very loss of love. "If I have no love, I am nothing" (1 Corinthians 13:2) remains the conclusion that reorders any hierarchy.

"Take Up Your Cross"

For Yeshua, the expression "take up your cross" is not an invitation to passive suffering, nor the glorification of pain, nor a religious fatalism. The language is concrete, existential. The cross is not a sacred object but the experience through which the old way of living — out of fear, ego, and self-salvation — dies. "If anyone wants to come after me, let him deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me" (Mark 8:34). The order is essential: first the denial of self, then the cross.

The cross is not something that happens to us from the outside but what remains when we relinquish identification with the false self — the image, the control, the manufactured securities. "Whoever loses his life for my sake and for the gospel will save it" (Mark 8:35). The life

that is “lost” is not the biological one but the life built on defense, status, and fear. Yeshua does not say that everyone has the same cross. On the contrary, each one “takes up his cross.” The cross is personal because the ego is personal.

For some, the cross may mean the loss of a relationship, a career, a social identity; for others, the confrontation with illness, limitation, failure. But not every suffering is a cross. The cross is suffering assumed in truth — not suffering that is avoided, dramatized, or used as an identity. A loss becomes a cross when you no longer flee from it through resentment, victimhood, or cynicism, but remain present and true in the midst of it.

“Blessed are the poor in spirit” (Matthew 5:3) — this poverty is the emptying of self, the stripping away of certainties, the acceptance of the fact that you are neither the center nor the master of life. Yeshua does not ask people to seek out their suffering. He himself does not seek the cross. In Gethsemane he avoids it if possible: “Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from me” (Luke 22:42). This shows clearly that the cross is not the ideal.

The cross is what remains when the truth can no longer be avoided. And immediately he adds: “Yet not my will, but yours be done” (Luke 22:42). This is the heart of it: no longer to direct your life out of fear, even when it hurts; not to betray your truth for the sake of comfort. The cross is bound to following him, not to religious performance. To take up your cross means to live as he lived in a world that runs on fear, power, and image.

“If they persecuted me, they will persecute you also” (John 15:20). This is not divine punishment but the natural friction between truth and a world that prefers appearance. The cross is the consequence of living in truth. What, then, does resurrection mean for us? It does not come after you have “suffered enough” but after you no longer cling to the ego. Yeshua does not say “take up your cross in order to die,” but in order to live: “I came that they may have life, and have it abundantly” (John 10:10).

Resurrection is not necessarily a change of circumstances but a change of the center from which you live. The “risen” person may remain within the same outer limits, but he is no longer defined by them. “Whoever believes in me, even if he has died, will live” (John 11:25). This life begins now: freedom from fear, resentment, and the need for self-salvation. For Yeshua, the cross without resurrection would be absurd, and resurrection without the cross — an illusion. The cross is the death of the lie about oneself.

Resurrection is the birth of true life. “Unless a grain of wheat dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit” (John 12:24). Not everyone will have the same cross, but all are called to the same passage: from a life lived out of fear to a life lived out of truth. Yeshua does not say “suffer,” but “follow me.” And following him passes through the cross, but it does not stop there. The cross is the passage. Resurrection is the life that begins.

How Yeshua Would Want Us to See His Resurrection

For Yeshua, the resurrection does not appear as a theological demonstration to be accepted intellectually, but as a revelation of the life that cannot be destroyed. He does not tell his disciples “believe that I have risen so that you may be saved”; rather, he shows himself, speaks with them, eats together with them, and calls them by name. The resurrection, in his way, is an encounter, not an argument. That is why his first words after the resurrection are simple: “Peace be with you” (John 20:19).

No explanations of what happened follow, but the healing of fear. The disciples sat locked away “for fear of the Jews,” and Yeshua does not rebuke them for their lack of faith; he enters into their fear and dissolves it through presence. He asks: “Why are you troubled, and why do doubts arise in your hearts?” (Luke 24:38). He does not demand the elimination of doubt through effort but looks at it and passes through it together with them.

That is why he shows himself vulnerable, with his wounds visible, saying: “Look at my hands and my feet” (Luke 24:39). The wounds are not hidden. The resurrection does not erase suffering but integrates it. The message is not triumphant power but love that has not turned into resentment in the face of death. Thomas is the clearest example that the encounter is not conditioned on prior faith. Yeshua tells him: “Put your finger here... and do not be unbelieving, but believing” (John 20:27).

Faith is not demanded blindly but is born of sight. When he adds: “Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed” (John 20:29), he is not praising credulity but trust in life even without direct sensory proof. Faith, for Yeshua, is openness toward reality, not adherence to a historical statement. The resurrection is immediately bound to mission and inner transformation: “As the Father has sent me, so I send you” (John 20:21).

It is not a medal for him but a responsibility for the disciples. Yeshua breathes on them and says: “Receive the Holy Spirit” (John 20:22). The resurrection is not only what happened to him but what can begin to happen in the human being: a new life, no longer driven by fear and guilt. On the road to Emmaus, Yeshua does not immediately say that he has risen but explains the Scriptures until they say: “Were not our hearts burning within us while he spoke to us on the road?” (Luke 24:32).

The resurrection is recognized by the life that is kindled in the human being, not imposed as a fact. That is why, even before the cross, Yeshua had said: “I am the resurrection and the life” (John 11:25). Not “I will be,” but “I am.” The resurrection begins as a state of consciousness before it is an event after death. In contrast, the Apostle Paul builds an explicit theology of the resurrection.

For him, the resurrection is the cornerstone of faith: “If Christ has not been raised, your faith is in vain” (1 Corinthians 15:17). The emphasis shifts from the encounter to the objective event. The resurrection becomes the proof that the sacrifice was accepted and that sin and death have been cosmically conquered. “Christ has been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep” (1 Corinthians 15:20).

Paul sees the resurrection as the beginning of a new order of existence, valid for all who are “in Christ,” affirming: “For as in Adam all die, so also in Christ all will be made alive” (1 Corinthians 15:22). He develops the idea of the risen body and the final victory, saying: “Death has been swallowed up in victory” (1 Corinthians 15:54). The resurrection is the foundation of future hope and of present justification.

Yet Paul also preserves an existential dimension when he says: “If you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above” (Colossians 3:1). Here he draws close to Yeshua’s perspective, but the framework remains theological: the resurrection is a reality that you enter through faith and belonging. The difference of emphasis is clear.

Yeshua would want us to see the resurrection as the revelation of the life that cannot be killed, as an invitation to a life without fear, as the beginning of a transformation here and now. Paul would want us to see it as the central event of salvation, as proof that sin and death have been conquered and that future hope is certain. For Yeshua, the question is: why are you still afraid? For Paul, the question becomes: do you believe that Christ has risen? Both perspectives meet, but they are not identical.

Yeshua invites us to sight and peace. Paul invites us to faith and hope. In the spirit of the texts, Yeshua would say that the resurrection is recognized by the life that begins to manifest in the human being, while Paul would say that this new life is possible because the resurrection took place.

Inner Freedom vs. Outer Security

One of the central tensions of Yeshua’s message is the conflict between inner freedom and outer security. People seek security: money, status, rules, protection. Yeshua does not deny this need, but he considers it insufficient and, in the end, deceptive. “Do not worry about your life” (Matthew 6:25) is not a call to irresponsibility but an invitation to change the source of security. Outer security is fragile.

It depends on circumstances, on others, on control. Any loss threatens it. That is why a life built on security is dominated by fear. Yeshua observes that fear does not disappear through accumulation but grows. The more you have to lose, the more you fear. Inner freedom, by contrast, does not depend on circumstances. It appears when the human being is no longer defined by what he can lose.

“Seek first the Kingdom” (Matthew 6:33) is not a religious slogan but a reordering of existential priorities. The Kingdom becomes the inner place from which life is lived, not the reward for a correct life. Yeshua does not promise security. He promises peace. And peace, in his language, is not the absence of conflict but the presence of an inner state that does not waver. “My peace I give to you” (John 14:27) is different from the peace of the world, which is based on control.

Inner freedom does not eliminate risks, but it eliminates the fear that makes them paralyzing.

What Remains When There Is Nothing Left to Defend

The final layer of Yeshua’s message appears when all the mechanisms of defense collapse. When there is no longer an identity to protect, a status to maintain, a rightness to prove, a question arises: what remains? Yeshua does not answer this question theoretically. He lives it. When there is nothing left to defend, the need to control disappears. Comparison disappears. The anxiety of being “someone” disappears.

In this space appears the love that does not negotiate, the truth that does not attack, the presence that does not justify itself. Yeshua calls this space the Kingdom. On the cross, Yeshua does not defend himself, does not explain himself, does not justify himself. “Father, forgive them” (Luke 23:34) is not moral heroism but the expression of the fact that there is no longer a self to be wounded. Not because the pain is not real, but because the identity is no longer built on opposition.

What remains when there is nothing left to defend is not emptiness but true life. A life that is no longer reaction but response. That is no longer defensive but creative. This is the life that Yeshua calls

“abundant” (John 10:10). Not because it has more, but because it no longer needs. At this point, discipleship comes to an end. Not because the road has ended, but because there is no longer a “someone” to walk the road.

What remains is only the life lived from a center that cannot be threatened. The truth requires no justification. When it appears, everything that was built as protection falls away through uselessness, not through violence. The human being has long lived out of tension, confusing vigilance with life and defense with identity. But what is real cannot disappear. When fear withdraws, what remains is not emptiness but simplicity — fullness without effort.

Here, the “I” that is right disappears, and the “others” who are wrong dissolve. Separation is not fought; it becomes unnecessary. Truth does not come to correct but to calm. The lie is not exposed; it is left without a role. Peace does not negotiate with circumstances. In this space, love is not a moral choice; it is the natural movement of unfragmented life. Words become rare, not from prohibition, but because reality is already expressed.

Silence is not an absence of meaning but a supersaturation of meaning. Yeshua no longer appears as a figure or a model, but as transparency. He does not say “follow me.” He says nothing. And precisely for this reason, everything is set in order. The cross is no longer tragedy or sacrifice; it is the point at which there is no longer a self to suffer in order to save itself. What remains is the life that flows, even through pain, without contracting. Forgiveness is not an act; it is the absence of the one who would need not to forgive.

Nothing is held against anyone — not through forgetting, but because nothing is stored anymore. When there is nothing left to defend, there is no longer discipleship, road, or progress. Only what has always been here, before fear. The Kingdom does not come and go; it is recognized. And the recognition makes no noise.

The Scale of Detachment in the Gospels

Yeshua's message is not only about morality, faith, or religious rules. At the heart of his preaching there constantly appears an invitation to detachment. Not to a cold or ascetic detachment, but to a progressive liberation from those things to which the human consciousness clings in order to build its identity, security, and worth.

In contemporary language we might say that Yeshua describes a process of untying attachments, and as each attachment falls away, the human being becomes freer and more capable of love. This movement is gradual. The person does not let go of everything at once. First the attachment to things falls away, then the attachment to security, then to results, to reputation, to possessive relationships, to the egoic identity, and, finally, to the very fear of death.

Seen this way, Yeshua's sometimes radical words are not impossible demands but stages in the maturing of consciousness. The first level of this liberation is detachment from objects and possessions. The human being often lives with the impression that his worth lies in what he owns. But Yeshua breaks this illusion by saying: "Watch out and guard yourselves against all greed for wealth; for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions" (Luke 12:15).

In the same spirit, he warns: "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy and where thieves break in and steal" (Matthew 6:19). The message is not that material things are evil in themselves, but that human identity cannot be built on them. When a person defines himself by what he has, he inevitably becomes a prisoner of the fear of losing. Once the attachment to objects is weakened, the next level of freedom is detachment from the anxiety of material security.

Here it is no longer merely a matter of things but of the constant fear of the future. That is why Yeshua says: "Do not worry about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink, nor about your body, what you will wear" (Matthew 6:25). To illustrate this freedom, he invites people to look at nature: "Look at the birds of the air: they neither sow nor reap

nor gather into barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them” (Matthew 6:26).

At this point, detachment does not mean indifference but the passage from fear to trust. The person begins to live less out of anxiety and more out of openness toward life. An even subtler step appears when the person frees himself from attachment to results. Most people tie their peace of mind to the success or failure of their actions.

But Yeshua invites us to another perspective: “Do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself” (Matthew 6:34). In this statement a profound inner freedom is hidden. The person continues to act, to work, and to create, but he no longer binds his identity to the result. Action becomes the expression of life, not an instrument for obtaining validation.

After these outer levels appears one that is far more powerful: detachment from reputation and the opinion of others. Few things hold human consciousness more captive than the need for social approval. People are willing to sacrifice their authenticity in order to be accepted. That is precisely why Yeshua warns: “Woe to you when all people speak well of you” (Luke 6:26).

He openly criticizes the religious leaders of his time, saying that they “love the places of honor at feasts and greetings in the market-places” (Matthew 23:6–7). At this point, the person begins to detach himself from the social image and to live from an inner center more stable than public opinion. An even deeper level appears when the possessive attachment within relationships falls away. Here appear some of Yeshua’s most radical statements.

He says: “Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me” (Matthew 10:37). In another, even more shocking form, he says: “If anyone comes to me and does not hate his father and his mother... he cannot be my disciple” (Luke 14:26). In the spiritual language of the era, this “hatred” does not describe a negative emotion but a breaking away from identity-based attachment. The relationships remain, but the possessiveness disappears. Love becomes free.

Beyond these layers, the Gospels lead toward an even more radical point: detachment from the egoic self. Here the human being begins to see that his social identity, his roles, and his personal story are not the essence of his being. That is why Yeshua says: “If anyone wants to come after me, let him deny himself” (Matthew 16:24). And he continues with the paradox that stands at the center of his spirituality: “Whoever loses his life for my sake will find it” (Matthew 16:25).

To lose one’s life, in this sense, does not mean physical death but liberation from the egoic identity that the person constantly defends. The final level of this scale is detachment from the fear of death. When this attachment falls away, the human being becomes truly free. Yeshua expresses this freedom by saying of his own life: “No one takes it from me, but I lay it down of my own accord” (John 10:18).

And of his disciples he affirms: “Whoever loves his life will lose it, and whoever hates his life in this world will keep it for life eternal” (John 12:25). At this point, the instinct of self-protection is no longer the center of existence. The human being lives out of truth and love, not out of fear. Seen this way, the Gospels describe a true scale of inner freedom.

First the person detaches from things, then from material security, from results, from reputation, from possessive relationships, from the egoic identity, and, finally, from the fear of death. The paradox is that as these attachments fall away, the person does not become colder or more indifferent. On the contrary, he becomes more present, more free, and more capable of love. Thus, Yeshua’s message is not one of sad renunciation but of a profound liberation of consciousness.

At the heart of the Gospels lies not the loss of life but the discovery of a life that no longer depends on anything external in order to be whole.

“Your Faith Has Saved You” — or the Clarity That Liberates

When Yeshua utters the words “your faith has saved you,” he does not validate a theological formula and does not confirm an intellectual adherence. In the living context of his encounters with people, these words never appear after a doctrinal confession but after an act of inner opening. They do not ratify a correct idea but recognize an inner state in which fear has been suspended and life has been able to flow again.

In the language of the era, the term translated as “faith” did not designate the acceptance of propositions about God. It indicated lived trust, availability, a heart that no longer defends itself. That is why the deeper meaning of the statement is not “you believed rightly” but “you saw clearly.” Salvation is not granted as a prize for correctness; it manifests where clarity dissolves resistance. Where there is no longer defense, life enters.

Each time these words are spoken, they come at the end of an inner movement. The woman who touches the hem of his garment does not present a theology; she dares to step out of shame and fear, and this stepping out liberates her (Mark 5:34). The blind man does not recite a creed; he rises up out of helplessness and asks for sight, and this request places him in truth (Mark 10:52).

The centurion does not argue about the divine nature; he sees clearly the reality of authority and of trust, and this seeing opens the way to his healing (Matthew 8:10). In all these encounters, it is not doctrine that produces life but clarity. That is why Yeshua never says “your faith about me has saved you.” He says “your faith.” The emphasis falls on the state of the one before him, not on the object of faith.

Salvation is not about someone in whom you believe but about the way you cease to defend yourself against truth. The truth is not imposed; it is recognized. And the recognition appears when fear withdraws. This clarity is not a mental effort but a simple seeing. It is the moment when the person ceases to negotiate with the real and lets

himself be touched by it. That is why Yeshua can say: “Do not be afraid; only believe” (Luke 8:50). Fear and clarity cannot coexist.

When fear disappears, faith — in its living sense — appears as a stillness that allows life to manifest. In this sense, “salvation” is not a heavenly verdict but a restoration of the flow. To be saved means to be brought back to wholeness, to be drawn out of fragmentation. “Son, your sins are forgiven” is not a juridical acquittal but a release from the inner tension that was blocking life (Mark 2:5).

Where the burden is lifted, the body straightens, the mind clears, the relationship heals. That is why Yeshua always binds salvation to lived truth, not to affirmation. “The truth will set you free” (John 8:32) does not refer to correct information but to a seeing that liberates. When a person sees without a mask, without calculation, without fear, the truth is no longer something to be demonstrated. It becomes evident. And the evidence brings freedom. This understanding radically changes the message.

Faith is no longer a condition imposed from the outside but a state that appears naturally when resistance disappears. Salvation is no longer deferred into a future but happens now, whenever clarity is allowed to be. “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) does not describe a location but a state of consciousness in which life recognizes itself.

In this framework, the words “your faith has saved you” become a silent recognition of a simple truth: life heals where there is no longer fear. Clarity is not a merit but an availability. And this availability, when it appears, is enough.

The Resurrection of Consciousness

In Christianity, the word “resurrection” is almost always associated exclusively with the historical event of Christ’s resurrection. But if we read the Gospels and Yeshua’s words carefully, we discover that resurrection is not only an external event that took place at a moment in the past or is awaited in an eschatological future. Resurrection is, above

all, a transformation of consciousness. A passage from a state of inner death to a state of life.

Yeshua says directly: “I am the resurrection and the life; whoever believes in me, even if he has died, will live” (John 11:25). But immediately he adds something even more profound: “and everyone who lives and believes in me will never die” (John 11:26). This “will never die” cannot be reduced merely to biological death, since all people continue to die physically. It points to another dimension: inner death — the death of consciousness, of love, of presence.

In this sense, resurrection is the awakening of consciousness from a state of spiritual unconsciousness. The Apostle Paul captures this idea when he says: “Awake, you who sleep, rise from the dead, and Christ will give you light” (Ephesians 5:14). We notice here that “death” is not described as a physical state but as a state of inner sleep. To be dead means to live without consciousness, without love, without presence. It means to be captive in fear, in ego, in resentment.

In this sense, many people are biologically alive but spiritually dead. That is why resurrection is not only a promise for after death. It is an invitation for now. Yeshua says: “Truly, truly, I say to you, the hour is coming, and is now here, when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God; and those who hear it will live” (John 5:25). The phrase “and is now here” is essential. Resurrection is not deferred to the end of history.

It begins at the moment when a person’s consciousness awakens. The problem appears when resurrection is completely externalized. When it is seen only as an event that happened to Christ but has no application in our inner transformation. In this case, the message becomes passive: Christ has risen, and we remain the same. But in the logic of the Gospel, Christ’s resurrection is a model of our transformation.

Paul says explicitly: “We were buried with him through baptism into death, so that, just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life” (Romans 6:4). The purpose is not merely the contemplation of Christ’s resurrection but participation in it. That is why Scripture speaks of a death that precedes

resurrection. “So you also, consider yourselves dead to sin and alive to God in Christ Jesus” (Romans 6:11).

This “death to sin” is not an annihilation of one’s being but a death of the old consciousness. It is the death of fear, of pride, of resentment, of separation. In spiritual language, sin is not merely a moral violation but a state of separation from life. To die to sin means to die to that separated consciousness. That is precisely why Paul says something paradoxical: “Christ, having been raised from the dead, dies no more; death no longer has dominion over him” (Romans 6:9).

But then he applies this principle to believers as well. When a person’s consciousness passes through this inner death and is reborn into a state of love and presence, death no longer holds the same power over him. The fear of death begins to dissolve. That is why the letter to the Hebrews says that Christ came “to deliver all those who, through fear of death, were subject to bondage all their lives” (Hebrews 2:15). True resurrection begins when fear dies.

Fear is one of the most powerful forms of inner death. Fear contracts consciousness, closes it, separates it. Love, by contrast, opens it. That is why the Apostle John says: “There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear” (1 John 4:18). In this sense, resurrection is the passage from fear to love. If we look at things this way, resurrection becomes a reality repeated in a person’s life. It is not only a single moment but a series of inner passages.

Each time an illusion dies and a deeper understanding is born, a small resurrection takes place. Each time resentment dies and compassion appears, a resurrection takes place. Each time the ego dies and humility appears, a resurrection takes place. Yeshua himself speaks of this dynamic when he says: “Unless the grain of wheat that has fallen to the ground dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit” (John 12:24).

This is the paradox of spiritual transformation: new life appears only after something old dies. Without death there is no resurrection. That is why resurrection can appear in any domain of life. A person can have a resurrection in relationships, when he passes from control to love. He

can have a resurrection in thinking, when he passes from rigidity to understanding. He can have a resurrection in the heart, when he passes from resentment to forgiveness. Every authentic transformation is, in a certain sense, a resurrection.

In spiritual language, this is transcendence. Not in the sense of escaping from the world, but of surpassing the previous level of consciousness. The Apostle Paul describes this reality in a poetic way: “If you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above... for you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God” (Colossians 3:1–3). To die and to rise are no longer here biological events but states of consciousness.

In this sense, the true question is not only whether Christ has risen. The question is whether his resurrection produces a resurrection in us as well. Whether fear dies and love appears. Whether separation dies and compassion appears. Whether unconsciousness dies and presence appears. For true resurrection is not only an event from the past. It is a continual awakening of consciousness. A passage, again and again, from death to life. As the Gospel says: “We know that we have passed from death to life, because we love the brothers” (1 John 3:14). And where love appears, death already begins to lose its power.

14. The Redeemed Person

What the Redeemed Person Looks Like from Yeshua's Perspective

In ordinary religious language, salvation is often described as a change of status: a person was lost, and then is declared saved. But when we read the Gospels closely, we discover that Yeshua speaks of salvation in a far deeper, far more existential way. For him, salvation is not merely a legal verdict in heaven, but a real transformation of a person's way of being. It is not only a promise for the future, but a change of consciousness in the present.

This is why he says of those who follow him: "I have come that the sheep may have life, and have it abundantly" (John 10:10). Salvation is life lived with an intensity and clarity that surpass fear, separation, and defensiveness. From Yeshua's perspective, the redeemed person is one who sees. He is not defined first of all by a doctrinal belief, but by a change of perception. This is why Yeshua says: "Blessed are your eyes, for they see" (Matthew 13:16).

This seeing is not intellectual but existential. The redeemed person sees reality without the filters of fear and religious identity. He no longer lives from the need to defend himself or to prove that he is right. He begins to perceive the world from an inner space of freedom. This is why Yeshua says: "You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free" (John 8:32).

The freedom he speaks of is not social or political freedom, but an inner freedom from the lies that have structured human consciousness.

This freedom shows itself in the way a person relates to others. The redeemed person no longer lives by moral hierarchies. He no longer sorts the world into superior and inferior people, into clean and unclean, into the worthy and the unworthy. He sees the same life in every person.

This is why Yeshua says: "Love your enemies, bless those who curse you" (Matthew 5:44). Such a statement would be impossible for a person still living out of fear or defensive identity. To love one's enemy is not a moral feat, but the expression of a consciousness that no longer perceives the world through separation. In the same spirit, the redeemed person no longer lives by judgment. Judgment is the mechanism by which the ego confirms its own superiority.

But Yeshua says: "Do not judge, so that you will not be judged" (Matthew 7:1). He does not forbid discernment; he dismantles the inner reflex by which a person builds his identity by pointing out the faults of others. The redeemed person sees human fragility without positioning himself above it. He recognizes in others the same struggle he himself has known. Another characteristic of the redeemed person is the absence of fear. Fear is the basic structure of the consciousness of separation.

It makes a person defend himself, accumulate, control. But Yeshua says again and again: "Do not be afraid" (Matthew 10:31). For the person who lives in this state of trust, life is no longer a constant struggle for psychological survival. He lives in a deep trust in the divine reality that sustains existence. This is why Yeshua says: "Look at the birds of the air... your heavenly Father feeds them" (Matthew 6:26).

This image is not an invitation to passivity, but to liberation from the fundamental anxiety that dominates ordinary consciousness. The redeemed person is also a person of presence. He no longer lives fragmented between past and future. Fear and regret lose their power over him. This is why Yeshua says: "Do not be anxious about tomorrow" (Matthew 6:34). This statement does not deny responsibility; it shows that real life can be lived only in the present.

The person who has come out of the anxiety of the future becomes able to be truly present for others. This inner state produces a special

kind of power. It is not the power of domination, but the power of presence. Yeshua says of those who live in this reality: “Whoever believes in me will also do the works that I do” (John 14:12). Power does not come from control, but from the deep alignment of a life with its source.

This is why the redeemed person becomes a presence that heals, calms, and transforms the space he enters. In this light, the salvation Yeshua describes bears a striking resemblance to what the contemplative traditions call enlightenment. It is not an accumulation of knowledge, but an awakening of consciousness. It is the moment when a person sees reality without the filter of fear and separation. He does not become morally perfect, but he becomes transparent to the life that flows through him.

This is why Yeshua says: “If your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light” (Matthew 6:22). Light is not a poetic metaphor, but the description of a consciousness that is no longer fragmented. In the end, the redeemed person, from Yeshua’s perspective, is one who lives from the same source from which he himself lived. He is not defined by religion, by identity, or by spiritual status. He is defined by the life that flows freely through him.

This is why Yeshua says: “Abide in me, and I in you... whoever abides in me bears much fruit” (John 15:4–5). The fruit is the true sign of salvation. Not the declaration, not the belonging, not the ideology. Thus salvation is not only being saved from something, but awakening to something. It is the passage from a consciousness dominated by fear to a consciousness that lives from love, truth, and freedom. It is what Yeshua calls “abundant life.”

And the person who lives this life becomes, without trying, a light for others: “You are the light of the world... let your light shine before others” (Matthew 5:14–16). In him, salvation is no longer a theological promise, but a living reality.

Healing

Healing is not a secondary or decorative element, but one of the living cores of Yeshua's message and work. He does not merely speak about God; he makes God visible through the concrete restoration of life. When Yeshua appears, the Kingdom is not described through concepts, but through people who recover their bodies, their minds, and their dignity. "Yeshua went throughout all Galilee... healing every disease and every affliction" (Matthew 4:23).

The healings are not an appendix to the preaching; they are part of the preaching. The Kingdom is seen in the body, in the psyche, and in relationships. When the disciples of John the Baptist ask whether he is the one they have been waiting for, Yeshua does not answer with a theological definition, but with an observable reality: "The blind see, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear" (Matthew 11:5). This is his language about God: life restored. Illness is not presented as divine punishment, nor as a spiritual test. Yeshua explicitly rejects this logic when he says of the man born blind: "Neither this man sinned, nor his parents" (John 9:3). The world is wounded, and the presence of God is seen in the healing of this wound, not in its justification. Yeshua's healings are not only physical. He touches the body—"immediately the leprosy left him" (Mark 1:42)—but also the psyche, as seen in the man who, after being delivered, is "clothed and in his right mind" (Mark 5:15).

He restores social relationships, reintegrating the excluded, and gives identity back to the shamed: the bent-over woman becomes a "daughter of Abraham" (Luke 13:16). Even guilt and shame are healed when he says to the accused woman: "Neither do I condemn you" (John 8:11). For Yeshua, healing means becoming whole. It is significant that the same Greek word, *sōzō*, is used both for "to save" and for "to heal."

When Yeshua says, "Your faith has healed you" (Mark 5:34), he is not speaking about doctrinal correctness, but about a relational openness that allows restoration. To be saved means to be brought to wholeness. When he sends out his disciples, the mandate is clear and direct: "Heal

the sick... and tell them: The Kingdom of God has come near to you" (Luke 10:9). The healing precedes the explanation. They are not asked to formulate a doctrine, but to restore life.

This shows that, for Yeshua, healing is not a charismatic exception, but the normal state of the Kingdom. In Paul, healing exists, but it is no longer the center of gravity. He acknowledges "gifts of healing" (1 Corinthians 12:9), yet he places them within a list of charisms, alongside others. The emphasis shifts toward justification, salvation through faith, the cross and the resurrection, the building up of the community.

It is telling that Paul does not promise universal healing, nor does he consider it the principal sign of God's presence. He speaks of his own "thorn in the flesh," which is not removed, and the answer he receives is: "My grace is sufficient for you" (2 Corinthians 12:9). Suffering begins to be reinterpreted as a pedagogical space, not necessarily as a reality that must be healed. As Christianity becomes institutionalized, this shift deepens.

Healing moves away from the center, and the emphasis falls more and more on sin and guilt, on post-mortem salvation, on doctrine and morality. Suffering is often spiritualized: a "cross to bear," "the will of God," a "test of faith." Healing is postponed to the afterlife. The body becomes secondary, and the present world becomes a place to be endured rather than restored.

Even where healing reappears in some modern currents, it is often turned into spectacle, technique, or proof of faith. Sometimes the absence of healing becomes guilt: "you were not healed because you did not believe enough." Such a logic would be foreign to Yeshua, who heals without setting conditions, without moralizing, and without turning suffering into an examination.

In Yeshua, healing is the principal sign of the Kingdom already present, and salvation is the making whole of the person here and now. In Paul, healing remains possible, but becomes one of the gifts, while the center shifts toward the cross and grace. In later Christianity, healing becomes marginal or conditional, suffering is normalized and some-

times sacralized, and the afterlife becomes the dominant concern. For Yeshua, healing is not a spiritual bonus.

It is the proof that God is present. Where life is restored, where a person recovers his body, his mind, and his dignity, there the Kingdom already is. Yeshua did not come to explain suffering. He came to heal it.

The Change of Perspective: The Quiet Method by Which Yeshua Transforms a Person

One of the most subtle and profound characteristics of Yeshua's teaching is that he almost never tries to correct people's behavior directly. We do not see him offering long lists of rules, moral codes, or techniques of personal discipline. Although he speaks about actions—about loving, forgiving, not judging—the way he frames these exhortations shows that he does not treat behavior as the fundamental problem.

For Yeshua, the problem is not what a person does, but how a person sees reality. This is why he first changes the perspective, knowing that when the perspective changes, behavior changes almost inevitably. One of the clearest examples appears in the Sermon on the Mount. Instead of simply saying “do not do this” or “do not do that,” Yeshua shifts attention from the behavior to the inner state out of which the behavior arises.

He says: “You have heard that it was said to those of old, ‘You shall not murder.’ But I say to you that anyone who is angry with his brother will be liable to judgment” (Matthew 5:21-22). Similarly, he continues: “You have heard that it was said, ‘You shall not commit adultery.’ But I say to you that anyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in his heart” (Matthew 5:27-28).

In these statements, the point is not to make moral rules stricter, but to show that the action is only the surface of an inner process. Yeshua moves the center of attention from the outside to the inside. He suggests that the real problem is not the act itself, but the perspective from which a person looks at life and at others. The same logic appears when he speaks about judging others.

Instead of simply saying “do not judge,” he creates an image that completely changes the way a person sees the situation: “Why do you see the speck in your brother’s eye, but do not notice the log in your own eye?” (Matthew 7:3). Through this metaphor, Yeshua does not try to correct the behavior of criticizing directly. He changes the perspective on one’s own limitation. When a person sees his own “log,” the need to judge disappears of itself. The behavior is transformed without coercion.

This method is also visible in the way he relates to sinners. In the episode of the woman caught in adultery, the people around her are focused on applying a rule: “In the Law, Moses commanded us to stone such women” (John 8:5). Yeshua does not begin a legal debate about the law. He changes the perspective of those present with a single sentence: “Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone at her” (John 8:7).

In that moment, the perspective shifts from the woman’s wrong to the awareness of one’s own wrongs. The result is immediate: the people leave one by one. Their behavior changes, but not because they were given a new rule—rather because they saw reality from a different angle. Similarly, when Yeshua speaks about love for one’s enemies, he does not offer a difficult moral technique that people must apply through effort.

He changes the perspective on God and on the world: “Love your enemies... so that you may be sons of your Father who is in heaven; for he makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good” (Matthew 5:44-45). Through this image, Yeshua introduces a radically different perspective: reality is not organized around merit, but around a divine generosity that includes everyone.

When a person sees the world this way, love for one’s enemies no longer appears as an impossible obligation, but as a natural consequence of a new understanding of reality. The same strategy appears in the parables. Each time, Yeshua does not offer rules; he changes the way people perceive life.

In the parable of the prodigal son, the emphasis does not fall on the son's wrong behavior, but on the perspective of the father who receives him back: "While he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion; he ran, fell on his neck, and kissed him" (Luke 15:20). Through this image, Yeshua radically changes the perspective on God. If God is a father who runs toward his lost son, then fear, shame, and defensiveness become useless.

A person's behavior is transformed not through coercion, but through the discovery of a reality greater than his guilt. This approach also explains why Yeshua speaks so often about "seeing." He says: "The eye is the lamp of the body. If your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light" (Matthew 6:22). Here the "eye" is not just the physical organ of sight, but the way a person perceives reality. If the perspective is clear, life becomes clear.

If the perspective is dark, all of existence becomes confused. Yeshua does not try to regulate every action a person takes, but to heal the "eye" through which a person looks at the world. In this light it becomes clear why Yeshua says: "You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free" (John 8:32). He does not say that rules will set you free, nor that moral discipline will set you free.

Freedom appears when the perspective changes, when a person sees reality as it is. From that new perspective, behavior reorganizes itself spontaneously. Therefore, Yeshua's method is not one of moral control, but of transformation of consciousness. He does not try to repair the fruit of a sick tree; he heals the root. This is why he says: "The good tree bears good fruit, but the bad tree bears bad fruit" (Matthew 7:17). If the tree becomes good, the fruit will become good without effort.

This is one of the most profound insights of the Gospels: behavior is only the visible expression of an invisible perspective. And Yeshua always works at the level of that perspective. He changes the way a person sees God, himself, and others. And when this seeing changes, the whole of life begins to transform almost inevitably.

What Is “Abundance” in Yeshua?

Abundance, in Yeshua’s language, is not accumulation, but fullness. It does not mean “more”; it means “whole.” It is not about having, but about being. “Abundant life” is not life without suffering, but life without inner separation. Yeshua lives this abundance even in lack. He has no material security, no stable social status, no political power.

And yet he says: “The Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head” (Matthew 8:20). Even so, he is alive, present, free, unafraid. His abundance does not come from what he possesses, but from the fact that he is not fragmented. “Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven” (Matthew 5:3). This “poverty” is not lack, but openness. It is the absence of false identities, of rigid attachments, of the fear of loss. Out of this emptying, abundance arises.

What Would People’s Lives Have Looked Like, Lived According to Yeshua’s Definition of Abundance?

Life lived in abundance, according to Yeshua, would have been a life not driven by fear. “Do not be afraid” (Matthew 10:31). It would have been a life in which a person is defined not by what he gathers, but by how present he is. “Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” (Matthew 6:21). It would have been a life in which relationships are not transactions, but real encounters.

“Love one another as I have loved you” (John 13:34). A life in which a person does not constantly defend himself, does not obsessively justify himself, does not live by comparison. “Do not judge, so that you will not be judged” (Matthew 7:1). Abundance would have meant the capacity to feel deeply without fleeing, to lose without losing yourself, to give without exhausting yourself.

“Whoever loses his life for my sake will gain it” (Matthew 16:25). This is not a call to masochistic sacrifice, but to the abandonment of the false identity that lives out of fear.

The Shepherd and True Life

“I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep” (John 10:11). To lay down one’s life does not mean only physical death, but total exposure, the absence of any mask, living in truth. Yeshua does not save the sheep from life; he leads them into life. He does not protect them from reality; he teaches them to live it without separation. “I am the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6). Abundant life is not a future reward, but a present state.

It is life lived from the center, from truth, from the heart. Not a controlled life, but a contained one. So when Yeshua says that he came so that people might have abundant life, he is not promising comfort, success, or security. He is promising true life. Life lived, not mimicked. Life felt, not postponed. People are called “sheep” not because they should remain so, but because they can be led from wandering to awakening. Abundance is not the destination, but the consequence of a life lived in truth.

What Would the World Look Like If We Were All Like Yeshua?

I have asked myself this question many times, and no one has yet managed to refute my theory that in a world of people like Yeshua there would no longer be any hospitals, doctors, judges, or police. The hospitals would not disappear because we closed them, but because the suffering that makes them necessary would be transformed. The police would not disappear because we no longer need order, but because order would become natural.

Yeshua did not come to reform the exterior, but to heal the root: “The Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21). Where a person is healed within, the outer structures are no longer mechanisms of control, but become simple expressions of a harmony that already exists. In such a world, hospitals would become spaces of care, not of crisis.

For illness, to a large extent, is the expression of an inner imbalance, and a person who lives in truth, in presence, and in love no longer

generates the same ruptures between body, mind, and soul. “Those who are well have no need of a physician, but those who are sick” (Matthew 9:12)—but in a world where consciousness is whole, illness is no longer the norm, but the rare exception. Medicine would no longer be a fight against the symptom, but a support for harmony.

The police, the courts, and the prosecutors would no longer function as instruments of coercion, because evil would no longer spring from within the person. Yeshua says: “Out of the heart come evil thoughts, murders, adulteries...” (Matthew 15:19). If the heart is pure, behavior naturally becomes right. “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God” (Matthew 5:8). In a world of people who see, there is no longer any need for laws to punish blindness.

Justice would no longer be a system of sanction, but a living consciousness, shared by all. But this would not mean a sterile world, devoid of expression. On the contrary. Music would not disappear—it would become deeper. Art would not disappear—it would become more authentic. Creativity would not be fueled by trauma, but by fullness. Today, much of what we call art is the cry of an uncomprehended pain. In a world like Yeshua’s, art would be revelation rather than discharge.

“Out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaks” (Matthew 12:34). If the heart is full of life, creation becomes the expression of life, not of lack. Painting would no longer be merely interpretation, but participation. Music would no longer be merely emotion, but resonance. Art would no longer seek validation, but would flow naturally, the way light flows through a stained-glass window. Not in order to impress, but because it cannot help but express itself. What happens to competition? It would not disappear entirely, but it would be radically transformed.

It would no longer be competition born of lack, of the desire to be “more than the other,” but play. A celebration of potential. “Whoever wants to be the greatest among you must be the servant of all” (Mark 10:44). This changes everything. You no longer compete in order to dominate, but in order to express yourself fully and to inspire. Sport would remain, but without the tension of the ego. It would become dance, not war.

In such a world, success would no longer mean rising above others, but aligning yourself with what you are. Failure would no longer be shame, but feedback. No one would need to prove anything anymore, because worth would no longer be negotiated. And perhaps most important: relationships would no longer be emotional transactions. No one would love in order to receive. “Love your enemies... so that you may be sons of your Father” (Matthew 5:44-45).

In a world like Yeshua’s, love would no longer be a strategy, but a nature. There would no longer be any “discard,” because no one would live in blindness anymore. Seeing would become the norm. In the end, the question “Would there still be hospitals, police, competition?” is in fact a question about the level of consciousness from which we live. Yeshua did not describe a different world through rules, but through people. A world in which people are healed within does not need to be controlled from without.

For when a person sees—truly sees—he can no longer wound. And when he no longer wounds, the world no longer needs to be defended against him.

What Would a Social System Truly Inspired by Yeshua Look Like?

If we tried to imagine a politics truly inspired by Yeshua’s logic, the first thing that would have to be understood is that he did not come to propose a political system. Every time he was pushed in this direction, he shifted the center of gravity from the outside to the inside: “My Kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36). Not because it has no impact on the world, but because it has its origin not in structures, but in consciousness.

Any social system that tries to apply Yeshua’s principles without the transformation of the person inevitably becomes a caricature—rules without life, morality without presence. In such a politics, power would no longer be defined as domination, but as responsibility. Yeshua says explicitly: “You know that the rulers of the nations lord it over them...

but it shall not be so among you. Rather, whoever would be great among you must be your servant” (Matthew 20:25-26).

This completely overturns the current paradigm. The leader is no longer the one who accumulates control, but the one who reduces suffering. He is no longer the one who imposes, but the one who supports. Power becomes the capacity to contain, not to constrain. I believe that a social system inspired by Yeshua would not function on the basis of fear and sanction, but on the basis of consciousness and inner responsibility. Law would not disappear, but its role would be transformed.

Yeshua does not deny the law—“I have not come to abolish the Law, but to fulfill it” (Matthew 5:17)—but he moves its purpose from the outside to the inside. Law is no longer an instrument for controlling behavior, but a mirror that shows where a person is not yet free. In a mature society, law would become less and less necessary, because people would no longer act out of unconscious impulses. Justice, in this logic, would no longer be centered on punishment, but on restoration.

Yeshua refuses to condemn the woman caught in adultery and says: “Let him who is without sin among you be the first to throw a stone” (John 8:7), and then: “Neither do I condemn you; go, and sin no more” (John 8:11). Here we see a justice that does not ignore responsibility, but that also does not reduce a person to his mistake. The system would no longer sustain cycles of guilt and punishment, but would create the conditions for real transformation.

The economy would undergo, perhaps, the most profound transformation. Instead of being built on accumulation and the fear of lack, it would be built on trust and sufficiency. “You cannot serve God and Mammon” (Matthew 6:24)—this statement is not only spiritual, but deeply social. A society driven by the fear of tomorrow will inevitably produce inequality and destructive competition.

By contrast, Yeshua points to another way of living: “Look at the birds of the air... your heavenly Father feeds them” (Matthew 6:26). Not as an invitation to passivity, but as the foundation of an economy without chronic anxiety. The distribution of resources would no longer

be a field of ideological battle, but a natural expression of consciousness. In the early communities inspired by this logic, “no one claimed that his possessions were his own, but they held everything in common” (Acts 4:32).

Not through coercion, but through inner transformation. Where there is no longer any rigid attachment to possession, generosity becomes spontaneous. The relationship between groups—whether ethnic, political, or cultural—would also be radically different. Yeshua says: “Love your enemies... do good to those who hate you” (Matthew 5:44). This is not a diplomatic strategy, but a paradigm shift. Instead of polarization, there arises the capacity to see beyond differences.

Conflict would no longer be fueled by rigid identities, but would become an opportunity for deeper understanding. Such a system would not eliminate the diversity of opinions or the tensions inherent in a living society, but it would change the way they are handled. Not through escalation, but through presence. “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called sons of God” (Matthew 5:9). Politics would no longer be the art of manipulating perception, but the art of reconciliation.

And yet the most important change would not be visible in institutions, but in people. For Yeshua never believed that you can create a just world with people who are inwardly unresolved. “How can you say to your brother, ‘Let me take the speck out of your eye,’ when you do not see the log in your own eye?” (Matthew 7:4). A politics inspired by Yeshua would begin not with external reforms, but with inner responsibility. In the end, such a system could not be imposed.

For that would contradict its very essence. It could only emerge, organically, from a sufficient number of people who live differently. “You will know them by their fruits” (Matthew 7:16). Not by ideologies, not by promises, but by the real effect on life. A politics inspired by Yeshua is not a program. It is the consequence of a humanity that has finally learned to see.

Yeshua and Awakening Through Relationship

Yeshua's message is not built around a technique for calming the mind, nor around a method of meditation or inner withdrawal. Constantly, he shifts attention away from the isolated interior of the individual toward the space between people, toward relationship. This is why, when he speaks of the Kingdom of God, he does not describe it as a solitary state of mental quiet, but as a reality that appears when people are transformed in the way they relate to one another.

He says: "The Kingdom of God is within you" (Luke 17:21), but immediately he shows that this Kingdom manifests itself in the way people forgive, are reconciled, and love one another. This orientation becomes very clear in the Sermon on the Mount. Instead of saying that a person must withdraw into himself in order to find peace, Yeshua places the emphasis on reconciliation. He affirms that authentic spirituality cannot exist alongside a rupture between people.

This is why he says: "If you bring your gift to the altar and there you remember that your brother has something against you, leave your gift there before the altar, go first and be reconciled with your brother, and then come and offer your gift" (Matthew 5:23–24). It is an extraordinary passage, because it moves the center of the spiritual life from ritual to relationship. God is not honored by religious gestures if the heart remains separated from one's neighbor.

Through this radical inversion, Yeshua completely changes the religious paradigm. In most spiritual traditions, transformation is presented as an inner process: a person withdraws, meditates, purifies himself, and arrives at peace. Yeshua, however, suggests that true transformation appears when a person learns to love and to forgive. He goes so far as to say: "Love your enemies, bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you" (Matthew 5:44).

This is not a meditation technique, but a revolution of the heart. It is not an invitation to quiet introspection, but to a profound change in the way a person responds to conflict and to pain. This is why, in Yeshua's message, spiritual awakening is not isolated. It does not take place in a

cave, in a state of solitary contemplation, but in the midst of human relationships. A person discovers the truth about himself not merely by sitting alone, but above all when he is confronted with the other.

In relationship, pride, fear, the need for control, and the desire for personal vindication rise to the surface. It is precisely there, in that tense space between two consciousnesses, that the possibility of transformation appears. This is why Yeshua says: “By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another” (John 13:35). Spiritual identity is given not by doctrine, nor by ritual, but by the capacity to love.

This perspective also explains why many of Yeshua’s parables are built around relationships: father and son, brother and brother, master and servant, Samaritan and stranger. In all these stories, what is at stake is not intellectual knowledge or mystical experience, but the transformation of the heart in relation to the other. In the parable of the good Samaritan, for example, the question is not who has the correct faith, but who was a neighbor to the wounded man.

Yeshua overturns the religious logic and shows that truth is verified in compassion. Seen from this perspective, Yeshua’s spirituality is profoundly relational. It does not begin with the stillness of the mind, but with the heart’s willingness to forgive and to love. Instead of seeking a state of personal peace, a person is called to enter into a dynamic of reconciliation.

It is precisely for this reason that, for Yeshua, the Kingdom of God is not an inner refuge, but a reality that manifests itself in community, in the way people treat one another. At this point one of the greatest tensions in the history of Christianity appears. If we read Paul’s writings, we notice that the emphasis shifts from relational transformation toward faith, doctrine, and theological justification.

While Yeshua speaks about forgiveness, reconciliation, and the love of enemies, Paul speaks about faith, grace, and salvation through faith in Christ. This is not necessarily an absolute contradiction, but it is a significant shift of emphasis: from the transformed relationship to the correct faith.

It is precisely here, between these two different emphases, that one of the greatest ruptures in the history of Christianity is born, and one of the most important questions for any reader of the Gospels: what did Yeshua really want to transform first—the human mind, or the human heart in relation to others?

I spent a few years of my life studying filmmaking in Hollywood, between 2015 and 2019. Thousands of hours in which I did not merely watch films, but dissected them, understood their structure, felt their rhythm, and, above all, wrote. Screenplay after screenplay. Stories that tried to work. Some succeeded. Others did not. But beyond technique, beyond dialogue, framing, and lighting, I discovered a simple and profound truth: all good films have something in common.

It is not just about conflict. It is not just about the transformation of the protagonist. It is not even about the final success. It is about what happens after. After the last confrontation. After the apparent victory or defeat. After the resolution of the external conflict. There is one more scene. A quiet scene, sometimes subtle, sometimes explicit, but absolutely essential: the scene in which a relationship is restored. Someone returns home. Someone forgives.

Someone is seen for the first time. Someone finally allows himself to love. This is, in fact, the true resolution of a film. Because a human being is not built for performance, but for relationship. And without this last scene, however spectacular the journey may have been, the story remains incomplete. Surprisingly—or perhaps not surprisingly at all—Yeshua does exactly the same thing. His entire work is not about religion. It is not about rules.

It is not about building an institution. It is about restoring relationships. Every time he enters a story, Yeshua does not leave without repairing something invisible but fundamental: the connection. He does not heal only bodies. He heals ruptures. When he meets the tax collector despised by everyone, he does not offer him only a moral direction, but gives him back his dignity in relationship: “Today salvation has come to this house” (Luke 19:9).

He does not say only that the man has changed, but that his relationship with life, with others, and with God has been restored. When he speaks about forgiveness, he does not do so as an ethical obligation, but as a relational liberation: “Forgive, and you will be forgiven” (Luke 6:37). For where there is no forgiveness, there is no relationship. There is only distance in disguise.

When he touches the leper—the person completely excluded from society—he does not perform only an act of physical healing, but one of reintegration: he brings him back into the relational fabric of the community. “I am willing; be cleansed!” (Matthew 8:3). In that “I am willing” there is not only power, but acceptance. And perhaps the most profound image of this restoration is in the parable of the prodigal son.

It is not the moment when the son acknowledges his mistake that is the climax, but the moment when the father runs toward him and embraces him before he can finish his confession: “For this son of mine was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found” (Luke 15:24). This is the final scene. Not the moral return. Not the correction of behavior. But the restoration of the relationship. Exactly as in a good film.

And perhaps this is one of the most misunderstood truths about salvation: it is not about becoming “correct,” but about being reconnected. The relationship with yourself—where you no longer reject yourself. The relationship with others—where you no longer operate out of fear or control. The relationship with the “enemy”—where separation begins to dissolve. The relationship with God—where there is no longer any distance, but presence.

For “the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21), and this Kingdom is not a place, but a state of unfragmented connection. The film industry taught me the structure of a story. Yeshua taught me its meaning. However complex the conflict, however dramatic the journey, however high or low the protagonist may rise or fall—the story is not complete until the relationship is restored.

And perhaps this is the real question, not only for films but for life: With whom are you still in conflict, within or without? And what would

it mean if the final scene were not your victory... but your reconnection? Because, in the consciousness of God, the story never ends with who is right. It ends with who returns into relationship.

Would the World Have Been More “Like Jesus” Without Christianity?

Looking at history, Christianity has played a profoundly ambivalent role. On the one hand, it kept the memory of Yeshua alive, transmitted his name, his words, his parables, carried his story from generation to generation. On the other hand, the same Christianity has, over time, justified wars, violence, domination, exclusion, and power exercised in his name. Yeshua said clearly: “My Kingdom is not of this world” (John 18:36).

And yet institutional Christianity has often tried to turn Yeshua into a banner, into a symbol of mobilization, into a group identity rather than a way of being. At many moments in history, religion has represented Yeshua without resembling him. It is precisely this rupture that the warning speaks of: “They say, but do not do” (Matthew 23:3).

It is possible that, without Christianity as an institution, Yeshua’s message would have remained smaller in scope, more limited geographically and historically, but purer in expression. It is equally possible that, without a form, without structure, and without organized transmission, the message would have been lost entirely. History offers no simple answer, and this tension remains open. Yeshua did not come to create a religion, but to awaken the person.

He did not call people to adhere to a system, but to enter into a new life. What we call the “Great Commission” is not, in essence, about religious expansion, but about the multiplication of a life lived in truth. “Greater things” does not mean the glorification of an individual or the consolidation of an institution, but continuity, maturation, and the extension of the same state of consciousness in different people. The apostles, in this key, are not guardians of dogma, but bearers of life.

They transmit what they live, not merely what they affirm. Christianity, in its historical form, has been a vehicle: sometimes faithful to the original message, sometimes distorting it. Sometimes transparent, sometimes opaque. The message is not the problem; the problem is the way it has been frozen, defended, instrumentalized. So Yeshua did not want a world full of “Christians.” He wanted a world full of living people. “I have come that the sheep may have life, and have it abundantly” (John 10:10).

Resemblance to Yeshua does not depend on the existence of Christianity as an institution, but on how many people live from the same heart from which he lived. It is not the label that brings the world closer to Yeshua, but the life that flows from the inside out—free, alive, and true.